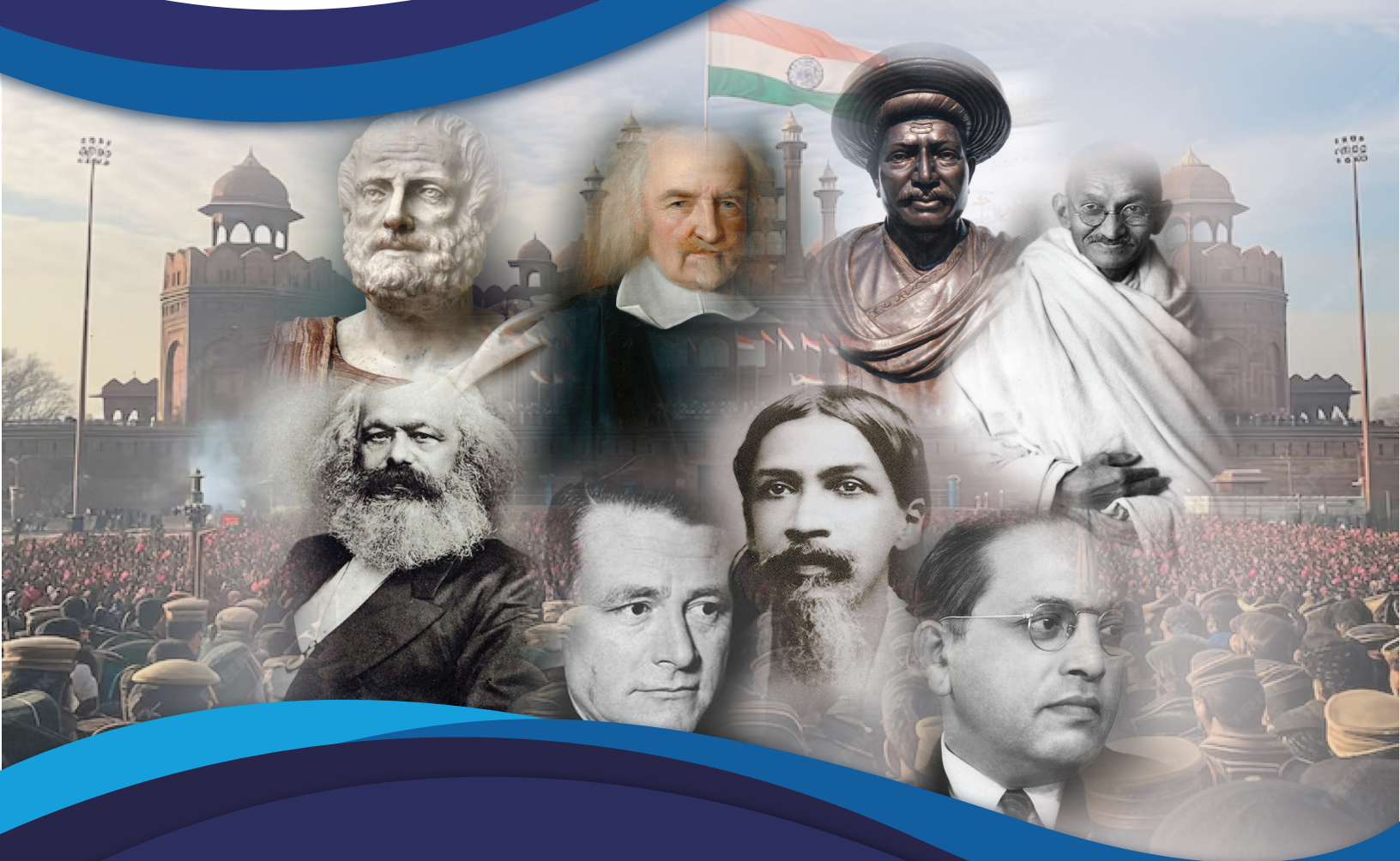


POLITICAL SCIENCE *and* International Relations



Paper 1, Part A

Political Theory and Thought



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UNIT 1: POLITICAL THEORY- MEANING AND APPROACHES

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ◉ Examine the importance of behavioural approach in political theory. What led to its decline? (2021)
- ◉ Discuss the significance of normative approach to political theory. (2020)
- ◉ Comment on: Resurgence of political theory. (2019)
- ◉ Comment on: Decline of political theory. (2018)
- ◉ Comment on: The Post-Behavioural Approach. (2016)
- ◉ Comment on: "...political theory is not an escape mechanism but an arduous calling." (John Plamanatz) (2014)

◉ Its evolution is generally traced from the tradition of thoughts from Plato to Marx.

◉ A critical evaluation of political belief and attempts to clarify and refine the concepts employed in political discourse.

◉ According to David Easton, political science could adopt the methodology of natural sciences.

2.

POLITICAL THEORY VERSUS POLITICAL SCIENCE

1. WHAT IS POLITICAL THEORY?

According to **George Catlin**, "Political theory includes Political Science and political philosophy, where science is concerned with means while philosophy is concerned with the end."

Whereas **John Plamenatz** defines it as, "Analysis of political vocabulary and critical examination, verification, and justification of political arguments".

MEANING OF THE TERM "POLITICAL":

The term "Political" is derived from the word "polis" which literally means the city. It is a place with the common world described as a community. Politics is hence related to the management of the community. It involves decision making within and about the community.

POLITICAL THEORY	POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY	POLITICAL SCIENCE
◉ Political theory involves the analytical study of ideas and concepts that are central to political thought.	◉ It is a branch of learning primarily concerned with the moral and substantive dimension of politics. It is the search for wisdom and understanding.	◉ Political science is essentially empirical. It tries to describe, analyze, and explain government and other political institutions in an impartial manner.

POLITICAL THEORY	POLITICAL SCIENCE
◉ It is not only concerned about the behavioural study of the political phenomena from empirical point of view but also about prescribing the goals which states, governments, societies, and citizens ought to pursue. ◉ Political theory also aims to generalize about the right conduct in political life and about the legitimate use of power. ◉ According to David Held, in absence of political theory and its systematic pursuit, there is a danger of politics being left to the ignorant.	◉ Political science is much more comprehensive and includes different forms of speculation in politics such as political thought, political theory, political philosophy, political ideology, law, and organizations etc. ◉ Political science is concerned with describing and explaining the realities of political behaviour, generalizations about man and political institutions on empirical evidence, and the role of power in society.

3.

SIGNIFICANCE OF POLITICAL THEORY AND POLITICAL SCIENCE

Clarity about these reflections enables us to understand social and political problems. Scientific analysis enables us to understand and solve these problems while political philosophy guides us towards betterment.

The tradition of Political theory has encouraged an order of dignified debate between proponents of opposing thoughts. The two branches of Political Theory i.e., science and philosophy together perform the task of description, criticism, and reconstruction of ideas/concepts.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE OF POLITICAL THEORY

The understanding of Political theory has become more important in the present-day world order facing challenges such as Poverty, population corruption, injustice, Conflict. The important work of Political Theory is to deeply study and analyse these problems and provide alternative means to the political leaders.

4.

EVOLUTION OF POLITICAL THEORY

As **Andrew Hacker** says, *political theory is a never-ending debate between the theorists*. The spatial and temporal impact on the thought process has led to the seamless evolution of western political thought from the ancient Greek philosophers to current times.

- **Ancient Greek Philosophers:** The ultimate aim of having a good life filled with knowledge led them to believe in the utility and virtue of the state. During ancient times, the Greeks developed critical thinking and the **method of dialectics**. Both **Plato and Aristotle**, considered the **state as a source of virtue** and natural institution maintaining equality and justice though they differed in the conception of state and king.
- **Medieval times:** political science was a sub-discipline of the religious authority of church. The divine rights theory of kingship provided unhindered powers to the ruling class to rule.
- **Renaissance Movement:** It accorded central importance to human life. And scientific revolution brought in fundamental changes in the western political thought.

- **Machiavelli:** He developed the realist approach towards political science. In his *"The Prince"*, he separated politics from ethics and religion.
- **Thomas Hobbes, Descartes:** They used principles of science to understand political questions. Utilitarianism made human pleasure the foundation of political decision-making and revolutionized western political thought.
- **Social contract:** Locke and Rousseau gave the concept of **popular sovereignty** to different degrees and focused on **human cooperation** which ultimately gave rise to modern liberal democratic political thought.
- **Pre-Marxist socialism:** In wake of widening of gap between rich and poor, socialists like Charles Fourier, Saint Simon and Robert Owen appealed for arresting growth of inequality.
- **Karl Marx:** He criticized the bourgeois dominance over the economic class and gave a class-based understanding of politics. His dialectic materialism countered dialectic idealism of Hegel and declared ideology as false consciousness and necessity of revolution for absolute quality and justice.

In contemporary times, we also see rise of political theories like Welfare state, Rawlsian idea of justice, neoliberal theory, etc.

Hence, the political theory, since its inception has seen changes in scale, scope, methodology, and teleology. The classical thinkers emphasized on knowledge, laid more emphasis on order, stability and harmony in the social life, and tried to provide a prescription of a perfect life.

On the other hand, the modern thinkers took the political inquiry nearer to science, facts, objectivity and focused on what the reality is rather than what it is supposed to be.

5.

APPROACHES TO STUDY POLITICAL THEORY

In Political Science, **Vernon Van Dyke** considers approach as defining criteria for selecting problems, reliable data, and appropriate procedures for utilizing them to arrive at conclusion. For instance, behavioural approach and normative approach.

TRADITIONAL APPROACH	CONTEMPORARY APPROACH
➤ Broadly the traditional approaches are dominated by the study of philosophy, law, history, and institutions. ➤ The traditional approach largely remained normative. ➤ Rawls theory of justice, though contemporary, belongs to the normative approach.	➤ The contemporary approach, the focus is on the behaviour of different actors in politics. ➤ The beginning can be traced to end of WW-II as Political science faced crisis of identity and relevance. ➤ In order to bring political science at par with other Social Sciences, political scientists give prominence to the empirical approach. ➤ Aristotle's comparative analysis of constitution and understanding of revolution.

NORMATIVE APPROACH	EMPIRICAL APPROACH
➤ The normative approach focuses on values and prescribes the preference for a particular type of order as dictated by morality to achieve "what ought to be" (what should be). ➤ Ex- In the theory of justice, a normative approach defines what the meaning of justice is. ➤ Criticism: Morality can be subjective so there can be many definitions of Justice. So, it is subject to a biased understanding.	➤ The empirical approach seeks to discover and describe the facts. It relies on observation through sensory experience to describe "what is?". ➤ Ex- The empirical analysis will give a detailed account of voting behaviour in a particular election. ➤ Criticism: It only describes a particular phenomenon and does not give any value judgment or plan of action. According to Robert Dahl, in politics, not deciding is simply deciding to allow others to decide for you.

Despite having pros and cons, both are important for the study of political science there is an urgent need to build a bridge between the two.

6.

SIGNIFICANCE OF A NORMATIVE APPROACH TO POLITICAL THEORY

- **Isaiah Berlin** defines the normative approach as the discovery and application of moral notions in the sphere of political relations and practice.
- A **Minimalist normative approach** formulates minimum standards of ideas and norms and a **maximalist normative approach formulates ideal standards** which no phenomenon could achieve.
- By making ideas like **justice and equality** an end in itself, the normative approach always strives to derive a **perfect order of peace and prosperity**. Without a normative approach, society and polity run the risk of **visionless directions** and conflicts that could end the very existence of these institutions.
- The normative approach faced decline post WW-II with advent of Behavioural Revolution. However, in recent times there has been the resurgence of normative approach in **Macpherson's theory of democracy**, **Rawls theory of justice** and also in writings of **Dworkin**, **Amartya Sen**, etc.

Daryl Glasser says, *"Engagement with normative theory proceeds from the hope that moral actors who debate their options in an open and self-conscious way will, on the whole, do fewer of the things most of us would consider bad than those who proceed unreflectively or suppress moral debate."*

7.

TRADITIONAL APPROACHES

PHILOSOPHICAL APPROACH	HISTORICAL APPROACH
➤ The philosophical method has its roots in classical Greece. It also goes by the name of political philosophy. This tradition is credited to Plato as its founder. Most classical political theory uses a philosophical	➤ Since the beginning, the thinkers have regarded history as the primary source of analysis. ➤ Main exponent- Machiavelli (adopted historical approach), Montesquieu, etc.

approach to represent normative orientation. - It follows a deductive method that begins with an assumption and goes on to establish it through logical reasoning. - Ex- Plato's Republic, Rawls' theory of Justice - Criticism: Utopian, Biased and Unrealistic.	- Sir John Seeley regarded history as past politics and politics as present history. - Criticism: Ernst Baker and David Easton criticize historical approaches as inadequate to guide or resolve the present problems (difference of times). Moreover, any political theory is not only the product of history.
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LEGAL APPROACH	INSTITUTIONAL APPROACH
- The legal approach is concerned with the study of constitutional law and legal institutions. - Cicero, Jean Bodin, Austin, Grotius, Bentham, A.V. Dicey (Law of the Constitution) etc. are the chief propagators of this approach. - The method is largely descriptive and institutional and is guided by logic and reason rather than facts and events. - Criticism: It is inadequate in understanding complex political processes and behaviour outside legal framework.	- Its roots lie in Aristotle's study of multiple constitutions where he classifies the constitutions of Greek City States. - It studies the structure and function of the government and its organs as well as political parties. Its methodology is descriptive and institutional. - Scholars: James Brice, Laski, and G.A. Almond - Criticism: No wide-reaching theory can be constructed from this approach as it is descriptive and cannot be applied to the situations in developing countries.

CONTEMPORARY APPROACHES

With the rapid growth of natural Sciences, efforts were taken to develop Political Science as a distinct discipline in the United States. The efforts of the **American Political Science Association** established an autonomous discipline in Political Science taking it away from History, Philosophy, Economy and Law and closer to Sociology, Anthropology, etc.

8. DECLINE OF POLITICAL THEORY

During the mid-20th century, the exponent of political science began to question the relevance of traditional political theory. **David Easton** in his work *"Political System: An enquiry into the state of political science"* (1953) asserted that the traditional political theory was devoid of observation. It could not explain the political reality.

Easton opined that- to lay the foundation of science in the study of politics it became **necessary to rescue it from the study of classics and history**. He also pointed out that there was **no outstanding political philosopher after Marx and J. S. Mill**.

During the Second World War, theorists of all the other Social Sciences were actively involved in the process and decision making while political scientists remained at back footing.

David Easton provided four reasons for decline:

Historicism	Less relevance to resolve contemporary issues
Moral Relativism	Relativistic attitude of Weber and Hume Non-subjection of values to critical analysis.
Confusion between science and theory	The scholars confused science with theory and forgot that theory goes beyond science.
Hyper-factualism	Problem of over-factualization and under-theorization.

Dante Germino (book- *Beyond Ideology the Revival of Political Theory*) gave two reasons for decline of political theory viz. craze of science (positivism) and culmination of ideological evolution into Marxism.

9. BEHAVIOURAL APPROACH

The origin can be traced to the works of **Graham Wallas** (*Human nature in Politics*) and **Arthur Bentley** (*The process of government*) where they laid emphasis on the process of politics than on political institutions.

- **Graham Wallas** insisted on exploring facts and evidence to understand human nature and its manifestation in human behaviour. The political process could be understood only by analysing how people actually behaved in Political situations, not merely by speculating how they should behave.
- **Charles E. Merriam** (*New Aspects of Politics*) criticized Political Science for its lack of scientific vigour. He criticized historians for ignoring the role of psychological sociological and economic factors in human affairs.
- **G.E.G. Catlin** (*Science and Method of Politics*) advanced the case for value-free science. He considered power as an essence of politics and its analysis should not be inclined in favour of any particular value system.
- **David Easton** In his article "*Decline of modern Political Theory*" attributes poverty of theory in discipline to preoccupation with the past and failure in taking up the task of building a systematic theory of Political behaviour.
- David Easton summed up the intellectual foundation of behaviouralism in his paper "*The Current meaning of behaviouralism in Political Science*" in 1967. He describes **8 major tenets or intellectual foundations** of behaviouralism:

Regularities	Verification	Technique	Quantification
Values	Systemization	Pure science	Integration

The works of **Robert Dahl**, **Phillip Converse**, and **David Easton** shifted the focus on studying political behaviour rather than the institution or interpretation of the legal text. Thus, Behaviouralists shifted the focus in the study of politics from Formalism and normative orientations of legalistic and philosophical schools to political behaviour.

Contemporary Relevance

Behaviouralism focused on micro-level situations rather than micro-level generalizations. It relied on questions that could be answered on the basis of the methods available.

They were used to analyse mass political participation, voting behaviour, elite decision making and activities of nonstate actors to come up with systemic explanations.

10. DECLINE OF BEHAVIOURALISM AND RESURGENCE OF POST-BEHAVIOURALISM

The behavioural approach widened the scope of political science and talent traditional vertical analysis. However, it has been **criticized for mindless empiricism**. Behaviouralists tend to study only those phenomena that are easily observable and can be analysed rather than focusing on what is actually important. **Karl Popper rejected the narrow inductive approach of scientific methodology.**

CONTEXT

- In 1960s, the US witnessed political upheavals. Political class was looking at the academicians to suggest a way forward, means how to deal with crisis.
- Unfortunately, political scholars were clueless as there work was of little significance and they were primarily focussing on studies related to electoral behaviour.
- Easton acknowledge that political science is once again in the state of decline for which Behaviouralists were responsible. The behaviouralists were engaged in research that was of limited relevance. They had nothing to offer to address the contemporary issues.

David Easton held that political scholars were sitting in Ivory Towers, perfecting their techniques. They fail to understand the purpose for which technique is to be used. So he gave the Creative Theory with two features- action and relevance.

11. RESURGENCE OF POLITICAL THEORY

- John Plamanatz stated, "Political theory is not an escape mechanism but an arduous calling".
- Dante Germino criticized behaviouralism for "over quantification and under theorizing".

➤ Critics like **Leo Strauss** argued that the rise of behaviouralism was symptomatic of a crisis in Political Theory because of its inability to deal with normative issues. Sheldon Wolin accuses behaviourists of abdicating their true vocation.

➤ **Rawls (*Theory for Justice*)** is being credited for resurgence of political theory.

In 1969, **David Easton** himself in his presidential address American political science Association announced a new revolution in Political Science, i.e., **Post behavioural revolution**.

A. WHAT IS POST-BEHAVIOURAL REVOLUTION?

➤ Post-behaviouralism represented a shift from strictly methodological issues to greater concern with public responsibilities of the discipline and political problems.

➤ David Easton gave twin slogans of post behaviouralism "**credo of relevance and action**". He also gave **seven features** of post-behaviouralism.

➤ It was not a complete departure from Behaviouralism rather it stood for building upon the gains of behaviouralism and utilising it for problem solving. Thus, it shifted the nature of political science from **pure science to applied science**.

➤ Post behaviouralism succeeded in resolving the **fact-value dichotomy**.

➤ If normative **Political Philosophy** is **thesis** and **Behaviouralism anti-thesis**, **Post-behaviouralism** exemplifies **synthesis**.

B. SEVEN FEATUERES OF POST-BEHAVIOURALSIM

Political Science should not be value-free.

Substance must have precedence over technique.

Political Scientists must protect humane values of civilization.

Emphasis should be on social change and not social preservation.

Political Science should not lose touch with brute realities of politics.

Urgent need to politicise the profession.

Post-behaviouralism emphasises action in place of contemplative science.

Isaiah Berlin: He says that political theory is neither dead nor in the state of decline. He says that there cannot be an age without political philosophy. Berlin argued that as long as rational curiosity existed political theory would not die nor disappear.

George H. Sabine: He opined that "**if political theory is systematic, disciplined investigation of political problems, then it is difficult to say that political theory was dead in the 1950s and 1960s.**"

12.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE

Political science is alive and very much relevant to contemporary concerns. It is a discipline with widening frontiers.

➤ **Hannah Arendt** stressed on the uniqueness and responsibility of human being in her book "**Human Condition**". She has criticized behaviouralism and highlighted **unique human role of acting in concert**. Her thoughts on totalitarianism, power and modern democracy revive Normative Political Theory.

➤ In 1974, **Robert Nozick** wrote "**Anarchy, State and Utopia**" and rejuvenated political theory. This rejuvenation has been a return to the true tradition of the classics in which normative analysis uses empirical findings.

➤ **The Macpherson's theory of democracy** is not an end in itself with more focus on procedures but tries to devise an idea of democracy to enhance creative freedom of citizens.

New Themes Evolved During the Resurgence of Political Theory: Communitarianism, Post-modernism, Multiculturalism, Feminism and Environmentalism.

UNIT 2: THEORIES OF STATE

*"Political Science begins and ends with state".
(Prof. James Wilford Garner)*

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ▶ Examine the liberal theory of State in contemporary politics. (2023)
- ▶ Factors like community, culture and nation weaken the hegemony of neo-liberalism today. Discuss. (2022)
- ▶ Feminist critique of the State. Comment. (2021 & 2016)
- ▶ Pluralist theory of the State. Comment. (2019)
- ▶ Critically examine the neo-liberal theory of State. (2018 & 2017)
- ▶ Post-colonial theory of the state. (2020 & 2011)
- ▶ Examine the conception of the State in the ideologies of Fascism and Marxism. (2014)
- ▶ What is meant by 'relative autonomy' of State in Marxist analysis? (2012)
- ▶ Evaluate Marx's instrumentalist approach to the State. (2010)

1.

INTRODUCTION

- ▶ According to **Raymond G. Gettel**, "Of all social institutions the state has been the most universal and most powerful. Some form of organisation and authority has been found wherever human life has existed, and a sanction of some kind has enforced some sort of rules."

Thus, in the process of human development, right from ancient Greek times till present times, there have been attempts to investigate the institution of the state.

- ▶ Therefore, **Gettel** defines political science as '**the science of the state**'. It is study of the state in the past, present and future, of political organization and political function, of political institutions and political theories.

2.

EVOLUTION OF THE CONCEPT OF THE STATE

The evolution of the concept of the state in political thought reflects changing philosophical, historical, and social contexts. Brief overview is as follows:

- ▶ **Ancient Greece:** For Greek idealists, the state (polis) was a natural institution essential for social life. It was seen as an organic and ethical entity, existing for the promotion of a good life.
- ▶ **Medieval Europe:** In medieval times, the state became closely associated with kingship, often viewed as deriving its authority from divine right.
- ▶ **Social Contract Theory:** Social contract theorists, such as Thomas Hobbes, John Locke, and Jean-Jacques Rousseau, introduced a mechanistic view of the state. It means state is a product of a social contract among individuals, created to secure their natural rights and promote common interests.
- ▶ **Modern Concept:** In modern political thought, particularly influenced by Max Weber, the state is defined by its monopoly over the legitimate use of physical force for maintaining order within a territory.
- ▶ **Post Modern Times (Post WW-II):** Rise of transnational or supranational system of governance like European Union. However, 2008 Financial Crisis and Brexit reflect reversal of trend and going back to era of Nation State.

Therefore, the concept of the state has evolved from being seen as a natural and organic entity to a more contractual and institutional one, reflecting changing ideas about the nature of political authority and governance.

Gettel: *"The state is a gradual and natural historic evolution. It is neither the gift of divine power nor the deliberate work of man. Its beginnings are lost in that shadow of past in which social institutions were consciously arising, and its development has followed the general laws of growth."*

3. CRITERIA OF STATEHOOD

The accepted criteria of statehood were laid down in the **Montevideo Convention** (1933), which provided that a state must possess–

1. A permanent population
2. A defined territory,
3. A government, and
4. Sovereignty or capacity to conduct international relations.

Among these, **sovereignty** is the **most important feature** and was recognised as essential element in **Treaty of Westphalia**.

4. THEORIES OF SOVEREIGNTY OF STATE

Jean Bodin defines sovereignty as “supreme power over citizens and subjects, unrestrained by law.” Sovereignty is the most distinctive feature of the modern state.

- In **Medieval times**, there was no clarity whether Church is sovereign, or state is sovereign.
- In **Modern times, Treaty of Westphalia (1648)** made it clear that sovereignty lies with the state and state is a territorial entity. Thus, state remains a supreme authority to make and enforce laws.
- The concept of sovereignty has 2 dimensions– Internal and External.
 - **Internal**– Within a particular territory, state made laws will prevail and no other institution will compete with the state.
 - **External**– State will not be controlled or governed by any external authority.

Quote by Hugo Grotius: “*Sovereignty is the supreme political power vested in him, whose acts are not subject to any other and whose will cannot be overridden.*”

A. MONISTIC THEORY OF STATE SOVEREIGNTY

Context: Medieval chaotic situation and feudalism.

Contribution of Hobbes (Book– Leviathan):

For establishing clear supremacy of the state and giving complete theory of state sovereignty, Hobbes is regarded as the first modern thinker.

Hobbes established that–

1. Law is command of sovereign. He rejected both religious and natural laws as “law”.
2. He also held that there can only be one sovereign.

Contribution of John Austin (Book– Lectures on Jurisprudence):

“If a determinate human superior, not in the habit of obedience to a like superior, receive habitual obedience from the bulk of a given society, that determinate superior is sovereign in that society, and that society (including the superior) is a society political and independent.”

He asserted that sovereignty lies with the state and sovereignty is **absolute, permanent, and indivisible**.

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE THEORY

It ended the prevailing confusion of medieval times. Thus, it put an end to the chaos and established the law-and-order situation.

Further, the theory created a conducive environment for rise of capitalism. In present times as well, the Monistic Theory is followed largely.

B. PLURALISTIC THEORY OF STATE SOVERIGNTY

Context: Need of avoiding WW-I and WW-2 like situation as monistic nation state system is war prone because monistic state does not have regard for international laws. With emergence of international laws post WW-II, there was realisation of the **need to limit power of the state** and promote **human rights**.

Thus, Pluralism is a feature of liberalism, and it stands for a limited state.

a. FEATURES OF THE PLURALISTIC THEORY

- **Legal Fiction:** The pluralistic theory calls monistic theory as a legal fiction. This is because–
 - **Externally** state’s choice is limited by other actors and its relations with them and
 - **Internally** sovereignty is limited by various organisations and associations.
- **Diluting the Authority:** The state is not the only institution that fulfils the needs of man and hence the state alone must not have the authority to make laws.

For example, India being a multicultural society, has not adopted **Uniform Civil Code** and recognises religion as a possible source of law.

- **Main Function:** The main function of the state is resolution of conflicts among various competing interests and association.

Thus, the pluralist scholars wanted to dilute sovereignty of state and suggested to give importance to international laws and other institutions.

b. WHY IS MONISTIC THEORY NOT DESIRABLE?

It concentrates too much power in the hands of the states, there is a fear of state becoming autocratic (anti-democratic). It is threat to international peace.

In context of this, **Harold Laski** emerged as a major critic of the Monistic Theory of state.

HAROLD LASKI (BOOK- AUTHORITY IN THE MODERN STATE)

Laski was a supporter of international laws, peace, and human rights. He held Monistic Theory responsible for wars as it disregards the international laws.

- He opines that it is an **impossible misadventure** to find and locate the sovereign in federal state.
- He argues that allegiance to various associations is partial and proportional to their contribution.
- He even goes on to say, "it would be of lasting benefit to political science is the whole concept of sovereignty were surrendered."
- State is a man-made institution (and not a natural entity). Man has created other institutions as well for promotion of his interests.

PROBLEM IN LASKI'S IDEAS:

On one hand he is sceptical with respect to the power exercised by the state. So, he wants to limit the powers. Hence, he says that "Since society is federal, authority should also be federal."

At the same time, he realizes the importance of the state and is forced to accept that the state is the **keystone of the social architecture**.

R.M. MACIVER (BOOK- POLITICAL PLURALISM)

Extreme pluralists, like MacIver, do not give any primacy to the state. For them state is just one of the associations.

- **MacIver's Concept of Service State:** MacIver suggested that- "state commands because it serves". By that, he means that state deserves the respect only when it fulfils the useful functions.

- **State is guardian as well as child:** According to MacIver, state is both the guardian of law and the child of law. By this, he means that state's purpose is to maintain law and order and at the same time, state is also under the law. State cannot exercise arbitrary powers. State powers are limited (similar to the concept of rule of law).

- **Meaning of General Will:** According to MacIver, "the general will is not the will of the state but will of the people for the state". It means the concept is misunderstood as if state enjoys ultimate powers. It is people's wish, which is expressed through the general will. State itself has to abide by the will of the people.

Laski (A moderate pluralist)	MacIver (An extreme pluralist)
➤ State is an association but also a keystone of social architecture. Its position is more important than other associations.	➤ Like any other association, state is also an association. ➤ Other associations like kingship or church existed prior to the state and they did not depend on the state for their existence.

c. CRITICAL EVALUATION OF PLURALIST THEORY

- **Realistic explanation:** In the age of federalism and growth of multiple associations like UN, ICJ, EU, etc., we cannot accept the monistic view that law is just the command of sovereign. Thus, monistic theory is relevant for jurists and lawyers. It is a legal fiction. On the other hand, pluralistic theory is sociological and political explanation.
- **Inconsistency in ideas:** The pluralists are against the **monist state**, but they do not eliminate the state (this is also the major difference in anarchists and pluralists). It is said that pluralists want to keep the cake and have it too.
- **Acemoglu and Robinson (Book- The Narrow Corridor)** argue that it is not advisable to give too much power to the state as socio-cultural norms also keep people disciplined. They coined the term- "**shackled leviathan**" to depict the state of affairs wherein the power is balanced between the society and the state.

- **Elitist thinkers:** Scholars like Mosca, Pareto, etc. reject pluralism and believe that behind the façade of liberal democracy there lies the **permanent power of "ruling elite"**.

Thus, even when pluralism is inconsistent it does not mean it is irrelevant. Consistency is not the most important requirement of a sound theory. Pluralism is more relevant because it is more realistic and more conducive for international peace and human rights.

5.

THEORIES OF STATE

A. LIBERAL THEORY OF STATE

Mainstream political theory is dominated by the liberal theory of the state. This theory emerged out of the writings of social-contract theorists such as **Hobbes and Locke**.

The liberal theory of the state focuses on **individual freedoms, limited government, and rule of law**. The state is a **neutral arbiter** among competing groups and individuals in society. It is an 'umpire' or 'referee', capable of protecting each citizen from the encroachment of his or her fellow citizens.

LIBERAL CONCEPTION OF THE STATE: MACHIAVELLI TO MILL

Niccolo Machiavelli and Jean Bodin: Machiavelli and Bodin were among the first to articulate new concerns about the state, examining its origins, foundations, relationship with society, functions, and whose interests it should represent.

THOMAS HOBBS (1588-1642)

- **State as Solution to Human Nature:** Hobbes, in his work "Leviathan," analysed the state as a necessary solution to the natural condition of humans, which he described as a "war of all against all." In the state of nature, life is "nasty, brutish, and short."
- **Absolute State:** Hobbes proposed the creation of an absolute state through a social contract, where individuals surrender their rights to a powerful authority to maintain order and protect property. This state is legitimate and represents the sum total of individual consent.

JOHN LOCKE (1632-1704)

- **State as Protector of Natural Rights:** Locke rejected the idea of an absolute sovereign and argued that the state exists to protect the natural rights of life, liberty, and property.

- **Limited Government:** Locke's state is an instrument for protecting citizens' rights, not a dominant force over them, marking a significant departure from Hobbes' absolute state.

JOHN STUART MILL (1806-1873)

- **Democracy and Individual Liberty:** Mill advocated for representative democracy as an end in itself, emphasizing the harmonious development of individuals and the protection of individual liberty.
- **Representative Democracy:** Mill proposed a representative democracy to ensure individual satisfaction and free development, while also regulating the limits of societal power over individuals.

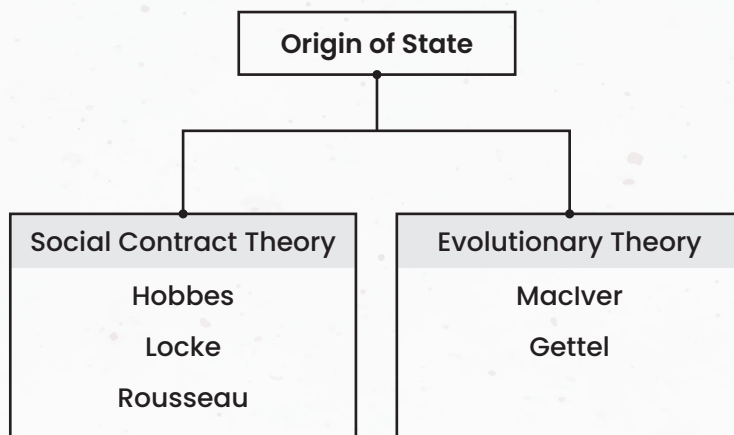
ROUSSEAU (1712-1778)

Direct Democracy: Rousseau championed the model of direct democracy and rejected the idea of transferring sovereignty through consent or elections. In his "Social Contract," he argued that the state arises from a **collective agreement** to overcome the obstacles to human preservation. This social contract establishes a law-making body where individuals directly participate in governance, ensuring laws reflect the **"general will" or collective interest**.

These scholars collectively shaped the liberal conception of the state, evolving from early concerns about state foundations and functions, through Hobbes' emphasis on order and absolute power, to Locke's focus on natural rights and limited government, to Mill's advocacy for democracy and Rousseau's idea of direct democracy.

THEORIES: ORIGIN OF STATE

As far as origin of the state is concerned, there are two types of theories: **Social Contract Theory and Evolutionary Theory**.



a. SOCIAL CONTRACT THEORY

Social-contract theory has been used not only to explain why orderly and civilized existence is impossible in the absence of government, but also to advance a theory of the nature of state power.

Origin of State: The theory argues that the state is result of the voluntary agreement between the citizens i.e., state is a man-made institution.

Purpose of state: The state acts in the interests of all and represents what can be called the 'common good' or 'public interest'. Thus, state is an instrument of utility.

Opposition to Idealistic and Divine Theories:

- ▶ The Social Contract Theory counters the **Idealistic Theory** which suggests that state is **natural** (organic theory of state) and state is priority over man. (**Aristotle- Man is by nature a political animal.**)
- ▶ It also opposes Theory of Divine Origin of State (i.e., state is representative of God).

b. EVOLUTIONARY THEORY

MacIver and Gettel (also known as pluralists) try to limit the powers of the state. MacIver argues that state has been the result of multiple associations like kingship, village, church, etc.

(**Note:** The theory has been discussed in detail earlier in this chapter.)

FUNCTIONS OF STATE

Classical Liberals (Adam Smith and Bentham) and **Neoliberals** (Hayek, Nozick and Friedman) support a minimal or night-watchman state.

Modern or Social Liberals: They are also called as supporters of welfare state.

Laski: He suggests that state should make an arrangement for social and economic rights.

TH Green: State should provide positive liberty (i.e., capacity building of the people).

They also include Contemporary Positive Liberals MacPherson, Rawls, Amartya Sen, Dworkin. They favoured affirmative action policies.

(**Note:** Details are provided in Justice Unit.)

B. MARXIST THEORY OF STATE

ORIGIN: **Frederick Engels (Book- The Origin of the Family, Private Property and State)** mentions that the state is neither a natural organisation (organic theory) nor a manifestation of will of the people (mechanistic theory). Marx and Engels provide a class perspective on the state.

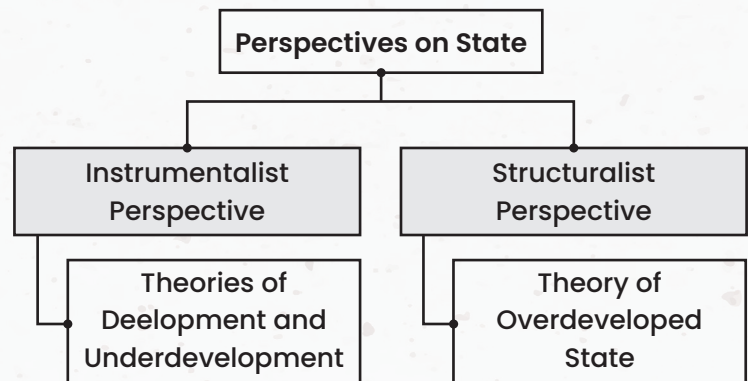
Class Perspective on State: According to the **Class Theory**, the state arises when society splits into two antagonistic classes: one owning the means of production and the other living on its labour. The emergence of private property creates this division. Those who own the means of production gain the power to dominate the other class, not just economically but in all aspects of life.

Lack of independent existence: For Marx, state is an institution of superstructure, and it is conditioned by the substructure or base i.e., economic structure of society. Thus, it does not have any independent existence as it is controlled by the capitalist class.

Thus, in Marxism, the state is an instrument in the hands of dominant class and perpetuates the exploitation of the working or dependent class.

Engels- "The state is, as a rule, the state of the most powerful, economically dominant class which, through the medium of the state, becomes also the politically dominant class and thus acquires new means of holding down and exploiting the oppressed class."

DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVES ON STATE WITHIN MARXISM:



a. INSTRUMENTALIST PERSPECTIVE

Instrumentalist Theory of the State: In his work *The State in Capitalist Society* (1969), Ralph Miliband studied the post-capitalist societies and argued that the state is invariably an instrument of class power. He argues for the unity between state power and class power (similar to Classical Marxist Position).

Marxist notion: According to Marx, the class which controls the base or basic structure controls the elements of superstructure. Thus, state acts as an instrument of the bourgeoisie class.

Perpetuation of Class Character: Miliband contends that the class character of the capitalist state is perpetuated by several factors:

- The middle or upper-class background of state officials.
- The economic power of the capitalist class.
- The inherent desire of politicians and bureaucrats to maintain the existing economic system on which their own positions depend.

Lenin (Book- The State and Revolution (1917): "According to Marx, the State is an organ of class rule, an organ for the oppression of one class by another, it is the creation of 'order', which legalizes and perpetuates this oppression by moderating the conflict between the classes."

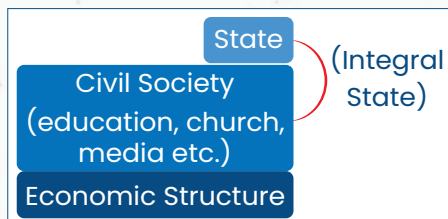
b. STRUCTURALIST PERSPECTIVE

It is also known as Relative Autonomy Theory of state. It believes that superstructure in itself is a structure, and its role cannot be ignored.

The origin of this concept can be traced to the work of Marx (The Eighteenth Brumaire of Louis Bonaparte). In this book, Marx gives the concept of Bonapartist State (state is not an instrument, rather there can be a situation where state becomes more powerful and acts as an equilibrium maker/ relatively neutral arbiter between the classes).

NEO-MARXIST VIEW ON STATE

Antonio Gramsci, a neo-Marxist, introduced the concept of the state's relative autonomy in the



Marxism. He introduced a clear distinction between distinguished between two levels of superstructure:

political society (which includes coercive structures and uses force for domination), and **civil society**, (which includes legitimating structures like family, school and church and it relies on consent).

These institutions instil respect to ruling class, **creating hegemony and legitimizing bourgeois rule**. The stability of capitalist society depends on the effectiveness of civil society. Coercion by political society is only necessary when civil society fails to prevent dissent.

NICOS POULANTZAS (BOOK- POLITICAL POWER AND SOCIAL CLASSES, 1973)

Structuralist Theory of the State: Poulantzas' structuralist theory of the state distinguishes between the position of the capitalist class and state power. He argues for the relative autonomy of the state, suggesting that class domination does not automatically translate into state power, and the state cannot simply be regarded as an instrument of a class.

Legitimacy of the State: Poulantzas believes the state enhances its legitimacy by invoking the authority of "the people," while the capitalist class boosts its legitimacy by distancing itself from state repression.

Role and Function of the State: The state's relative autonomy helps improve its economic performance and promotes capitalist interests. He views the state as an arena of class struggle, rejecting Miliband's concept of the unity of class and state power.

ALTHUSSER'S CONTRIBUTION

Althusser provides a multi-structural perspective (presence of multiple structures) and believes that power belongs to the state.

The state acts through two institutions or apparatuses i.e., **ideological state apparatus and coercive state apparatus**.

RALPH MILIBAND AND NICOS POULANTZAS: DEBATE

Context: After facing challenges from Marxism, capitalist states adopted a more humane approach and evolved into **welfare states**. Miliband and Poulantzas studied these post-capitalist states to understand their nature and determine whether they act in the interest of the poor.

Miliband's conclusion: Miliband arrived at the conclusion that the state still is an instrument of capitalist class as economic power remains concentrated in the hands of few.

Reasons:

- Miliband found that state and bureaucracy are dominated by the economically dominant class.
- He calls **Managerial Revolution** as a myth because managerial class is primarily from capitalist or upper class as management education is unaffordable for the poor people.

THE MANAGERIAL REVOLUTION (CONCEPT GIVEN BY JAMES BURNHAM): As per the theory, there has been a shift of power from capitalists into hands of managers. Managers can be from any background, even from working class.

Oxfam Report and Thomas Picketty's Capital in 21st Century highlight the glaring inequalities in the society.

POULANTZAS' OBSERVATIONS:

His arguments are based on the theory of Relative Autonomy. He calls the post-capitalist states as relatively autonomous as the state acts in the interests of both poor and rich (capitalists).

For instance, in response to labour movements and protests, states have enacted laws like minimum wage and collective bargaining rights, even when these measures conflict with business interests.

The competitive party system demands that the political programs of political parties must cater to the needs of all the classes in order to remain in power.

However, Poulantzas call the state as relatively autonomous because in the crisis situations the state supports only the dominant class.

C. THEORY OF DEVELOPMENT AND UNDERDEVELOPMENT

The Instrumentalist Approach, developed by Latin American and African Marxist scholars such as **A.G. Frank and Samir Amin**. It offers a critical analysis of the ongoing effects of colonialism in Third World countries, which have transitioned into a **state of neocolonialism**. This approach suggests that despite political independence, these countries remain economically and politically controlled by Western powers.

Exploitation by MNCs: Multinational corporations from Western countries exploit the resources and labour of Third World nations, continuing the colonial pattern of wealth extraction.

Development of Underdevelopment: The flow of wealth from poor to rich countries persists, exacerbating poverty and underdevelopment in the Global South. Thus, instead of progressing, these countries experience increasing poverty.

Class Division of States: Scholars argue that capitalism as a global system creates a hierarchy among nations, similar to class divisions within societies. States are categorized into:

➤ **Core (Metropolis, Rich State):** Advanced industrial economies of the North that benefit from global capitalism.

➤ **Periphery (Satellite, Poor State):** Developing countries of the South that are dependent on and exploited by core countries.

Lack of Autonomy in Developing States: From this perspective, states in developing countries are not truly autonomous or sovereign. Instead, they function as puppet regimes serving the interests of the capitalist class in core countries.

An example is **the Saudi Monarchy**, which is seen as a client regime of the USA, prioritizing American interests over its own people's needs.

The Instrumentalist Approach highlights the persistence of colonial structures in a neocolonial guise. This exploitation and dependency contribute to the continuing poverty and underdevelopment in these regions, **challenging the notion of true sovereignty and independence**.

NOAM CHOMSKY'S CONTRIBUTION

American intellectual Noam Chomsky extends this analysis by highlighting that the state in **the USA acts as an instrument of its capitalist class**. The state in USA had gone to war (e.g., Vietnam, Iraq, Afghanistan) to protect capitalist interests. This dynamic reinforces the subservient position of states in the Global South, perpetuating poverty and dependency.

C. THEORY OF POST-COLONIAL STATE

WHAT ARE POST-COLONIAL STATES?

These are the states which had **colonial past** and they continue to **inherit the colonial legacy** such as administrative structures, legal frameworks, etc. Such states are known as Countries of the South or Third World Countries or Developing Countries.

Ex- India, Pakistan, Myanmar, South Africa, etc.

Frantz Fanon: "The history of all developing countries, which have put an end to colonization, is a history of decolonization."

KEY FEATURES OF POST-COLONIAL STATES:

➤ Post-colonial states often see the persistence of power structures established during colonial rule.

- State formation in post-colonial societies is complex, involving struggles for independence, new border formations, and the integration of diverse ethnic groups. (ex- Sri Lanka)
- Many post-colonial states face economic challenges due to colonial-era resource exploitation.
- Neocolonial economic arrangements (Neocolonialism) often involve control over resources by powerful countries or corporations.
- Post-colonial states often face developmental challenges related to infrastructure, education, healthcare, etc.

a. EDWARD SAID'S CONCEPT OF ORIENTALISM

Edward Said's "**Orientalism**" (1978) explains how Western societies have depicted the Orient (East) in a biased way to justify their rule and dominance. He argues that Orientalism created a **distorted and negative image of the Orient**, portraying it as backward and irrational, which made Western imperialism and colonialism seem necessary and beneficial. This biased view was spread through Western literature, art, media, and scholarship, making the West appear superior and rational.

Said showed that these cultural representations were manipulated to maintain **Western hegemony** over Eastern societies. Through his analysis, Said highlights the power dynamics in knowledge production and questions the neutrality of Western academic and cultural discourse.

Edward Said: "Every single empire in its official discourse has said that it is not like all the others that its circumstances are special, that it has a mission to enlighten, civilize, bring order and democracy, and that it uses force only as a last resort."

Gayatri Chakravorty Spivak: She emphasized that Orientalist narratives frequently marginalized and silenced the voices of the very people they aimed to represent. Spivak famously posed the question, "**Can the subaltern speak?**"

Franz Fanon (Book- The Wretched of the Earth): "When a colonialist speaks of the 'development' of the 'backward' countries, what he means is that the exploitation of [those countries] has reached new heights now."

Middle East Region through the American Lens: American media coverage of the Middle East often emphasizes conflict, terrorism, and veiled women, reinforcing Orientalist stereotypes. These portrayals shape public opinion and influence foreign policy.

Gayatri Spivak and subjugation of the Subaltern: Gayatri Spivak built on **Foucault's notion of epistemic violence**, highlighting how non-Western perspectives have been marginalized through dominant Western Knowledge System. She focused on women, arguing that colonialism erased their cultural identities, preventing them from authentically expressing their experiences and understandings of the world.

b. NATURE OF POST-COLONIAL STATE: VARIOUS PERSPECTIVES

1. Nature of State from Western Perspective

The nature of state can be understood through the approaches like-

- Political Development Approach
- Political Modernization Approach

Important Works:

- Fred W. Riggs- Concept of Prismatic Societies**
- Gunnar Myrdal- Concept of soft state**

FRED W. RIGGS' "PRISMATIC SOCIETY MODEL"

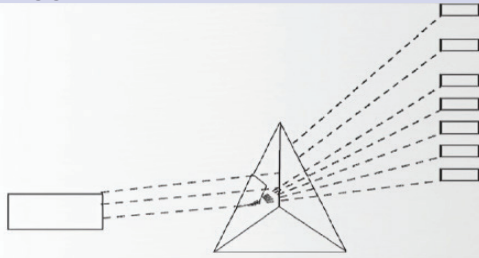
To conclude, Riggs gave his new theory entitled in a book- "**Prismatic Society-Revisited**" in 1973.

Overview: This model offers a detailed framework for understanding the diverse and intricate nature of societies and governments in developing countries.

Fred W. Riggs' "Prismatic Society Model" describes developing countries as diverse, transitioning from underdeveloped to developed, with features of both traditional and modern societies. This complexity leads to governance challenges due to misaligned administrative structures.

Riggs call the post-colonial societies as prismatic (India) and developed societies (USA) as diffracted societies.

Fused-Prismatic-Diffracted Model (Fred W. Riggs)



Fused	Prismatic	Diffracted
ascription	attainment	achievement
particularism	selectivism	universalism
functional diffusion	poly-functionalism	functional specificity

FEATURES OF PRISMATIC SOCIETIES

Heterogeneity: In this system, various patterns, rules, systems, and viewpoints coexist. The society is a mix of fused and diffracted elements.

Formalism: There is a significant gap between theory and practice, highlighting the difference between what is formally prescribed and what is effectively practiced.

Overlapping Structures: Differentiated and undifferentiated structures coexist, leading to overlapping administrative behaviours from both types of societies.

Besides this many other features are also presented like polynormativism, **polyfunctionalism**, **polycommunalism**, **bazaar-canteen model**, **authority v/s control**, **political instability**, etc.

This model is crucial for comprehending **the unique governance challenges** in these societies, stressing the need for flexible administrative systems to effectively address their diverse needs.

GUNNAR MYRDAL'S CONCEPT OF SOFT STATE

Gunnar Myrdal introduced the concept of the "Soft State" in his book "Asian Drama," using India as a primary example. Myrdal questioned whether the Indian state would be successful in its poverty alleviation programs and concluded that it would not, primarily because India exemplifies a soft state.

Meaning of Soft State: A soft state is characterized by the inability to properly implement laws and maintain order. This results in poor governance and ineffective policy execution.

REASONS FOR INDIA BEING A SOFT STATE

Corruption: Widespread corruption in the political system and bureaucracy hinders the proper implementation of laws. Corruption is partly a legacy of colonial rule, perpetuating inefficiencies.

Gandhian Legacy of Disobedience: The Gandhian tradition of civil disobedience has influenced India's political culture, leading to a scenario where even leaders do not strictly adhere to laws. This results in a culture of lawlessness and weakens state authority.

Cultural Factors: Indian society often respects muscle power over law-abiding behaviour. Law-abiding individuals are sometimes seen as weak, further undermining respect for the rule of law.

Myrdal's concept of a soft state explains why India struggles with effective governance and poverty alleviation. Addressing issues of corruption, cultural attitudes towards law, and leadership behaviour is crucial for improving the state's capacity to enforce laws and implement policies effectively.

HAMZA ALWI'S CONCEPT OF OVERDEVELOPED STATE

Concept: The Theory of Overdeveloped State, from a Marxist perspective, suggests that post-colonial states like those in **South Asia** have a state structure more developed than their basic economic structures.

Reasons: This is because these states inherited a modern state system from their colonial masters, leading to a **powerful, centralized authority** within the territory of the state.

Historical Conditions: Unlike Western states where the bourgeoisie controls the state, in overdeveloped states, the state itself controls the bourgeoisie. This is due to **historical conditions** such as **colonialism** and the continuation of **colonial legacies**, which gave the state overwhelming power.

Role of Freedom Movement: The state's dominance is further reinforced by its role in the independence movement and its adoption of a state-led developmental model, concentrating economic power within the state.

As a result of all this, the state emerges as the most powerful institution, leading to what is termed as a **Military-Bureaucratic Oligarchy**, as seen in **Pakistan**.

While the post-colonial state is not completely autonomous, it acts on behalf of three classes: **indigenous feudal class**, **indigenous bourgeoisie class**, and **metropolitan bourgeoisie** (capitalist class of Western countries).

c. SIGNIFICANCE OF POST COLONIAL THEORY OF STATE

The post-colonial theories exposed and challenged **global exploitation and inequality**; critiquing Eurocentric views applied to postcolonial states. They **emphasized cooperation among third world countries** and the need to preserve postcolonial state sovereignty against metropolitan capital.

d. CRITICISM OF POST-COLONIAL THEORY

Critics argue that postcolonial theory is **more of an analysis** than a comprehensive theory of the state, **often lacking concrete prescriptions**.

It avoids engaging with theoretical constructs like the origin of the state, its ideal form, legitimacy, and citizen obligations.

Its **focus on third world states** limits its **universal applicability**, and its emphasis on **"otherness"** and **identity** may hinder understanding compared to Western theories.

e. CONCLUSION

Despite the limitations, post-colonial theory, offers valuable insights into third-world nations, their socioeconomic structures, and impacts of globalization. It enriches political theory by integrating post-colonial states into mainstream discourse.

D. FEMINIST THEORY OF STATE

Feminist thought offers a diverse range of perspectives on the state's role. These are discussed below:

a. LIBERAL FEMINISM (TRUSTING THE SYSTEM)

These feminists, like **John Stuart Mill** (On the Subjection of Women) and **Mary Wollstonecraft** (A Vindication of the Rights of Woman), believe the state can be a force for good.

They advocate for political rights for women (suffrage) and increased participation in government (holding office).

b. MARXIST FEMINISM (SCEPTICAL OF THE SYSTEM)

Marxist feminists view the state as an instrument of the capitalist class that also exploits women. They believe that **dismantling capitalism**, not relying on the state, is key to women's liberation.

Robin Morgan's assertion, "We can't destroy the inequities between men and women until we destroy marriage," reflects the critique of traditional institutions that perpetuate women's economic and social subjugation, notably through unpaid domestic labour.

Friedrich Engels, a key figure in Marxist thought, argued in "The Origin of the Family, Private Property and the State" that the end of capitalism would bring about the end of women's exploitation within the economic system.

c. RADICAL FEMINISM (DISTRUSTFUL OF THE SYSTEM)

Radical feminists see the state itself as inherently patriarchal, reflecting male dominance in society.

Carole Hanisch's famous slogan **"the personal is political"** highlights how societal norms and power dynamics within families and relationships contribute to broader gender inequality.

Catherine MacKinnon (a radical feminist) views the state as inherently patriarchal. MacKinnon argues **"there is no feminist theory of the state"** because it simply reinforces existing power structures. Analysing rape laws in the US, she sees them favouring men due to low conviction rates. This reinforces her view of the state as "male." Thus, she proposes dismantling patriarchy (starting with ending heterosexual marriages) to achieve true gender equality.

d. POSTMODERN FEMINIST PERSPECTIVE

Deconstructs traditional notions of gender, arguing that gender identity is fluid and constructed through social and cultural practices.

Judith Butler's idea that "Identity is performatively constituted," highlights the challenge to fixed gender identities and promotes inclusivity and diversity.

Thus, though feminist perspectives on the state vary, but they share a common focus on understanding the power dynamics in the society, particularly how patriarchy impacts women and transgender individuals.

UNIT 3: JUSTICE- CONCEPTIONS OF JUSTICE WITH SPECIAL REFERENCE TO RAWL'S THEORY OF JUSTICE AND ITS COMMUNITARIAN CRITIQUES

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ▶ Rawls' idea of the 'liberal self' is too individualistic. Explain, in this context, the communitarian critique of Rawls' theory of justice. (2023)
- ▶ Dr. Ambedkar's idea of social justice leads to 'egalitarian justice' as compared to Rawls' 'justice as fairness' which at the notion of 'pure procedural justice'. Comment. (2022)
- ▶ Examine the entitlement theory of justice. (2022)
- ▶ How has Rawls enriched the idea of justice in liberalism. (2021)
- ▶ Make a comparative assessment of Greek Perspective of Justice with the Rawlsian Perspective of Justice. (2020)
- ▶ Examine Communitarian Perspectives on Justice. (2019)
- ▶ Comment on Distributive Justice. (2018)
- ▶ Rawls' theory of justice is both contractual and distributive. Examine. (2017)
- ▶ Critically examine John Rawls's argument for democratic equality. (2016)

KEY FACTS

Major Works: A Theory of Justice (1971), justice as Fairness (1985), Political Liberalism (1993).

Key Ideas: Procedural and Substantive Justice, Veil of Ignorance, Original Position, Lexical Order, and Reflexive Equilibrium.

Major Critics: Will Kymlicka, Michael Sandel, Michael Walzer, Charles Taylor, Amartya Sen, Catherine MacKinnon and other feminists, etc.

1. INTRODUCTION

Justice has been primarily the domain of moral philosophy, but it has to be implemented by a political order.

Hence, the concept has been found in the inquiries of all political thinkers and is a subject of all political dialectics. Justice is a foundational concept of political theory and practice.

John Rawls holds justice to be the first virtue of social institutions.

2. WHAT IS JUSTICE?

- ▶ **Distributive principle:** Just like a bond, justice serves to organise people together into a right or fair order of relationships by distributing to each person his or her due share of rights and duties.
- ▶ **Dynamic idea:** The term justice has been assigned different meanings by people of different times and spaces. For instance, Slavery was considered to be just in ancient Greek philosophy but today slavery is one of the worst values.
- ▶ **Aristotle's idea:** According to Aristotle, political rights, special rights, wealth, property, materialistic things, prestige, etc. should be allotted on the basis of distributive justice.
- ▶ **Impact of renaissance:** New concepts of justice emerged in the works of Grotius, Hobbes, Locke, and Kant, etc. For Hobbes, justice was following the authoritative order of the state. Utilitarianism propounded by Bentham sought to derive justice based on the hedonistic calculus of pleasure and pain. Marxists believed that the fundamental element of justice is the end of capitalism and class conflict.

Today justice is seen in terms of redistribution of resources based on affirmative action. So, the idea of justice has been a dynamic concept, and it is still evolving.

3. DISTRIBUTIVE JUSTICE

Any social value has some criteria for its nature and distribution. Justice, from the perspective of distribution, has three criteria: Equality, Merit/Desert, and Need.

Equality based Justice	Merit or Desert based Justice	Need based Justice
- With the universal recognition of human rights and human equality, equality has become the important basis of any theory of justice. - The fundamental demand for justice is that everyone gets equal rights in society. Economic, social, and political equality is a fundamental feature of any just society.	- It is a non-egalitarian concept of justice. It emphasises the idea of innate worth of an individual. Aristotle, distributive justice requires that goods and rewards be distributed based on merit and virtue. - Merit is an important part of liberal justice which is expressed by the principle of equality of opportunity. - These ideas serve to give a conservative, social-Darwinian defence of free-market capitalism. Herbert Spencer and Edmund Barker are chief exponents of this idea.	- Every person has some minimum necessities for being a human which have to be satisfied irrespective of personality or merit. Necessity is one of the criteria to bring in a just distribution of resources. Karl Marx advocated for need based justice- <i>"From each according to his ability, to each according to his needs"</i>.

4.

PROCEDURAL JUSTICE

Meaning: Justice is **giving one's right** which allots rights, duties and material in the society and **amending the mistakes** by punishment and penalties as per legal

arrangement. This approach to justice is also called procedural justice. According to its proponents, it is necessary to determine a just procedure for the allocation of social advantages (ex- Rawls' idea of justice).

The five procedural steps, or "conjectures" in Rawls are:

1. Entering into the contract,
2. Agreeing unanimously to the contract,
3. Including basic conditions in the contract such as freedom of speech,
4. Maximizing the welfare of the most disadvantaged persons,
5. Ensuring the stability of the contract.

Evolution: The notion of procedural justice originated in **Aristotle's thought**. However, it comes close to the **tradition of liberalism**. Procedural justice ensures freedom of contract which is protected by the state which will ensure that no individual or group would oppress another by fraud.

Linkage with Neoliberalism: Proponents of market economy treats procedural justice as model of human behaviour. Scholars like **Hayek, Nozick** and **Milton Friedman** suggest that market economy creates necessary conditions for growth.

CRITICAL EVALUATION

- It rejects discrimination on grounds of caste, creed, sex, religion, etc, and accepts equal dignity and moral worth of all human beings. Though the idea is progressive, yet it overstretches the notion of competition.
- C.B. Macpherson** argues that this strictly procedural capitalist mode destroys the creative freedom of human beings. John H. Sachar believes that talents might not be rewarded according to their intrinsic worth because of social hierarchies present in the society.

It doesn't matter who wins if the rules and the procedures followed in a race are just.

Norman Barry

Thus, it is suggested that the state should create adequate opportunities for all and eliminate unjust discrimination.

In India, procedural justice was followed until the **Maneka Gandhi judgement**. Thereafter, the basis of law making has become the mix of procedural justice and due process of law.

5. SUBSTANTIVE JUSTICE

Substantive justice refers to **just and fairness** of the **content** as well as **outcome** of the **laws, policies**, etc. Thus, substantive justice not just focuses on procedure, but on fairness of the procedure and just outcomes. The basic principle of substantive justice is- **"Treating everyone equally in an unjust society will not lead to justice"**.

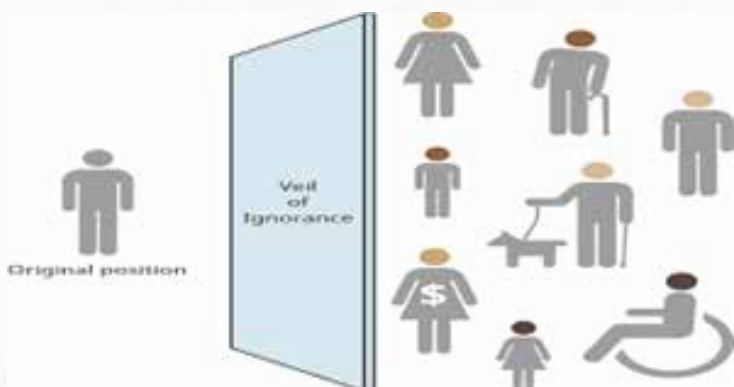
The substantive justice attempts to ascertain adequate opportunities for the poor and the underprivileged sections of the society.

Thus, in order to ensure just outcomes, the state needs to constantly distribute and redistribute resources so that there is no concentration of wealth. Just redistribution will bring in maximum equal opportunity. **Rawls' theory of justice** brings in the **Difference principle** to uphold substantive justice even if it is a procedural theory.

6. JOHN RAWLS' THEORY OF JUSTICE

John Rawls (1921-2002) was an influential **political philosopher of liberal tradition** known for his work on **justice and political liberalism**. His most notable contribution is the development of the **theory of justice as fairness**, which he presented in his seminal work **"A Theory of Justice"** published in **1971**.

Rawls' theory of justice as fairness envisions a society of free citizens holding equal basic rights cooperating within an egalitarian economic system. Influenced by the **social contract tradition** and **Immanuel Kant's concept of human dignity**, John Rawls has attempted to devise a universal theory of justice that is **purely procedural** and **contractual**.



PRIMARY GOODS

Justice is the principle of distribution of things/ goods and services in the society. For Rawls, justice is the architectonic principle of all social institutions. Based on the principles of justice, the social institutions make political and legislative decisions for achieving the goal of egalitarian society.

The primary goods are of two types:

SOCIAL GOODS	NATURAL GOODS
- Ex- wages, wealth, opportunity, material goods, rights, freedom, etc. - These goods are distributed by the social institutions directly.	- Ex- Health, intelligence, imaginative power, and capacity. - These goods are not distributed by social institutions directly, but they influence the social institutions.

Rawls's theory of justice has pointed out that a good society is characterised by several virtues. But **justice is the first virtue of a good society**. According to Rawls, a good society is "a cooperative venture for mutual advantage." Along with **cooperation**, there is also conflict among its members regarding their **share of the burdens and benefits** of social living. Therefore, the purpose of principles of social justice is to ensure that the distribution of the benefits and burdens of society are just or fair to all its members.

John Rawls in the process of devising this just procedural theory creates an **imaginary situation** of the veil of ignorance where parties to the contract are in their **original position**.

ORIGINAL POSITION

Concept Overview: The "original position" is a central concept in John Rawls' theory of justice as fairness. It is a hypothetical thought experiment designed to determine the principles of justice that rational individuals would choose.

Pre-Social and Pre-Political Equality: In the original position, individuals are imagined to be in a state of equality before any social or political structures are established. They do not know their own characteristics, such as gender, race, social class, talents, or abilities.

Veil of Ignorance: These individuals are behind a veil of ignorance, which means they are unaware of their particular circumstances and the specific society they will be part of.

Purpose and Methodology: The original position helps citizens move from abstract concepts to concrete principles of justice. This ensures fair terms of social cooperation. By stripping away personal biases, the thought experiment aims to identify rules that everyone would agree upon as fair.

Connection to Social Contract Tradition: This methodology places Rawls' justice as fairness within the social contract tradition of philosophers like Locke, Rousseau, and Kant. By imagining a fair starting point, it aligns with their ideas of forming a just society through mutual agreement.

VEIL OF IGNORANCE

"Natural distribution is neither just nor unjust, it is the institution of society controlled by human beings that makes it just or unjust".

—Rawls

Veil of ignorance is the most striking feature of the original position in Rawls' theory of justice. It prevents the arbitrary facts and circumstances about citizens from influencing the agreement among the participants. Each participant in the original position is therefore deprived of knowledge about his/her social, economic, or political background.

This is a situation of individual wisdom and general ignorance. Hence, this is a **partial veil of ignorance**.

PARTIES/ PARTICIPANTS ARE AWARE OF	PARTIES/ PARTICIPANTS ARE NOT AWARE OF
- Race, ethnicity, gender, age, income, wealth, natural endowments, etc. - The political system of the society, its class structure and level of economic development.	- Different comprehensive doctrines and plans of life; that all citizens have interests in more primary goods. - General facts about human social life; facts of common sense; general conclusions of science.

The veil of ignorance is intended to situate the representatives of free and equal citizens fairly with respect to one another. No party can press for agreement on principles that will arbitrarily favour the particular citizen they represent, because no party knows the specific attributes of the citizen they represent.

Each party tries to agree to principles that will be best for the citizen they represent (i.e., **maximin rule of choice**— that will maximise that citizen's share of primary goods). Since the parties are fairly situated, the agreement they reach will be fair to all actual citizens.

According to **Kalley**, the basis of Rawls theory of social contract is that **political and social arrangements are created on the basis of a self-willed plan of impartial social cooperation** in which people are considered free, equal, and reasonable. And the rules will be accepted by the free and reasonable person with the objective of unceasing their benefits.

Under the social contract, the objectives fulfilled are:

1. The first principle of social justice concerns political institutions: Each person has the same and inalienable [permanent] claim to a fully adequate scheme of equal basic liberties, which scheme is compatible with the same scheme of liberties for all.

2. The Second Principle of social justice concerns social and economic institutions:

- They are to be attached to offices and positions open to all under conditions of fair equality of opportunity; and
- They are to be to the greatest benefit of the least-advantaged members of society (the Difference Principle).

LEXICAL ORDER

These principles are arranged by Rawls in a specific order and are subject to the priority rule. The first principle must always come before the second, and **2a)** has to come before **2b)**.

Thus, there is no risk of individual liberty being compromised for the liberty of others. It also ensures that any departure from the principle of equality brings maximum benefit to the least advantaged; in other words, inequalities should be so arranged that they benefit the worst-off. This specific order is known as the **Lexical order**.

However, the Rawls idea of veil of ignorance is criticised as a **hypothetical condition** as any deliberations without the knowledge of social and economic conditions of each other is meaningless. Justice can be analysed in the light of class relations and ownership of private property.

PRINCIPLES OF THEORY OF JUSTICE: ANALYSIS

The first principle affirms for all citizens' familiar basic rights and liberties: liberty of conscience and freedom of association, freedom of speech and liberty of the person, the rights to vote, to hold public office, to be treated in accordance with the rule of law, and so on.

Unequal rights would not benefit those who would get a lesser share of rights, so justice requires equal rights for all in all normal circumstances.

First distinctive feature of Rawls' first principle is- the basic rights and liberties must not be traded off against other social goods.

The second distinctive feature of Rawls's first principle is that it requires the fair value of political liberties. Political liberties are a subset of the basic liberties, concerned with the rights to hold public office, the right to affect the outcome of national elections, and so on.

Fair equality of opportunity: It requires that citizens with the same talents and willingness to use them have the same educational and economic opportunities regardless of whether they were born rich or poor. "In all parts of society, there are to be roughly the same prospects of culture and achievement for those similarly motivated and endowed".

Difference principle: It regulates the distribution of wealth and income. The difference principle requires that social institutions be arranged so that **any inequalities of wealth and income work to the advantage of those who will be the worst off. In "Justice as fairness," Rawls says, "men agree to share one another's fate."**

RAWLS' DEFENCE OF INEQUALITY

- According to Rawls certain inequalities, which serve as incentives for the greater creativity and productivity of the talented and the gifted, are not unjust if that they benefit all, especially the least advantaged members of the society.

- According to the Difference Principle, inequalities that are advantageous to the better off but not to the least advantaged are unjust. His Difference Principle is meant not to replace inequality with equality in income and wealth, but to transform unfair or unjust degrees or kinds of economic inequalities into a fair or just kind or degree by maximising the benefits of the least advantaged.

WHY SHOULD ACCEPT RAWLS' TWO PRINCIPLES?

Refining of social contract: Justice is defined as what people would accept as the fairest set of guiding principles for the regulation of the fundamental social structure. Since something is only considered fair after an ideal procedure would accept it as correct, Rawls' initial position is an illustration of a fair proceduralist criterion of justification.

Concern for least advantaged: Rawls discards the idea of natural talent, saying skills and talents are the results of naturally and socially acquired advantages. These social advantages should extend to the least advantaged sections for fair justice.

Social liberalism: Rawls marked a departure from classical liberalism that stood for individual liberty but left the individual alone to face the market risks. He also departed from the socialist ideas that made individuals subservient to social equality. Rawls's theory of justice was in line with the needs of the liberal democratic welfare state (i.e., social liberalism).

LOGICAL CONSEQUENCE THEORY OF JUSTICE

The next step of the agreement is creation a **constitution** to satisfy the theories of justice and become the basis of a just and effective **judiciary**. Here, **rule of freedom** has not been compromised. After the creation of the constitution, people will have to think about making policies and laws to provide maximum and benefit to the long-term aspirations of the lower class of the society.

Thus, Rawls' theory of justice is in accordance with the need of contemporary liberal democratic welfare state. It removes the limitations of liberalism (absolute individual freedom) as well as socialism (maximum control sacrificing individual freedom).

However, the Rawls idea of veil of ignorance is criticised as a **hypothetical condition** as any deliberations without the knowledge of social and economic conditions of each other is meaningless. Justice can be analysed in the light of class relations and ownership of private property.

EVALUATION OF RAWLS THEORY OF JUSTICE

Despite contributing greatly to reviving the interest in political philosophy, Rawls' book 'A Theory of Justice' is not free from criticism. The important points of criticism are absence of **direct dialogue between the participants** and his assumption that the participants of the social contract are **mutually disinterested**.

Brian Barry in his 1973 book, "*The Liberal Theory of Justice*" even questions about the **rationality** of the individuals in the original position. He also argues that it is very difficult to define the least advantaged sections in any society.

7.

COMMUNITARIAN CRITIQUE OF RAWLSIAN THEORY OF JUSTICE

Basic premise of the communitarian critic of Rawls' theory of justice is **liberal-egalitarian conception of justice** and emphasis on **individual rights at the expense of the good of the community**. **Will Kymlicka** argues that "the value of community is not sufficiently recognized in liberal theories of justice or the public culture of liberal societies".

Michael Sandel (Book- *Liberalism and the Limits of Justice*, 1982): He criticises Rawls' notion of disembodied or unencumbered self. He advances the notion of **the situated self**, i.e., the self or subject, who is invariably a member of a community. While, for Rawls, **the right is prior to the good** and **justice is the first virtue of society**, for Sandel, **justice is only a remedial virtue** that is needed in an individualistic society. For Sandel, moreover, the **common good of the community is prior to the rights of the individuals**. Sandel asserted that **the self is not prior to its ends**; it is rather constituted by its ends, which are not chosen but discovered by the self by virtue of its being embedded in some shared social context.

In **Democracy's Discontent**, Sandel reiterated his argument and even claimed that the decline of democratic politics in the United States in the late twentieth century

was due to the wrong ordering of priorities between the self and its ends.

Michael Walzer (Book- *Spheres of Justice*)

- ▶ We cannot distribute goods to men and women until we understand what the goods mean; what parts they play, and how they are valued, among those same men and women. Hence, he says **that justice can be understood only as a community principle and not as an individualistic one**.
- ▶ He also argued that the quest for a **universal theory of justice was misguided** because it was futile to look for any principle of justice outside the community- particularly its history and culture. Walzer argued that modern society includes a number of spheres of distribution in which goods are allocated.
- ▶ Walzer asserts that if the **boundaries between different spheres are respected**, one person's pre-eminence in the **sphere of money** may be offset by another's higher **social prestige** and a third's success in holding political office. In this **way, social pluralism** may lead to a kind of equality in which no one decisively outranks other. Thus, Walzer denies that the economic status of an individual holds key to his social prestige and power.
- ▶ **Criticism of Walzer's Idea:** The problem with Walzer's suggestion is that there is no reliable method to compare the value of non-economic factors like reputation, political power, education, and health, etc. with the value of income and wealth. In the absence of such criteria, it is difficult to attack the disparities created by market society.
- ▶ **Charles Taylor:** He criticises Rawls' atomistic conception of the individual. The well-being of the individual depends on the good of his community, and therefore, the recognition and protection of the group or cultural rights of the community are not less important than the just distribution of the freedom and equality rights to the individuals.
- ▶ It is true that Rawls contemplates **to retain the capitalist system** on some specified conditions. However, it should not be forgotten that once these conditions are fulfilled, the capitalist system is bound to assume a new humane look. In fact, Rawls has discovered a method for making procedural justice an instrument of meeting the requirements of social justice.

8.

CRITIQUE OF RAWLSIAN THEORY OF JUSTICE

In response to Rawls's distributive theory, libertarian thinker **Robert Nozick** gives **Entitlement Theory of Justice** in his book- "*Anarchy, State and Utopia*".

If I own myself then I own my talents and that if I own my talents, I own the products of my self-owned talents.

-Nozick

- **Legitimate means:** According to Nozick, individuals are entitled to their holdings as long as they have acquired them through legitimate means, such as voluntary transactions, labour, or original appropriation. In other words, people have a right to the property and resources they have acquired through fair and voluntary means.
- **No use of force:** He argues that any distribution of wealth or resources that arises from these just initial acquisitions or voluntary exchanges is itself just. He rejects the idea of redistributive justice, which involves forcibly taking from some individuals to give to others in order to achieve a more equal distribution of wealth.
- **Voluntary charity:** He contends that any system that violates individual rights, even for the sake of a more equal distribution, is inherently unjust. According to him, people have the right to freely dispose of their property as they see fit, as long as they acquired it justly.
- **Criticism of Nozick:** Critics of the entitlement theory argue that it fails to address historical injustices and disadvantages that some individuals may face. They argue that Nozick's focus on the initial acquisition and voluntary exchanges overlooks the role of social structures, inherited advantages, and unequal starting points in determining one's holdings.

Overall, **the entitlement theory of justice** provides a framework that prioritizes individual rights, voluntary transactions, and just acquisition as the basis for a just distribution of resources and wealth. However, it is also seen as strongest defence of free-market capitalism.

9.

AMARTYA SEN'S CRITICISM OF RAWLS AND HIS IDEA OF JUSTICE

Amartya Sen argues that in the Rawlsian system of justice, whole attention is bestowed almost exclusively on 'just institutions', rather than focusing on 'just societies' that may rely on both effective institutions and actual behavioural features. Rawls thinks that the two principles are aimed at ensuring that the right choice of institutions and to lay the ground for the emergence of appropriate actual behaviour, but this is not so obvious.

A second critique raised by Sen relates to **Rawls's perception of the primary goods**. However, the conception lacks clarity. For instance, "Poverty is not just a lack of money; it is not having the capability to realise one's full potential as a human being."

However, Sen credits Rawls for reviving the interest in political philosophy through his theory of justice as fairness.

10.

CAPABILITY APPROACH OF AMARTYA SEN

Amartya Sen's capability approach is a **philosophical and economic framework** that provides an **alternative perspective on evaluating well-being and social justice**. Sen developed this approach in response to the limitations of traditional welfare economics, which primarily focused on measuring well-being based on economic indicators.

He introduced the concept of '**capability equality**' between these two extremes where capability means what various goods do for people, apart from the welfare they achieve.

Poor institutional capacity: Sen objects to Rawls's belief in institutions' capability of fair redistribution arguing that persons born with different physical and psychological propensities will generally be unequally efficient transformers of resources such as primary social goods into whatever goals they might seek.

Capability as freedom: The basis of interpersonal comparisons for a theory of justice should be a measure of people's real freedom to achieve functions they have reason to value. Capability thus represents freedom whereas Rawlsian primary goods are just means to this freedom.

Varying abilities: People have varying capabilities due to genetic, age, or other factors to convert resources into actual freedoms. These variations influence people in different ways to build freedom in their lives, despite having the same primary resources.

Evaluation of capabilities: People's capabilities are influenced by various factors like social, economic, political, gender inequality, etc. Thus, evaluating well-being requires examining the range of opportunities available to individuals and the actual freedoms they have to exercise those opportunities.

CRITICISM OF CAPABILITY APPROACH

- ❖ Critics of the capability approach argue that it is too broad and lacks clear guidance for policy making.
- ❖ They suggest that it is challenging to measure and compare capabilities across individuals, making it difficult to implement in practical terms.
- ❖ Additionally, some argue that the capability approach does not provide a clear framework for determining which capabilities are most important or how to prioritize them in policy decisions.

11.

FEMINIST CRITIQUE OF RAWLS' THEORY OF JUSTICE

Feminist analysis of justice focuses on whether there is a specific female way of moral reasoning distinct from the universal and impersonal ethic of justice in mainstream political theory. Some other feminists have argued that the **model of autonomous, self-interested, rational, and individualistic person** is a typically male conception of human behaviour, and it leaves very less or no scope for values such as care, nurturing empathy, and cooperation that are typically female qualities. Hence, they argue that female qualities are not represented in Rawls's original position.

Susan Moller Okin (Book- *"Justice, Gender and the Family"*): She argues that family should be considered as the main unit for any discussion on justice. Any theory of justice that does not address inequalities in a family is incomplete and lacks credibility. She criticizes the veil of ignorance as it denies any knowledge of gender which is the basis of sexual hierarchy.

Catherine MacKinnon: In a liberal state, it is through law that women's subordination and silence are maintained.

12.

MARXIST CRITIQUE OF RAWLS THEORY OF JUSTICE

- ❖ Marxists have criticised liberal egalitarians for their **failure to address inherent exploitative inequalities** between capitalists and workers by solely focusing on fair distribution within a capitalist system.
- ❖ They have also argued that Rawls's idea of the veil of ignorance is a hypothetical condition as any deliberations without the knowledge of social and economic conditions of each other are meaningless.
- ❖ Justice can be analysed in the light of class relations and ownership of private property.

13.

RAWLS'S RESPONSE TO THE CRITIQUE

In his book- *Political Liberalism*, Rawls engages his critiques and accepts some of his earlier mistakes. In it, he accepts that his earlier theory of justice is not a comprehensive conception of justice but is compatible with a liberal conception of the role of justice. Thus, the theory of justice is a liberal political concept and does not encompass the moral standpoint.

OVERLAPPING CONSENSUS

- ❖ In the concept of Overlapping consensus, Rawls explains how **complex interactions** between human beings based on differing viewpoints can be converged to arrive at some common ground.
- ❖ The citizens despite **reasonable pluralism** come to respect liberal political institutions and individuals work towards liberal principles from mutually incompatible perspectives and an overlapping consensus is achieved.
- ❖ Rawls agrees that his theory of justice is not a comprehensive **conception of the good but rather is compatible with a liberal conception of the justice**—that is, the government should be neutral in competitions between two forces of good.

14. CONCLUSION

Despite criticism, John Rawls was arguably the most important political philosopher of the twentieth century. Even one of his most significant critiques, Robert Nozick, acknowledges the significance of Rawls's theory by accepting that everyone should work within the framework provided by Rawls or else explain specifically the reasons for not doing so. Thus, the theory has a transformative impact on contemporary theories of justice, policies, debates in political philosophy.

15. KEY THEMES IN RAWLSIAN THEORY OF JUSTICE

Justice as the First Virtue of Social Institutions: Rawls emphasizes justice as the primary virtue, differing from utilitarian views, and focuses on equal distribution of resources.

Justice as Fairness: Rawls' concept of social and distributive justice. It involves a systematic method and political conception of justice aiming for consensus among diverse groups.

Legitimate Use of Political Power: Political power is legitimate when used in accordance with a political conception of justice, highlighting the idea of overlapping consensus.

Overlapping Consensus: Developed further in "Political Liberalism" (1993), this idea involves different groups

finding a conception of justice compatible with their comprehensive doctrines/ views through reflective equilibrium.

Reasonable Pluralism: Rawls acknowledges reasonable pluralism and the impracticality of eradicating diversity using state power. Stability cannot rest on self- or group-interests alone.

Veil of Ignorance: A method ensuring fair and equal conditions for all groups in negotiating a political conception of justice, eliminating bargaining advantages and encouraging society-wide interests.

Public Justification and Social Unity: Agreement on the political conception of justice must be made public, promoting social unity and a well-ordered, stable society through the integration of values into comprehensive doctrines.

Social Stability through Overlapping Consensus: Stability arises when citizens endorse a core set of laws for internal reasons, providing better stability than a mere balance of power among differing worldviews.

Critique by Michael Sandel and Communitarians: Rawls is criticized for his metaphysical presuppositions, with Communitarians emphasizing individuals as rational beings shaped by specific differences.

Rawls' Response and Plurality: In "The Idea of Overlapping Consensus" (1987), Rawls refutes the critique by emphasizing political, not metaphysical, agreement through overlapping consensus. His theory relies on individuals being free, equal, and living in a pluralistic society, aiming for stability and social unity.

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UNIT 4: EQUALITY

“Equality is basically a process of equalization. So, first of all equality implies the deficiency of special rights. Secondly, it implies that everyone should get enough opportunities for growth.” (Harold Laski)

QUESTIONS FOR DISCUSSION

- ▶ “Equality of estates caused equality of power, and equality of power is liberty.” Comment. (2022)
- ▶ Comment: Equality of opportunity. (2020)
- ▶ Equality means fair treatment rather than equal treatment. Comment. (2018)
- ▶ Comment on: Affirmative Action. (2016, 2021)
- ▶ How is liberty a precondition for equality? Explicate the relationship between equality and liberty. (2014)
- ▶ Difference between equality of opportunity and equality of outcome. (2012)
- ▶ Why is ‘affirmative action’ important in provision of equal opportunity? (2012)

1. INTRODUCTION

The idea of equality is the **central feature** of modern political thought. Equality is a **fundamental value in democratic societies** and is often **considered a cornerstone of social justice**. Classical and Medieval thinkers considered hierarchy as natural and inevitable while Modern thinkers started with the assumption that all human beings have equal moral worth. Today Equality is a highly complex concept; there are as many forms of equality as there are ways of comparing the conditions of human existence.

2. MEANING OF EQUALITY

Dworkin: Equality is a sovereign virtue. He believes that “No other value has been under threat in Liberalism as the value of equality”. He has highlighted that equality is more fundamental than liberty. Liberty is hollow in absence of equality.

Isaiah Berlin: Human dignity/ equality is considered as the core of liberalism.

Harold Laski:

- ▶ Absence of special privileges.
- ▶ Adequate opportunities are laid open to all to realise the implications of one’s own personality.
- ▶ All must have access to social benefits, and no one should be restricted on any ground.
- ▶ Absence of economic and social exploitation.

Barker: “The principle of equality, accordingly, means that whatever conditions are guaranteed to me in the form of rights shall also and in the same measure be guaranteed to others and that whatever rights are given to others shall also be given to me”.

3. DIMENSIONS OF EQUALITY

DIMENSIONS	DESCRIPTIONS
Legal Equality	Equality before law: Equal subjection of all classes to the ordinary law of the land (negative concept). Equal protection of law: Right to equal treatment in similar circumstances. Equal protection requires affirmative action by the state in favour of disadvantaged sections of the society.
Political Equality	Political equality is associated with democratic institutions and the right to participate in the political process. It includes- right to vote, right to contest elections, right to freedom of speech and expression, etc. Political equality means the authority which exerts that power must be subject to rules of democratic governance (Laski).
Social Equality	The economic equality of early liberals was equality of choosing one’s trade or profession irrespective of his caste, creed or economic status. Economic equality is two folds: ▶ It is a matter of status. ▶ It is a matter of property and income.

Economic Equality

Social equality focuses on ensuring equal opportunities for all to develop their personalities. It involves eliminating any form of discrimination based on factors such as caste, creed, religion, language, race, gender, etc.

Social equality also depends on accessibility of public services, education, health etc on equal basis to facilitate social mobility.

4.

EVOLUTION OF CONCEPT OF EQUALITY

- **View of Aristotle:** Aristotle, for instance, discovered that 'inequality' was a cause of rebellion in many states. He defined justice as "treating equals equally and unequals unequally".
- **Medieval feudalism:** legal privileges were based upon status and birth. Different ideologies justified inequality on grounds of superior race, sex, religion, military strength, wealth, knowledge, etc.
- **Renaissance period:** Puritans, Levellers and proponents of natural rights doctrine (John Locke) raised cry for equality against landowners' status and religious intolerance.
- **Modern times:** In the modern world, equality has been accepted as a basic principle of organising human life. As a result, along with legal equality, demand for economic and social equality was raised by liberal socialists and Marxist writers alike such as J S Mill, TH Green, Karl Marx, etc.
- **National movements:** In 20th century, the demand for equality became more persistent with national liberation movements, socialist revolutions in Russia and China, etc.
- **UDHR 1948:** The Universal Declaration on Human Rights extended the recognition of equality to all the countries of the world and eventually resulted into rise of international society based on socio-economic equality.

Today, equality has become a foundational principle of all modern political constitutions recognising it as human as well as fundamental right.

5.

EQUALITY: FAIR TREATMENT VS EQUAL TREATMENT

EQUAL TREATMENT	FAIR TREATMENT
➤ It implies all people have the right to receive the same treatment irrespective of circumstances. ➤ Libertarians like Nozick advocate equal treatment. He believes that "unjustly taking someone's holdings for redistribution violates their rights". ➤ He speaks against "Progressive taxation" and calls it similar to bonded labour that amounts to the unjust treatment of the Rich. ➤ However, equal treatment alone does not make society equal, as different people have different starting points owing to historical discrimination. ➤ For example, Dalits in India or Blacks in the USA or Women. ➤ Therefore, there is a need for positive discrimination to ensure fair treatment.	➤ It implies people will receive differential treatment as per the circumstances or needs. ➤ Rawls acknowledged equality as fair treatment and given the difference principle that makes disadvantaged ones better off. ➤ Rawls even justifies discrimination thereby establishing Democratic equality between Liberty and Equality. ➤ Dworkin has advocated Resource Egalitarianism. For him, internal inequalities e.g., disabilities also need to be considered. ➤ Amartya Sen (capability approach) argues that equal treatment is not enough as people vary in abilities to convert equal resources into functioning.

6.

EQUALITY OF WELFARE

This principle is advocated by the utilitarians. It emphasizes the fair distribution of resources, benefits, and services in society to reduce disparities and promote a sense of **well-being** (pleasure) among all members of the community. People should be made equal in terms of welfare or happiness.

DWORKIN'S ARGUMENT

Dworkin finds this principle illogical. He counters the principle with the help of a story.

Two sisters--> One has simple lifestyle and second has lavish lifestyle--> To keep their pleasure equal, second must be given more resources to match the pleasure. So, Dworkin above distribution does not appear to be logical and just.

7.

DWORKIN'S THEORY OF EQUALITY OF RESOURCES

Dworkin's theory of equality of resources offers a perspective on distributive justice that focuses on providing individuals with equal resources rather than equal outcomes or opportunities. The aim is to ensure that individuals have necessary resources to pursue their own goals and lead a life they value.

This theory is given by **Dworkin (Egalitarian)**. He is inspired by **Rawls' theory of justice**, and he criticises **Nozick's entitlement theory**.

- **Entitlement theory:** It limits the role of the state to regulation, rectification, and grievance redressal. But it has no role in distributive justice. He justifies complete entitlement of man's property. Nozick believes that **people should be held responsible for the choices they make**.

AUCTION THEORY BY DWORKIN

The Dworkin's idea is to organize an auction in which each person receives a hundred shells. The one hundred shipwrecked people will be auctioned off with their shells and there are a number of lots to be auctioned off. In front of each of the lots, each will put the number of shells he is willing to use to finance his desire.

- **Dworkin's Theory:** People should be held responsible for the choices they make, but only the choices they made **under chosen circumstances** and **not under unchosen circumstances**. However, he suggests that a person should be compensated only once, not again and again. Hence, Dworkin suggests the idea of **just initial distribution**.
- **Just Distribution:** Dworkin in his book "**Sovereign Virtue**" has prescribed envy test or jealousy test for

that. He explains his idea with the help of a story of a **wrecked ship near an island**. Resources Equality means the possibility of having equitable resources so that everyone can carry out their conception of what is good or wellbeing. As per Dworkin's idea, there will be no inequality and no monopoly. The end of the auction will be considered fair as long as each person does not envy the other's endowment.

- **Optional luck and Brute luck:** In **Optional luck**, the risks are taken through rational choices and hence the disadvantages are a person's own choice. But in **Brute luck**, a person has no choice such as being born in a lower caste in India. Here, we have to be conscious about brute luck and the state will have some kind of role. This whole concept is known as **Luck Egalitarianism**.
- **Dworkin's equality of resources** asserts that a just distribution of rights and responsibilities occurs when it stems from individuals' **free choices** following an initial distribution of resources that is strictly equal, complemented by **insurance coverage** to mitigate natural disadvantages.

8.

SEN'S THEORY OF EQUALITY OF CAPABILITIES

It is a concept that focuses on the enhancement of individuals' freedom and opportunities to lead lives they value. It emphasizes the importance of not only equal access to resources but also equal capability to use those resources effectively to achieve well-being and pursue one's own goals.

The idea goes beyond the theory of equality of resources because even when we give equal resources it is not necessary that we achieve equality as people differ in terms of capabilities.

Two distinctive features of capability approach:

1. **It is based on social choice:** It considers real persons. In reality different persons may suffer from different types of deprivations will stop it also takes into account social factors. For ex- as girls face more deprivation in India equal resources may not give equal sense of wellbeing to girls and boys.
2. It is realisation focussed approach: according to Sen, the purpose of life is happiness or wellbeing. He gives the concept of being and doing. Being means existence i.e. person should realise her importance



and must get respect from others. Doing means person does what she wants to do. (Ex- fasting is a choice and hunger is a deprivation).

Thus, capability approach does not look at people as a means of economic growth but it considers people as the end of economic growth or development. Sen defines development in terms of freedom and freedom in terms of capabilities or functioning.

9. AFFIRMATIVE ACTION

Affirmative action refers to policies and practices that are designed to address historical and ongoing inequalities, discrimination, and underrepresentation experienced by certain disadvantaged or marginalized groups.

It is an approach taken by governments, organizations, and institutions to promote equal opportunities and increase representation for individuals who have historically faced discrimination (Ex- Blacks in **USA** and **Dalits in India**) based on characteristics such as race, gender, ethnicity, or disability.

Affirmative action has to be class based rather than individual based. It is meant for the community as a whole which has suffered deprivation.

Affirmative action has to be differentiated from preferential action policy. Preferential action is in favour of dominant section of the society (Ex- Sinhalese in Sri Lanka); where as policy in favour of weaker section is known as affirmative action (ex- quota or reservation policy).

DEBATE AROUND RESERVATION POLICY

- **Difference of Opinion:** According to **Ramchandra Guha**, debates on reservation creates "more heat than light". Similarly, **Pratap Bhanu Mehta** suggests that reservation policies make us immoral. Our opinions in public are different from our opinions in private.
- **Criticism:** Those who are against reservation believe that it **compromises merit**, and it results in reverse discrimination. Reservation policies are **political gimmicks** and do not bring any real benefit.
- **Case Law:** It is to be noted that success of reservation policies will depend on **conceptualisation and implementation**. For ex- in Ram Singh Case (Jat reservation), Supreme Court has directed that the government should identify the new vulnerable classes like transgenders.

10. EQUALITY OF OUTCOME

Equality of outcome, also known as outcome equality or distributive equality, refers to the principle that individuals should have equal outcomes or results in terms of resources, wealth, opportunities, and other factors. It suggests that society should strive to ensure that everyone has an equal share or level of various goods and benefits, regardless of their starting point or individual contributions.

The idea of an equality of outcome is the most radical and controversial face of egalitarianism. Defenders of equality of outcome believe that the guarantee of all other equalities would be inadequate so long as equality of outcome is not ensured.

Karl Marx believed that any right to equality circumscribed by a bourgeoisie economy can only be partial. He, thus, argued for absolute social equality, possible only if private property was abolished.

CRITICISM OF EQUALITY OF OUTCOME

- Critics of equality of outcome point out that such a pursuit would only lead to stagnation, injustice and worse of all tyranny.
 - **Hayek** argues that people being very different have different aspirations and goals and any system that treats them equally actually results in inequality.
- The imposition of socialist egalitarian measures, it is argued, undermines the dignity and self-respect of the individual.
- Critics of equality of outcome raise concerns about its feasibility, potential disincentives to productivity and individual effort, and infringements on individual liberty and property rights.

11. EQUALITY OF OPPORTUNITY

Equality of opportunity advocates that every individual should have an **equal chance to succeed**, regardless of their characteristics or circumstance. It emphasizes the importance of **removing barriers, biases, and systemic inequalities** that can limit opportunities for certain groups or individuals.

- **Plato's Concept of Social Position:** The idea of equal opportunity can be traced to the **works of Plato**, who proposed that social position should be based strictly upon individual ability and effort. Social **democrats and modern liberals** believe that such equal opportunity is the cornerstone of social justice.

- **Equal Starting Point, Not Equal Outcomes:** In a society upholding equality of opportunity, individuals are not guaranteed equal outcomes, but rather an **equal starting point**. The focus is on creating conditions that enable individuals to compete based on their own merits, talents, and efforts.
- **Meritocratic Inegalitarian Ideal:** Equality of opportunity points towards a **meritocratic inegalitarian ideal**. Because everyone started equally, unequal outcomes are acceptable and legitimized. The underlying assumption is that so long as the competition has been fair, advantage itself is beyond criticism.
- **Challenges in Implementation:** However, challenges remain in translating the principle into practice, as deeply entrenched social, economic, and cultural factors can **perpetuate disparities and limit equal opportunities for marginalized or disadvantaged groups**.

12.

FREEDOM/ LIBERTY AND EQUALITY

Liberty and equality are considered as antithetical to each other, as attempts to establish equality imply coercion and loss of liberty. Early liberal thinkers like Locke, Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, and Tocqueville felt that there should be minimum restrictions on the liberty of the individual. De Tocqueville considers equality as a danger for liberty.

- Early liberals believed that **no individual will voluntarily give up wealth and privileges**. As a result, programmes of social equalisation must interfere with the democratic rights of the individual. In the modern era this view is supported by scholars like **Nozick, Hayek, Milton Friedman**, etc.
- Even supporters of elite theory of democracy believe that liberty and equality are incompatible as they allow only elites to participate in democratic processes.

- However, **Positive liberals** maintained that liberty and equality are complementary to each other, and the state was assigned the task of correcting the social and economic imbalances through legislation and regulation.
- **Rousseau, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Barker, Laski, Macpherson**, etc. are of the view that inequality in the access to the resources and essential services such as education will have adverse effects on the liberty of individuals and can be a limitation on the individual's ability to lead a meaningful life.

In contemporary times, the theories like **Rawls' difference principle, Sen's capability approach and Dworkin's equality of resources** are an attempt to establish complementary relationship between equality and liberty.

13.

COMPLEX EQUALITY

It is a theory of justice propounded by **Michael Walzer (Book- Spheres of justice)**. It is seen as innovative because covers not only tangible goods but also abstract goods such as rights. However, it allows certain inequalities in social goods.

The basic premise of the theory is that inequalities in one sphere of society should not invade the other sphere.

In **Walzer's** words, "In formal terms, complex equality means that no citizen's standing in one sphere or with regard to one social good can be undercut by his standing in some other sphere, with regard to some other good."

However, in practice, the principle is difficult to be implemented as a person dominant in economic sphere will use his resources to gain prominence in political sphere (for ex- elections in India where elections are fought on the basis of money and muscle power).

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UNIT 5: RIGHTS- MEANING AND THEORIES; DIFFERENT KINDS OF RIGHTS; CONCEPT OF HUMAN RIGHTS

"Rights are those conditions of social life without which no man can seek in general, to be himself at his best." – Harold Laski

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Human rights are complex and contested social practice that organises relations between individual, society, and the State. Comment. (2022)
- Can there be universal conception of human rights? Give your arguments. (2021)
- Discuss the doctrine of 'rights as trumps'. (2019)
- What do you understand by three generations of Human Rights? (2018)
- "The implementation of human rights is regarded as a matter of changing the conduct of States." Comment. (2016)
- Comment on: Idea of Natural Rights (2015)
- Analyse the relationship between natural rights and human rights. (2013)
- Examine the multi-cultural perspectives on rights. (2012)

1. INTRODUCTION

Rights are entitlements that determine permissible actions and states, both for individuals and others. They play a crucial role in shaping our understanding of justice and form the basis for governments, laws, and morality. Accepting a set of rights implies endorsing a particular distribution of freedom and authority, and aligning with a specific perspective on what is permissible, required, or prohibited.

2. WHAT IS RIGHT?

- A right is essentially a justified claim or entitlement. Right is a modern concept.
- Medieval times:** There was a theory of Divine Rights of King. It was replaced by the theory of Natural Rights of Man (anti-statist concept).

- Right as claim on entitlement
- Right as liberty
- Right as power
- Right as immunity

Ronald Dworkin (Book- Taking Rights Seriously) calls Rights as Trumps. It means the rights of individuals should be given preference over any other consideration whether if community or state.

According to **Dworkin**, certain rights, such as **freedom of speech**, should be **protected by the constitution** and **cannot be taken away by the government**, even if it believed it would benefit the majority. These rights are considered essential and **should not be sacrificed** for the greater good of the community.

According to this doctrine, rights are not subject to weighing. **Dworkin** says that "If the relevance of fundamental rights can be weighed at every new upcoming factual scenario and like any other social interest, then balancing is a confusion that threatens to destroy the concept of individual rights". This is similar to Mill's absolute right to freedom of speech.

In a democracy, the doctrine emphasizes the significance of preserving certain rights as inviolable, as they safeguard the dignity and freedom of individuals. It also ensures that governments are held accountable by upholding these rights as supreme.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE

In modern societies, the fundamental rights of the individuals find place in the Constitution. However,

- Rights are essentially a liberal discourse. Marxists consider rights as bourgeoisie concept. Socialists believe interest of man and that of society are not in conflict with each other. They give emphasis on duties.
- In liberal countries, people enjoy civil and political rights whereas in socialist countries people are given socio-economic rights.
- Wesley Hohfeld has given four interpretations of the concept of rights:

3. RIGHTS AS TRUMPS

These rights are not absolute, rather there are placed reasonable restrictions.

In developing countries, there is a substantial lack of development that requires intervention from the state, and there is a significant diversity that necessitates finding a balance between different rights. In such situations, it becomes challenging to prioritize rights above other significant social benefits.

4. THEORY OF NATURAL RIGHTS

It is one of the oldest theory of rights of man. The idea is mainly found in the thoughts of John Locke.

As per American Declaration of Independence, natural rights are “self-evident truths”. Every person has right to life, liberty and pursuit of happiness given to him by God. Thus, natural rights have theological origin and are similar to divine rights of King.

Natural rights are fundamental to human existence and man can't be deprived of his fundamental rights. Theory of natural rights is the absolutist view of rights of man.

Two schools of thought have in Natural Rights tradition:

1. Social Contract Tradition (Locke and Rousseau):

According to Locke, man enjoyed the natural rights in the state of nature. Reason in man teaches him not to harm others in his **life, liberty, health** and property. Man has not transferred these rights to the state.

2. Teleological Tradition (Thomas Paine, TH Green):

They didn't believe in the social contract tradition as it is illogical for them and there is no justification to impose the contract on successive generations. According to **Paine**, man is different from animals and man should possess certain rights which give them opportunity to lead the life as humans (**teleology**).

CRITICISM OF NATURAL RIGHTS

THEORY OF LEGAL RIGHTS (HOBBS AND BENTHAM)

- According to them, in the state of nature, man had power and not rights. In the state of nature, might is right. And only when state comes into existence and establishes law and order, man can enjoy rights. Thus, the real source of rights of man is state, not state of nature.

- Legal Rights tradition remained prominent till WW-II. Only after WW-II, we see revival of natural rights tradition in the form of natural rights.
- Bentham criticises natural rights as “**a rhetorical nonsense upon stilts**”. He condemns natural rights as an invention of fanatics, which are dogmatic and unintelligible, devoid of reasoning. He also calls natural rights as **chimera, anarchical fallacies, terroristic language and rebellion**.

CONSERVATIVE THEORY OF RIGHTS (EDMUND BURKE)

- According to Burke, rights are products of customs and traditions. Because even when we recognise rights of man and if there is sanction from society, man cannot enjoy those rights. According to him, natural rights are “**metaphysical abstractions**”.
- Burke was critical of French revolution as it challenged the existing order. Instead of going for some untested theory, we should go for reforming the existing system gradually. According to Burke, natural rights does not bring consciousness of duty and discipline towards the society.
- Burke's theory is supported by **communitarians and cultural relativists**. According to communitarians, the theory of natural rights is based on concept of **abstract individual** or **atomistic man**, whereas man is situated self. Good is prior to end. According to MacIntyre, “**belief in natural rights is like believing in witches and unicorns**”.

SOCIAL DEMOCRATIC PERSPECTIVE OR LASKI'S THEORY OF RIGHTS

- According to **Laski**, “rights are those conditions without which no man can seek in general to be at his best”. Every state is known by the rights it maintains. The performance of the state is judged on the basis of contribution made by the state to the human welfare and happiness.
- According to them, the social order that is not based on claims of individuals is based on sand. So, state should control industries otherwise industries will control the state.

5. HUMAN RIGHTS

Definition: Human Rights are inherent moral claims that all individuals possess because of the simple fact that he or she is a human being. No government or any other individual can't take away the human rights.

- **Origin and Purpose of Human Rights:** Human rights are norms that aspire to protect all people everywhere from severe political, legal, and social abuses. The concept originated after the WW-II and based on the atrocities committed by Hitler on Jews.
- **Shift from Sovereignty to International Intervention:** Till WW-II, the principle of sovereignty of state was sacrosanct. So, there was little or no scope for intervention from the international community in domestic affairs. However, after the atrocities by Hitler, it was realised that there is need to recognise the role of international community in protecting the rights of individuals in case of violation of rights by the state itself.
- **Adoption of the UDHRs:** So, the international community adopted Universal Declaration of Human Rights on 10th December 1948. The UDHR is based on **Locke's** theory of natural rights and Kant's concept of human dignity.

CHARACTERISTICS/ FEATURES OF HUMAN RIGHTS

Dr. Justice Durga Das Basu defines Human Rights as: "Human rights are those minimal rights, which every individual must have against the State, or other public authority, by virtue of his being a 'member of human family' irrespective of any consideration".

This definition brings out the essence of human rights. He also observed that human rights include those areas of individual or group freedom that are immune from government interference and these are rights that no one can be deprived of.

FEATURE	EXPLANATION
Universal	Human rights are applicable to all individuals universally, regardless of their geographical location, gender, race, religion, culture, or ethnicity. The principle of universality is reflected in Article 1 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, which emphasizes that all human beings are inherently free and equal in dignity and rights.
Inherent	Human rights are intrinsic to individuals as they are not bestowed by any individual or governing body. These rights are not contingent upon one's

Universal	ability to purchase, earn, or inherit them; rather, they are inherent to every person solely by virtue of their humanity.
Fundamental	Human Rights are fundamental rights because, without them, the life and dignity of man will be meaningless.
Inalienable	Human rights are bestowed upon individuals by virtue of their existence and are not dependent on factors such as caste, creed, religion, gender, or nationality. Human rights are considered inalienable, meaning they cannot be legitimately taken away from individuals, nor can individuals voluntarily relinquish or forfeit them.
Equality	Since all are humans, all are to be treated equally. It means all humans should be given equal rights. This very first characteristic makes human rights highly controversial. (For instance, in most non-western societies, women don't have equal status to men).

6.

THREE GENERATION OF HUMAN RIGHTS

Karel Vasak (1979) has given three generations of human rights:

First Generation of Human Rights: Civil and Political Rights.	➤ They include civil and political rights such as rights of life and liberty, security, freedom from slavery, freedom of movement, right to freedom of speech and expression, right to religious freedom, right to vote and participate in political processes, etc. ➤ Articles 3 to 21 of the UDHR and International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights of 1966.
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Second Generation of Human Rights: Socio-Economic and Cultural Rights.	- They impose an obligation on the government to respect, promote, and fulfil their values; however, the government's ability to fulfil this duty is contingent upon the availability of resources. They are known as red rights. - They include right to food and work, right to minimum wage, right to rest, right to education, right to protect/ conserve own culture and heritage, etc. Articles 22 to 28 of the UDHR and the International Covenant on Economic, Social, and Cultural Rights.
Second Generation of Human Rights: Group and Solidarity Rights.	- They are known as green rights or soft laws and solidarity human rights. They are wider in scope and include group and collective rights. - They include rights such as right to self-determination, right to development, right to healthy environment, communication rights, right to participate in cultural heritage, etc.

7.

IMPLEMENTATION OF HUMAN RIGHTS AS A MATTER OF CHANGING CONDUCT OF STATES

The promotion and safeguarding of human rights by individual states are inherently influenced by a range of internal and external factors that prompt modifications in the behaviour of states.

- **Adoption of UDHR, 1948:** States were morally compelled by an obligation to grant protection to the human rights (civil, political, and socio-economic) of the individuals.
- **Rise of civil society:** The behaviour of nation-states underwent a transformation as non-state actors, recognized as intermediaries for the people, gained acceptance. Organizations such as Amnesty International exerted pressure on the state to address human rights abuses.

- **Who is human:** The absence of agreement on the definition of "human" and the scope of the universal human rights regime raises various concerns. For instance, there are questions regarding whether terrorists should be regarded as human beings and granted human rights.
- **Politicisation of HRs:** In developing countries, the implementation of human rights faces challenges in striking a delicate balance between respecting state sovereignty and persuading states to modify their behaviour and policies to safeguard human rights, including issues such as protecting child labour.

States must be aware of the potential risks of excessive emphasis on human rights and should acknowledge their significant role as key participants in promoting and upholding human rights. They should maintain an unwavering commitment to the protection and implementation of human rights.

8.

DEBATES ON HUMAN RIGHTS

"Human rights" is one of the most energetic ideas of our times. There is almost universal acceptance with respect to the necessity of protection of human rights. However, beyond that idea of human rights is highly contested.

THEORETICAL DEBATES

- **Definition of human:** Scholars lack consensus on the basic definition of human. And the most contested issue is whether terrorists can be regarded as human and whether they should be given basic minimum rights.
- **When human life begins:** It is unclear whether human life begins after the birth or in the womb of the mother. There is also debate over abortion rights in many catholic countries.
- **Who should be the guardian of Human Rights:** States are considered to be the principal protectors of human rights of individuals. But, since the idea of human right is anti-state, the powers of the state are weakened. Hence, state go for moral guarantees, but in reality they are unable to deliver.

PHILOSOPHICAL DEBATES

A. VALUE PLURALISM BY ISAIAH BERLIN

Isaiah Berlin is a supporter of negative liberty. He defines liberty in terms of absence of external interference. He is a pluralist and suggests that



toleration rather than liberty is the core value or substantive heart of liberalism.

- **Against Universalism:** Berlin argued that there is a fundamental and irreducible plurality of values, meaning that different values are inherently incommensurable and may conflict with one another. According to Berlin, there is no single universal value or set of values that can serve as an ultimate guide for human conduct.
- **Toleration as heart of Liberalism:** Berlin's value pluralism emerged as a response to moral and political theories that sought to establish a single, comprehensive set of values or a grand moral theory. He criticized such "monist" or "totalitarian" approaches that aimed to reduce all values to a single principle, such as happiness, justice, or equality. So, he recommends for principle of toleration.
- **Respecting diversity of values:** Instead, Berlin emphasized the importance of recognizing and respecting the diversity of human values. He believed that different individuals and communities hold a variety of legitimate and often conflicting values, which cannot be reduced or ranked hierarchically. Berlin argued that attempts to impose a single set of values on society risked suppressing individual liberty and leading to tyranny.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE OF IDEA OF VALUE PLURALISM

In the multicultural and diverse society, value pluralism might be the **practical approach** to remove the **confrontations of values and protect the human rights** of individuals. West shouldn't be imposing its value system on the rest, the best way to resolve conflict is **dialogue among civilisations**. Imposing democracy and human rights on all societies cannot be a universal solution to all problems.

B. MULTICULTURALISM

Multiculturalism emerged out of Liberal-Communitarian debate. **Bhikhu Parekh** (*Book-Rethinking Multiculturalism*) believes that multiculturalism lies between monism and pluralism. It involves a dynamic interaction between the cultural context in which humans exist, cultural diversity, and the diverse and multicultural makeup of each society.

MULTICULTURALISM AS A CHALLENGE TO LIBERALISM

Multiculturalism challenges **traditional liberalism**, which emphasizes **equal treatment** under the law and often **overlooks diverse cultural and social identities**. The core tension lies in **multiculturalism's push for recognizing and preserving cultural diversity**, which contrasts with liberalism's focus on **individual equal rights and a unified national culture**.

KEY FEATURES OF MULTICULTURALISM

- **Differentiated equality:** The formal and difference-blind idea of universal citizenship is criticised by the multiculturalists, and they call it as "not real". They advocate for **recognition of differences** and genuine treatment of equality in multicultural societies. There is need for recognition of **group-specific and minority rights**.
- **Limitations of liberalism:** Supporters of multiculturalism contend that the principles of neutrality and liberal equality are insufficient in fostering equality for both minority cultural communities and their individual members.
- **Autonomy and freedom:** Will Kymlicka (*Book-Multicultural Citizenship*) has argued that liberalism does not simply value **individual autonomy and freedom to make choices**. Autonomy and freedom are valued only because they enable individuals to reflect upon the beliefs and institutions that they have inherited.
- **Rights for culture:** Kymlicka suggests that it is necessary to have **special minority rights** to protect and promote liberal ethos. **Group-differentiated rights** such as land claims and language rights can help in alleviating the vulnerability of minority cultures and their differences.

Differentiated Citizenship: Multiculturalism rejects the idea of universal citizenship and calls it as **colour-blindness**. Universal citizenship believes in **homogeneity**, and it eclipses group differences. Hence, differentiated citizenship is devised to reject **fears of assimilation of minorities** and give them cultural security.

However, Kymlicka makes a distinction between national minorities and immigrants, and he limits the special rights only to the national minorities.

"I strongly disagree with what you say, yet I will defend to death your right to say."

-Voltaire

C. BHIKHU PAREKH (POST-COLONIAL PERSPECTIVE)

Bhikhu Parekh (book- **Rethinking Multiculturalism**) **rejects Kymlicka's argument of not extending special rights to the immigrants.** Parekh argues that it is wrong to believe that culture and religion won't matter to the non-citizen minorities or immigrants. Culture is part and parcel of a person's identity.

Thus, he advocates for a "**variegated**" approach that includes **affirmative action** to ensure equal treatment for ethnic, cultural, and religious minorities compared to the majority community.

Parekh also suggests for application of **Harm Principle** in deciding the rights that can be given to minorities. He also suggests for promoting dialogue among civilisations to arrive at some common values.

D. ASIAN VALUES AND CULTURAL RELATIVISM

The concept of cultural relativism is attributed to Franz Boaz. According to cultural relativism, culture is intrinsic part of man's personality, and every culture is rational. We cannot establish hierarchy or primacy of one culture over another.

Cultural relativistic perspective opposes the idea of universalism enshrined in UDHR. The leaders of Southeast Asia like **Mahathir Mohammed** and **Lee Quan Yew** opposes the Western notion of human rights. They advocate for "**Asian values**" approach which emphasizes social stability, privileging community, and duties over the rights of the individual.

According to **Hoon Chang Yau**, "**consensus, harmony, unity, and community**" are values commonly proposed as the essence of Asian culture and identity.

Will Kymlicka advocates a hierarchy of differentiated rights-

- Cultural rights
- Self-government rights
- Special representation rights

9.

CRITICISM OF MULTICULTURALISM AND CULTURAL RELATIVISM

- **Feminists: Susan Moller Okin** (Book- *Gender, Justice, and Family*) prefers universal idea of human rights. Since many cultures are discriminatory toward

women, she thinks multiculturalism is bad for women. For her, multiculturalism reinforces gender inequality within these groups.

- **Liberal scholars:** According to **Amartya Sen**, multiculturalism will end up in ghettoization. It is not good for national unity in long term. **Brian Barry** also believes that too much cultural consciousness leads to mobilisation of people on such issues which hamper development processes.
- **Cosmopolitan scholars: Jeremy Waldron** and **Seyla Ben Habib** believe that multiculturalism prevents intermingling of cultures and thus the emergence of cosmopolitan culture.

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UNIT 6: DEMOCRACY- CLASSICAL AND CONTEMPORARY THEORIES; DIFFERENT MODELS OF DEMOCRACY-REPRESENTATIVE, PARTICIPATORY AND DELIBERATIVE

"Government is a trust, and the officers of the government are trustees, and both the trust and trustees are created for the benefit of the people".

- Henry Clay (Former Secretary of State of US)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ▶ Success of contemporary democracies lies in the State limiting its own power. Explain. (2023)
- ▶ Elitist theory of democracy denies the possibility of democracy as 'rule of the people'. Elucidate. (2022)
- ▶ Free and fair deliberation is key to the foundation of democracy." Explain. (2021)
- ▶ Comment on: Deliberative democracy. (2019)
- ▶ Comment on: M. K. Gandhi's concept of Swaraj. (2019)
- ▶ Comment on: Substantive Democracy. (2018)
- ▶ Critically examine Macpherson's views on Democracy. (2018)
- ▶ Deliberative democracy does not have its salience without participation and participatory democracy does not have its credence without deliberations. Comment. (2017)
- ▶ Political democracy could not last unless social democracy lay at its base - B.R. Ambedkar. Comment. (2017)
- ▶ Explicate the features of Representative Democracy. (2016)
- ▶ Comment on: Difference between Participatory and Deliberative Democracy. (2015)
- ▶ Comment on: "India has thrown up a form of judicial democracy that has no parallel anywhere else and has nurtured a kind of civil society that is uniquely its own." (Bhikhu Parekh) (2014)
- ▶ Issues of debate in contemporary democratic theory. (2012)

1.

INTRODUCTION

In narrow sense, democracy is defined as a form of government and in broader sense it is defined as a way of life. The roots of democracy can be traced to the Ancient Greece.

In Ancient Greece, direct democracy was practiced in Athens. Though Aristotle favoured democracy, he considered Polity as the best practicable form of government. For him, democracy is a perverted form of polity.

DEMOCRACY IN MODERN FORM

"Democracy is the government of the people, by the people, for the people." **Abraham Lincoln's** Gettysburg Address encapsulates democracy's essence, emphasizing **collective will and citizen participation**. It denotes that power lies with the people and central idea of democracy is power lies with the people.

On desirability, **Winston Churchill** says that "Many forms of Government have been tried and will be tried in this world of sin and woe. No one pretends that democracy is perfect or all wise. Indeed, it has been said that democracy is the worst form of Government except all those other forms that have been tried from time to time."

2.

DEBATE BETWEEN LEE KUAN YEW AND AMARTYA SEN

Context: Over the suitability of the form of government in the independent countries (post-colonial societies), scholars of comparative politics gave two approaches:

1. **Political Development Approach:** **Lucian Pie** argued that former colonies must go for an ideal form of government i.e., democracy. However, **Farid Zakaria** suggests for constitutionalism should precede democracy. **JS Mill** also believed that democracy is not suitable for barbarians and there is need of democratic culture.
2. **Political Modernization Approach:** Scholars like **Edward Shils** argued that for developing countries, development is important irrespective of the form of government.

Dimension	Lee Kuan Yew's Perspective	Lee Kuan Yew's Perspective
Focus	Economic growth, political stability and Asian Values.	- Intrinsic and instrumental value of democracy. - Makes distinction between economic growth and development (as freedom).
Argument	- Advocated for "authoritarian capitalism" with strong leadership and limited political freedoms. - Views Democracy as a Western value, not suitable for Asian societies.	- Believed democracy is essential for protecting individual freedoms (freedom as empowerment) and ensuring sustainable development. - India has rich tradition of deliberative democracy (Book-Argumentative Indian).
Example	Singapore's transformation into a prosperous nation.	Role of democratic institutions in addressing social issues and preventing famines.
Core Debate	Economic Growth vs. Individual Freedoms: Appreciated Chinese model of development and justified authoritarianism for economic progress.	- Democracy fosters true, long-term development. - Appreciated Kerala Model for improvement in human development indicators.

3.

THEORIES OF DEMOCRACY

CB Macpherson represents Liberal Egalitarian or Social Liberal School. He has given the most comprehensive theory of democracy. He studied various models of democracy and gave the future roadmap for the ideal democracy.

Important Works: *The Real World of Democracy* (1965) and *Democratic Theory: Essays in Retrieval* (1975).

Being a liberal egalitarian, he shows concern for the poor. He argued that West cannot claim monopoly over democracy. The West do not consider alternative models as democracies. For instance, they call **Iran and Russia as totalitarian regimes**.

On the other hand, **Karl Marx** calls democracy in Western societies as **instrument of Bourgeoisie class and dictatorship** of minority over majority or working class. According to Marx, Socialism is more democratic in nature because power is in the hands of majority. And Communism is perfect democracy.

Thus, Macpherson rejects following claims of western scholars:

- Liberalism has monopoly over democracy.**
- Liberal democracy is a perfect model of democracy.**

Macpherson argues that liberalism has always been **undemocratic**. In Western countries, only the property-owning class could vote from the 17th to 19th centuries. **The right to vote** for workers and the **welfare state model** emerged only after the socialist revolution.

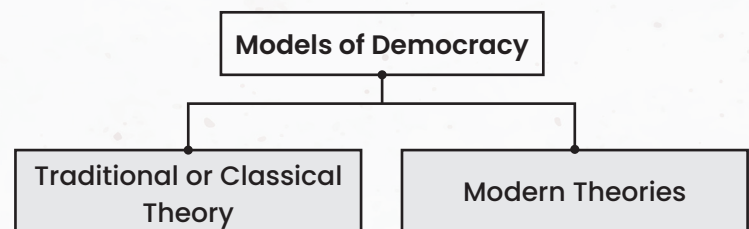
Thus, Macpherson suggests that other models can be considered as democracy-

- Communist model:** If there is intra-party democracy in the political party.
- Models of Third World Countries:** If One Party Dominant System exists and enjoys mass support.

4.

CLASSIFICATION OF DEMOCRATIC MODELS

Macpherson classifies them into two categories:



A. TRADITIONAL OR CLASSICAL THEORIES

They are also called as normative or philosophical theories, as they emphasize on democratic values such as liberty, equality, dignity, fraternity, etc.

Since they focus on democratic values, they can also be called as substantive model of democracy.

Classical Theories can be further categorised into:

- **Protective Model (Locke and Bentham):** The role of the government is to protect the rights of man from arbitrary action of the state.
- **Developmental Model:** The government maximises the opportunities for development of man and realise true freedom.

CRITICISM: The Classical Model has been criticised for overlooking the real world of democracy and ignoring empirical dimensions. They focus on what ought to be rather than what it is.

B. MODERN OR EMPIRICAL THEORIES OF DEMOCRACY

These theories deal with real world of democracy. These can be categorised into:

1. Elitist Theory of Democracy
2. Pluralist Theory of Democracy

a. ELITIST THEORY OF DEMOCRACY

This theory is based on Elitist Theory of Power. According to it, power always lies with small section (elites) irrespective of the form of government.

Robert Michels: Michels' "Iron Law of Oligarchy" posits that all organizations, including nations, tend toward oligarchy. His study of the German Social Democratic Party, considered highly democratic, concluded that even radical parties develop bureaucracies that cling to power, turning into oligarchies. The masses, often unwilling or unable to challenge this, withdraw or follow leaders passively.

Vilfredo Pareto: Pareto's quote "History is a graveyard of aristocracies," reflects his view that political power is always in the hands of a few.

Mosca: "In all societies... two classes of people appear - a class that rules and a class that is ruled." He argued that **elite dominance** is an inevitable feature of all societies due to the organizational and managerial skills required to maintain social order.

C. Wright Mills: He introduced the concept of the "**power elite**", a small group of influential individuals who hold the majority of power in the United States. According to him, true democratic processes are undermined by the concentration of power in the hands of the elite.

Jospeh Schumpeter (Book- Capitalism, Socialism and Democracy, 1942): He argues that if elites of leaders are chosen through fair and transparent procedure.

Raymond Aron: Elitism in Authoritarian and Western Liberal Societies

Aron rejects elitism in authoritarian regimes as there is circulation of elites in such societies. Such societies are characterised by **monolithic elite**. Therefore, people do not have any choice to decide who will govern them.

Aron argues that elite structure in western liberal democracies is **fractured** (competitive party system and circulation of elites). Further, Elitist scholars believe that elitism is not incompatible with democracy.

Elitist Scholars (unlike classical scholars) do not view democracy as a source of empowerment. Rather, they view democracy as **a procedure of elections**. Hence, elitist theory of democracy is called as **procedural model of democracy**.

ECONOMIC THEORY OF DEMOCRACY

It is closely associated with Elitist Theory of Democracy. According to Anthony Downs, democracy is like a market where politicians are entrepreneurs and voters are consumers. Consumers vote for that party which provides them maximum utility.

For instance, the freebies announced in the party manifesto during the elections.

b. PLURALIST THEORY OF DEMOCRACY

The basis of Pluralist Theory lies in the pluralist theory of power. It is mainly found in the works of **Robert Dahl** (critic of C. Wright Mills- concept of Power Elite and USA as oligarchy). **Dahl** challenges the position of Mills and argues that USA is polyarchy, not oligarchy.

Democracy	Oligarchy	Polyarchy
Rule of all or masses	Rule of few or Elite	Rule of many

According to Dahl, all western societies are polyarchies. Democracies cannot exist in its ideal form, and polyarchy is the practical form of democracy.

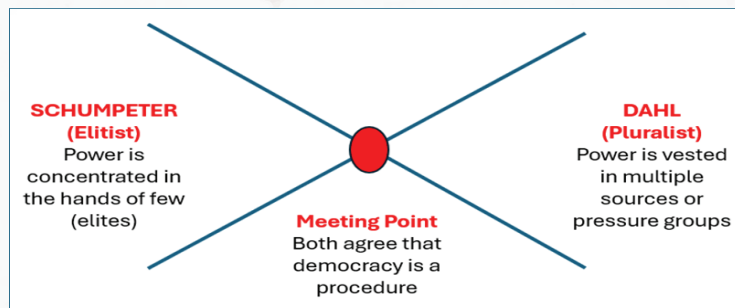
Pluralists argue that power in democracy is not concentrated in small section of elites, rather it is distributed among various interest groups.

Features of polyarchy/ Pluralist Democracy:

- Right to form associations
- Freedom of speech and expression
- Toleration for dissent
- Multi-party system
- Free press
- Judicial independence

Thus, according to **Macpherson**, both elitist and pluralist models are empirical and procedural models as they emphasise on the real world of democracy and overlook substantive aspects of democracy.

MACPHERSON'S SCHUMPETER-DAHL AXIS



Macpherson appreciates the efforts of these scholars for giving real worldview of democracies. However, he criticises them for ignoring substantive aspects of democracy.

MACPHERSON'S THEORY OF DEMOCRACY

Combination of Empirical and Normative aspects: While going for empirical view of democracy, he also emphasises on normative aspects of democracy. He believes that the objective of democracy should be empowerment of people and provide creative freedom to the people.

According to him, Ideal Society is the one in which everyone has maximum developmental power, and no one has extractive power.

According to him, power is of two types:

1. **Extractive Power** i.e., power of coercion
2. **Developmental Power** i.e., power to enhance one's capabilities.

Macpherson's View of Liberal Capitalist Societies: These societies are far from being egalitarian. The capitalist class has maximum developmental power as well as extractive power. On the other hand, working class has minimal or no developmental and extractive power.

For instance, Macpherson argues that when an **independent repairman** is paid for his service, it is a fair exchange of labour for payment. However, if the repairman is an employee, his employer exercises extractive power over him. This power dynamic, where few hold extractive power, reduces others' developmental power. **Conversely, increasing an individual's capacity for development doesn't diminish others' capacities.**

C.B. Macpherson distinguishes between **productive power**, the ability to produce material goods, and **extra-productive power**, the ability to engage in activities for enjoyment. Capitalism diminishes both, as labourers transfer productive capacities to capitalists, losing satisfaction value.

Developmental power is exercised when individuals work under their control, free from compulsion. In a capitalist system, labourers engage in compelled labour, limiting their developmental power.

ARGUMENTS OF MACPHERSON:

- Western liberal democracies are not ideal societies and perfect models of democracy.
- They cannot claim monopoly over democracy.
- They need to correct their themselves and move from inequalitarian to more egalitarian model.

5. REPRESENTATIVE DEMOCRACY

Representative democracy involves citizens electing representatives to make decisions and enact policies on their behalf. **John Locke's** social contract theory, which emphasizes the consent of the governed, has significantly shaped this concept.

FEATURES OF REPRESENTATIVE DEMOCRACY

- **Elected Representatives:** Citizens elect individuals or political parties to represent them in legislative bodies or government institutions.
- **Delegated Decision-Making:** Elected representatives draft and pass laws, make policy decisions, and represent their constituents' interests.
- **Regular Elections:** Periodic elections ensure accountability and allow for potential changes in leadership.
- **Rule of Law:** Decisions are made according to established legal principles, protecting individual rights and liberties.

MERITS OF REPRESENTATIVE DEMOCRACY

- **Practicality in Large Societies:** Suitable for managing the complexities of large, diverse societies.
- **Efficiency in Decision-Making:** Representatives specialize in policymaking, leading to more informed decisions.

"The heart of the democratic process is majority decision-making, and if that is not preserved, democracy is seriously jeopardized." - **James Buchanan**

- **Accountability through Elections:** Provides mechanisms to hold representatives accountable.

"Democracy means that institutional arrangements for arriving at political decisions in which individuals acquire the power to decide by means of a competitive struggle for the people's vote." - **Joseph Schumpeter**

- **Stability and Predictability:** Includes fixed terms for officials and established procedures for decision-making.
- **Protection of Minority Rights:** Safeguards to prevent the tyranny of the majority.

"The health of a democratic society may be measured by the quality of functions performed by private citizens." - **Alexis de Tocqueville**

- **Legal Framework:** Ensures government actions are subject to legal scrutiny.

"Wherever law ends, tyranny begins." - **John Locke**

CRITICISM OF REPRESENTATIVE DEMOCRACY

- **Limited Direct Participation:** Reduces citizens' direct involvement, leading to disconnection. Example: Low voter turnout.
- "The absence of participation in power by citizens is the first symptom of what is generally called 'the crisis of democracy.'" - **Hannah Arendt**
- **Risk of Elite Capture:** Representatives may serve elites or special interest groups. Example: Prioritizing interests of wealthy elites over the general populace.
 - **Accountability Issues:** Difficulty holding representatives accountable between elections. Example: Unfulfilled campaign promises.

"When the ordinary citizen is virtually powerless in shaping or participating in government decisions, government policy tends to be... responsive to the privileged." - **Robert Dahl**

- **Underrepresentation:** Certain groups may be underrepresented, leading to disparities. Example: Marginalized groups having limited representation.

"Inequalities in the actual modes of public voice, access to public office, and influence on state actions undercut democratic participation and equality." - **Iris Marion Young**

- **Party Politics:** Partisan interests can overshadow the public interest.

"The party in a democracy is the instrument of democracy." - **Maurice Duverger**

- **Complex Campaign Financing:** Raises concerns about election fairness and transparency.

"Our democracy has sold out to the highest bidder." - **Lawrence Lessig**

Lack of Inclusivity: May not provide mechanisms for direct citizen participation on important issues. Example: Exclusion of some voices in decision-making.

"Strong democracy emphasizes debate and active participation by citizens in the public realm." - **Benjamin Barber**

In order to overcome the challenges of representative democracy, there is a need integrate digital platforms for direct feedback, enhance transparency, foster community engagement, and ensure mechanisms for accountability and inclusivity.

6.

PARTICIPATORY DEMOCRACY

The classical theory of participatory democracy, advanced by influential political thinkers such as **Jean-Jacques Rousseau and John Stuart Mill**, lays the foundational framework for understanding this form of governance.

The supporters of participatory democracy are Aristotle, Gandhi, Hannah Arendt, Habermas, etc. They also support civic republicanism (direct participation of people in governance).

JEAN-JACQUES ROUSSEAU'S CONTRIBUTION

- Rousseau articulated the concept of **popular sovereignty**, positing that sovereignty originates in and is perpetually retained by the people.
- For Rousseau, **sovereignty** is inalienable and cannot be represented. The government serves merely as an instrument to execute the general will.



- The people must engage in **continuous deliberation** on public policy. Non-adherence to the people's instructions by the government necessitates its replacement.

JOHN STUART MILL'S PERSPECTIVE

"The worth of a state, in the long run, is the worth of the individuals composing it." – John Stuart Mill

- Mill argued that participation shields ordinary citizens from autocracy and advances **humanity's development**.
- His ideal political system involves participatory institutions fostering **active citizenship**.
- These institutions encourage individuals to prioritize the **common good over self-interests**.
- Mill viewed democratic institutions as "**schools of political capacity**."
- Scholars like **Carole Pateman and Benjamin Barber** advocate for "strong" democracy, emphasizing greater citizen involvement. Pateman mentions that "Participatory democracy is a way of life."
- **Example:** Porto Alegre's Participatory Budgeting, where citizens allocate part of the municipal budget through public meetings.

JUSTIFICATIONS FOR CITIZEN PARTICIPATION

- **Instrumental View:** Participation driven by personal interests. Voting is based on a rational cost-benefit analysis.
 - Example: Supporting a candidate whose policies align with personal economic interests.
- **Developmental or Educational View:** Enhances moral, social, and political awareness. According to John Dewey "Democracy needs to be born anew every generation, and education is its midwife."
 - Example: Mock election simulations in schools foster civic responsibility.
- **Communitarian View:** Contributes to the common good and community well-being.
 - Example: Community clean-up days foster solidarity and shared responsibility.

CHARACTERISTICS OF PARTICIPATORY DEMOCRACY

- **Direct Citizen Involvement:** Citizens engage directly in political decision-making (Rousseau's "general will").
- **Decentralization:** Decision-making at local levels.

- **Open and Inclusive:** Ensures equal participation for all citizens.
- **Transparency and Accountability:** Government actions are accessible to the public (Robert Dahl).
- **Active Civic Education:** Prioritizes informed participation.
- **Theory of Communicative Action:** Public forums and debates for policy discussion (Jurgen Habermas).
- **Referendums and Initiatives:** Citizens propose and vote on policy decisions (JS Mill supported direct democracy practices).
- **Diverse Forms of Participation:** Includes voting, public hearings, and online activism.
- **Continuous Engagement:** Encourages political activity beyond elections (Robert D. Putnam).
- **Citizen Oversight:** Mechanisms for citizen oversight of government actions.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE

- **Institutional mechanisms** (supported by Liberal School): Gram Sabhas, Social Audit, etc.
- **Grassroot Democracy** (Supported by Marxist School): Empowerment of SCs, STs, women, etc.

CRITICISM OF PARTICIPATORY DEMOCRACY

- **Feasibility in Large Populations:** Difficult to ensure meaningful participation (Robert Dahl).
- **Limited Expertise:** Citizens may lack specialized knowledge (Joseph Schumpeter).
- **Potential for Populism:** Risk of decisions influenced by emotions (Hannah Arendt).
- **Low Turnout:** Decisions may not represent the broader population. (Carole Pateman)
- **Resource Intensity:** Referendums and initiatives can divert resources from other governance tasks. (**Benjamin Barber**)
- **Manipulation and Coercion:** Risk of manipulation or coercion by interest groups. (**Jürgen Habermas**):

Therefore, participatory democracy strives for increased citizen involvement in decision-making but faces challenges in implementation and effectiveness.

7. DELIBERATIVE DEMOCRACY

Deliberative democracy critiques the limitations of voting-centric models. It emphasizes the importance of reasoned discourse and inclusive dialogue in shaping public policy. This theory prioritizes the quality of deliberation and exchange of ideas among citizens, aiming to achieve well-informed and legitimate collective decisions.

The essence of deliberative democracy lies in the rational debate. Most important component of rational debate is right to freedom of speech and expression (which includes freedom to form association and right to dissent).

In this model, there is no need for hyphenation (no need of mentioning deliberation) as idea of deliberation is inherent in the idea of democracy.

IMPORTANT PROPONENTS

Jurgen Habermas: He views public deliberation as a way for citizens to achieve consensus and make decisions based on rational discourse. According to him, "Deliberation takes place when the participants in the discourse argue and weigh the validity claims with the intention of reaching a rationally motivated agreement."

John Rawls: He argued that the principles of justice should be determined through a fair process of deliberation among citizens who are behind a "veil of ignorance" regarding their own circumstances

Joshua Cohen: He emphasizes the need for fairness in deliberative processes and the importance of achieving mutual respect among participants.

Pericles (Athenian Statesman): Debate and discussion are preconditions for sound policy, rather than obstacle.

Habermas: He talks about importance of public sphere and emphasises on deliberative democracy because he talks about importance of communicative action in ideal speech situation (open discussion without fear of coercion).

FEATURES OF DELIBERATIVE DEMOCRACY

➤ **Reasoned Discourse:** It advocates for rational, informed discussions, fostering democratic legitimacy through "communicative rationality."

○ **Jurgen Habermas:** "The only force that can overcome the fragmented modernity of our age and permit the emergence of a democratic public sphere is the force of what I have called communicative rationality."

➤ **Inclusivity:** It emphasizes the inclusion of diverse voices and perspectives in decision-making.

➤ **Public Reason:** Policies and decisions should be justified through reasons accessible to all citizens.

○ **John Rawls:** "The principles of justice are the result of public reason, now fully developed, and the result of free and reasoned agreement among equals."

➤ **Active Citizenship:** Encourages participation beyond voting, involving citizens in discussions and policymaking. Example: Ireland's citizens' assembly on abortion influenced legislative changes.

➤ **Common Ground:** Aims to find consensus through reasoned discourse.

○ **James S. Fishkin:** "Deliberative democracy...offers a way to counter the polarization and paralysis that have come to characterize contemporary politics."

➤ **Impact on Policy:** Outcomes from public deliberation meaningfully influence public policy.

➤ **Democratic Legitimacy:** Decisions made through inclusive and informed deliberation are seen as more legitimate.

➤ **Citizen Education:** Participation in deliberation educates citizens about political issues, enhancing reasoning and empathy.

SIGNIFICANCE OF DELIBERATIVE DEMOCRACY

➤ It makes democracy consociational (a stable democratic system in deeply divided societies that is based on power sharing), which is superior to majoritarian model.

➤ It provides legitimacy to the laws.

CRITICISM OF DELIBERATIVE DEMOCRACY

➤ **Inclusivity and Participation:** Risk of amplifying dominant group voices, sidelining marginalized groups.

➤ **Elitism and Expertise:** Preference for skilled communicators or experts can create an epistemic elite.

➤ **Implementation Challenges:** Logistical difficulties and resource demands on a large scale.

- **Manipulation and Coercion:** Potential for powerful actors to control deliberative processes.
- **Slow Decision-Making:** Time-consuming nature may impede timely responses to emergencies.
- **Limited Enforcement:** Concerns about the lack of enforcement mechanisms.

8.

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN PARTICIPATORY AND DELIBERATIVE DEMOCRACY

Participatory Democracy	Deliberative Democracy
Direct citizen involvement in decision-making, focusing on the number of participants.	Emphasizes quality of participation through rational deliberation.
Direct democracy, citizens make decisions themselves.	Exists in both representative and participatory models, focusing on meaningful debate.
Involves direct, broad citizen engagement in local decision-making.	Relies on informed, reasoned discourse and consensus-building.
Emphasizes broad inclusion and transparency in processes.	Ensures diverse voices and public insight into deliberative processes.
Focuses on civic education and legitimacy through direct involvement.	Educates citizens and derives legitimacy from informed, inclusive deliberation.

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OFFLINE ONLINE

UNIT 7: CONCEPT OF POWER- HEGEMONY, IDEOLOGY AND LEGITIMACY

"Political Science is 'the study of the shaping and sharing of power'".

– H. Lasswell and A. Kaplan (*Power and Society*; 1950)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ◊ Comment on Foucault's concept of power. (2023)
- ◊ Comment on Bases of Power. (2022)
- ◊ Comment on Tools for the legitimization of state. (2021)
- ◊ Examine the nature and meaning of power. (2020)
- ◊ According to Gramsci, "Hegemony is primarily based on organization of consent". Comment (2019)
- ◊ Comment on: End of ideology debate (2019)
- ◊ Explain the relationship between power, authority and legitimacy. (2018)
- ◊ Write a brief note on The End of History debate. (2017)
- ◊ Distinguish between Power and Authority. (2015)
- ◊ Discuss the "Crisis of Legitimacy" in capitalist societies. (2015)
- ◊ "Power is never a property of individual; it belongs to a group and remains in existence only so long as the groups keep together". (Hannah Arendt) Comment (2014)
- ◊ Examine the conditions that are required for the maintenance of legitimacy in modern societies. (2014)
- ◊ Comment on Hannah Arendt's conception of the 'political'. (2012)
- ◊ Distinguish between the concepts of legitimacy and hegemony. (2012)
- ◊ Attempt a comparative examination of the views of Marx and Weber on 'Power'. (2011)

1. INTRODUCTION

'Power' may be regarded as one of the central concepts of political science. It is said that the concept of power holds the same status in the realm of political science.

This view was confirmed by **William A. Robson** who suggested: "It is with power in society that political science is primarily concerned—its nature, basis, processes, scope and results ... The 'focus of interest' centres on the struggle to gain or retain power, to exercise power or influence over others, or to resist that exercise".

Michel Foucault's view on power is multifaceted and complex. He **rejected the traditional notion of power** as something that is only held by a few individuals or institutions and instead argued that **power is omnipresent and diffused throughout society**. According to Foucault, power is not just **repressive** but also **productive**; it shapes knowledge, discourse, and social practices.

According to **Robert Dahl**, power is a relational concept. He describes power as a capacity to get things done by the other either willingly (soft power) or unwillingly (hard power).

Thus, the concept of power is dynamic, multifaceted, essentially a contested concept.

CONCEPTUALIZATION OF POWER: BY COSER (1982)

Coser delineated two major traditions in the conceptualisation of power that can be distinguished in sociological writings. These are as follows:

Scholar	Tradition	Key Arguments
Max Weber	Power as Domination	Power is seen as a relationship where one actor (A) can impose their will on another actor (B), even against B's resistance. Power is inherently tied to the ability to dominate others .
Talcott Parsons	Power as a Collective Facility	Power is viewed as a positive social resource that collectives can utilize to achieve their goals. It is a means to facilitate collective action and is essential for the functioning of social systems.

2. THEORIES OF POWER

According to **Steven Lukes (Power: A Radical View, 1975)**, power has three faces:

1. **Ability to influence the decision making** (Ex- **Hobbes's notion of power** i.e., ability of an 'agent' to affect the behaviour of a 'patient').
2. **Capacity to shape the political agenda and thus prevent decisions being made** (Ex- Interest Groups shaping the political agenda and Marx's ideas).
3. **The form of controlling people's thoughts by the manipulation of their perceptions and preferences** (Ex- Gramsci's concept of hegemony and Marcuse's one-dimensional).

A. LIBERAL PERSPECTIVE OF POWER

According to liberals, the state holds a monopoly on power and acts as a symbol of the people, reflecting **popular sovereignty**. In liberal democracies, ultimate power lies with the people, and the government exercises power delegated by them.

B. MARXIST THEORY OF POWER

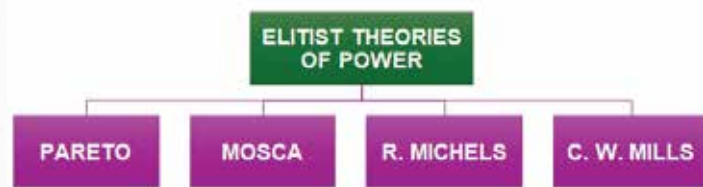
Marx viewed political power as being possessed by those who control the means of production, while the labour force has little or no control over these means. This "**relation of production**" thus determines the distribution of political power.

State as Instrument: Marx sees a **close integration between political power and the prevailing socio-economic system**. According to Marxist theory, **the state is part of the superstructure** and is not autonomous. In practice, the state functions as the executive committee of the bourgeoisie, exercising power on behalf of the economically dominant class.

Transitional State: Marxists believe that in a **socialist society** characterized by **the dictatorship of the proletariat**, the majority exercises power. In a **communist society**, they envision a **stateless and classless system** where no one exercises power over others, and everyone is free.

C. ELITIST THEORY OF POWER

Elitist Theory of Power is seen as an improvement over the Liberal and Marxist theory of power. It is also called as **Empirical Theory** (observation based).



a. VILFREDO PARETO'S ELITIST THEORY OF POWER

Elitist Theory of Pareto (**Book- Mind and Society**) divides society into the **elite and the non-elite**. The elite are those considered the best by peers and the public, with **two subcategories**: the governing elite (ruling minority), who influence or participate in government, and the **non-governing elite**.

Apart from elites, he categorises the "others" as **masses or the ruled majority**. He argues that power always lies with the elite.

ROOTS OF ELITIST THEORY

The roots of the theory can be traced to the thoughts of-

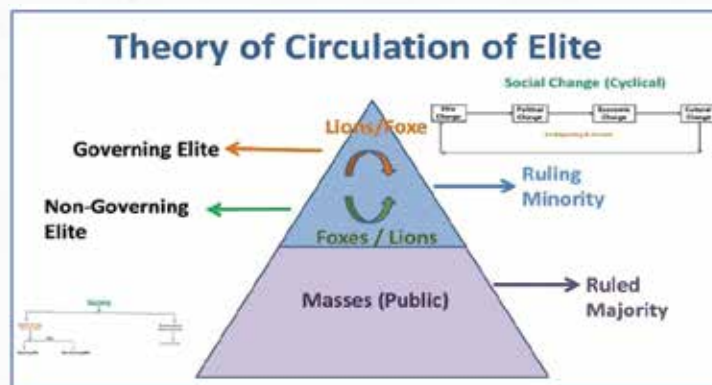
- **Plato:** Classified people into 3 categories i.e., men of reason, courage and appetite.
- **Aristotle:** Master-Slave Relationship.
- **Machiavelli:** Everyone can't be a Prince.

Pareto- "History of mankind has been the graveyard of aristocracy."

Pareto asserted that those at the top in wealth and other attributes also hold significant political and social influence.

THEORY OF CIRCULATION OF ELITES

He introduced the "circulation of elites," where individuals move between elite and non-elite groups (ruling minority), or one elite replaces another. And the power circulates in the closed loop between them. This power never percolates down to the masses.



Pareto believes that there are two types of elites: **Foxes** (mentally strong), and **Lions**, (physically strong). These groups are interdependent.

Renewal of Elite Class: Pareto observed that the elite **continually renews** itself by incorporating individuals from lower classes. This process sustains both quality and stability within the elite. However, if this circulation slows down, the elite can degenerate while the non-elite acquire superior elements, leading to instability and potential revolution. To counter such threats, the governing elite may integrate potential challengers from **lower classes**, who then adopt the established elite's interests.

Note: The process of renewal of elite class is similar to **the concept of Sanskritization (MN Srinivas)** whereby people of lower castes collectively try to adopt upper caste practices and beliefs to acquire higher status.

b. GAETANO MOSCA

According to Mosca, in all societies there are two classes of people:

- **One that rules:** performs all political functions, monopolizes power and enjoys all the advantages and privileges that accompany power.
- **Other that is ruled:** Majority in number, but governed and controlled by ruling class through legal, sometimes arbitrary and violent means.

Like Pareto, Mosca was also concerned with elites as groups of people vested with political power. He argues that power in democracy lies with those who have organisation skills (leadership skills). Members of this ruling minority enjoy high esteem in the eyes of ruled majority due to their outstanding qualities.

c. ROBERT MICHELS (BOOK- POLITICAL PARTIES)

R. Michels has given the concept of Iron Law of Oligarchy (universally proven law). He argues that democracy (power with people) is a myth. Whether it is Western liberal state like USA or communist state like Russia, power always lies with the small section of elite (power concentrated in the hands of few). It is called as the Iron Law of Oligarchy. Thus, Michels argued that all forms of government are destined to be reduced to oligarchy.

View of Raymond Aron: He argues that the situation in Western countries is better because of the fractured nature of the elite structure.

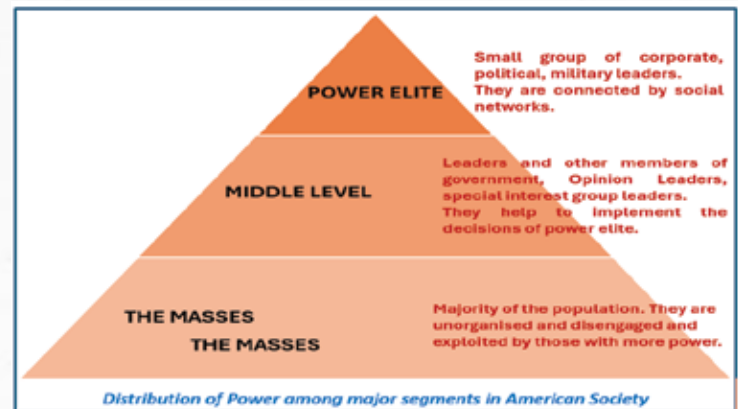
FRACTURED ELITE	MONOLITHIC ELITE
Liberal States have a competitive party system and people have choices with respect to political elite class.	In Communist states, there exists a single party and people do not have choices.

Thus, people can exercise the franchise (voting rights) and power in the direct democracies and states with multi-party system.

d. WRIGHT MILLS (BOOK- THE POWER ELITE)

- **Coalition and Strategic Positions:** The 'power elite' is a coalition of influential groups holding dominant positions in key areas of social life in modern American society, occupying strategic command posts.
- **Creation of Social Demands:** These elites create social demands rather than gaining power by fulfilling existing ones, thereby shaping society according to their interests.
- **Self-Conscious Class and Moral Indifference:** The power elites form a self-conscious class, reinforcing each other's power through cooperation. They project an image of high moral character for societal respect but are often indifferent to their actual moral and social responsibilities.

In USA, power elites are top government executives, military directors and corporation officials.



D. PLURALIST THEORY OF POWER

Associated scholars: **Robert Dahl** and **Charles Lindblom**

Context of Robert Dahl's Work:

In his work "**Who Governs?**", Dahl studied the observations of **C. Wright Mills** i.e., USA is ruled by few, and USA is actually not a democracy rather an oligarchy.

Dahl conducted study in New Havens (Connecticut State of USA) and **falsified C. Wright Mills' view about democracy in USA**. Dahl argued that ordinary people in USA exercise considerable amount of power. However, they do not exercise power as individuals, rather they exercise power **as members of interest groups or pressure groups**. And different interest groups enjoy fairly equal amount of power.

Thus, Dahl held that USA is not an oligarchy, rather **USA is a polyarchy**.

Democracy	Oligarchy	Polyarchy
Rule of People (Ideal form)	Rule of Few (Pakistan)	Rule of many (USA)

Democracy is a system where all citizens participate in the governance of the country. But according to the pluralist, this is **utopia or an ideal scenario**. They believe that we can not have a perfect democracy and what exists in **reality is a polyarchy (an approximate democracy)**. Polyarchy means maximum democracy which is feasible or practically possible.

WHO DOES HOLD POWER IN WESTERN LIBERAL

Classical Liberals	Everyone holds equal power.
Marxists	Power is held by economically dominant classes.
Elitists	Power elites wield the power or power is held by few.
Pluralists	Power lies with the people in groups (Interest Groups).

DEMOCRACY?

NEO-PLURALIST VIEW OF POWER

Robert Dahl revised his earlier opinion. He acknowledged that in USA all groups do not wield and exercise equal amount of power. According to him, the corporate groups wield greater amount of power.

It means that USA is not a polyarchy. Rather USA is a "deformed polyarchy", i.e., power in polyarchy is tilted in favour of corporate groups.

Conclusion: The Neo-pluralist view of power comes near to the position held by Marxist i.e., economically dominant classes exercise greater power.

NEO-NEO PLURALIST VIEW OF POWER

Eric Nordlinger has given neo-neo pluralist view of power. He argues that **the State monopolises all the power**. This analysis is relevant with respect to the third world countries where state is the most prominent actor.

Thus, this view of Nordlinger comes near to the **Structural Marxists** or concept of **Overdeveloped State**.

3. VARIOUS PERSPECTIVES ON POWER

Various other perspectives on power are discussed below:

A. GRAMSCIAN VIEW OF POWER

Gramsci's view of power focuses on **cultural hegemony**, where dominant groups maintain control by shaping thoughts through **societal norms, values, and beliefs**. This subtle, ideological influence ensures **consent and stability**, making **power appear natural and inevitable** rather than enforced through coercion.

This invisible power i.e., hegemony allows the bourgeoisie class to rule in the society. Therefore, he suggests fighting **the war of position** first, and then the **war of manoeuvre**.

B. FEMINIST VIEW OF POWER

Since the nature of society has always been patriarchal, feminists believe that the power always lies with the man.

C. HANNAH ARENDT'S VIEW OF POWER

She provides an unconventional view of power. She suggests that power lies with the people acting in concert with each other. Power is sui generis in nature, and it should not be equated with force, strength and violence. Thus, she provides a positive view of power.

"Power corresponds to the human ability not just to act but to act in concert. Power is never the property of an individual; it belongs to a group and remains in existence only so long as the group keeps together." (**Hannah Arendt**)

For example: The Civil Rights Movement, led by Martin Luther King Jr., used collective action and peaceful protests to advocate for racial equality.

D. POST-MODERNIST VIEW OF POWER

The post-modernists refute **the monochromatic view** and argue that there can be no one narrative to describe society and reality and instead there are multiple narratives.

Jean-François Lyotard (postmodernist), thus, calls postmodernism as **incredulity** (disbelief) **towards metanarratives** (grand theories).

E. FOUCAULT'S THEORY OF POWER

Foucault is a French philosopher and often categorised as Postmodernist, **Post-structuralist and Critical School Theorist** (**Critical Theorists** aim to understand various forms in which oppression exist).

Michel Foucault's concept of power is a central element of his philosophical and sociological work. Foucault's ideas on power are complex and multifaceted, and they have had a significant influence on various fields, including sociology, political science, and philosophy.

Rejection of Hobbesian Notion: Being a postmodernist, Foucault rejects the metanarrative/ dominant perspective on power. **Hobbesian notion of power.** It represents a **juridico-legal view of power** i.e. power lies with the sovereign state. Foucault argues that if we limit ourselves with this view, then we fail to understand infinite ways in which power operates in the society.

Rejection of Marxist View: As per the Marxist view, state is an executive committee of bourgeoisie class. However, Foucault believes that Marxian view is just another metanarrative.

Foucault's Prescription: According to Foucault, meta-narratives are constructed to hide rather than reveal the reality. Therefore, he emphasises that we should not look at the truth through these narratives. Since power operates throughout the society in infinite ways, like **the blood flows through the network of capillaries**. So, we should look for the truth from multiple perspectives or narratives.

Thus, Foucault shifts his focus of his study of power from state to society and provides a **sociological view** of power. It is known as **micro-view of power**.

KEY FEATURES OF FOUCAULT'S CONCEPT OF POWER

Ubiquitous and Productive Nature of Power: By saying *"Power is everywhere; not because it embraces everything, but because it comes from everywhere"*, he means that power is not confined to specific institutions or individuals but is present everywhere in society. Power is a strategy, and it operates in the form of **complex web of social relations**.

Productive Nature of Power: Power is not necessarily coercive; it can be productive. It provides identity to the

agent exercising power. Thus, power is productive, as it shapes knowledge, norms, and social practices.

➤ **Example-** Knowledge of Medical Science provides identity and thus power to the **Doctor**.

Power/Knowledge Relationship: Foucault introduced the concept of "power/knowledge" to emphasize the interconnectedness of power and knowledge. Knowledge is phenomenon of power and only that knowledge is treated as knowledge or truth which comes with power. Thus, power structures shape what is considered valid knowledge, and knowledge reinforces existing power structures.

➤ **Example-** **Homosexuality** is considered as wrong and **Heterosexuality** is considered as natural and right. This knowledge reflects the phenomenon of power (majoritarian view).

Note: **Nietzsche's ideas** on the relationship between truth, knowledge and power influenced him very much. **Nietzsche rejected the notion that history unfolds in a rational way** with the gradual development of higher forms of reason. Any form of knowledge or truth that emerges in a culture not because it is valuable or eternal, but it is because one group manages to impose their will on others.

Panopticism and Surveillance: Foucault's concept of the **Panopticon**, borrowed from **Jeremy Bentham**, illustrates how surveillance and the potential for surveillance can exert control over individuals. The idea is that people modify their behaviour when they believe they are being watched.

"He who is subjected to a field of visibility, and who knows it, assumes responsibility for the constraints of power." – Foucault

Discourse and Power: Foucault describes discourse as the location where power and knowledge intersect. Discourse generates the subject. Foucault explored how power operates through discourse, which consists of language, practices, and institutions that shape knowledge and social reality. Discourses can marginalize certain groups and reinforce dominant ideologies. For Foucault, power is discourse.

➤ **Example:** Identity is a product of discourse.

Resistance and Subjugation: Foucault recognized that power is not unidirectional; it operates in a network of resistance and subjugation. Individuals and groups can resist power structures and create counter discourses.

"Where there is power, there is resistance." (Foucault)

Historical Contingency: Foucault emphasized that power is historically contingent, meaning that it changes over time and in response to social and cultural shifts. There is no ultimate truth, rather there are regimes of truth. Truth belongs to this world, in different phases of history different truths have prevailed. Foucault calls this method studying history as **Archaeology**.

"Power is not an institution, and not a structure; neither is it a certain strength we are endowed with; it is the name that one attributes to a complex strategical situation in a particular society." (Foucault)

Disciplinary Power: In his book "**Discipline and Punish**", Foucault narrates an incident of torturous punishment of a man in public to create fear or terror. However, in modern times, the technique of exercising power has changed. It is called as **disciplinary power** (it is exercised on mind. It is oppressive, but not realised as it is considered as normal).

➤ **Example:** Earlier, prisons were considered as places of torture. Today they are being seen as places of reform.

Governmentality: It refers to the techniques and strategies used by governments to control and manage populations. It combines governance ("government") with mentalities ("mentalities"), emphasizing how modern states exercise power through an array of **institutions** (prisons, schools, etc.), **practices**, and **knowledge systems to regulate the behaviour and thoughts of individuals**.

It also involves the creation of **policies and practices** that guide and shape the conduct of people, aiming to produce a **compliant and productive citizenry**.

Biopower: Foucault's biopower refers to how modern states regulate populations by managing biological aspects like birth rates, health, and hygiene. It shifts power from sovereign control over life and death to optimizing and regulating life itself. This is how state goes for homogenisation easier control and regulation of populations.

Michel Foucault challenges traditional views of power as solely negative and oppressive. Instead, he sees power as **productive, shaping knowledge, subjects, and even reality**. Foucault emphasizes the historical nature of knowledge and power, with strategies like **pastorate** (love-based power) and **panopticism** (surveillance) used to control. However, his later works suggest individuals can resist through self-cultivation and challenge power structures.

CONCEPT OF AUTHORITY

Authority is based on a perceived '**right to rule**' and brings about **compliance** through a **moral** obligation on the part of the ruled to obey.

It constitutes a socially or institutionally sanctioned form of power, where individuals or entities are endowed with the formal prerogative to make decisions, issue directives, or enforce regulations within a specific domain or context.

MAX WEBER, a prominent sociologist and critic of Marx, identified three key elements of authority which help to understand the ways in which the authority in the society is established. These are:

Traditional Authority: It is based on customs, traditions and hereditary rights. Society tends to accept traditional authority because it is deeply ingrained in cultural norms and history.

➤ **Example-** Leadership passed down through generations within a family or lineage (monarchies, tribal societies, etc.).

Legal-Rational Authorities: Legal-rational authority is impersonal and grounded in laws, rules, bureaucratic system and government.

➤ **Example-** Elected officials in democracies, judges in courts, and managers in big corporations, etc.

Charismatic Authority: It is derived from charisma and exceptional leadership. Charismatic leaders possess qualities that make them extraordinary and help create a strong followers base. Charismatic authority can be transformative and may challenge existing power structures.

➤ **Example-** Mahatma Gandhi's leadership during Indian freedom struggle.

Dimension	Power	Authority
Definition	The ability to influence or control others	The legitimate right to exercise power
Source	Can be derived from various means (coercion, influence, etc.)	Derived from a recognized and accepted position or institution
Legitimacy	Not necessarily legitimate or accepted	Legitimate and socially or institutionally accepted

Nature	Can be personal or informal	Institutionalized and formal
Enforcement	May rely on force, coercion, or persuasion	Relies on established rules and norms
Scholars	Hobbes view on power and Steven Lukes' three faces of power	Max Weber's types of authority, Robert Michels' concept of oligarchy

OTHER PERSPECTIVES ON AUTHORITY

Hannah Arendt: Authority is an essential element of social and political stability, derived from the collective consent of the governed.

Steven Lukes: He outlined three dimensions of power: decision-making power, agenda-setting power, and ideological power. These dimensions help explain how power operates within decision-making processes and influences authority.

Robert Dahl: Democratic systems function effectively when authority is pluralistically distributed among various groups and institutions.

Jurgen Habermas: Legitimate authority is achieved through reasoned public dialogue and consensus, underscoring the importance of communicative action in democratic decision-making.

LEGITIMACY

Legitimacy is typically defined as '**rightfulness**.' It plays a crucial role in distinguishing between power and authority. Legitimacy is the **quality that transforms naked power into rightful authority**; it endows an order or command with an authoritative or binding character, ensuring compliance based on a sense of duty rather than fear.

A. MEANS OF LEGITIMIZATION OF POWER

Aristotle (Ancient Greece): "Rule was legitimate only when it operated to the benefit of the whole society rather than in the selfish interests of the rulers."

Medieval Period: Divine rights theory says that people should obey king because king is representative of God on the earth.

Modern Times: Social Contract Theorists (Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau) provides the concept of consent (will of people).

- **Rousseau:** By saying '*The strongest is never strong enough to be always the master unless he transforms strength into right and obedience into duty*', **Rousseau** (The Social Contract) argues that Government was legitimate if it was based on the '**general will**'.

Liberal Tradition:

- Legitimacy emerges when power is exercised according to established rules and **principles** that are widely accepted.
- Rule is based on the consent of the governed, indicating that legitimacy arises '**from below**'.
- **Francis Fukuyama** (1992) and other '**End of History**' theorists view liberal democracy as the only stable and enduringly successful form of government. They argue that its virtue lies in its ability to guarantee continued legitimacy through two key mechanisms: **constitutionalism** and **consent**.

Radical Theorists (Marxist Influence):

- Legitimacy is created '**from above**' through the manipulation of information, beliefs, and knowledge of citizens.
- Legitimacy may be a form of **ideological dominance** where regimes maintain control by shaping the ideological context.

Modern Liberals:

- **TH Green** counters the Marxist view and suggests that "will, not force, is the basis of state" and "state hinders the hindrances".
- However, **Marxist scholars** like **Gramsci** says that will for the state is not natural or spontaneous, rather manufactured.
- **Hannah Arendt** believes that, state cannot be legitimate, and power does not require legitimation as power in itself is legitimate.
- Thus, authority can be considered as exercise of power which is endorsed by the people (consent and legitimacy). Consent and legitimacy are prerequisites because power can not be exercised solely with the use of force or coercion for long. In the absence of legitimacy, there is possibility of
- **Governability Crisis** (i.e., protests, violence, resistance, revolution, etc.).
- The **indications of legitimacy** of state are: law and order in society, people paying taxes and respecting national symbols, participation in elections, etc.



B. CONDITIONS FOR LEGITIMACY

David Beetham (Book- **The Legitimation of Power**) provides the following conditions for Legitimate Power:

1. Power must be exercised according to established rules (rule of law), whether embodied in formal legal codes or informal conventions.
2. These rules must be justified in terms of the shared beliefs of the government and the governed.
3. Legitimacy must be demonstrated by the expression of consent on the part of the governed (citizens).
4. Other factors include:
 - a. Independence of judiciary
 - b. Protection of fundamental rights
 - c. Welfare provisions.

C. CONCEPT OF LEGITIMATION CRISIS BY HABERMAS

Jürgen Habermas, a German sociologist and philosopher, introduced the concept of Legitimation Crisis in the 1970s. It describes a situation where institutions lose the public's trust and confidence in their ability to govern effectively. A legitimation crisis arises from the **tension between the demands of a democratic system and the realities of a capitalist economy**.

Context: The context is **debate on state** between **Liberals** (who believe that state represents will people) and **Marxists** (who believe state as an instrument of bourgeoisie). And **Modern Liberals** argue that welfare state had ended the contradiction of capitalism as it works in the interest of the poor. So, there is no possibility of revolution.

Core Question of Habermas: Whether welfare state has ended the contradiction of capitalism and possibility of revolution?

- **Observation of Habermas:** Welfare state can not resolve the contradictions on permanent basis, and it cannot escape the legitimation crisis.

REASONS FOR LEGITIMATION CRISIS:

Welfare state is based on contradictory principles. These are- politics is based on socialism and economics is based on capitalism.

- **Socialism in politics:** Since workers have right to vote, politicians will have to offer welfare provision, freebies, etc. to gain vote.

- **Economics in capitalism:** Welfare state has not abolished private property, giving rise to inequalities. Thus, Marxists argue that permanent solution is social ownership of means of production.

Thus, the cost of welfare programs makes government finances unsustainable (Anthony King calls it as Government Overload), and they need to be supported by private companies or industries. Thus, this results into rolling back of state and people protesting against the hardships (ex- Greece's sovereign debt crisis).

KEY FEATURES:

- **Loss of Public Trust:** The public begins to question the legitimacy of institutions, doubting their authority to make decisions and govern fairly.
- **Breakdown of Communication:** Communication between institutions and the public breaks down. Institutions may be seen as unresponsive to the needs and concerns of the people.
- **Focus on Efficiency:** Institutions become overly focused on economic efficiency and bureaucratic processes, neglecting social values and democratic participation.
- **Crisis in Advanced Capitalism:** Habermas argues this crisis is particularly evident in advanced capitalist societies where economic concerns overshadow social well-being.
- **Consequences:** A Legitimation Crisis can lead to social unrest, political instability, and a decline in civic engagement.

Examples:

- The rise of the New Right in the 1970s can be seen as a response to perceived government overload and a decline in public trust.
- The collapse of communist regimes in Eastern Europe in the late 1980s was partly due to a legitimacy crisis caused by economic stagnation and a lack of political freedoms.

Habermas' Viewpoint: He emphasizes the importance of open communication and democratic participation in restoring legitimacy. He advocates for a "rational-critical discourse" where citizens can freely debate and challenge the decisions of institutions.

D. CONTRIBUTION OF MAX WEBER TO LEGITIMATION THEORY

Weber critiqued Marx and suggested that state does not represent naked power or force. Rather state represents authority. He suggested **three ideal type**

of authority as the basis of legitimacy in the society (traditional, legal-rational and charismatic authority).

According to Weber, in all societies all the three forms exist, but in different permutations and combinations. Only state has **monopoly over right to use force** because people have given their consent.

IDEOLOGY

Ideology is a set of ideas and aim to give a world view. Similar to ideology, religion also provides a world view. However, the basis of ideology is reason whereas basis of religion is faith. Secondly, for followers of an ideology, ideology becomes a secular religion.

Tracy projected ideology as **"science of ideas"**. He believed that ideas governing life should be based on scientific reasoning, not superstitions. However, later scholars politicised the concept and it became opposite to science.

Thus, in political science, ideology has become a versatile concept guiding political behaviour and policymaking. **Michael Freeden** emphasizes its role as the core of political language. **Karl Marx** highlights how ruling classes use ideology to maintain power, while Friedrich Hayek warns against ideological planning, emphasizing individual freedom. These scholars demonstrate that **ideology is not merely a set of beliefs but a powerful force shaping politics and society**.

Karl Mannheim, a pioneer in the study of ideology, defined it as "a more or less systematic and integral set of beliefs and attitudes centring on the basic issues of metaphysics, epistemology, axiology, and praxeology."

A. MARXIST PERSPECTIVE ON IDEOLOGY

Karl Marx's analysis of ideology provides a critical lens to understand how power dynamics are maintained in society. His insights reveal the mechanisms through which ruling classes perpetuate their dominance and the potential for revolutionary change.

- **Ruling Class Tool:** Marx argued that *"the ideas of the ruling class are in every epoch the ruling ideas."* **Antonio Gramsci** expanded this with **"cultural hegemony,"** where cultural institutions maintain control.
- **False Consciousness:** Marx introduced "false consciousness," where the working class adopts ruling class ideology.
- **Ideological Superstructure:** Marx posited that the economic base shapes the ideological superstructure.

- **Revolutionary Potential:** Marx believed the working class could achieve class consciousness and challenge capitalist ideology. Georg Lukács explored this as a catalyst for social change.
- **End of Ideology:** Marx and Friedrich Engels envisioned a communist society without class divisions or the need for ideology, aiming to eliminate alienation and create true human freedom.

Thus, Marx made distinction between science and ideology. He himself called as scientist. From then on, ideology word has been used to refer something as unscientific, biased and political.

B. LENIN'S VIEW ON IDEOLOGY

- **Marxism as the Guiding Ideology:** Lenin believed Marxism was the correct ideology to lead the working class in their quest for revolution and socialism.
- **Vanguard Party:** He emphasized the need for a dedicated vanguard party to promote and implement Marxist ideology.
- **Class Struggle:** Lenin saw ideology as a reflection of class interests, with the ruling class promoting its own ideology to maintain power.
- **Proletarian Dictatorship:** He advocated for a temporary dictatorship of the proletariat to defend and promote Marxist ideas after a successful revolution.
- **Propaganda and Education:** Lenin stressed the importance of propaganda and education to spread Marxist ideology among the masses.

Lenin treated ideology contrary to what Marx portrayed. He treated Marxism as science and called Marx as God. Therefore, Lenin is termed as Peter who denied his own master

C. ANTONIO GRAMSCI ON IDEOLOGY

Antonio Gramsci's concept of **"cultural hegemony"** is central to his interpretation of ideology. He argued that the ruling class maintains power not merely through force but by shaping and controlling the **dominant culture and ideology**. Gramsci emphasized the significant role of **intellectuals**, both **traditional and organic**, in disseminating and challenging hegemonic ideology.

Note: Refer Gramsci (WPT) for more details.

D. LOUIS ALTHUSSER ON IDEOLOGY

Louis Althusser (Book- **Ideology and Ideological State Apparatuses**, 1970) expanded Marxist ideology theory by introducing the concept of "**Ideological State Apparatuses**". He argued that institutions such as **education, media**, and religion play a pivotal role in reproducing capitalist ideology and maintaining social order. Althusser's ideas highlight the **material practices** through which ideology is transmitted and perpetuated.

He gives the concept of interpellation which means we are interpellated i.e., we cannot think independently.

E. HERBERT MARCUSE ON IDEOLOGY

Marcuse (Frankfurt School of critical theory) explored the concept of "**false consciousness**". He argued that advanced capitalist societies manipulate people's desires and needs, creating **false needs and maintaining false consciousness** through **consumerism and mass media**. Marcuse emphasized the role of ideology in sustaining capitalism.

F. ESTABLISHMENT OF USSR AND RISE OF COLD WAR

Roughly by mid twentieth century, ideology got linked with Marxism and western scholars started linking Marxism with totalitarianism and projecting liberalism with science.

On the basis of ideology of Marxism, USSR and communist regime was established. The world was divided into two blocks and there was emergence of Cold War which was an ideological battle.

In this backdrop, Marxism became a symbol of totalitarianism.

G. IDEOLOGY AND TOTALITARIANISM

Hannah Arendt (Book- **The Origins of Totalitarianism**) had clubbed Nazism and Stalinism together and held that these were the examples of totalitarian states. The basis of these states lies in **ideology and terror**.

KARL POPPER (THE OPEN SOCIETY AND ITS ENEMIES)

Idea	DESCRIPTION
Protect Open Societies	Popper argues that open and tolerant societies are essential and should be protected from ideologies that aim to destroy tolerance itself (paradox of tolerance).
Reject Historicism	Popper criticizes historicism, the belief that history follows predetermined laws. He Favors a more open approach to change through trial and error.
Promote Open Societies with Critical Thinking	Popper advocates for open, democratic societies that encourage critical thinking over closed, totalitarian ones.
Apply Falsifiability	Popper emphasizes falsifiability (the ability to be proven wrong) as a criterion for both science and ideology. Ideologies should be open to criticism and potential falsification

H. KARL MANHEIM ON IDEOLOGY

Mannheim argued ideologies aren't just about ruling class interests (like Marx) but are shaped by the social location of a group (workers, elites, etc.).

He distinguished between particular ideologies that reflect a **specific social group's perspective** (like **Liberalism**), and **utopian ideologies (Marxism)** that propose radical change for a better future.

Despite being critical, he believed that even utopia is important because it is a ray of for the suppressed class.

I. MICHAEL OAKESHOTT (CONSERVATIVE VIEW)

In his famous quote, Oakeshott mentions- "***In political activity... men sail a boundless and bottomless sea; there is neither harbour for shelter nor floor for anchorage, neither starting place nor appointed destination.***"

By this he implies that, man is **not rational**, and ideologies cannot provide political reality. Oakeshott distrusted attempts to use reason to impose grand, pre-determined plans on society.

Oakeshott believed conservatism promotes a more cautious and practical approach to politics, sceptical of grand ideologies that promise to remake society.

J. END OF IDEOLOGY THESIS

The idea that ideological conflict between capitalism and communism had subsided in the West during the 1950s and 1960s.

Daniel Bell (The End of Ideology: On the Exhaustion of Political Ideas in the fifties):

The modern state, Bell believed, had eluded the classical problems of industrial societies simply because it had evolved into a post-industrial society, whereby political compromise, the welfare state, and corporations- all buttressed by technical reasoning and interest groups- could channel social expectations into political realities. Bell used the term "cunning of reason" to describe how pragmatic problem-solving had supplanted ideological thinking.

ARGUMENTS IN FAVOUR:

- **Post-WWII Consensus:** Broad agreement between political parties in the West led to a decline in ideological division.
- **Focus on Economics:** Economic prosperity became the primary goal, pushing aside ideological debates. (e.g., **Edward Shils' report**, "The End of Ideology")
- **Convergence of Societies:** Western societies, capitalist and communist alike, were seen as becoming more similar due to shared features of industrialization. (e.g., W.W. Rostow's "The Stages of Economic Growth")
- **Decline of Class Conflict:** Marx's theory of class conflict based on economics was deemed outdated in developed societies. (e.g., **Ralph Dahrendorf's** "Class and Class Conflict in Industrial Society")
- **Diminished Political Differences:** Issues in Western democracies became more about marginal economic adjustments than fundamental ideological clashes. (e.g., Seymour M. Lipset's "Political Man")
- **Technocratic Convergence:** Industrialization led to similar features across societies, regardless of ideology, such as centralization, bureaucratization, and professionalization. (e.g., J.K. Galbraith's "The New Industrial State")

ARGUMENTS AGAINST

- **Persistence of Ideological Issues:** Debates on social justice, environment, and role of government continued.
- **Rise of New Ideologies:** The end of the Cold War did not eliminate ideological differences globally (e.g., rise of religious extremism).
- **CB Macpherson argues that in western democracies** are far from being egalitarian. So he believes that ideologies are still relevant for them to be more organised.
- **C. Wright Mills (Book- The Sociological Imagination)** dissents from the "End of Ideology" view. He argues a powerful elite and intellectuals manipulate public opinion, promotes consumerism and militarism, while silencing dissent. The apparent consensus is temporary, with new ideologies like feminism and environmentalism emerging.
- **Ralph Miliband** argued that even the welfare state is an instrument of capitalist class. Hence there is need for ideological mobilisation of poor.
- **Alasdair MacIntyre** believes that "end of ideology is itself an ideology". It aims to maintain the status quo and mask the interest of capitalist class.

The "End of Ideology" thesis captured a shift in Western politics after World War II, but it underestimated the enduring role of ideology in shaping societies and global conflict. The collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991 further fuelled the idea, but new ideological challenges have emerged since.

Amidst the rising inequalities (Capital in the Twenty-First Century by Thomas Piketty), there is growing appeal for Socialism reflecting the relevance of ideology.

K. END OF HISTORY THESIS

Francis Fukuyama's essay, "The End of History?" (1989), argues that liberal democracy represents the "end of history" as the ultimate form of government. Fukuyama draws on Hegel's concept of "end of history," suggesting liberal democracy fulfils humanity's quest for self-realization and freedom.

Underlying Fukuyama's thesis was the optimistic belief, inherited from classical liberalism, that industrial capitalism offers all members of society the prospect of social mobility and material security, encouraging every citizen to regard it as reasonable and attractive.

FUKUYAMA'S ARGUMENTS

- **Triumph of Liberal Democracy:** The collapse of the Soviet Union and the spread of liberal democracy mark the victory of this ideology over rivals like communism and fascism.
- **Fall of Competing Ideologies:** Fascism's association with Nazi Germany and communism's economic failures led to their decline.

CHALLENGES TO THE THESIS

- **Ongoing Conflicts:** Critics point to continuing global conflicts, authoritarian regimes, and ideological struggles as evidence that history is not over.
- **Clash of Civilizations:** Some argue the spread of liberal democracy might lead to a clash of cultures rather than universal acceptance of Western values.

CRITIQUE OF THE THESIS

- **Resurgent Nationalism:** Critics like Samuel P. Huntington argue Fukuyama underestimated the resurgence of nationalism in Eastern Europe after the Cold War.
- **Ethnic and Religious Conflicts:** Critics like Benjamin Barber argue the thesis overlooks the persistence of ethnic and religious conflicts that can challenge liberal democracy.
- **Economic Inequality:** The growing wealth gap within democracies is seen as a threat to their stability (Thomas Piketty's Capital in 21st Century).
- **Unresolved Global Issues:** Critics argue that liberal democracies may not have solutions to global challenges like climate change and terrorism.

- **Alternative Ideologies:** The rise of authoritarian models in countries like China and Russia challenge the idea of liberal democracy's dominance.
- **Cultural Relativism:** Promoting liberal democracy as a universal value can be seen as cultural imperialism, disregarding diverse cultural norms.
- **Post-9/11 Re-evaluation:** The 9/11 attacks and the "War on Terror" highlighted the enduring presence of ideological conflict.

After the September 11, 2001, attacks, Fareed Zakaria called the events "the end of the end of history", while George Will wrote that history had "returned from vacation".

Fukuyama's "The End of History?" sparked significant debate. While criticized for its optimism and overlooking complexities, it remains influential in discussions on political ideologies and the future of liberal democracies.

In response to critiques of his "End of History" thesis, Fukuyama sought to clarify his original proposition. He emphasized that the "end of history" referred specifically to the evolution of the human political system, which he envisioned converging towards the model of the "liberal-democratic West." Furthermore, he acknowledged that his thesis did not posit a utopian future devoid of conflict, nor did it suggest the erasure of cultural distinctions between societies.

Optional Classroom Program 2025

Admission Open

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| Anthropology | Geography |
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| Public Administration | Sociology |



UNIT 8: POLITICAL IDEOLOGIES- LIBERALISM, SOCIALISM, MARXISM, FASCISM, GANDHISM, AND FEMINISM

IDEALISM AND LIBERALISM

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ◆ Factors like community, culture and nation weaken the hegemony of neo-liberalism today. Discuss. (2022)
- ◆ Liberalism as a revolutionary idea. (2021)
- ◆ "The Political ideology of Globalization is Neoliberalism." Comment. (2016)

1. POLITICAL IDEALISM

Idealism is an oldest political ideology. Plato is the originator of Idealism. According to him, "reality is shadow of ideas" and idea is real, not material world. Thus, Idealists are **rationalists** (reason is source of knowledge) and **normativists** (emphasis on norms and values).

EVOLUTION OF POLITICAL IDEALISM

Ancient Age: Political Idealism originated in ancient Greece. Plato first time gave concept of Ideal State and gave prescription for good life.

Medieval Age: However, it lost the appeal in Medieval age which was clouded by religion or church. The Divine Rights Theory dominated the medieval age (Ex-Filmer's Patriarcha). Theory of Divine Rights denote: State is creation of God, King is representative of God on this earth and bears absolute powers. This theory was criticised by the enlightenment thinkers.

Modern Age: We see the revival of political idealism and reason in modern age with the advent of renaissance and enlightenment. Idealism was represented by two traditions:

- ◆ **Kantian Tradition:** Gave primacy to individual or human dignity and later influenced the liberal school.
- ◆ **Hegelian Tradition:** Gave primacy to state and later inspired Fascists and Totalitarians.

Locke established that "Its not God, but man has created the state through social contract". Man is prior to state and authority of state is limited by the rights of man.

Thus, renaissance, enlightenment, and reformation culminated into emergence of new political ideology i.e., **Liberalism**.

2. LIBERALISM

Liberalism is an ideology of the modern West. John Locke is called the Father of Liberalism. As an ideology, it was fully established in the 19th century in Western Europe and became so dominant that it evolved into a way of life.

A. HISTORICAL INFLUENCES ON LIBERALISM

- ◆ The rise of modern liberalism as an ideology can be traced back to the decline of feudalism in Europe and the emergence of capitalist societies.
- ◆ Influenced by the Renaissance, Reformation, and Scientific Revolution, liberalism places the human individual at the centre of its analysis.

B. CHALLENGING MONARCHIES AND ARISTOCRACY

- ◆ Liberal thinkers challenged the absolute power of monarchies, which claimed authority through the "divine right of kings." Instead, they advocated for constitutional and later representative forms of government.
- ◆ Liberals also criticized the political and economic privileges enjoyed by the aristocracy and the inherent unfairness of a feudal system where social status was determined solely by birth.

3. CORE ASSUMPTIONS OF LIBERALISM

- ◆ **Rationality, Equality, and Individual Rights:** Liberalism assumes the rationality of human beings, the inherent

equality and freedom of individuals, and the importance of individual autonomy, rights, and liberties. It emphasizes equality, asserting that all individuals are born with equal worth and should be treated as such by society and its institutions.

- **Value of Individual Autonomy:** Individual autonomy is central to liberalism, highlighting the ability of individuals to govern their own lives and make decisions based on their own beliefs and values. Liberalism advocates for limited state interference in personal matters, allowing individuals to exercise their autonomy within a just and fair society.
- **Concept of Atomistic Individuals:** Liberalism also assumes the concept of atomistic individuals, viewing individuals as independent entities with their own interests and goals.

4.

LIBERAL VIEWS ON SOCIETY, STATE, ECONOMY, EQUALITY, AND LIBERTY

DIMENSION	DESCRIPTION
LIBERTY	➤ Liberalism views society as a marketplace where individuals pursue personal interests, focusing on fulfilling their desires. ➤ These assumptions are challenged by idealists, socialists, and communarians who prioritise society over individuals.
STATE	➤ The state, according to liberalism, is formed by a social contract where individuals voluntarily establish a governing authority. ➤ Liberals support a minimal "night watchman state" focused on law and order. Thomas Jefferson said, "That state governs the least is the one which governs the best."
ECONOMIC POLICY	➤ Liberals advocate for <i>laissez-faire</i> economic policies and a free market, as championed by Adam Smith's concept of the "invisible hand." ➤ They believe in minimal state interference in economic activities, allowing market forces to drive economic growth and efficiency.

EQUALITY

- Liberals emphasize inherent equality and **equal dignity** of all individuals, focusing on equal opportunities and treatment under the law.
- They advocate **proportional equality**, where fairness is achieved by providing equitable opportunities, acknowledging varied outcomes based on individual efforts.

LIBERTY

- Liberals approach liberty from two perspectives. Firstly, they see liberty as the **absence of external constraints** on individuals. Secondly, they view **liberty** as the **promotion and development of individual capabilities**.

5.

JOURNEY OF LIBERALISM

The ideology of liberalism has undergone significant evolution from its origins in classical liberalism to its contemporary forms.

A. CLASSICAL LIBERALISM

Initially, liberalism emerged as a progressive ideology cantered on the principles of liberty and the protection of individuals. Over time, however, the capitalist class adopted a more conservative stance, prioritizing utility over liberty. **Hence, it is termed as philosophy of emerging bourgeoisie class.**

This shift resulted in liberalism becoming primarily associated with economic doctrines, dominated by utilitarians, which earned it the derogatory label of **"Pig's philosophy."**

BASIC TENETS OF CLASSICAL LIBERALISM

- **Human Nature and Individualism:** Classical liberalism is rooted in a view of human nature characterized by atomistic individualism, emphasizing the autonomy and rationality of individuals.
- **Role of the State:** Classical liberals advocate for a limited government. They believe that "state is necessary evil". They confine state's authority to protection for property rights, ensuring law and order, and providing external security.
- **Natural Rights and Personal Freedom:** Classical liberals emphasize the importance of natural rights,



which are inherent to all individuals and should not be infringed upon by any authority. They reject the notion of a common good that transcends individual interests.

QUOTES OF CLASSICAL LIBERALS

- **Herbert Spencer:** He advocates for "survival of the fittest" and supports the concept of competition.
- **Graham Sumner:** "A drunkard in the gutter is just where he ought to be according to the fitness and tendency of things". It is no business of the state to remove him out of the gutter.

EVOLUTION WITHIN CLASSICAL LIBERALISM

Within classical liberalism, we see two traditions:

- **Libertarian Tradition:** It emphasizes on liberty of individual in economic as well as socio-cultural sphere (ex- LGBTQ Movement)
- **Utilitarian Tradition:** It focuses on utility or profit and comes more closer to capitalism.

CRITICISM AND REFORMS

Liberalism's association with economic doctrines and utilitarianism led to criticism, particularly due to the exploitation of workers. This prompted the rise of socialism and left-wing movements, which challenged classical liberalism and forced it to undergo changes and reforms.

JS Mill reformed the utilitarian principles and established primacy of liberty and thus contributed to emergence of libertarian tradition. It is said that Mill was standing at the crossroads. After him, we see emergence of **Modern Liberalism** (20th Century).

Thinkers like **T.H. Green** and **John Dewey** argued for a more active role of the state in ensuring equal opportunities and addressing social injustices, laying the groundwork for modern liberalism.

B. MODERN OR POSITIVE LIBERALISM OR WELFARE STATE

The rise of classical liberalism in the West was influenced by the workers' movement and aimed to protect capitalism. During this period, there was a shift in ideas within liberalism, with scholars such as **J.S. Mill** and **T.H. Green** playing significant roles.

J.S. Mill introduced idealism into liberalism, broadening its philosophical foundations. **T.H. Green** often considered the **father of modern or positive liberalism**, redefined liberty as "**capacity**" and argued that true

liberty involves the ability to engage in meaningful pursuits in accordance with the laws of our being.

- **Interconnection of Liberty, Rights, and the State:** According to **Green**, "human consciousness postulates liberty; liberty involves rights; rights demand the state." He believes the state should foster and protect social, political, and economic environments, providing individuals the best chance of acting according to their consciences.
- **From Liberalism to State Intervention: Harold Laski,** a key figure in Fabian socialism, shifted from liberalism to advocate for a strong state role in the economy. He criticized capitalism and championed socioeconomic rights. His ideas significantly influenced Pandit Nehru, shaping India's post-independence policies towards a more interventionist state.

Laski's Statements

1. *"Every state is known by the rights it maintains"*
2. *"Rights are those conditions of life without which no man can seek in general to be at his best "*
3. *"Social order not based on recognition of claims of persons is based on sand"*
4. *"Rights are claims not empty of duties"*

C. NEOLIBERALISM

Neoliberalism emerged in the late 20th century as a reaction to the perceived failures of the welfare state. Economic challenges like fiscal deficits and the growth of bureaucratic power contributed to its rise. Influential figures like Margaret Thatcher promoted neoliberalism as the "only viable option" (TINA).

CORE PRINCIPLES

Neoliberalism advocates for:

- **Market liberalization:** Reducing state intervention, promoting competition, and encouraging free trade.
- **Fiscal austerity:** Cutting government spending and reducing public debt.
- **Privatization:** Transferring ownership of public assets to private entities.
- **Deregulation:** Reducing government regulations on businesses.

PHILOSOPHICAL UNDERPINNINGS

Neoliberalism is based on the belief in the supremacy of the market. Critics often term this "market fundamentalism," arguing it overlooks the market's limitations and its potential to exacerbate inequality.

- **HAYEK** termed **planning as a road to serfdom**: By terming planning as a useless exercise, he argued that **social justice is mirage, justice is not a feature of society, rather a characteristic of human soul**. He was against progressive taxation (termed it as bonded labour, as money doesn't reach the targeted, rather goes to the pockets of Bureaucrats. He suggested 'charity' as a better approach to target poverty.
- **ROBERT NOZICK** – in **"Anarchy, state and Utopia"** also argued that minimal state is inspiring and right, criticised welfare state and supported night watchman state.
- **MILTON FRIEDMAN** – in **"Capitalism and Freedom"** argued that Freedom is possible only through the market. If **people want to be free, they should bring capitalism**.
- **MURRAY ROTHBARD** – He compared Politicians and Bureaucrats as **gangs of Robbers and thieves**, he called central bank as a legislative fraud, supported free market economy.

Neoliberalism has faced various criticisms from different perspectives:

- **Wrong view of human identity**: Critics argue that neoliberalism promotes an unrealistic and undesirable view of individual identity, disregarding the importance of family, community, and the state in human flourishing.
- **Questioning the Efficiency**: Some argue that laissez-faire capitalism, promoted by neoliberalism, does not always produce the most efficient outcomes and fails to prevent the abuse of natural resources.
- **Critics of Robert Nozick's entitlement theory** argue that it is an inadequate theory of distributive justice, and its principles of justice in acquisition, transfer, and rectification are subject to criticism.
- **Marxist and social liberal scholars** have strongly criticized neoliberalism, comparing it to barbarism and advocating for alternative approaches such as the Doha Development Agenda and Humane Governance.

D. SOCIAL LIBERALISM

Social liberalism emerged as a prominent ideology in response to the prevailing neoliberal hegemony after the Cold War. The work of Amartya Sen, who won the Nobel Prize, played a significant role in shaping this emergence.

- **Contribution of Sen**: During this period, discontent grew due to persistent inequality at international and national levels. Sen's research highlighted that neoliberalism primarily favoured the rich without a trickle-down effect, leading to global protests, notably against the WTO in 1999. Sen advocated for "capacity building" for individuals and marginalized communities to access the benefits of globalization.
- **Contribution of Stiglitz**: In **"Globalization and Its Discontents,"** **Joseph Stiglitz** called for reforms in global institutions like the IMF and World Bank, advocating for transparency, democracy, and sustainable development. He emphasized effective markets require sound regulation, competition policy, and technology transfer.
- **Contribution of Rawls**: **John Rawls**, in **"A Theory of Justice,"** provided a philosophical basis for social liberalism, emphasizing aid for the least advantaged and fair equality of opportunity. He criticized utilitarianism and supported egalitarianism as a means to achieve a just society.

Therefore, social liberalism gained prominence as a response to the shortcomings of neoliberalism. It focused on addressing inequality, promoting capacity building, advocating for institutional reforms, and emphasizing fairness and egalitarianism.

6.

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN CLASSICAL LIBERALS AND MODERN LIBERALS

DIMENSIONS	CLASSICAL LIBERALS	MODERN LIBERALS
View on Individual	Respect individual autonomy or atomistic man (Possessive individualism).	Believe in concept of developmental individualism (moral man).
View on Liberty	View liberty as absence of state (negative liberty).	Believe that man can be free in presence of state (positive liberty)

		and state can play role in capacity building.
View on Equality	Advocate for equality of opportunity (strict).	Advocate for "fair" equality of opportunity (positive discrimination).
View on Social Justice	Support meritocracy (survival of the fittest).	Merit cannot be a sole criterion and need to include chance factor.
View on Society	View society as market-place where people come for advancement of own interests.	Man is by nature social animal and society is a place of common good.
View of State	State is necessary evil.	State is a source of virtue.

7.

LIBERALISM AS AN EVOLVING IDEOLOGY

According to **Sartori**, liberalism is an amorphous and constantly evolving ideology, susceptible to arbitrary interpretations. It is not a rigid creed or dogma but rather a flexible approach to social issues that emphasizes the importance of reason and human innovation.

Due to its adaptable nature, liberalism is often classified into different categories such as negative and positive liberalism. It can also be associated with individualism, democracy, or social democracy depending on the specific context and interpretation.

8.

MOVING BEYOND NEOLIBERALISM IN THE POST-COVID ERA

The COVID-19 pandemic exposed systemic weaknesses, necessitating a global reset. Priorities include sustainable development and addressing inequalities exacerbated by the crisis.

Neoliberalism's shortcomings such as widening inequality and environmental damage require re-evaluation. The global economic system needs to be restructured with a focus on worker rights, fair taxation, and preventing monopolies.

In the article published in Hindu Business Line (**Covid-19: Is this the end of neo-liberalism?**), **Jinoy Jose P** addresses answers to following question:

WHY IS IT THE END OF NEOLIBERALISM?

- **Globalisation's perils:** The interconnected world exposed vulnerabilities, as seen in the rapid spread of COVID-19.
- **Inequality:** Neoliberal policies exacerbated income disparities, leading to social unrest and political backlash.
- **Market failures:** The pandemic revealed the inability of the free market to address public health crises, highlighting the need for state intervention.
- **Loss of public trust:** The financial crisis of 2008 and the COVID-19 pandemic eroded public confidence in neoliberal capitalism.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE?

- **Rebalance globalisation:** Prioritize public health, worker rights, and environmental sustainability.
- **Strengthen the state:** Increase government role in regulating markets, providing public goods, and ensuring social safety nets.
- **Redistribute wealth:** Address income inequality through progressive taxation and social welfare programs.
- **Global cooperation:** Foster international collaboration to tackle global challenges like pandemics and climate change.
- **Ethical capitalism:** Promote business models that prioritize social responsibility and long-term sustainability.

Therefore, the concept of "capital" must be broadened to include environmental and social factors, shifting towards a more sustainable and equitable economic model.

MARXISM

"Workers of the world, unite! You have nothing to lose but your chains!" – Karl Marx

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Comment on: "Revolution in Permanence". (2022)
- Marx's concept of 'alienation' is an essential part of the reality in capitalism. Explain. (2021)
- Discuss Marx's concept of class. (2020).
- What is the contemporary relevance of Marxism? (2019)
- Differentiate between Freedom and Liberty. Discuss Marx's notion of freedom. (2017)
- Explain Marx's understanding of Human Essence and Alienation. (2016)
- Discuss the relationship between base and superstructure in Marxist theory. (2015)
- Discuss the key features of pre-Marxist socialist theory. (2015)

1.

INTRODUCTION

Marxism, formulated by **Karl Marx**, is a socio-political and economic theory that emerged in the 19th century as a response to the inequalities of the Industrial Revolution and capitalism. It has influenced history by addressing class struggle, power dynamics, and societal transformation.

Marxism, developed by **Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels** in the 19th century, critiques capitalism, focusing on class struggle and the exploitation of the proletariat by the bourgeoisie. It advocates for a classless society with collectively owned means of production, aiming for economic and social equality.

2.

EARLY SOCIALIST IDEAS AND MARX'S UNDERSTANDING

- Influence and Proposals of Early Socialists:** Early socialists like **Saint-Simon, Louis Blanc, and Robert Owen** proposed various approaches to address capitalism and social inequality, influenced by the French Revolution. They aimed to create a more centralized economy under state control or establish cooperative model communities instead of competitive ones.

- Louis Blanc's Critique and Proposals:** **Louis Blanc** criticized **competitive capitalism** for undermining human personality and causing poverty and social divisions. He proposed state-funded "social workshops" controlled by workers, aiming for a gradual transition to a socialist society.
- Marx's Critique of Early Socialism:** Marx referred to these early socialists as "**Utopians**" due to their **focus on class harmony and non-revolutionary methods**. He believed capitalism's inherent contradictions would inevitably lead to its destruction.
- Transition to Scientific Socialism:** Marx and Engels sought to replace **Utopian Socialism** with **Scientific Socialism**, developing Marxism as a comprehensive philosophy to analyse social problems and propose solutions. Marx argued that capitalism would ultimately undermine itself, paving the way for a socialist transformation of society.

3.

INFLUENCES ON MARX

Marx's theoretical framework in Marxism was shaped by:

- German Philosophy:** Incorporating Hegelian dialectics applied to the material world.
- French Political Thought:** Embracing radical change inspired by the French Revolutionary tradition.
- English Economics:** Drawing on classical economists to analyse capitalism and the Industrial Revolution, with a focus on England.

4.

CORE FACETS OF MARXISM

Marxism, developed by **Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels**, is a socio-political and economic theory that aims to understand and address the inequalities inherent in capitalist societies. Here are the core facets of Marxism:

A. DIALECTICAL MATERIALISM

Dialectical materialism forms the philosophical foundation of Marxism, influenced by Hegel's dialectics and Feuerbach's materialism.

Dialectics: Hegel's method of dialectics involves contradictions between opposing ideas (thesis and



antithesis) clashing to create a synthesis, driving historical development toward absolute truth. Marx adopted Hegel's concept of history as a process of constant change but focused on social and material conditions rather than intellectual and ideal aspects.

Materialism: Marx emphasized that matter, not ideas, is the essence of the universe. Social institutions and human consciousness are shaped by changing material conditions.

Economic Production and Social Relations: Marx analysed history through the lens of economic production and its associated social relations. He believed consciousness is determined by material conditions, rejecting the conservative and idealistic elements of Hegelian philosophy.

Principles of Dialectical Materialism: Engels elaborated on dialectical materialism, highlighting—

- **Transformation of Quantity into Quality:** Gradual quantitative changes lead to significant qualitative transformations.
- **Interpenetration of Opposites:** Contradictions within phenomena drive development.
- **Negation of Negation:** The resolution of contradictions leads to higher levels of development.

These principles explain social progress and class conflict, key aspects of Marxist theory.

B. HISTORICAL MATERIALISM

Historical materialism, the scientific basis of Marxism, emphasizes economic relations in shaping society's social, political, and cultural dynamics.

- **Foundation of Marxism:** Marx rejected Hegel's idealism, arguing that ideologies obscure material conditions. He identified the mode of production and exchange as pivotal in driving social change and revolutions.
- **Base-Superstructure Framework:** Marx proposed a framework where the base (economic base) determines the superstructure (legal, political, cultural aspects). Class conflict, according to Marx, is the catalyst for historical progression and societal transformations.
- **Practical Human Activity:** Marx prioritized practical human activity in material life over contemplation. He critiqued ideologies that perpetuate false consciousness among people.

- **Criticism and Debate:** Critics, like Karl Popper, challenged Marx's economic determinism, arguing that societal knowledge cannot be governed by rigid laws. Popper also criticized Marx's social engineering and his neglect of factors like religion and nationality in societal analysis.

However, despite criticism, Historical Materialism remains influential despite criticisms, shaping Marxist theory's understanding of history and societal evolution.

C. THEORY OF CLASS CONFLICT IN MARXISM

Marx's theory of class conflict is foundational to understanding societal development through history.

- **Historical Materialism and Class Struggles:** Marx posited that history is shaped by continuous class struggles. The ownership patterns of means of production determine relations and generate opposing classes.
- **Dynamic Class Relations:** Changes in modes of production lead to shifts in contending classes. Class conflict persists until resolved through social revolution, replacing old social formations.
- **Historical Examples of Class Conflict:** **Ancient societies** saw conflict between masters and slaves. **Feudal societies** witnessed clashes between lords and serfs. **Modern capitalist societies** feature conflict between bourgeoisie (capitalists) and proletariat (workers).
- **Unique Role of Proletariat:** Marx viewed the proletariat in capitalist society as distinct—a self-conscious majority working for its own interests. Proletarian revolution, envisioned by Marx and Engels, aims to establish social ownership and end class exploitation, leading to communism.
- **Criticism and Debate:** Critics argue Marx overly politicized history by focusing primarily on class conflict. Marxists defend class conflict theory as pivotal in understanding societal evolution and revolutionary change.

Marx's theory of class conflict remains a cornerstone of Marxist sociology, influencing critiques of capitalism and aspirations for social transformation towards communism.

D. MARX'S THEORY OF SURPLUS VALUE AND VIEWS ON CAPITALISM

Marx's critique of capitalism centres on the theory of surplus value and its economic implications.

- **Theory of Surplus Value:** Labor is the sole source of value in Marx's analysis. Capitalism exploits workers by extracting surplus value, where labour creates more value than what workers are compensated (subsistence wages).
- **Fundamentals of Capitalism:** Capitalism is defined by wage labour and private ownership of means of production. Capitalists profit from employing wage labourers who sell their labour power.
- **Capitalism's Advantages and Disadvantages:**
 - **Advantages:** Economic progress, global expansion, and urbanization.
 - **Disadvantages:** Expulsion of peasants, exploitation of the proletariat, and alienation of workers, leading to class conflict.
- **Inherent Contradictions of Capitalism:** Capitalism's concentration of wealth leads to heightened exploitation and social inequality. Growing organization and empowerment of the working class foster conditions for revolutionary change.
- **Path to Socialist Transformation:** Marx foresaw capitalism's collapse due to internal contradictions. A socialist society would replace private ownership with collective control of production means, achieving economic and social equality.

Marx's theory underscores the systemic exploitation within capitalism and anticipates its eventual transformation through revolutionary means towards socialism.

5. MARX'S CRITIQUE OF THE STATE

Marx's critique of the state was rooted in his philosophical and sociopolitical analysis, contrasting sharply with Hegelian perspectives.

- **Rejection of Hegelian Separation:** Marx dismissed Hegel's view of the state as a divine institution and rejected the notion of a distinct civil society separate from the state. He argued that the state and its bureaucracy serve the interests of the dominant economic class, rather than representing universal interests.

- **State as a Tool of Class Domination:** Marx viewed the state as a mechanism through which the ruling economic class maintains its power and suppresses other societal groups. He posited that each mode of production shapes the state to serve the economic base of society, particularly evident in capitalist societies where the state acts as the "executive committee of the bourgeoisie."
- **Relative Autonomy and Bonapartism:** In his analysis of Bonapartism, Marx acknowledged that while the state primarily serves the ruling class, it can temporarily gain autonomy during periods of class equilibrium. This concept illustrates Marx's nuanced understanding of state dynamics within class societies.

Thus, Marx envisioned **a future society devoid of class distinctions and state control**. In this truly democratic society, the political state would cease to exist, replaced by a system where collective decision-making and equality prevail without the need for hierarchical governance.

6.

MARX'S VISION: FROM SOCIALISM TO COMMUNISM

Eradicating Alienation: For Marx and Engels, communism wasn't just about economics; it aimed to eliminate alienation from work, society, and human potential. They envisioned a society where everyone could freely develop their talents.

Path of Dictatorship of the Proletariat (Socialism): The first step was a transitional phase called the "dictatorship of the proletariat." Here, the working class would seize power and establish a socialist state. This state would:

- Abolish private property (seen as the root of alienation).
- Centralize power to dismantle the old order.
- Distribute resources based on work performed ("**from each according to his ability, to each according to his work**").

The Ideal of Communism: Following the socialist phase, Marx envisioned a classless, stateless communist society:

- Production would be abundant, meeting everyone's needs.
- Distribution would shift to "**from each according to his ability, to each according to his needs.**"



- The state would "wither away," replaced by a focus on managing resources for the common good.

Limitations: Marx and Engels didn't leave a detailed plan for transitioning from socialism to communism. Concepts like the state's "**withering away**" remain unclear.

7. MARX'S THEORY OF ALIENATION

Capitalism's Dehumanizing Effects: Marx argues that core features of capitalism, like private ownership and the market economy, lead to worker alienation.

Four Forms of Alienation:

- **Product Alienation:** Workers have no control over what they produce or how it's made.
- **Work Alienation:** Repetitive, unfulfilling tasks turn work into a burden.
- **Social Alienation:** Capitalism pits workers against each other, hindering cooperation.
- **Self-Alienation:** Work dominates life, leaving no room for personal growth.

Alienation as a Result and Cause of Class Struggle: Alienation creates a divided society. Workers are exploited by capitalists who control the means of production.

Overcoming Alienation: Marx believed a communist society could eliminate alienation by uniting workers and the means of production.

Alienation is a central concept in Marx's philosophy, providing an analysis of the dehumanizing aspects of capitalism and pointing towards a non-alienated form of labour in a transformed society.

8. MARXISM POST-MARX

Socialism after Marx evolved through various interpretations and adaptations, influenced by historical contexts and the experiences of different countries. Here are some key developments in socialism after Marx:

A. LENIN'S THEORY OF THE STATE AND REVOLUTION

Lenin, in "**The State and Revolution**," emphasized the necessity of a **professional revolutionary party**. He argued that workers could achieve trade union consciousness but not revolutionary consciousness on their own. Lenin's key contribution was the concept of a professional revolutionary, a dedicated group with unique **Marxist insight to lead the proletariat**.

- **Dictatorship of the Proletariat:** Lenin clarified that the dictatorship of the proletariat would not abolish the state; true state abolition would occur only with the establishment of communism. He distinguished between anarchist state destruction and the Marxist theory of the state's gradual withering away. While Marx believed in natural class-consciousness development, Lenin stressed the role of a disciplined communist party in raising political awareness among workers.

- **Political Party Structure:** Lenin's political party operated on "democratic centralization," acting as the vanguard of socialism. The party demanded total dedication to the revolution, with members sacrificing personal desires for the collective cause. It was tightly centralized, with strict discipline, hierarchical authority, and rejection of federalism and local autonomy.

- **Criticism and Implementation:** The dictatorship of the proletariat often translated to the Bolshevik Party's dictatorship over the proletariat. Critics like Karl Kautsky and Rosa Luxemburg were sceptical. Kautsky viewed the Bolshevik revolution as a coup, while Luxemburg criticized the limitations on spontaneity, freedom of opinion, and socialist democracy.

IMPERIALISM: THE HIGHEST STAGE OF CAPITALISM

Capitalist Expansion: Lenin, in "**Imperialism: The Highest Stage of Capitalism**," argued that capitalism needed new sources of raw materials and markets, driving Western countries to seek opportunities in Asia, Africa, and South America. He described this stage as monopolistic and parasitic, marking capitalism as reactionary.

Global Conditions for Revolution: Imperialism created global conditions ripe for a socialist revolution, exhausting its mission of promoting revolutions within individual nations.

B. MAOISM

Mao Zedong, following Lenin, led a successful revolution in China by mobilizing the peasant class, which Marx had dismissed as non-revolutionary. Emphasizing armed struggle, he believed "**power flows through the barrel of a gun**."

- **Concept of Contradictions:** Mao introduced the idea of contradictions as the unity of opposites.



- He differentiated between antagonistic contradictions (e.g., **Chinese people vs. comprador bourgeoisie**) and non-antagonistic contradictions (e.g., conflicts between peasantry and proletariat).
- **Peasantry as a Revolutionary Force:** Contrary to Marx and Lenin, Mao recognized the revolutionary potential of the peasantry. He led the Chinese revolution with significant peasant support, inspiring other peasant societies in Africa and Asia.
- **Lessons from the Soviet Union:** During the Cultural Revolution, Mao learned from Soviet experiences and warned against a new bourgeois class emerging from the party's hierarchy. He emphasized preventing the party's top echelons from becoming a new ruling class.
- **United Front Strategy:** Mao acknowledged that the peasantry alone couldn't overthrow imperialism and feudalism in China. He advocated for a United Front strategy, forming alliances with the proletariat, petty bourgeoisie, national bourgeoisie, and non-party intellectuals to oppose imperialism.
- **New Democratic Republic:** In 1940, Mao proposed a new democratic republic of China, evolving into the New Democracy system in 1945. The "People's Democratic Dictatorship" included multiple classes: peasantry, working class, petty bourgeoisie, and national bourgeoisie. Mao's approach combined Marxism with nationalism, diverging from the classical Marxist idea of the dictatorship of the proletariat.

Mao's revolutionary methods and class alliances, especially with the peasantry, profoundly influenced Marxist thought and were relevant to various peasant societies worldwide.

C. NEO-MARXISM

Broadly speaking, contemporary Marxist thought—better known as **Neo-Marxism**—has developed in two directions: **Humanist** and **Scientific**. While **Humanist School**, also known as **Critical School**, was developed in **Frankfurt**, **Scientific or Structuralist School** was developed by **Althusser** and was influenced by Gramsci.

D. FRANKFURT SCHOOL

The Critical/Frankfurt School originated in **Germany** but moved to the **University of Columbia** in the US due to **Hitler's rise to power**. Its primary aims were to

investigate the decline of labour and communist movements in the West and to understand the masses' attraction to fascism.

E. MAINSTREAM CRITICAL THEORY

Drawing on the Young Marx, it focuses on alienation and human emancipation. Scholars criticized both capitalism and Soviet socialism, viewing the latter as totalitarian and neglectful of **Marx's core concern: freedom**.

Critique of Science and Rationality: Critical theorists argued that science undermines reasoning, degrades human values, and promotes instrumental rationality. They were concerned with the loss of freedom in capitalist and post-capitalist societies, examining mass society and consumerist culture.

Interdependence of Base and Superstructure: Recognizing an interdependence between the base and superstructure, the theorists extensively analysed various aspects of the superstructure to develop an alternative path for social development according to their understanding of Marxism.

Role of Culture, Mass Media, and Advertising:

- **Theodor Adorno and Max Horkheimer** analysed the impact of the **culture industry, mass media, and advertising**. They argued that these institutions create false needs and desires, sustaining capitalism.
- **Herbert Marcuse**, in "**One Dimensional Man**," highlighted the subjective, critical, and humanist dimension of Marxism. He criticized consumer capitalism for creating a distorted second nature, making people behave like herds and eliminating the possibility of generating revolutionary consciousness.

Jurgen Habermas and the Public Sphere: Jurgen Habermas, a second-generation critical theorist, discussed how mass media hijacks the public sphere, distorts views and choices, and reduces citizens to spectators. He advocated for deliberative democracy and participation in civic affairs.

Therefore, the Frankfurt School provided a **cultural critique of bourgeois society**, focusing on cultural and technological domination rather than just capitalist domination. They aimed to enhance awareness of the roots of domination, undermine ideologies, and compel changes in consciousness and action.

F. STRUCTURALIST SCHOOL

Neo-Marxism, influenced by Marx and developed by thinkers like Gramsci and Louis Althusser, emphasizes **the scientific and explanatory aspects of Marxism**. It seeks to refine Marxist analysis, particularly by examining structures and the roles of cultural, ideological, and social factors.

Gramsci's Theories: Gramsci, a theoretician of superstructure, emphasized the role of civil society in generating false consciousness. He highlighted **the importance of superstructure alongside the base** in Marx's base and superstructure model of Historical Materialism.

Althusser's Contributions:

- **Challenging Humanism:** Althusser critiqued humanist themes in Marxism and emphasized the analysis of deep structures in societies, especially their modes of production.
- **Multi-Sectoral Analysis:** He proposed a methodology called "Multi-Sectoral Analysis" for analysing capitalist societies, criticizing economic determinism in Marx's theory.
- **Russian Revolution:** Althusser attributed the primary cause of the Russian Revolution to economic structure rather than political structure.
- **Ideological Interpellation:** He introduced the concept of "**ideological interpellation**" to analyse the relationship between the state and the subject, explaining how regimes maintain control by reproducing subjects who see their social position as natural.
- **Ideological State Apparatuses:** According to Althusser, ideologies are instantiated by institutions known as "**Ideological State Apparatuses**," such as the family, schools, and church, which provide individuals with categories to recognize themselves and their social roles.
- **Dictatorship of the Proletariat:** Althusser argued for the necessity of a Dictatorship of the Proletariat, which would replace Ideological State Apparatuses that produce bourgeois subjects with those that produce proletarian or communist subjects.

Thus, Neo-Marxism focuses on scientific analysis, challenges economic determinism, emphasizes the role of superstructure, and explores the relationship between the state, ideology, and subjectification.

9. CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE OF MARXISM

Context: The contemporary relevance of Marxism has been questioned, particularly after the collapse of communism in 1991 with the fall of the USSR and its failure to take hold in Western societies, often seen as utopian. However, Marxism remains relevant in several ways today.

Mode of Analysis: Marx's historical materialism offers a valuable framework for understanding history and politics. It is used in international politics through World Systems Theory and the dependency school to comprehend global dynamics. Despite certain biases, Marxism is still recognized as an important tool for understanding political realities.

Political Ideology and Program of Action: Marxism significantly influenced Eastern Europe and Third World nations in Africa, Asia, and Latin America until the 1990s. Although its popularity declined after the disintegration of the USSR, there has been a renewed interest in Marxism, particularly following the global financial crisis, with increased popularity in Latin America and parts of Europe.

Adaptation to Contemporary Society: Neo-Marxists argue that Marxism must be adapted to address the complex forms of domination and exploitation in contemporary society. They highlight the need to modify the Marxist framework to tackle these problems effectively.

Scholarly and Activist Perspectives: Thomas Piketty, in his book "**Capital in the Twenty-First Century**," explores growing inequalities in the US and EU and proposes global progressive wealth taxes.

- Movements like **Occupy Wall Street** and the **Yellow Vest movement** demonstrate the ongoing relevance of Marxist ideas. **Richard Wolff** has argued that the rise of homelessness in the US can be attributed to capitalism.

Despite challenges and criticism, Marxism retains its relevance today. It serves as an analytical tool, influences political movements and programs, and has been adapted to address the complexities of modern society. Ongoing discussions and applications of Marxist ideas by scholars and activists underscore its significance in understanding and shaping the world.

SOCIALISM

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Define Socialism. Discuss the salient features of Fabian Socialism. (2017)
- Comment on the view that socialism in the 21st century may be reborn as anti-capitalism. (2014)
- Comment on: Socialism is a much-used hat, whose original shape no one can define (C E M Joad). (2009)

1. INTRODUCTION

Socialism is a **socio-economic ideology** that advocates for the collective ownership or control of property and natural resources instead of private ownership.

- It emphasizes the importance of cooperation among individuals and considers all products of labour as social contributions.
- According to socialism, everyone who contributes to the production of goods should have a share in their benefits. Therefore, society as a whole should either own or have significant control over property to ensure the well-being of all its members.

The term 'socialism' is variously understood and defined by various thinkers and schools of thought.

C.E.M. Joad, in his **Introduction to Modern Political Theory (1924)** significantly observed: Socialism proves to be a different creed in the hands of its exponents, varying with the temperaments of its advocates and the nature of abuses which have prompted their advocacy ... **"Socialism, in short, is like a hat that has lost its shape because everybody wears it".**

2. ORIGIN OF SOCIALISM

Socialism originated in the **nineteenth century** as a response to the **negative social and economic effects of industrial capitalism** in Europe.

- It developed as a critique of liberal market society, offering an alternative to the inequalities and hardships faced by industrial workers.
- While socialism and liberalism share some Enlightenment principles, socialism emerged as a

distinct ideology aiming to challenge and provide an alternative to industrial capitalism.

3. SOCIALISM BEFORE MARX

Socialism before Marx emerged as a response to the social and economic conditions of industrial capitalism in the nineteenth century. Figures like Robert Owen, Charles Fourier, and Saint Simon put forth different visions of a socialist society.

- Robert Owen** advocated for cooperative principles and state control of production to alleviate poverty and transform human nature.
- Charles Fourier** focused on making work pleasant and eliminating competition through small producer cooperatives.
- Saint Simon** emphasized the role of science, technology, and industry in social reconstruction, with the state playing a central role. Early socialism was shaped by the harsh conditions faced by the industrial working class, leading to revolutionary alternatives and utopian experiments.

4. DEVELOPMENT AND EVOLUTION OF SOCIALISM

Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels later developed more comprehensive theories, arguing for the inevitability of a revolutionary overthrow of capitalism. However, as working-class living conditions improved and political democracy advanced, socialist parties shifted toward **legal and constitutional tactics**.

The Russian Revolution of 1917 further divided socialists into revolutionary communists and reformist social democrats. In the twentieth century, socialism spread to countries without industrial capitalism, often blending with anti-colonial struggles. India, for instance, adopted a moderate form of socialism based on the outlook of the Congress Party.

SOCIALISM WITH CHINESE CHARACTERISTICS

Deng Xiaoping's adaptation of socialism to China's unique context. Introduced in 1982, it integrates Marxism with market mechanisms and foreign investment while maintaining socialist principles.

- It is a pragmatic adaptation that balances planning and market forces.
- The economic reforms are focused on modernization, productivity, and foreign investment.
- It prioritizes rapid growth of productive forces.

5. CORE ASSUMPTIONS OF SOCIALISM

Socialism can be understood in three distinct ways.

- Economic Model:** Socialism is an alternative to capitalism, often involving collectivization and planning, and modern socialists aim to use it to achieve broader social goals.
- Labour Movement Tool:** Socialism represents the working class and provides a path to political or economic power, its significance tied to the global working-class movement.
- Political Ideology:** Socialism is a political ideology focused on community, cooperation, equality, class politics, and common ownership.

6. REVOLUTIONARY AND EVOLUTIONARY SOCIALISM

Revolutionary and evolutionary socialism are two distinct approaches within the broader socialist movement, differing primarily in their methods and strategies for achieving socialism.

A. REVOLUTIONARY SOCIALISM

- Immediate Overthrow of Capitalism:** Revolutionary socialism advocates for a rapid and complete dismantling of the capitalist system through revolutionary means.
- Class Struggle and Proletariat Revolution:** It emphasizes the necessity of a proletariat (working class) revolution to overthrow the bourgeoisie (capitalist class) and seize control of the state and the means of production.
- Dictatorship of the Proletariat:** Following the revolution, a transitional state (the dictatorship of the proletariat) is established to suppress counter-revolutionary forces and reorganize society on socialist principles.

EXAMPLES:

- Russian Revolution of 1917:** Led by the Bolsheviks, it resulted in the establishment of the Soviet Union.
- Cuban Revolution:** Led by Fidel Castro, it resulted in the establishment of a socialist state in Cuba.

B. EVOLUTIONARY SOCIALISM

- Also known as **social democracy**, evolutionary socialism takes a **gradualist approach**, aiming to **achieve socialist values through existing political institutions and reforms**.
- It employs methods like **taxation for wealth redistribution and economic interventions to address capitalism's moral defects**, combining equality with a mixed economy and advocating for state authority over certain industries while recognizing the benefits of capitalism.
- Example- Labour Party in the UK:** Historically, the Labour Party has pursued socialist goals through parliamentary means, focusing on expanding the welfare state and workers' rights.

Notable figures in the evolutionary socialist tradition include Eduard Bernstein and members of the **Fabian Society, such as Sydney and Beatrice Webb, G.D.H. Cole, Bernard Shaw, Laski, and Tawney**. These individuals emphasized the importance of strengthening democracy and sought alternative paths to socialism that did not rely solely on revolution.

Based on these approaches, following are the types of socialism:

a. FABIAN SOCIALISM

Fabianism is a socialist movement that emerged from the **Fabian Society**, founded in **London in 1884**. It derives its name from **the Roman general Fabius Maximus**, known for his gradual tactics. The early Fabians rejected revolutionary Marxism, advocating for a gradual transition to socialism, termed evolutionary socialism.

Approach and Strategies

- Fabians aimed to introduce socialism incrementally through **state and cooperative ownership of industries, enhancing labour's political and trade union power**, and promoting social consciousness.
- Unlike Marxists, who focused on the working class, Fabianism relied on the **middle class to drive social change**.



Influence and Key Theorists: Prominent Fabians like **George Bernard Shaw and Sidney Webb** promoted the strategy of permeation, seeking to influence the mainstream Liberal Party to adopt socialist agendas.

They believed socialism was already progressing unconsciously through **public control of services** and aimed to **reorganize society by transferring land and industrial capital ownership from individuals and classes to the community** for the benefit of all.

b. REVISIONISM

Eduard Bernstein, a key proponent of Revisionism, argued that **liberal democracy was the essence of socialism**. He believed democracy represented a partnership among all adult citizens within a limited government, rather than through class struggle and rule.

Observations and Theories: Bernstein observed that the intensity of class struggle had diminished due to improvements in working-class conditions and the expansion of the middle class, contrary to traditional socialist predictions of a shrinking middle class.

Contrasts with Marxism: Contrary to Marx, Bernstein rejected the necessity and feasibility of revolution. He advocated for a **parliamentary approach to socialism**, dismissing Marx's materialist interpretation of history, which posited class conflict as the inevitable path to socialism.

c. SYNDICALISM

Syndicalism, or Anarcho-syndicalism, advocates for direct action by the working class to overthrow capitalism and establish a society organized around worker-managed production units.

Opposition to Capitalism and the State: Syndicalists, like Marxists, oppose capitalism and foresee a class war in which the working class will prevail. **They view the state as a tool of capitalist oppression and inherently inefficient**, believing it cannot be reformed peacefully but must be abolished.

Organizational Structure: In a syndicalist community, **local syndicates (self-governing associations of producers)** serve as the primary organizational units. These syndicates coordinate through **local labour exchanges, or "Bourses du Travail,"** which function as employment and economic planning agencies.

Direct Action and Tactics: Syndicalists reject political means for achieving their goals and instead rely on direct industrial action.

➤ **Georges Sorel**, a key syndicalist theorist, introduced the concept of the **"social myth"** to mobilize workers for revolutionary action. The **general strike is a central tactic**, aimed at inspiring workers with a sense of collective power and improving organization, even if not immediately successful.

Green Syndicalism: It is an integration of anarcho-syndicalism and environmentalism. It posits that effective environmental protection requires decentralization, regionalism, direct action, autonomy, pluralism, and federation.

d. GUILD SOCIALISM

Guild socialism is a political movement that advocates for workers' control of industry through trade-related guilds, operating in a contractual relationship with the public. It emerged in the UK in the early 20th century and was associated with **G. D. H. Cole** and influenced by **William Morris**.

- Guild socialists supported state ownership of industry, combined with democratic control by workers through national guilds.
- Guild socialism aimed to abolish the wage system and emphasized the importance of both workers and consumers. It sought to replace the exploitative old state with a more egalitarian and participatory system.

e. DEMOCRATIC SOCIALISM

Democratic socialism advocates for **political democracy** combined with a **socially owned economy**, emphasizing **economic democracy and decentralized planning**.

Critique of Capitalism: Proponents argue that capitalism conflicts with core values such as freedom, equality, and solidarity, and assert that socialism is essential to achieve these ideals.

Response to Authoritarianism: Democratic socialism arose in response to the authoritarian nature of Soviet-style regimes. **It distinguishes itself from Marxist-Leninist systems by rejecting their governance and economic planning models.**

Approach and Goals: While aiming for socialism in the long term, some democratic socialists focus on moderating capitalism's excesses through progressive reforms. Others contend that such reforms offer only temporary relief from inequalities, as capitalism's inherent contradictions would re-emerge in different forms.

f. THE KEY DIFFERENCES BETWEEN FABIAN SOCIALISM, SYNDICALISM, AND THE GUILD MOVEMENT

Dimnesions	Fabian Socialism	Syndicalism	Guild Movement
Origin	Late 19th century England	Early 19th century France, Italy, Spain, and other countries	Early 20th century England
Key Thinkers	George Bernard Shaw, Sidney and Beatrice Webb, H.G. Wells	Georges Sorel, Frantz Fanon	G.D.H. Cole, Harold Laski
Core Belief	Pragmatic, gradual and democratic transition to socialism	Revolutionary overthrow of capitalism by trade unions influenced by Marxism and psychoanalytic theory of Freud	Co-ownership and co-management of production by workers and government (influenced by theory of class conflict)
Economic Approach	Partially planned economy, labour reform, and economic internationalism	Direct action and general strikes to achieve worker control	Industrial democracy and worker self-management
State Role	Minimal government, supporting democratic socialism	Independen t of the state, bottom-up organization	Community ownership with union control over production
Focus	Labor rights, social justice, living wage, and national healthcare	Workplace democracy, direct democracy, decentralize d socialism	Production over distribution, industrial democracy

Method of Change	Democratic reforms and policies	General strikes and direct action	Trade unions as post-capitalist organization, maximum participation
Impact	Foundation of British Labor Party, lasting influence on labour movements	Manifested in movements like International Workers of the World	Comprehensive alternative to capitalist industry organization

POST-MODERNISM

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Comment on post-modernism. (2017)

1. INTRODUCTION

Postmodernism challenges the assumptions of modernity, rejecting the idea of absolute, universal truths. It emphasizes discourse, debate, and democracy as key to understanding and interpreting the world. Originating from experimental movements in arts and culture, it emerged prominently in philosophy after World War II. Friedrich Nietzsche is regarded as a central figure in post-modernist thought.

2. EVOLUTION OF POST-MODERNISM

- **Friedrich Nietzsche:** Proclaimed the "Death of God" and questioned absolute truth, emphasizing the relationship between knowledge and power.
- **Albert Einstein:** Introduced the **Theory of Relativity**, highlighting subjective perception based on the observer's context.
- **Thomas Kuhn:** Proposed the concept of "**paradigm shifts**," suggesting that knowledge evolves through changing frameworks.
- **Louis Althusser:** Developed the concept of "**interpellation**," which explores how dominant ideologies shape perceptions of reality.

3. KEY FEATURES OF POST-MODERNISM

- **Rejection of Absolute Truth:** Asserts that certainty and universal truths are arrogant claims.
- **Focus on Discourse:** Prioritizes debate and diverse narratives over singular, dominant truths.
- **Relativity and Subjectivity:** Emphasizes that perceptions and knowledge are influenced by context and power dynamics.
- **Multiplicity of Truths:** Highlights that various discourses and truths coexist, with some becoming dominant over others.

4. PROMINENT PROPONENTS OF POST-MODERNISM

Jean-François Lyotard: Introduced the term "postmodernism" in 1979, emphasizing "**incredulity towards meta-narratives**" and advocating for **listening to multiple narratives**.

Michel Foucault: Developed the concept of "**discourse**," arguing that knowledge and truth are constructed through narrative frameworks, influenced by power dynamics. Introduced "governmentality" and analysed the knowledge-power connection.

Jacques Derrida: Introduced "**deconstruction**," a method of interpreting texts to reveal multiple, often conflicting meanings. Argued that language can lead to misunderstandings and multiple interpretations.

5. CONCEPT OF GOVERNMENTALITY

Foucault's concept of "governmentality" refers to how modern liberal democracies manage and regulate populations through indirect means rather than direct threats or commands. Governmentality reveals the subtle, pervasive ways power operates in modern societies, **influencing behaviour** through **normalization** and **self-regulation** rather than through overt coercion.

A. MECHANISMS OF CONTROL

- **Disciplinary Power and Bio-Power:** Instead of overt coercion, governmentality uses disciplinary power to regulate behaviour by creating a sense of self-regulation. This is achieved through norms and practices that influence how individuals conduct themselves.
- **Surveillance:** Foucault cites surveillance as a key example of governmentality. Surveillance, while purportedly for safety and freedom, induces self-censorship due to the fear of being observed. This mechanism extends beyond state control to social institutions like the family, education, prisons, hospitals, and religious institutions.

B. INSTRUMENTS OF DISCIPLINARY POWER

- **Hierarchical Observation:** Monitoring and evaluating individuals within institutions.

- ▶ **Normalizing Judgments:** Setting standards for behaviour and assessing deviations from them.
- ▶ **Examinations:** Using tests and evaluations to scrutinize and categorize individuals.

Relation to Sovereignty: Governmentality functions alongside and interacts with traditional notions of sovereignty and discipline, employing dispersed and non-centralized forms of power.

Production of Truth: Foucault argues that truth is not inherent but produced through various forms of power and constraint. It reflects the interests and norms of those in power.



FASCISM



PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ▶ Fascism displays an ambivalent stance towards parliamentary democracy. Explain. (2023)
- ▶ Examine the conception of the State in the ideologies of Fascism and Marxism. (2014)
- ▶ Comment on: "Fascism is the destruction of liberal ideas and institutions in the interest of those who own the instruments of economic power." (Laski) (2008)

1.

MEANING OF FASCISM

Fascism is an **authoritarian ideology** that emphasizes the **supremacy of the state and the collective over individual rights and freedoms**. It promotes the idea of a unified national community where personal identity is absorbed into the collective identity of the nation. Central to fascism is the concept of the **"new man,"** an idealized figure characterized by duty, honour, self-sacrifice, and absolute obedience to a supreme leader. This **leader embodies the nation's strength and vision**, and the state's power is exercised through a highly centralized and often dictatorial regime.

Emergence: Fascism emerged prominently in the early 20th century, particularly during the interwar period, as a reaction against the perceived failures of modernity and Enlightenment values.

Historical Influences:

- ▶ **Post-World War I Instability:** The Treaty of Versailles and the political instability of post-war Europe created fertile ground for extremist ideologies.
- ▶ **Industrialization:** The disruption caused by industrialization led to widespread discontent among the lower middle class, who felt squeezed between big business and organized labour.
- ▶ **Economic Crisis of the 1930s:** The Great Depression undermined democratic institutions and provided an opportunity for fascist movements to exploit public disillusionment.
- ▶ **Nationalist Tensions:** Nationalist resentment and a desire for revenge after World War I, particularly in

Germany, Italy, and Japan, fuelled the rise of fascist ideologies.

3.

KEY FEATURES OF FASCISM

- ▶ **Anti-Rationalism:** Fascism rejects the rationalist ideals of the Enlightenment, emphasizing the importance of emotions, instincts, and vitalism over reason and intellectual discourse.
- ▶ **Struggle and Conflict:** Fascist ideologies view struggle, competition, and war as essential for progress. They often have expansionist goals, seeing conflict as a means to achieve national greatness.
- ▶ **Leadership and Elitism:** Fascism advocates for a hierarchical society led by a supreme leader with absolute authority. It emphasizes the role of a warrior elite and a passive mass population, contrasting with the egalitarian principles of democracy.
- ▶ **Ultra-Nationalism:** Fascism promotes an extreme form of nationalism, asserting the superiority of one nation over others. It seeks to establish a militant national identity and views other nations as rivals in a struggle for dominance.

EXAMPLES

- ▶ **Italy:** Benito Mussolini's Fascist Party, established in 1919, aimed to revive Italy's greatness and impose a totalitarian regime.
- ▶ **Germany:** Adolf Hitler's Nazi Party, founded in 1919, transformed Germany into a Nazi dictatorship by 1933, pursuing aggressive expansion and racial purity.

4.

CAN FASCISM BE REGARDED AS AN IDEOLOGY?

Challenges in defining Fascism as an Ideology:

Lack of Cohesive Core:

- ▶ **Lack of Rationality:** Fascism is often criticized for lacking a rational and cohesive core. It is described by some as a "jumble of ideas" rather than a unified ideology. Fascists adopted various theories and ideas more for their capacity to inspire political activism rather than their logical consistency.
- ▶ **Political Movement:** Due to its eclectic nature and emphasis on action over ideology, fascism is

frequently seen as a political movement or even a political religion, rather than a coherent ideological framework.

Complex Historical Phenomenon:

- **Diverse Regimes:** The classification of various regimes as fascist is controversial. For instance, regimes like Imperial Japan, Vichy France, Franco's Spain, Perón's Argentina, and Hitler's Germany display different characteristics and may not fit neatly into a single definition of fascism.
- **Contemporary Groups:** The relationship between modern radical right groups (e.g., Front National in France, British National Party in the UK) and historical fascism is debated. Terms such as "fascist," "neo-fascist," "post-fascist," and "extreme nationalist" reflect this ongoing dispute.

Fascism's emphasis on action, its **reactionary stance against Enlightenment rationalism**, and its complex historical manifestations make it challenging to categorize strictly as an ideology. Instead, it is often viewed as a **political movement or phenomenon** with varying principles and goals that resist a singular ideological label.

5. KEY PROPONENTS AND THEIR IDEAS

- **Friedrich Nietzsche:** Described fascism as a form of nihilism that reverses Enlightenment values. Emphasized charismatic authority and creative destruction.
- **Benito Mussolini:** Emphasized totalitarianism, the supremacy of the state, and the role of the state in modernization and national revival.

6. CONTEMPORARY ASPECTS OF FASCISM

- **Radical Right Resurgence:** **Contemporary right-wing movements** often operate within democratic frameworks, seeking to transform these systems from within rather than overthrowing them. This contrasts with classical fascism, which sought to dismantle democratic institutions from above.
- **New Targets:** Modern forms of fascism focus on a broader range of issues, including **racism, homophobia, and xenophobia**, often using democratic procedures to enact discriminatory laws and policies. This approach reflects a shift from targeting ideological opponents to broader societal changes.

Fascism's ability to operate within democratic systems today poses significant challenges, necessitating a nuanced understanding and response to its evolving forms and impacts on modern societies.

FEMINISM

"One is not born, but rather becomes, a woman" (**Simone de Beauvoir**, *The Second Sex*).

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ◉ Difference between Liberal and Radical forms of Feminism. (2012)
- ◉ Distinguish between liberal feminism and radical feminism. (2019)
- ◉ Comment on Personal is political. (2013, 2010)
- ◉ Comment on Eco-feminism. (2017)
- ◉ Distinguish between liberal feminism and socialist feminism in detail. (2010)

1. INTRODUCTION

Feminism is a **socio-political and cultural movement** aimed at advocating for **women's rights and equality** across various facets of society. It strives to address and correct both historical and ongoing inequalities, discrimination, and oppression that women face.

Despite encompassing a diverse array of perspectives, theories, and approaches, feminism is **unified by the overarching goal of promoting gender equality and dismantling patriarchal structures**.

2. CORE PRINCIPLES AND GOALS OF FEMINISM

- ◉ **Gender Equality:** Feminism seeks to achieve equality between genders by challenging traditional power dynamics that favour men over women. For examples, **Suffrage Movements**.
 - ◉ **Gloria Steinem:** "A feminist is anyone who recognizes the equality and full humanity of women and men."
- ◉ **Empowerment:** Feminism encourages women to assert their rights and agency across all spheres of life. For examples, Feminist Organizations working to empower women economically, socially, and politically.
 - ◉ **Bell Hooks:** "Feminism is a movement to end sexism, sexist exploitation, and oppression."
- ◉ **Intersectionality:** It recognizes and addresses the intersection of gender with other aspects of

identity such as race, class, sexuality, and disability. For instance, feminist movements seek to address challenges faced by Black Women (marginalised groups).

- ◉ **Kimberlé Crenshaw:** Coined the term "**intersectionality**," emphasizing the need to address multiple forms of discrimination. "If you want to have a conversation about feminism and intersectionality, then we need to be having a conversation about justice."
- ◉ **Social Justice:** Feminism is linked to broader struggles for social justice and human rights, advocating for policy changes to address gender-based discrimination and violence. For example, #MeToo Movement focuses on sexual harassment and driving changes in workplace policies and legal systems.
- ◉ **Angela Davis:** "I am no longer accepting the things I cannot change. I am changing the things I cannot accept."
- ◉ **Critique of Patriarchy:** Critiques patriarchal systems that perpetuate male dominance and gender inequality, advocating for alternative, equitable ways of organizing society. For instance, **Kate Millett** critiqued patriarchal structures in **Sexual Politics** and Shulamith Firestone challenged traditional family structures in **The Dialectic of Sex**.

Feminism, through its diverse approaches and core principles, continues to drive discussions and actions towards achieving gender equality and social justice.

3. EVOLUTION OF FEMINISM

The evolution of feminism is often divided into several waves, each with distinct objectives, challenges, and accomplishments.

First-Wave Feminism (19th and early 20th centuries):

This wave primarily focused on legal recognition and political rights for women, particularly suffrage. For example, Seneca Falls Convention (1848): Adopted the Declaration of Sentiments, calling for equal rights, including women's suffrage.

First-Wave Feminism (19th and early 20th centuries):	Suffragette Movement in the UK: Led by Emmeline Pankhurst, used militant tactics like hunger strikes and protests to advocate for women's right to vote. 🔹 Elizabeth Cady Stanton: Known for her declaration at the Seneca Falls Convention in 1848, which demanded women's right to vote.
Second-Wave Feminism (1960s to 1980s):	This wave expanded the scope of feminism to include reproductive rights, workplace discrimination, and sexual liberation, challenging traditional gender roles and norms. For example, National Organization for Women (NOW) (1966): Aimed at advancing women's rights and combating workplace discrimination. 🔹 Betty Friedan: Author of "The Feminine Mystique," which identified "the problem that has no name" and ignited the second wave. 🔹 Simone de Beauvoir: Her work "The Second Sex" explored the concept of "the other" and examined women's historical definition in relation to men.
Third-Wave Feminism (1990s to present):	This wave emerged in response to the perceived limitations of earlier waves, emphasizing diversity, intersectionality, and inclusivity. It acknowledges that women's experiences are influenced by factors such as race, sexuality, and class, and engages with issues related to body image, sex positivity, and pop culture. For Example, #MeToo Movement (2017): Instrumental in addressing sexual harassment and rights related to consent and bodily autonomy. 🔹 Bell hooks: Known for "Ain't I a Woman?" exploring the intersection of race and feminism. 🔹 Judith Butler: Her work "Gender Trouble" on performativity challenged traditional notions of gender identity.

4.

UNDERSTANDING DIFFERENT STREAMS OF FEMINISM

A. LIBERAL FEMINISM

Liberal feminists assert that women should have equal rights and opportunities in education, employment, and political participation. They contend that gender discrimination and inequality stem from social and cultural practices rather than inherent differences between men and women.

KEY FEATURES OF LIBERAL FEMINISM

Equal Opportunities: Liberal feminists **advocate for equal opportunities for women in education, employment, and public participation**, arguing that women should have the same choices and chances as men, free from discrimination.

- 🔹 **Mary Wollstonecraft:** "I do not wish women to have power over men, but over themselves."

Individual Rights: This perspective emphasizes **individual rights and freedoms, including reproductive rights, the right to vote, and the right to work** without gender-based discrimination. Women should have the autonomy to make decisions about their own lives.

- 🔹 **John Stuart Mill:** "The legal subordination of one sex to the other is wrong in itself, and now one of the chief hindrances to human improvement."

Legal Protections: Liberal feminists work to **change discriminatory laws and policies, advocating for legislation against gender-based discrimination, sexual harassment, and domestic violence.**

- 🔹 **Betty Friedan, "The Feminine Mystique":** Highlighted the struggles of suburban housewives and questioned societal expectations of women.

CRITIQUES OF LIBERAL FEMINISM

Liberal feminism, while advocating for gender equality through legal reforms and equal opportunities, faces several criticisms regarding its focus on individualism, its inadequate critique of capitalism, and potential elitism.

- 🔹 **Individualism and Choice Feminism:** Critics like Nancy Fraser argue that the emphasis on individual choice may overlook structural inequalities.

- 🔹 **Lacks Capitalism Critique:** Socialist feminists, including Sylvia Federici, contend that liberal



feminism fails to address capitalism's role in perpetuating gender disparities. They emphasize the need to confront deeper economic structures.

- **Elitism and Class Bias:** Figures such as Bell Hooks criticize liberal feminism for primarily serving middle-class, affluent women. They urge a more intersectional approach that includes the experiences of all women, especially those marginalized by race and socioeconomic status.
- **Violence and Reproductive Rights:** Critics like Susan Brownmiller highlight a lack of focus on violence against women and reproductive rights within liberal feminism.
- **Reform vs. Radical Change:** Radical feminists like Shulamith Firestone argue for more transformative changes beyond reforms, challenging the patriarchal foundations of society more directly.

B. RADICAL FEMINISM

Radical feminism is a theoretical approach within feminism advocating for a fundamental restructuring of society to eliminate male supremacy in all social and economic contexts. It recognizes that women's oppression is compounded by intersecting factors such as race, class, and sexual orientation.

KEY FEATURES OF RADICAL FEMINISM

- **Patriarchy as the Fundamental Problem:** Radical feminists view patriarchy as the primary source of women's oppression, necessitating the dismantling of male dominance in societal institutions (Kate Millet). Shulamith Firestone called for societal transformation to eliminate male dominance.
- **Personal is Political:** Carol Hanisch coined the phrase "personal is political" and emphasized that personal experiences, such as domestic labour and sexual harassment, are political issues rooted in structural inequalities.
- **Rejection of Reformist Approaches:** Andrea Dworkin criticizes reformist efforts, arguing that only radical societal change can achieve true liberation.
- **Female Solidarity:** Sheila Jeffreys advocates for female-only spaces to foster solidarity and challenge male dominance.
- **Critique of Gender:** They view gender as a social construct used to enforce male dominance and advocates for its abolition.

CRITICISM OF RADICAL FEMINISM

- **Essentialism:** Bell Hooks criticized for essentializing women's experiences, potentially overlooking the challenges faced by women of colour and LGBTQ+ individuals. She suggests for an intersectional approach.
- **Strategies and Tactics:** Angela Davis called for a balance between revolutionary zeal and pragmatic actions within existing structures.
- **Rejection of Gender:** It faced challenges in reconciling the rejection of gender with supporting transgender and non-binary rights.
- **Class and Economic Factors:** This approach has been criticized for not fully addressing economic disparities and class-based oppression.

C. SOCIALIST FEMINISM

Emerging in the 1960s and 1970s, socialist feminism integrates feminist and socialist principles to address the interconnectedness of gender and class inequalities. It critiques both patriarchy and capitalism as systems that reinforce each other, advocating for a more equitable society by challenging these structures.

- **Critique of Capitalism:** Critiques capitalism for exploiting labour and exacerbating economic inequalities, particularly affecting women's work.
- **Economic Equality:** Advocates for achieving economic parity between genders through policies such as equal pay, affordable childcare, and social safety nets.
- **Collective Action:** Emphasizes the power of solidarity among working-class women to challenge oppressive systems and secure workplace rights and dignity.
- **Social Reproduction Theory:** Highlights the importance of unpaid labour, such as caregiving and housework, in sustaining both society and the capitalist economy.

CRITICISM OF SOCIALIST FEMINISM

- **Class Reductionism:** Criticized for potentially reducing women's struggles to class issues alone, neglecting the diverse experiences of women from different backgrounds.
- **Neglect of Cultural and Social Factors:** Accused of focusing too heavily on economic factors while overlooking cultural and psychological dimensions of oppression.



- **Revolutionary Approach and Feasibility:** Questioned the practicality of revolutionary goals, with some advocating for a balance between incremental reforms and transformative aims.

D. MARXIST FEMINISM

Marxist feminism integrates Marxist and feminist theories to critique capitalism's role in exacerbating gender inequality through the exploitation of women's labour, advocating for systemic change.

KEY FEATURES OF MARXIST FEMINISM

- **Economic Exploitation:** It highlights how capitalism profits from women's unpaid and underpaid labour.
- **Intersectionality:** Recognizes that gender oppression intersects with other forms of oppression, including class and race.
- **Structural Change:** Advocates for societal reforms such as wealth redistribution and equal pay to address systemic inequalities.
- **Collective Action:** Emphasizes the empowerment of working-class women through organizing and collective struggle.
- **Critique of Capitalism:** Views capitalism as inherently linked to patriarchy and inequality, advocating for fundamental societal transformation.
- **View of Shulamith Firestone:** "To achieve true gender equality, we must question and transform the very foundations of this system."

CRITICISM OF MARXIST FEMINISM

- **Economic Determinism:** Criticized for reducing gender oppression to economic terms, overlooking cultural, psychological, and identity-based factors.
- **Class Reductionism:** Often accused of focusing primarily on class issues, potentially marginalizing the experiences of women from diverse backgrounds.
- **Revolutionary Strategy:** The emphasis on revolutionary change is seen by some as impractical or idealistic.

E. POST COLONIAL FEMINISM

Post-colonial feminism integrates feminist and post-colonial theories to examine how colonialism has shaped and continues to influence gender oppression

globally. It critiques traditional gender hierarchies, emphasizes intersectionality, and promotes global solidarity.

KEY FEATURES OF POST-COLONIAL FEMINISM

- **Colonial Legacy:** Gayatri Chakravorty Spivak analyses how colonialism's impacts shape contemporary gender relations and oppression.
- **Intersectionality:** Chandra Talpade Mohanty critiques Eurocentric feminism for its narrow focus and advocates for a more inclusive approach.
- **Voice and Agency:** Centers marginalized women's voices and challenges Western-centric perspectives.
- **Deconstruction of Stereotypes:** Works to dispel stereotypes about women in non-Western societies, providing nuanced portrayals. For instance, **Leila Ahmed** challenges monolithic views imposed by colonial and Western perspectives.
- **Global Solidarity:** Vandana Shiva highlights the interconnectedness of feminist struggles worldwide and emphasizes the need for global solidarity to address gender oppression and links ecological issues with gender and social justice.
- Post-colonial feminism thus offers a critical lens for addressing global gender oppression, advocating for inclusive and culturally sensitive feminist approaches.

F. OTHER STREAMS OF FEMINISM

Libertarian Feminism:	Emphasizes personal autonomy and minimal government intervention to achieve gender equality through principles of liberty and free markets. Wendy McElroy focuses on individual empowerment through freedom of choice and limited state interference.
Ecofeminism:	Links the exploitation of women with environmental degradation, advocating for sustainable living practices. Vandana Shiva calls for addressing gender and ecological injustices together, emphasizing the interconnectedness between feminism and environmentalism.

Womanism:	Centres on the experiences of women of colour, advocating for an intersectional approach to feminism. Bell hooks emphasizes inclusivity and justice beyond traditional feminist boundaries, highlighting the unique struggles and perspectives of women of colour.
Queer Feminism	Challenges binary gender and sexuality constructs, advocating for LGBTQ+ rights and visibility. Judith Butler envisions a world free from discrimination based on gender identity and desires, promoting fluidity and diversity in gender expression.
Black Feminism:	Focuses on the unique oppression faced by black women, emphasizing intersectionality. Kimberlé Crenshaw argues for addressing overlapping forms of discrimination, advocating for justice and equality within racial and gender contexts.
Chicana Feminism:	Addresses the struggles of Mexican-American and Chicana women, advocating for cultural recognition and empowerment. Ana Castillo explores issues of identity and intersectionality within the context of Chicano culture and feminism.
Transfeminism	Connects feminism with transgender advocacy, emphasizing gender justice for all identities. Julia Serano advocates for the inclusion of transgender perspectives and issues within the feminist movement, promoting solidarity and understanding across gender lines
Islamic Feminism	Seeks to reconcile feminist principles with Islamic values, challenging patriarchal interpretations of Islamic texts. Leila Ahmed advocates for gender equality within the Islamic framework, promoting interpretations that support women's rights and agency.

Anarchist-Feminism:

Merges **feminist and anarchist ideologies, critiquing all forms of hierarchy and advocating for decentralized social structures. Emma Goldman** envisions a society free from oppression and domination, promoting equality and autonomy through anarchist principles.

5.

RELEVANCE OF FEMINISM TODAY

- **Gender Equality Advocacy:** Feminism continues to advocate for equal rights across workplaces, politics, education, and relationships, addressing issues like the gender pay gap and underrepresentation in leadership roles.
- **Combating Violence Against Women:** Efforts are focused on combating domestic violence, sexual harassment, and human trafficking, with movements like #MeToo highlighting the need for systemic change in addressing sexist exploitation and oppression.
- **Reproductive Rights:** Feminism fights for reproductive rights and bodily autonomy, advocating for access to abortion, contraception, and comprehensive healthcare as fundamental human rights.
- **Representation and Inclusion:** Feminists advocate for greater representation and inclusion of diverse women and non-binary individuals in media portrayals, politics, and societal spheres to celebrate differences and challenge exclusionary norms.
- **Sexual Orientation and Gender Identity:** Feminism supports LGBTQ+ rights, promoting equality for all sexual orientations and gender identities, challenging normative societal structures that enforce rigid gender roles.
- **Global Feminism:** Addressing global issues such as child marriage, female genital mutilation, and education access, feminism advocates for solidarity and action across borders to empower women worldwide.
- **Environmental Feminism:** Ecofeminism links gender issues with environmental challenges, advocating for equitable and sustainable practices

to mitigate the impact of environmental degradation on women.

- **Online Activism:** Leveraging social media platforms, feminism extends its reach through campaigns like #MeToo and #BlackLivesMatter, facilitating awareness, solidarity, and mobilization for social justice movements.
- **Challenging Patriarchy:** Feminism critiques patriarchal structures and traditional gender norms that perpetuate inequality, aiming to dismantle systems of power that restrict and marginalize women.

Therefore, feminism today remains a vital force for advocating gender equality, combating various forms of oppression, promoting inclusivity, and challenging entrenched societal norms that perpetuate inequality.

NOTE: Gandhism has been discussed in the Chapter- Indian Political Thought (MK Gandhi).



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Performance and Progress Analysis

UNIT 9: INDIAN POLITICAL THOUGHT

DHARMASHASTRA, ARTHASHASTRA, AND BUDDHIST TRADITIONS; SIR SYED AHMED KHAN, SRI AUROBINDO, M. K. GANDHI, B. R. AMBEDKAR, M. N. ROY

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ▶ Buddhist thought on Dhamma facilitates the emancipation of political action. Explain. (2023)
- ▶ Do you think that the Buddhist traditions have lent greater ethical foundation to the ancient Indian political thought? Give your arguments. (2021)
- ▶ Explain the sources of ancient Indian political thought. (2020)
- ▶ Discuss Kautilya's views on elements of the state. (2019)
- ▶ What do you understand by the notion of Statecraft? Discuss the theory of statecraft as given by Kautilya. (2017)
- ▶ Evaluate the contributions of Buddhist tradition to Indian political thought. (2014)
- ▶ Examine the significance of Dharma in ancient Indian political thought. (2013)
- ▶ Draw parallels between Arthashastra tradition and the 'Realist' tradition represented by Machiavelli. (2012)
- ▶ Comment on: Of those (officers) the ways of embezzlement are forty (Kautilya). (2005)

1. INTRODUCTION

Contrary to the previous opinion that India did not contribute to political thought, ancient Indian thinkers had a distinct notion of the political separate from philosophy or religion. The erroneous belief arose from scholars using Western definitions of politics and political science. Defining politics as the "affairs of a territorially organized community held together by allegiance to a common authority" reveals that ancient India did have a systematic development of political thought.

2.

SOURCES OF ANCIENT INDIAN POLITICAL THOUGHT

Important sources of ancient Indian political thought include:

- 1. Vedas:** Provide insights into political institutions, duties of kings, and references to assemblies like Sabha and Samiti.
- 2. Mahabharata:** Discusses principles of governance (Rajadharma), duties of kings, administration, and warfare tactics.
- 3. Smritis:** Manusmriti, for example, elaborates on the structure of society, laws, justice, and duties of rulers.
- 4. Arthashastra:** Authored by Kautilya, it covers various aspects of statecraft, including governance, economics, diplomacy, and military strategy.
- 5. Bhagavad Gita:** Offers philosophical insights relevant to political leadership, duty, and societal harmony.
- 6. Puranas:** Include political ideas and governance principles embedded in mythological narratives.
- 7. Buddhist and Jain Texts:** Advocate principles like equality and non-discrimination within the societal and political framework. Buddhist texts like Mandhata Jataka and Digha Nayaka deal with the theory of Mahasammata or Great Elect.
- 8. Niti Shastras:** Such as Kumandakiya Nitisara, which summarize and expound upon earlier political treatises.

These sources collectively contribute to understanding ancient Indian political thought, reflecting a diverse range of perspectives and principles that shaped governance, ethics, and societal organization in early Indian civilization.

3.

FEATURES OF INDIAN POLITICAL THOUGHT

Important characteristic features of IPT are discussed below:

- **Dharma and Politics:** Unlike Western texts like Plato's "Republic," ancient Indian texts infused politics with a supernatural element. The divine's role in society and government is emphasized, but there was a gap between sastras and actual life. According to **Bhikhu Parekh**, the Hindu political thinkers used the concepts of dharma and **danda** to conceptualize political life.
- **Moral Guidance:** Social thought in ancient India intertwined with ethics. The king was expected to stimulate virtue and guide moral life. **Dharmashastras** detailed the moral duties of individuals and rulers. In contrast, **Kautilya** in the **Arthashastra** approached diplomacy with realism akin to Machiavelli.
- **Varnashrama Dharma:** Caste dictated social functions and government theory. The king ensured adherence to caste duties, and higher varnas (Brahmanas, Kshatriyas) held ruling power.
- **Importance of Higher Varnas:** The Brahmanas provided spiritual authority, and the Kshatriyas provided temporal power. **Coronation by priests** was essential, and Brahmanas, as intellectual leaders, had significant influence without seeking temporal power.
- **Interconnected Society:** Government and politics were seen as parts of a larger society, which was religious, political, economic, and military. There was no clear conception of the state or government as separate entities.
- **Monarchical form of Government:** Monarchy was the natural form of government due to the Kshatriya's role. While non-monarchical forms existed (like ganasanghas), they were exceptions.
- **Divine Sovereignty:** The government shared validity with divine will and did not have independent sovereignty. Loyalty was to society rather than a unified allegiance to the government.

According to **Bhikhu Parekh**, Indian political thought was in-egalitarian, pluralistic, uncritical of the caste system, and didactic, often serving as ethical and administrative manuals for rulers.

4.

LIMITATIONS OF INDIAN POLITICAL THOUGHT (IPT)

Religious Nature of Sources: The western scholars (Edward Said's Orientalism) do not recognise the

existence of IPT because most of the sources are religious, making it difficult to isolate political facts.

➤ Observations made by RS Sharma

- **Alienation of Muslims:** The focus on ancient Hindu institutions tended to alienate Muslims.
- **False Sense of Past Values:** Overlooked the dominance of upper varnas over lower varnas, who were generally excluded from political offices.
- **Lack of Anthropological Perspective:** Showed little interest in studying ancient institutions in light of the evolution of primitive tribes as known from anthropology.
- **Idealized Representation:** Dharmasutras present an idealized picture of society and politics, often not reflecting reality.
- **Gender bias and discrimination:** Dharmashastra texts prescribe unequal treatment of women in property rights, education, and ritual participation, reflecting patriarchal norms. These teachings are incompatible with modern principles of gender equality and women's rights.
- **Questionable Authenticity:** Scholars have taken the authority of these sources for granted, despite uncertainties about their time, place, and authenticity.

However, **Prof. V.R. Mehta** has held that the Western tradition fails to recognize the political nature of Indian Political Thought (IPT) because there is a fundamental difference in the way Indians and Western scholars think. Western scholars think in dichotomies (like Politics vs. Ethics, Man vs. Society, etc.). However, Indian thinkers never think in dichotomies. Indians always see them in continuity.

5.

MATSYANYAYA: JUSTIFICATION AND ORIGIN OF THE STATE

In ancient Indian political thought, *matsyanyaya* describes a state of nature where the strong prey on the weak, akin to big fish devouring smaller ones. This chaotic situation underscores the need for a state to maintain order and protect the vulnerable.

- **Role of Force (Danda):** The concept of danda (force) is central to maintaining order and preventing soci

etal chaos. While force is essential for stability, its use must be checked to ensure it is not misused by those in authority.

- **Manu's Perspective:** According to Manu, before the establishment of an organized state, people lived in confusion and anarchy without legal rules, marking the darkest period in human history. This period of disorder justified the creation of a state to impose law and order.
- **Divine Creation of the King:** People, in their desperate state, appealed to Brahma, who created a king to enforce law and order. Manu asserts that the state was a creation by divine intervention, necessary due to evil intentions and uncontrollable habits of human beings.

6.

DHARMASHASTRA AND DANDASHASTRA TRADITIONS

In the Ancient Indian political thought, both **Dharma-shastra** and **Dandashastra** constitute important tradition. They integral to the Hindu tradition of political thought and they aim to maintain social order and stability.

The differences are discussed below:

Dimensions	Dharma	Danda
Focus	Dharma of individuals, social groups and government.	Organization and mechanics of danda (discipline, force).
Orientation	Legalistic and religious.	Secular and political.
Role in Society	Holding society together through specific duties.	Maintaining order through force and restraint.
Primary Concern	➤ It provides a Code of conduct covering entire human life. ➤ Providing framework for ensuring adherence to varnashrama dharma or caste duties.	➤ Nature and organization of government and acquisition, exercise and maintenance of power. ➤ Understanding threats to the state and ways to deal with them.

Approach	Exploring political life from the standpoint of dharma.	Exploring political life from the standpoint of danda.
Similarity	Both aim to maintain social order and stability.	Both are integral to the Hindu tradition of political thought.

KAUTILYA

"Dharma is law in its widest sense—spiritual, moral, ethical and temporal. Every individual, whether the ruler or the ruled, is governed by his or her own dharma. To the extent that society respected dharma, society protected itself; to the extent society offended it, society undermined"

—Kautilya, The Arthashastra

1.

INTRODUCTION: KAUTILYA

- **Kautilya** is also known as **Chanakya** or **Vishnugupta**. He is known for his work Arthashastra.
- **Pt. Nehru** in his book *Discovery of India* compared Kautilya and called Kautilya as Indian Machiavelli.
- **Max Weber** in his book *Politics as A Vocation* held that Kautilya is more Machiavellian than Machiavelli. He also says that if we look at Kautilya's King or Raja, then Machiavelli's Prince will sound harmless.
- **Arthashashtra:** It is a par of Vedic text, there is no complete break between Manusmriti and Arthashashtra. Both deals with Dharma and Danda, but the central force of Arthashashtra is on Dhanda.
- **Key ideas:** Origin of state, Saptanga Theory, and Mandal Siddhant.
- His intention was to **replace the misrule of Nanda Dynasty by Chandragupta** who could make the strong and powerful state.

2.

ORIGIN OF THE STATE

- According to Kautilya the state originated when people got weary of the logic of the fish (**matsyanyaya**) according to which bigger fish swallow the

smaller ones. The state originated to **fulfil the desire of the people to have a peaceful society**. King took upon themselves the responsibility of maintaining the safety and security of their subjects.

- Kautilya points towards the social contract theory according to which the state came into existence after such a contract between the king and the people. People agreed to pay taxes and to be ruled by one person in order that they may be able to enjoy security and wellbeing.
- Thus, state originated to curb the anarchy and purpose is **Rakshan, Palan and Yogakshema**.
- If **Manusmriti** focuses its attention on social system/ varna dharma, **Arthashastra** primarily focuses on STATE i.e. how to administer the state.

3.

KAUTILYA THEORY OF STATECRAFT

Kautilya's theory of statecraft, as articulated in his seminal work, **the Arthashastra**, encompasses several key principles and strategies that have enduring relevance in present times. Key elements of Kautilya's Theory of Statecraft are as follow:

- **Ruler's Responsibilities:** Protecting the state, ensuring welfare, and upholding justice form the core duties of the ruler.
- **Mandala Theory:** Neighbouring states are categorized into concentric circles, guiding diplomatic and military strategies based on proximity and relationships.
- **Realpolitik:** Advocates pragmatic statecraft driven by national interest, emphasizing alliances, intelligence operations, and economic leverage.
- **Economic Management:** Focuses on maximizing state revenue through efficient taxation, trade regulations, and resource management.
- **Military Strategy:** Outlines comprehensive strategies for defence, offense, troop deployment, fortifications, naval operations, and intelligence.
- **Internal Administration:** Emphasizes effective governance with a well-organized bureaucracy, clear laws, and fair mechanisms for justice.
- **Ethics and Governance:** Balances pragmatic governance with ethical principles of justice and public welfare for legitimacy and stability.

- **Strategic Diplomacy:** Includes alliances, treaties, espionage, and negotiation techniques to secure state interests and manage external threats.

Kautilya's Arthashastra remains a foundational text for understanding ancient Indian statecraft, offering insights into governance, diplomacy, economics, and military strategy that continue to inform political thought and strategic planning to this day.

4.

SAPTANGA THEORY

The Arthashastra of Kautilya introduces the **Saptanga Theory**, also known as the **Theory of Sovereignty or Elements of State (Sapta Prakriti)**. It enumerates the seven essential components of a state, defining it comprehensively for the first time in ancient Indian political thought.

In western tradition, state has four elements: territory, government, population and sovereignty. However, in Indian tradition, state has **seven elements: the Swami, the Amatyas, the Janapada, the Durgas, the Kosha, the Danda/ Bal and the Mitra (allies)**.

A. SEVEN ELEMENTS

1. SWAMI (KING): Kautilya bestows upon the king the highest position in the body politic, as the very life force of the state. **The king is entrusted with executive, legislative, judicial, and financial powers, and is considered the defender of Dharma.**

- **Knowledge and Responsibilities:** The king must possess vast knowledge encompassing the Vedas, Arthashastra, politics, and military science. His happiness hinges on the welfare of his people, prioritizing public good over personal gain.
- **Vigilance and Strategic Leadership:** Emphasis is placed on the king's vigilance and energy to thwart external threats. With political acumen, even a small kingdom can expand under capable leadership and strategic alliances.
- **Duties of the King:** The king's duties include appointing ministers, safeguarding the populace, and ensuring justice through punishment for wrongdoers.

2. AMATYA: Kautilya defines Amatya as the council of ministers holding key positions such as chief priests, ministers, collectors, officers, envoys, and departmental superintendents.

- **Importance of Competent Advisors:** Kautilya underscores that effective kingship relies on capable councillors. The Arthashastra emphasizes the critical role of skilled advisors in ensuring the king's success and the state's stability.
- **Analogy of State Governance:** The state is likened to a carriage requiring two wheels: the king and the ministers. Both are indispensable for the smooth functioning and governance of the state.
- **Qualities of Ministers:** While the king leads, effective governance necessitates ministers with qualities like wisdom, integrity, courage, and loyalty. Their presence is essential for efficient administration and decision-making.

Arthashastra: "The king shall lose his character if he cherishes a wicked and unrighteous minister. All righteousness is to be observed by the king and his minister."

3. JANPADAS: Kautilya emphasizes the necessity of Janpadas i.e., both **territory** and **population**, for the existence of a state.

- **Requirements for Territory:** The territory should encompass fertile lands, mines, timber, pasture grounds, forests, and waterways to ensure prosperity.
- **Population Criteria:** The population should include individuals with good character, loyalty, intelligence, wisdom, and skills—both masters and slaves contributing to the state's strength.
- **Population Management Strategies:** Kautilya advises the king to encourage migration and settlement, either by attracting foreigners to establish new villages or by relocating people from densely populated areas.
- **Role in Economic Development:** The king's responsibilities extend to safeguarding agriculture and promoting industrial growth within the kingdom.

4. DURGA (FORTS): Kautilya emphasizes the vital role of forts in ensuring the state's security and protection. He views forts as equally powerful as the people and the land itself.

- **Forts and fortifications serve as crucial defences against external threats, safeguarding the treasury and the army.** Kautilya advocates for the construction of forts in all directions, ensuring comprehensive security.

Kautilya categorizes forts into four types, each with distinct characteristics:

- **Audak Forts**, featuring water-filled trenches.
- **Parvat Forts**, surrounded by high mountains and rocky terrain.
- **Danvan Forts**, situated in deserts far from oases, making them difficult to access.
- **Van Forts**, built within dense forests, providing natural barriers.

These forts play a vital role in ensuring safety and security. They serve as strongholds for the state and its people, protecting them from potential threats.

5. KOSHA (TREASURY): Kautilya underscores the treasury (Kosha) as vital, crucial for organizational stability and efficient management.

- **Revenue Sources:** Kautilya identifies taxes like export, sales, and village taxes as primary sources of state income, crucial for maintaining the treasury's stability.
- **King's Duty:** The king's principal responsibility is to ensure the treasury's prosperity by diligently collecting taxes to replenish it.
- **Ethical Wealth Accumulation:** Kautilya stresses that the treasury should accumulate wealth through righteous and lawful means, prioritizing ethical finance practices.

6. DANDA (ARMY): Kautilya asserts that a state's survival hinges on a robust defence system, necessitating a strong army.

- **Military Preparation:** He stresses thorough training and equipping the army with superior weaponry, ensuring soldier satisfaction, especially during active engagements.
- **Soldier Qualities and Composition:** Kautilya outlines essential soldier qualities: loyalty, courage, bravery, and military expertise. The army comprises hereditary and hired soldiers from divisions like infantry, chariots, elephants, and cavalry. He allows for lower caste inclusion in emergencies.

7. MITRA (ALLIES): Kautilya defines an ally, or Mitra, based on ethical principles, emphasizing genuine, hereditary alliances devoid of artificiality and characterized by unwavering loyalty and mutual support.

- **Identification of Enemies:** Kautilya advises identifying enemies as individuals displaying traits such as greed, disloyalty, immoral behavior, indulgence in base pleasures, powerlessness, and impotence.

- **Qualities of an Ideal Ally:** According to Kautilya, an ideal ally exhibits longstanding familial friendship, steadfast loyalty, compliance with control, substantial support, shared interests, swift mobilization, and a commitment to not betray friends.

Dynamic Nature of Alliances: Kautilya acknowledges alliances as beneficial only when serving mutual interests, cautioning that shifts in power dynamics can alter relationships between allies and enemies.

Kautilya emphasizes that the fate of a state and good governance hinges upon the king's approach to these elements. A benevolent and just king has the power to uplift even the most disadvantaged sections of society, fostering their well-being and prosperity. Conversely, a wicked king will undoubtedly undermine the prosperity of the state's most thriving aspects.

B. RELEVANCE OF SAPTANGA THEORY

- **Good Governance and Accountability:** The Saptanga Theory emphasizes governance for social order, reflected globally in initiatives like the UN SDGs promoting transparency and accountability.
- **Economic Development and Welfare:** Modern development goals align with the theory's focus on economic prosperity, seen in initiatives such as India's "Make in India" for growth and poverty reduction.
- **National Security and Defense:** States prioritize defense against external threats, evident in global efforts like counter-terrorism and cybersecurity measures.
- **Social Welfare and Inclusivity:** The theory supports reducing inequality and promoting social justice, as seen in campaigns like India's "Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao" for gender equality.
- **Cultural Preservation and Promotion:** Nations preserve cultural heritage for identity, exemplified by UNESCO's World Heritage Sites program.
- **Environmental Conservation:** Environmental protection efforts align with the theory's focus, as demonstrated by international agreements like the Paris Agreement on climate change.

The Saptanga Theory remains relevant today by guiding principles of governance, economic growth, social justice, cultural preservation, and environmental sustainability globally.

5.

FUNCTIONS OF THE STATE

Kautilya in Arthashastra identifies following functions of the state:

Economic Functions	Kautilya emphasized comprehensive economic development through sound financial management, promoting agriculture, industry, commerce, and efficient resource utilization. Kautilya on Tax Collection- "A tax collector should collect taxes from a taxpayer just like a bee collects honey from a flower in an expert manner without disturbing its petals."
Political Functions	The state's primary role was ensuring citizen safety and security from internal and external threats, protecting property rights, and maintaining societal cohesion through effective governance. Kautilya in Arthashastra: "A king shall ever strive to augment his power and enhance his prosperity in every possible way, for that is (his) duty."
Social Role of the State	The state focused on the welfare of its people, fostering harmonious relationships, supporting the disadvantaged, and undertaking developmental initiatives like education, healthcare, and social support. Kautilya in Arthashastra: "In the happiness of people lies the happiness of the king, their welfare is his welfare".
Educational Functions	Establishing accessible educational institutions and promoting universal education were vital for societal progress, with the state responsible for ensuring educational opportunities for all citizens.
Judicial and Law and Order Related	Kautilya advocated for a sophisticated judiciary system where the king served as the source of justice, emphasizing impartial adjudication and strict

	adherence to legal principles to maintain order and fairness. The Arthashastra provides guidelines on various types of punishment, including finances, imprisonment, and corporal punishment .
Diplomatic and Foreign Relations	Ancient India, under Ashoka's Mauryan Empire, engaged in treaty-making after the Kalinga War, promoting non-violence through inscriptions. Kings formed alliances, using espionage per Chanakya's Arthashastra, ensuring pragmatic diplomacy and security .
Emphasis on Morality	The concept of "Dharma" was central to ancient Indian governance, emphasizing moral principles in leadership.

6.

MANDALA THEORY

The Mandala Theory is outlined in Kautilya's famous treatise, the Arthashastra, and describes geopolitical dynamics and foreign policy strategies based on the principle of the mandala, meaning "circle" in Sanskrit.

- **Overview:** According to the Mandala Theory, the world is divided into concentric circles or mandalas, with the ruler's kingdom at the centre and neighbouring states as concentric rings around it.



- **Categorization of Neighbouring States:** Kautilya categorizes neighbouring states into friendly, neutral, and hostile based on their proximity and relationship with the ruler's kingdom.
- **Dealing with Friendly States:** Friendly states are seen as allies, and Kautilya advises maintaining alliances, strengthening economic ties, and building mutual trust with them.

- **Strategy for Neutral States:** Neutral states, situated in the intermediate rings of the mandala, are potential allies or threats. Kautilya recommends employing a balance of power strategy to prevent them from aligning with hostile powers.
- **Approach to Hostile States:** Hostile states, positioned in the outermost rings of the mandala, pose a direct threat. Kautilya advises caution, espionage, military preparedness, alliances with other hostile states, and even pre-emptive strikes when necessary.

The Mandala Theory reflects a **pragmatic** and **realistic approach to foreign policy** and emphasizes understanding the **geopolitical landscape, assessing neighbouring states' interests, and adapting strategies accordingly**.

The Mandala Theory has been subject to interpretations and adaptations over time, but the principles outlined in the Arthashastra continue to provide insights into statecraft, diplomacy, and power relations in international politics.

7.

PEACE POLITICS: KAUTILYA'S UPAYAS

Kautilya's "Upayas" (methods) for achieving political objectives include sama, dana, bheda, and danda. These strategies have been used in statecraft since the epic and Dharmashastra periods and are still relevant in modern politics.

SAMA (CONCILIATION)

- **Praise:** Highlighting the target's merits or qualities to reduce resistance.
- **Commonalities:** Using mutual connections to disarm the opponent.
- **Cooperation:** Convincing the opponent that cooperation benefits them.
- **Benefits:** Promising material gains or advantages.
- **Honor:** Awarding ranks or honors to ease potential conflicts.

DANA (GIFT)

- **Payments:** Offering cash, valuables, or concessions to gain favour.
- **Obligation:** Using small favors to create a sense of obligation.



- **Bribery:** Minimizing costs to achieve larger political and economic gains.

BHEDA (DISSENSION)

- **Divide and Rule:** Creating discord and isolating allies.
- **Weakening Alliances:** Preventing the formation of threatening alliances.
- **Selective Discrimination:** Planting seeds of discord among potential adversaries.

DANDA (PUNISHMENT)

- **Force:** Utilizing war or punishment as a last resort.
- **Covert Actions:** Sabotage and assassinations for strategic advantage.
- **Legitimacy:** War is justified only for political unification, not for plunder.

Kautilya's Upayas emphasize a hierarchy in conflict resolution, with force being the last resort. These principles align with modern realist theories in international relations, highlighting their enduring relevance.

NOTE: 20th century **Classic Realist**, **Hans J Morgenthau**, in his book **Politics Among Nations: The Struggle for Power and Peace**, (1966) has given methods that can be used in **balance of power**. These methods are similar to those echoed by Kautilya, but Morgenthau does not give any reference of Kautilya. The methods discussed by him include **divide and rule, compensation, armaments and alliances**.

8.

WAR TACTICS: KAUTILYA'S SHADGUNYAS

In the **Arthashastra**, Kautilya outlines six strategic options for states to manage foreign policy. These **strategies**, or **Shadgunyas**, are designed to navigate varying circumstances in pursuit of political objectives, akin to Machiavelli's goals for Italy.

SANDHI (PEACE)

- **Condition:** Applied when weaker compared to an adversary.

- **Condition:** Applied when weaker compared to an adversary.

- **Objective:** Build military strength during peacetime to shift from inferiority to superiority.

VIGRAHA (WAR)

- **Condition:** Used when having military superiority.
- **Objective:** Destroy the opponent's fighting capability but not their entire potential (*prakriti*). Maintain generosity towards the defeated.

ASANA (NEUTRALITY/WAIT AND WATCH)

- **Condition:** Employed when power potential is equal.
- **Objective:** Upgrade military capabilities while remaining neutral. Transition to offensive actions when stronger.

YANA (COERCION)

- **Condition:** Applied when the king's power is growing while the adversary's is declining.
- **Objective:** Use coercion and covert operations to secure concessions or ensure surrender without direct conflict.

SAMSHRYA (ALLIANCE)

- **Condition:** Used when surpassing the adversary's capabilities is not feasible in the near future.
- **Objective:** Form defensive alliances, working towards making them offensive against a common enemy.

DVAIDHIBHAVA (DUPLICITY)

- **Condition:** Necessary in complex situations requiring strategic deception.
- **Objective:** Engage in diplomatic double games involving intelligence, deception, and psychological tactics.

Kautilya's Shadgunyas provide a comprehensive framework for managing statecraft through strategic peace, war, neutrality, coercion, alliances, and duplicity, emphasizing the importance of assessing power dynamics and employing tactical flexibility.

9. KAUTILYA'S VIEW ON CORRUPTION

Kautilya viewed corruption as a pervasive problem rooted in human nature. He famously compared human beings to *"horses at work [who] exhibit constant change in their temper,"* suggesting that the desire for personal gain through corrupt means could easily override honesty. He believed corruption was detrimental to the state and its governance, leading to inefficiency and moral decay.

A. CAUSES OF CORRUPTION

According to Kautilya, corruption stemmed from several factors:

- **Human Nature:** He believed that humans are inherently prone to temptation and can easily succumb to the allure of personal gain.
- **Lack of Accountability:** Inadequate oversight and accountability mechanisms within the administration allowed corrupt practices to flourish.
- **Opportunity and Temptation:** The presence of opportunities for illicit gain and the temptation to exploit these opportunities for personal benefit were significant causes.

B. CONSEQUENCES OF CORRUPTION

Kautilya highlighted numerous consequences of corruption:

- **Illegality and Unethicalism:** Corruption promotes illegal and unethical behaviour.
- **Inequity and Injustice:** It leads to unfair distribution of resources and justice, favouring those who can pay bribes.
- **Administrative Inefficiency:** Corruption undermines the efficiency of administrative processes.
- **Moral Degradation:** It erodes the moral fabric of society and reduces public trust in government institutions.
- **Waste and Inconsistency:** Resources are misallocated, leading to wastage, and policies become inconsistent and biased.

C. KAUTILYA'S PRESCRIPTIONS

Kautilya proposed several measures to combat corruption:

- **Strict Vigilance:** He advocated rigorous monitoring of government officials, including their activities, finances, and behaviour. He recommended the use of spies to monitor potential corruption.
- **Accountability and Punishment:** Corrupt officials were to face severe penalties, including fines and public humiliation. He suggested that fines should be proportionate to the offense committed.
- **Whistleblower Protection:** Encouraged informants to report corruption with incentives like monetary rewards, albeit with harsh penalties for false accusations.
- **Promotion of Ethical Behavior:** Kautilya emphasized promoting professionalism and ethical conduct among officials through incentives and recognition for honest work.

Systematic Reforms: Proposed reforms included periodic transfers of officials to prevent complacency and the establishment of self-scrutinizing mechanisms within departments.

Kautilya's approach to combating corruption was comprehensive and reflected a deep understanding of human behaviour and administrative challenges. His strategies aimed not only at punishing corrupt behaviour but also at preventing its occurrence through systemic reforms and ethical incentives.

D. IMPORTANT QUOTES

- "Just as it is impossible not to taste honey or poison that one may find at the tip of one's tongue, so it is impossible for one dealing with government funds not to taste, at least a little bit, of the king's revenue."
- "Just as it is impossible to know when a swimming fish is drinking water, so it is impossible to find out when a government servant is stealing money."

10.

REALISM AND KAUTILYA

Kautilya's Arthashastra is a seminal work in political realism, often overshadowed by Western theories. Roger Boesche's 2002 book, *The First Great Realist: Kautilya and His Arthashastra*, argues that Kautilya is a precursor to modern political realism, with parallels to Machiavelli and Morgenthau.

REALIST FOUNDATIONS IN ARTHASHASTRA

- **National Interest:** Kautilya prioritizes national interest in foreign policy.
- **Anarchy:** Highlights the anarchic nature of inter-state relations.
- **Power:** Emphasizes the centrality of power in international politics.

COMPARISON WITH WESTERN REALISM

- **Morgenthau:** Classic realist Morgenthau notes similarities between Kautilya's strategies and his own theories, such as divide and rule, compensation, armaments, and alliances.
- **Thucydides:** Though Thucydides' Peloponnesian War is a landmark in realism, it serves more as a historical account rather than a theoretical foundation.
- **Henry Kissinger:** Viewed Kautilya as a blend of Machiavelli and Clausewitz, emphasizing that diplomacy is a subtle form of war aimed at achieving conquest.

NORMATIVE AND MORAL ASPECTS

- **Dharma:** Contrary to purely realist interpretations, Arthashastra incorporates the concept of dharma, or morality, indicating a blend of idealism and realism.
- **Holistic Approach:** Kautilya's work reflects a mix of normative and pragmatic elements, addressing both ethical and strategic dimensions.

Kautilya's Arthashastra stands as a foundational text in political realism, with its principles resonating in modern theories of international relations. However, it also integrates normative elements, providing a comprehensive perspective that combines realism with ethical considerations.

11.

RELEVANCE OF KAUTILYA IN CONTEMPORARY WORLD

Kautilya's teachings remain relevant today for several reasons:

- **Realpolitik and Statecraft:** Emphasizes pragmatic pursuit of national interests and strategic decision-making in international relations.

- **Geopolitical Analysis:** Mandala Theory provides insights into assessing relationships and forming alliances in the global landscape.
- **Corruption and Governance:** Advocates for ethical leadership, transparency, and public participation to combat corruption.
- **Economic Policy:** Insights on economic prosperity, resource allocation, and entrepreneurship for sustainable development.
- **Intelligence and Security:** Emphasis on intelligence gathering and national security strategies.
- **Leadership and Ethics:** Focuses on ethical conduct and responsible governance.
- **Public Administration:** Guidance on effective administration and policy implementation.

Kautilya's adaptable principles continue to inform governance and international relations in the modern world.

BUDDHIST POLITICAL THOUGHT

According to **Professor Bhikhu Parekh**, the Indian tradition emphasizes continuity rather than change, making Hindu and Buddhist traditions qualitatively similar. Buddhism can be seen as the "**rebel child of Hinduism**," sharing concepts like Karma and rebirth. The primary difference lies in social dynamics: Hinduism represents the hegemony of Brahmins and Kshatriyas, while Buddhism reflects the alliance of Kshatriyas and Vaishyas.

1.

KEY CONTRIBUTIONS OF BUDDHIST POLITICAL THOUGHT TO INDIAN POLITICAL TRADITION

Important contributions of Buddhist Political Tradition are discussed below:

ORIGIN OF KINGSHIP

- **Democratic Elections:** Buddhist literature, unlike Brahminical texts, portrays kingship as arising from popular elections. The Jatakas describe instances where kings were elected by the purohita or elders based on their qualities, known as "**Maha-Samma-ta**" (**accepted by all**).
- **Social Contract:** The king's authority was derived from a contract with the people, who could revolt



against a tyrannical ruler. This concept emphasized the king's duty to protect subjects and uphold justice, binding him to the law.

DEMOCRATIC NATURE OF THE BUDDHIST SANGHA

- **Prof. Rhys Davids** noted that the Buddhist Sangha operated on democratic principles, with decisions made through resolutions and majority votes in regular meetings, following established rules and quorum requirements. Thus, we can trace the roots of deliberative democracy to Buddhist political thought.

THEORY OF THE ORIGIN OF THE STATE

- **Moral Decline and Social Order:** The state's necessity emerged from societal corruption, and the institution of kingship resulted from a social contract with a distinguished individual.
- **Dighanikaya:** This text presents a theory where kingship arose due to a decline in moral and physical conditions, leading people to appoint a "**Maha Sammata**" to maintain order in exchange for a share of their harvest. This challenges the Vedic divine origin theory.

PRINCIPLE OF RIGHTEOUSNESS

- **Dharma over Danda:** Unlike Brahminical emphasis on danda (punishment), Buddhism prioritized upholding dharma (righteousness) positively. The king and subjects were bound by the same ethical principles.
- **Chakravartin Concept:** The ideal ruler or "chakravartin" was envisioned as one who governed with universal supremacy. Internal administration was based on reciprocal love and affection, while foreign conquests were achieved through righteousness.
- **Foreign Policy:** Buddhism advocated peaceful relations with neighbouring states and conquest by winning hearts (**dhammaghosha or cultural conquest**). Indian foreign policy of Panchasheel is inspired by Buddhist tradition.

REJECTION OF CASTE SYSTEM IN GOVERNANCE

- **Rejection of Caste System:** Buddhist political thought denies the caste restrictions on kingship and the sanctity of the king's person, contrasting with Brahminical norms.
- **Voluntary Selection of Occupations:** Superior positions were determined by virtue and knowledge, not caste.

These contributions highlight a distinct, democratic, and ethical approach to governance in Buddhist political thought, emphasizing moral integrity, social contract, and the importance of righteousness in leadership.

11.

CONCEPT OF DHAMMA AS A TOOL OF POLITICAL EMANCIPATION

Dhamma, derived from the Sanskrit word Dharma, encompasses moral, ethical, and social duties essential for maintaining order in society. It represents righteousness, propriety, and justice, forming the foundation of individual and collective conduct. In Buddhism, Dhamma is crucial for personal and societal well-being, guiding actions towards ethical living and harmonious coexistence.

- **Control Over State Power:** Dhamma served as a check on unrighteous rulers, ensuring ethical governance within large empires.
- **Ideal Kingship:** Buddhist ideals integrated Dhamma into state governance, aiming for a just social order and ethical statehood, exemplified by Emperor Ashoka.
- **Autonomy of the Sangha:** Separation of authority (ānā) from Dhamma preserved the moral integrity of the Buddhist monastic community, safeguarding against monarchical despotism.
- **Cosmic Force of Dhamma:** Dhamma was seen as a cosmic force ensuring ethical conduct of rulers, influencing political decisions and natural outcomes.
- **Practical Measures:** Buddhist rulers supported the Sangha, prohibited monk involvement in politics, and enacted ethical laws reflecting Dhamma's influence.

Dhamma's integration into political philosophy facilitated ethical governance, regulating state power and promoting societal well-being in ancient Buddhist societies.

SIR SYED AHMED KHAN

"WHEN A NATION BECOMES DEVOID OF ARTS AND LEARNING, IT INVITES POVERTY. AND WHEN POVERTY COMES, IT BRINGS IN ITS WAKE THOUSAND OF CRIMES."



-Syed Ahmed Khan

KEY FACTS

- **Known for:** Asbab-i-Baghawat-i-Hind, As a founder of Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental (MAO) College and • Tahzib-ul Akhlaq
- **Key ideas:** great reformers, educationist, and moderniser within the Muslim community.
- **Impact:** His observations and recommendations are quite relevant for the Muslim Community in present times.

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Comment on: Syed Ahmed Khan as a modernizer. (2013)
- "When a nation becomes devoid of arts and learning, it invites poverty." (Sir Syed Ahmed Khan). In the light of this statement, assess the role of Sir Syed Ahmed Khan as a reformer of modern India. (2021)

1.

INTRODUCTION: SIR SYED AHMED KHAN

- **A Reformist Leader:** Sir Syed Ahmad Khan was one of the most formidable figures of the late nineteenth century India. He emerged on the Indian scene as one of the great reformers, educationist, and moderniser within the Muslim community.
- **Reconciliation Efforts Post-1857 Revolt:** Witnessing brutal repression by the British post 1857 Revolt, Sir

SA Khan attempted reconciliation between the Muslims and the British. He wrote **Asbab-i-Baghawat-i-Hindu** published in 1858, in which he tried to explain various underlying causes of the Revolt. However, his central argument was that the Revolt came about because the British were entirely unaware of the Indian opinion since Indians were deliberately kept out of the governance of their country.

- **Advocacy for Loyal Muslims:** In The Loyal Mohammedans of India (1860), he argued that it was not true that all the Muslims were the enemy of the British as enumerated, that there were several Muslims who had stood by the British during the tumultuous days of the Revolt. From this time onwards, Sir Syed devoted his entire life to bring about reconciliation between the British and the Muslims. He also tried to seek support of the British for Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental (MAO) College.

2.

CONTRIBUTION TO MODERN EDUCATION

Sir SA Khan's objective was **to bring his community out of the state of stagnation**. He wanted the empowerment of the Muslim community. He believed that the only way community can end its stagnation is through education. Sir Syed was, by now, convinced that in order to stem the declining fortunes of the Muslims, it was important that **they took to modern education** as it was introduced by the British.

"Muslim youth should carry the book of science in one hand and Holy Quran on other hand".

-Sir Syed Ahmed Khan

- He looked for the causes behind the frustration and stagnation of Muslim community. He found that-Muslim follow orthodox/ irrational customs and traditions.
- **Scientific Society at Ghazipur (1863 UP):** Basic objective was to translate scientific literature, into Urdu. The subjects such as mechanics, electricity, pneumatics, and natural philosophy received particular emphasis.
 - Indian Institute Gazette (a journal started on behalf of Society in 1866.

- **Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental (MAO) College in 1875:** While modern education would be imparted to the Muslims, they would also have some training in the preservation of their cultural heritage. The doors of the college were open to all.
- **Tahzib-ul Akhlaq (Magazine):** Many practices which were out of tune with modern trends of the time were ridiculed. He also advocated for fresh interpretation of the Quran. His inclination was to inculcate science in Islam and believed that science and Islam are not contradictory to each other.

3.

SIR SYED AHMED KHAN AS ORIGINATOR OF TWO NATION THEORY

In Sir Syed Ahmed Khan, we see evolution in his ideas.

- **Initial Phase:** Sir Syed was also a champion of the Hindu-Muslim unity. He had once described *the Hindus and Muslims as two beautiful eyes of a beautiful bride*. He wrote two essays in *Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq*, one in 1888 and another 1898 exhorting Muslims **to give up killing of cows** since this would bring about a good neighbourly relation between the Hindus and the Muslims.
- **Later Phase:** He started talking about- Hindus and Muslims as separate nations. The change in opinion was due to the Language Controversy in Awadh between the supporters of Urdu (Persian script) and Hindi (Devnagari script).
- **Criticism of INC:** INC was not in the best interest of the Muslim community. He thought the Congress was likely to take a confrontationist stance in due course of time, which would be injurious to the interest of the Muslims.

"Now I am convinced that these two nations will not work unitedly in any cause. At present there is no hostility between them. But, on account of the so-called educated people it will increase a hundred-fold in the future."

-Sir Syed Ahmed Khan

Thus, at times he is criticised as an anti-national and leader of the community who ignored the national interest.

4.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE

Sachar Committee (2005) on the social, economic, and educational condition of Muslims in India and current status (Indian Express, Report by Zeeshan Shaikh):

- It placed Indian Muslims below Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in backwardness.
- The Sachar Committee recorded the percentage of Muslims in the IAS and IPS as 3% and 4% respectively. These numbers were 3.32% and 3.19% respectively on January 1, 2016.
- Muslims continued to have the lowest average monthly per capita expenditure (MPCE) among all communities.

Thus, Sir Syed Ahmed Khan's recommendations are quite relevant in present times as well.

5.

CONCLUDING REMARK

If we understand Sir Syed Ahmed Khan from neutral perspective-

- He was quite pragmatic, realistic and whatever he said continues to be true.
- He is the tallest leader in the Muslim community.

SRI AUROBINDO GHOSH (1872 -1950)

"...Nationalism was already born and a slowly growing force. It was not born and did not grow in the Congress Pandal, nor in the Bombay Presidency Association, nor in the councils of the wise economists and learned reformers... nor under the hat and coat of the denationalised ape of English speech and manners."

-SRI AUROBINDO



KEY FACTS

- **Important works:** His writings in journals like *Bande Mataram* and *Indu-Prakash*, *Life Divine*, *Essays on Geeta*, *The Synthesis of Yoga*, etc.

➤ **Architectonic Ideas:** Concepts of **Nation, Nationalism** (spiritual and cultural), **Swaraj**, Program of political action and **Passive Resistance**.

➤ **Sources of influence:** **Geeta**, **Upanishads**, **Neo-Vedantism** of **Vivekananda**, **Bankimchandra Chatterjee** (**Goddess Shakti**), **Goethe**, **Herder** and **Hegel**.

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Comment on: According to Sri Aurobindo, Swaraj is a necessary condition for India to accomplish its destined goal. (2017)
- Discuss Sri Aurobindo's views on Cultural Nationalism. (2016)
- Comment on: "Nationalism is not a mere political programme but a way of life like religion." (Aurobindo Ghose). (2014)
- Comment on: Sri Aurobindo's "idea of freedom". (2013)

1. INTRODUCTION: SRI AUROBINDO

- Sri Aurobindo believed **Neo-Vedanta philosophy** would increase cultural strength of Hinduism and pave the way for the **growth of nationalism** in modern India. They interpreted Indian nationalism in the context of **reformation and rejuvenation of Hinduism**. He became one of the authentic exponents of Hinduism and Hindu philosophy.
- In the beginning of the 20th century, **nationalism became more aggressive and anti-colonial**. Sri Aurobindo Ghosh was instrumental in giving radical content to nationalism in India.
- Sri Aurobindo's ideas can be divided into **two phases**:

First Phase	Second Phase
➤ He expounded the concept of Indian nationalism and developed the theory of passive resistance .	➤ As a great sage of India, he wrote extensively on the ideal of human unity and the essential characteristics of Indian model of state building .

➤ He was a militant nationalist eager to **liberate his motherland** from the bondage.

➤ He sought to **give** message to the world in the **ideals of the human unity and nationalism** to achieve the goal.

- Sri Aurobindo wanted to complete the task of **Renaissance of Hinduism for the awakening of the Indian soul which was in deep slumber**, which was left incomplete by **Swami Vivekananda and Bankimchandra Chatterjee**. Aurobindo carried forward the development of Neo-Vedanta and declared that the true message of Vedanta was **selfless action** or **Karma Yoga**. The Geeta taught us to **fight against injustice** because life is a series of struggles.
- According to him, the goal of new Hinduism was to pave the way for emergence of Indian nationalism and to harmonise the world and the spirit.
- It could achieve its glory through the philosophy of Vedanta which gave more **importance to spirituality than to science**. The West glorified **science but science is a light within a limited room and not the sun that which illumines the world**.
- Aurobindo was a harsh critic of the British Rule in India. He did not agree with the opinion of the moderates that it was a **divine dispensation**.
- **British rule was a curse** because the foreign rule in India exhausted moral and mental energies of the Indian people. The British rule **ruined the economy of India**, and it was the worst type of **bureaucratic despotism** motivated by plunder and domination.
- The British claim of a good government was false and a **good and efficient government was no substitute for self-government and freedom**.
- Aurobindo contended that the spirit of India could be freed only by securing complete independence.

2.

SRI AUROBINDO'S CRITIQUE OF POLITICAL MODERATES IN INDIA

When Sri Aurobindo entered Indian politics, it was dominated by the moderate leaders who were of the view that **British rule in India was a divine dispensation**.

Aurobindo was highly critical of their approach to politics. The Congress confused sufferance with freedom and favour of foreign despotism with the right of citizenship.

- He wrote a series of articles in the '*Indu Prakash*' of Pune under the **title 'New Lamps for Old'** and severely criticised the **politics of petitions and prayers of the moderate leaders**.
- He believed Congress leaders had **narrow and limited ideals**. The Congress was selfishly frigid of social development and awakening of the masses and organically infirm. It was **unaware of deeper facts**; therefore, it did not articulate the popular opinion of the entire Indian people.
- It **lacked the spirit of sincerity, whole heartedness, right type of methods and right type of leaders** because when the blind led the blind both were bound to fall in a ditch.
- Aurobindo argued that during **Ram Mohan Roy's period**, politics of prayers and petition was the only possible policy, but it was wrong to continue it even in the later years. He pleaded for the adoption of new and strong methods.
- He called for a complete change in the policy of the Congress party. He pleaded for the adoption of new policies and programmes to replace the politics of supplication carried out by the moderates.
- He suggested four methods as part of his **program of political action: Swaraj** (Self-government), **Swadeshi** (local goods), **National Education** and **Boycott** (foreign goods).

3.

SRI AUROBINDO'S THEORY OF NATIONALISM

Context: There was a debate going with respect to the identity of India as a nation. British position was that India is merely a geographical expression. Indian Moderates held that India is a nation in making. He had a great influence of **Vedanta Philosophy** (unity and oneness in man and God) and idea of **Mother India or Shakti of Bankimchandra**.

"Nation is natural. Nation has spirit and nation never dies. Nation exists for divinity."

-Hegel

- **Spiritual Basis of Nationalism:** Aurobindo believed that the **aim of nationalism** should not be limited to political, economic, or social goals alone, but should also **encompass the spiritual and cultural upliftment of the nation**. He was influenced by ideas of Herder, Hegel, and German tradition of cultural nationalism.
- **Ideal of Swaraj:** By the term Swaraj, he meant complete independence. However, his concept of freedom went **beyond political independence and emphasized a broader and deeper understanding of human liberation**.
 - Freedom involved the **harmonious integration of individual freedom with the freedom and well-being of the collective**.
 - Freedom enables individuals to transcend limitations, overcome ego and ignorance, and awaken to their true divine nature.
 - He believed in the concept of **integral freedom**, which involved the liberation of all dimensions of human existence - physical, vital, mental, and spiritual.
 - The objective of Swaraj is realisation of the self and human self is part of universal spirit. It requires freedom from **tamas or desire** (purification of soul for flowering of divine).
 - A large part of his theory of nationalism was based on **awakening the dormant spirit of nationalism** that was latent in the soul of India. The struggle against the foreign rule would enable it to achieve self-realisation.

In words of Aurobindo, *"craving for freedom is lodged so deep in human heart that even thousands of arguments are powerless to disapprove it."*

- **Synthesis of East and West:** He believed that cultural nationalism should assimilate and integrate the best elements from various traditions to create a vibrant and inclusive national culture. He was critique of British Utilitarian tradition and admirer of Idealist tradition represented by the German scholars (Hegel and Herder). **Romain Rolland** said, Sri Aurobindo was **"the highest synthesis of the genius of Asia and the genius of Europe."**
- **Harmonizing Universal and National Aspirations:** He believed that **nationalism should not be narrow-minded or exclusive** but should work

towards the larger aim of human solidarity and global well-being. Thus, we can see the cosmopolitan approach expressed in Indian traditions (**Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam i.e. the world is one family**). This view was influenced by the **Sanatana Dharma** and **Natural Law of Aggregation**.

- **Essential elements:** essential elements were **geographical unity, common past**, common interest impelling towards unity and certain favourable political conditions which would strengthen **Indian Nationality** to offer united resistance to foreign rule.
- **Importance of villages:** He believed that the ideal of national Swaraj must be modelled on the old village community, which was democratic, self-sufficient, autonomous, and self-governing.
- **Inclusive character:** The ideal of **Indian nationalism** was largely Hindu in character but he pointed out that this nationalism was wide enough to include the Muslim culture and traditions. He said that the Hindu should win Swaraj for himself as well as for the Muslim.

➤ *"Nationalism survives in the strength of God, and it is not possible to crush it, whatever weapons are brought against it. Nationalism is immortal because it is not human being."*

➤ *"Nationalism is not mere a political program, nationalism is a religion."*

–Sri Aurobindo

4.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE OF SRI AUROBINDO'S THOUGHTS

- **Spiritual Evolution:** Sri Aurobindo's teachings provide guidance on personal transformation, self-realization, and the pursuit of inner growth, which remain relevant for individuals seeking spiritual and personal development.

Integral Education: Sri Aurobindo's vision of integral education emphasizes the **holistic development of individuals**, including their physical, mental, emotional, and spiritual dimensions.

- **Social Transformation:** Sri Aurobindo's vision of social transformation emphasizes the need for

ethical leadership, social justice, and the harmonious development of communities.

- **Environmental Consciousness:** Sri Aurobindo's emphasis on living in harmony with nature and his vision of sustainable development are relevant in the context of environmental challenges.

Integral Politics: Sri Aurobindo's concept of integral politics, which emphasizes the integration of spiritual values into governance, holds relevance in exploring **alternative models of politics and leadership** that prioritize the well-being of individuals and the collective.

Sri Aurobindo on Education

In 1907, Sri Aurobindo wrote an essay titled '**A System of National Education**'. In this, he explained the concept of his education and said, *"In every human being there is some God-given divine power, something that is his own, which can be moved towards perfection. The task of education is to identify, develop and use it. The main goal of education should be to fully develop the inherent power of the developing soul and prepare it for the best work."*

MOHANDAS
(1869 –1948

KARAMCHAND

GANDHI

Generations to come will scarce believe that such a one as this over in flesh and blood walked upon this earth (said of Mahatma Gandhi)."

–Albert Einstein



QUESTIONS FOR DISCUSSION

- The Panchayats with Gram Sabhas should be so organised as to identify the resources locally available for development in agricultural and industrial sectors." Examine the statement in the context of Gram Swaraj. (2022)
- MK Gandhi's concept of Swaraj. (2019)
- Examine Gandhi's critique of 'Modernisation'. (2016)
- Explain Gandhis ideas regarding State and highlight their relationship with modern democracy and principles of anarchism. (2006)
- Comment on: The true source of light is duty. If we all discharge our duties, rights will not be far to see. (M K Gandhi). (2002)

KEY FACTS

- **Important works:** Hind Swaraj, My Experiments with Truth
- **Key ideas:** Ahimsa, Satyagraha, Swaraj, Sarvodaya, Ram-rajya.
- **Sources of influence:** His mother, GK Gokhle (his political guru), Socrates, John Ruskin (Book- Unto This Last), Leo Tolstoy (Book- Kingdom of God Within You)
- **Architectonic Ideas:** Ahimsa and continuity between ends and means.

1.

INTRODUCTION: MAHATMA GANDHI

- Gandhism began a brand-new era in the development of political philosophy. It led the world to assume that the only way to resolve even the most pressing political issues was by making personal sacrifices and convincing the adversary of his excesses and errors.
- Gandhi is one of the most inspirational people of our time. He was the **foremost representative of Indian nationalism** in India during British control. Gandhi led India to independence through **non-violent civil disobedience**, which served as an inspiration for nonviolent, civil **rights, and liberation movements** around the globe.
- He wanted to establish an **ideal society** in which **panchayathi raj** based on real democratic principles was to flourish.

2.

GANDHI'S VIEWS ON TRUTH

His philosophy and practice were deeply influenced by the concept of truth, which he referred to as "Satya" in Sanskrit. Here are some key aspects of Gandhi's views on truth:

- **Truth as God:** For Gandhi, truth and God were intimately connected. He famously said, "God is truth." He believed that truth was not just an abstract concept but a divine force that permeated all aspects of existence. Gandhi saw the search for truth as a spiritual journey that ultimately led to the realization of God.

- **Truth as a Universal Principle:** Gandhi believed that truth is a universal principle that transcends religions, cultures, and personal beliefs. He considered truth to be eternal and unchanging.
- **Pursuit of Truth:** Gandhi saw the pursuit of truth as a lifelong journey and a moral obligation. He believed that individuals should continuously seek truth in their thoughts, actions, and relationships.
- **Truth and Non-Violence:** Gandhi saw non-violence as the natural outcome of a commitment to truth, as violence distorts and obstructs the realization of truth.
- **Inner Truth and Moral Integrity:** He believed that individuals should align their thoughts, words, and actions with their inner truth, which would lead to a sense of moral integrity and personal authenticity.
- **Truth and Social Transformation:** He believed that uncovering and exposing social injustices, inequalities, and oppressive systems was essential to the pursuit of truth. Gandhi encouraged individuals to challenge unjust social norms and work towards creating a more just and equitable society.

3.

GANDHI'S VIEWS ON NON-VIOLENCE/ AHIMSA

Ahimsa is the central concept of the Gandhian ideals. He used to say that "**Ahimsa is my creed/ religion and article of faith.**" Gandhi considered non-violence to be a powerful and effective means of achieving social and political change.

- **Principle of Non-Violence:** Gandhi believed that non-violence is not simply the absence of physical violence but a positive force and a moral and spiritual principle that rejects the use of force in thought, word, or action. According to Gandhi, non-violence requires courage, self-discipline, and a deep commitment to truth.
- **Active Resistance:** Gandhi believed that non-violent actions, such as strikes, boycotts, civil disobedience, and peaceful protests, could effectively challenge unjust laws and systems and aimed at transforming the oppressor, by appealing to their conscience.
- **Non-Retaliation and Forgiveness:** Gandhi advocated for responding to violence and aggression with non-violence and forgiveness to

promote reconciliation and peace. He rejected the idea of revenge or retaliation, seeing it as perpetuating a cycle of violence.

- **Personal Transformation:** Gandhi believed that non-violence is not only a means for social and political change but also a path for personal transformation. He saw non-violence as a way to cultivate inner strength, self-control, and spiritual growth.
- **Universal Applicability:** He believed that non-violence could be practiced in all aspects of life, from personal relationships to politics and international conflicts. Gandhi envisioned a world where non-violence was the guiding principle in resolving conflicts and building a just and peaceful society.

Gandhi's philosophy of non-violence influenced numerous social and political movements around the world, inspiring leaders like Martin Luther King Jr. and Nelson Mandela. His belief in the transformative power of non-violence continues to resonate as a powerful tool for social change and conflict resolution.

4.

GANDHI'S CONCERN ABOUT PURITY OF MEANS OVER ENDS

- The purity of means is linked to Gandhi's emphasis on action and not consequences. The idea is influenced by the philosophy of Geeta- "**Do your duty, reward is not your concern**" i.e. **NISHKAMA KARMA**.
- In case of India's freedom struggle, Gandhi has emphasised on purity of means and non-violent nature of struggle. For instance, post eruption of violence at **Chauri-chaura**, Gandhi called off the Non-Cooperation Movement. He always believed in hating the sin, not the sinner.
- Gandhi's hatred towards the British Raj was because they have established **satanic** or **Leviathan State** which is rooted in force, coercion, and violence. He has described India's battle as **Satyagraha**.

5.

GANDHI'S CONCEPT OF SATYAGRAHA

Mahatma Gandhi developed the concept of Satyagraha as a philosophy and method of nonviolent

resistance. Satyagraha, a term he coined, combines the Sanskrit words "Satya" (truth) and "agraha" (holding firmly or insistence). It can be understood as "holding onto truth" or "the force of truth."

- **Power of Truth:** Gandhi thought that truth had intrinsic force and was the only ultimate reality. The foundation of Satyagraha is the conviction that truth is the most powerful force and that it has the power to transform society, individuals, and even repressive systems.
- **Nonviolent Resistance:** Satyagraha advocates for nonviolent passive (peaceful) resistance as a means of confronting injustice, hatred, and oppression. Gandhi believed that nonviolence was not a sign of weakness but a source of great strength.
- **The Principles of Satyagraha:** Gandhi identified a set of principles that guided Satyagraha: **Ahimsa (Nonviolence)**, **Satya (Truth)**, **Tapasya (Soul Force)**, **Tyaga (Sacrifice)**, and **Swadeshi (Self-reliance)**.
- **Constructive Program:** Alongside nonviolent resistance, Gandhi advocated for constructive programs that aimed to uplift communities and promote social change. For instance, education, sanitation, economic self-sufficiency, and the eradication of social evils like untouchability.
- **Teleological approach:** The battle of the satyagrahi is for the ultimate truth, so the approach of Gandhi is teleological.
- **Political Strategy:** Satyagraha is a Gandhian political strategy which he first employed in South Africa and then in India (Kheda, Champaran, Non-cooperation movement, etc.)

Through the philosophy of Satyagraha, Gandhi led successful nonviolent movements, such as the **Salt March and the Quit India Movement**, against British colonial rule in India. His theory of Satyagraha continues to inspire nonviolent resistance movements worldwide as a powerful means to address social, political, and moral issues.

6.

GANDHI'S CRITIQUE OF WESTERN CIVILISATION

Gandhi in Hind Swaraj provides the critique of western civilisation. In Gandhi's critique of western/ modern civilisation, we also understand Gandhi's vision or blueprint for future India or the form of ideal society.

He was influenced by Edward **Carpenter's "Civilization: Its Cause and Cure"**. Gandhi found no morality or religion in western civilization.

- **Man as depraved animal:** Gandhi believes that true meaning of civilisation is which makes a man a better human being rather than a depraved animal. However, in modern civilisation, man is like an animal who is guided by appetite, not reason.
- **Materialism and Consumerism:** He believed that the pursuit of material wealth and possessions had led to a devaluation of spiritual and moral values. Gandhi emphasized the importance of simplicity and contentment, advocating for a focus on inner growth rather than material accumulation.
- **Industrialization and Modernization:** Gandhi criticises the industrial progress which had resulted in environmental degradation, exploitation of natural resources, and the marginalization of traditional livelihoods. Gandhi favoured a more sustainable and decentralized approach to development, rooted in the values and needs of local communities.
- **Centralization of Power and Individualism:** Gandhi criticized the concentration of political (even parliamentary democracy) and economic power in Western societies, which he believed led to the marginalization of the masses and the erosion of community bonds. So, he emphasises the importance of **collective responsibility, community-oriented values, and Swaraj**.
- **Violence and War:** Gandhi strongly criticized Western civilization's history of **violence**, including **colonialism, imperialism, and warfare**. He believed in the futility and immorality of war, advocating for nonviolent resistance and peaceful means of conflict resolution.

Thus, his aim was not to reject Western civilization entirely, but to promote a more balanced, inclusive, and morally grounded approach to human progress and societal well-being.

Blue-Print for Future India

Following Dharma (law of Being)	Adoption of Non-violence approach for development	Minimum harm to environment
Democratic decentralisation	Promotion of Panchayati Raj	Cottage Industries

Critical Review of Gandhi's critique

Gandhi's critique of modern civilisation can be seen as part of **Gandhi's War of Position** (counter-hegemony to British position on imperialism as a civilising mission. He also called Modern Civilisation as Satanic Civilisation.

7.

GANDHI'S CONCERN ABOUT PURITY OF MEANS OVER ENDS

The idea of 'Swaraj' or self-rule is one of the philosophical principles of Gandhian teachings, which stimulate man in **conquering complete individuality and reorganization of the society**. Gandhi holds that self-rule or 'Swaraj' was nothing but self-determination of the individual while taking decisions. By Real Swaraj Gandhi meant the "welfare and happiness of the masses".

- **Political Swaraj:** Gandhi's idea of Swaraj went beyond mere political independence i.e., **freedom and autonomy of India from British colonial rule**. He believed that true Swaraj required **active participation and empowerment of individuals in the decision-making processes** that affected their lives. Gandhi emphasized the importance of decentralization and the empowerment of local communities through concepts like **Gram Swaraj (village self-rule)**.
- **Economic Swaraj:** Gandhi advocated for economic self-sufficiency and self-reliance to address poverty, unemployment, and inequality. He believed in the promotion of cottage industries, agriculture, and the use of local resources to achieve economic independence.
- **Moral and Spiritual Swaraj:** Gandhi's Swaraj went beyond political or economic concept; it touches

moral and spiritual dimensions. He believed that Swaraj could only be achieved **through self-discipline, self-transformation, and the adherence to truth and nonviolence.**

- **Swadeshi:** Swadeshi concept of Gandhi encompassed the idea of self-sufficiency, local empowerment, and the rejection of dependence on foreign goods and systems.
- **Cultural Swaraj:** One should feel proud of one's own culture and heritage. He also sees it as end of the evils like untouchability and communalism.

Thus, we can see the direct influence of Aurobindo Ghosh. Both Gandhi and Ghosh talk about swaraj in terms of emancipation and spiritual liberation.

8.

GANDHI'S PRINCIPLE OF SARVODAYA

Sarvodaya, a term coined by Mahatma Gandhi, means "the upliftment of all" or "the welfare of all." It is Gandhi's translation of John Ruskin's book- "Unto This Last". It was a central concept in Gandhi's philosophy and vision for a just and equitable society.

- **Human Dignity and Equality:** Gandhi believed in the inherent worth and dignity of every individual, regardless of their social, economic, or caste background.
- **Dignity of Labour:** The dignity of bread labour is that everyone should perform some sort of physical labour because only when we perform the manual labour, we will develop the respect for those who are performing manual labour.
- **Trusteeship:** Gandhi believed that individuals with wealth and power should act as trustees and use their resources for the welfare of all, considering themselves as custodians rather than owners. Its main aim is to solve the **contradiction between capitalist and labour** and concept of class struggle. Thus, it's aim is to appeal to the conscience of the capitalists. It does not recognize any right of private ownership of property except so far as it may be permitted by society for its own welfare.
- **Nonviolence and Harmony:** Sarvodaya was deeply rooted in the **principles of nonviolence and communal harmony.** Gandhi believed that true progress, social cohesion, and welfare could only be achieved through peaceful means and the resolution of conflicts through dialogue and understanding.

While Sarvodaya was particularly relevant in the Indian context during the freedom struggle, its principles continue to inspire movements for social and economic justice worldwide.

9.

GANDHI ON RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN RIGHTS AND DUTIES

Mahatma Gandhi had a unique perspective on the relationship between rights and duties. He believed that rights and duties were inseparable and that individuals should focus more on fulfilling their duties rather than demanding their rights.

- **Interdependence:** Gandhi emphasized that one's rights could not be divorced from their corresponding duties and responsibilities towards themselves, and society.

"That a lawyer's work has the same value as the barber's, inasmuch as all have the same right of earning their livelihood from their work".

- **Duty as the Foundation of Rights:** Gandhi saw duty as a prerequisite for the enjoyment of rights. Gandhi believed that the fulfilment of one's duties was the foundation for claiming and exercising rights

"Work of the barber is as important as the work of lawyer."

-MK Gandhi

- **Duty to Overcome Selfishness:** Gandhi believed that individuals have a duty to overcome selfishness and work towards the well-being of all. According to Gandhi, individuals should prioritize the welfare of others and work towards creating an inclusive and equitable society.

Inclusion of **Article 51-A** in the Indian Constitution as part of the 42nd Amendment highlighting ten Fundamental Duties of the citizens reflects the relevance of Gandhian thoughts on relationship between rights and duties.

10.

GANDHI'S VIEW ON STATE

He gathered experience in South Africa that more and more power to the state meant more and more violence or greater amount of coercion. Gandhi wanted the state to be free from its violent elements and sought to inculcate fearlessness in the minds of people.

11.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE OF GANDHIAN THOUGHTS

- **Nonviolence and Conflict Resolution:** Gandhi's philosophy of non-violence (Ahimsa) offers a powerful and effective approach to resolving conflicts and promoting peace (ex- Apartheid movement).
- **Ethical Leadership:** Gandhi's emphasis on moral and ethical leadership is highly relevant in today's world. His call for leaders to prioritize the well-being of others, serve selflessly, and act with integrity remains an important reminder of the qualities we expect from our leaders (Role of United Nations).
- **Sustainability and Environmentalism:** Gandhi's principles of self-reliance, simplicity, and respect for nature hold great relevance in the face of environmental challenges (climate change and global warming). His emphasis on Swadeshi (using locally made goods) and his call to live in harmony with nature offer insights into sustainable living and responsible consumption.
- **Community Empowerment and Self-Governance:** Gandhi's advocacy for decentralization, Gram Swaraj and empowering local communities resonates with contemporary discussions on participatory democracy, community-led development, and grassroots movements.
- **Social Justice and Equality:** Gandhi's tireless efforts to combat social injustice and his emphasis on equality are enduring principles. His focus on uplifting marginalized communities and promoting inclusive societies continues to inspire movements for social justice, equal rights, and the eradication of discrimination.

DR. BHIMRAO RAMJI AMBEDKAR (1891-1956)

"What are we having this liberty for? We are having this liberty in order to reform our social system, which is full of inequality, discrimination and other things, which conflict with our fundamental rights."

-DR. Babasaheb Ambedkar



KEY FACTS

- **Important works:** The Problem of the Rupee (1923), Annihilation of Caste (1936), What Congress and Gandhi have done to the Untouchables (1945), Who were the Sudras?
- **Key ideas:** Social Justice, Social Democracy, State Socialism, Annihilation of Caste.
- **Impact:** Thoughts and actions of Ambedkar have greater impact in areas like social transformation, Dalit empowerment, women's rights, legal reforms, etc.

QUESTIONS FOR DISCUSSION

- Ambedkar's ideas on Constitutionalism. (2020)
Dr. Ambedkar's ideas of social justice leads to "egalitarian justice" as compared to Rawls' "justice as fairness" which aims at the notion of "pure procedural justice". Comment. (2022)
- Discuss Ambedkar's ideas on 'annihilation of caste'. (2018)
- Comment on: Dr. B. R. Ambedkar's idea of state socialism. (2016)
- Examine Ambedkar's critique of Marxism. (2013)
- Political democracy could not last unless social democracy lay at its base (B.R. Ambedkar). Comment. (2017)

1.

INTRODUCTION: DR. BABASAHEB AMBEDKAR

- Ambedkar, popularly also recognized as Babasaheb was a **great patriot, social-political thinker, educationist, economist and administrator, political reformer, parliamentarian, constitutionalist** of high order and a revivalist for Buddhism in India. He was also the chief architect of the Indian Constitution.
- Ambedkar is one of the foremost thinkers of modern India. His thought is centrally concerned with issues of **freedom, human equality, democracy, and socio-political emancipation**. He is a unique thinker of the world who himself suffered much humiliation, poverty, and social stigma, right from his childhood, yet he rose to great educational and philosophical heights.

- He made a representation before the **Southborough Committee** that preceded the **Montague-Chelmsford Reforms of 1919** and pleaded for separate representation to the depressed classes.
- He started **Mooknayak**, a fortnightly in Marathi in January 1920 and played a leading role in the first All-India Conference of Depressed Classes (1920).
- He formed the **Bahishkrit Hitkarini Sabha (Depressed Classes Welfare Association)** in 1924. He led the famous Satyagraha at Chowdar Tank in Mahad demanding rights for untouchables from common water tank, from which they were hitherto barred, eventually leading to the burning of the **Manusmriti**.
- He started the fortnightly journal **Bahishkrit Bharat** in Marathi and formed two organisations, **Samaj Samata Sangh and Samata Sainik Dal** in 1927 to reinforce the demand for equality of the depressed classes.
- He led the **Satyagraha at Kalaram Temple**, Nasik demanding temple entry to untouchables in 1930. In the same year, he presided over the **First All India Depressed Classes Congress**, held in Nagpur.

2. CONTEXT OF HIS IDEAS

- **Discrimination:** Since people did not approach Ambedkar for his services as lawyer, he realised that even after the economic and educational empowerment; situation of Dalits will not improve.
- **Annihilation of caste:** In this major work, Ambedkar recommended to end Brahminism by putting dynamite on Vedas and Smritis for improving the situation of Dalits.
- **Disillusionment:** Initially he thought educational empowerment would end misery of Dalits. So, he organised Mahad Satyagraha for assertion of rights of Dalits to use water from the Chowdar Tank which was opposed by Hindus. Ambedkar was sad that he didn't get even the support of Gandhi for his Satyagraha.

3. GANDHI AND AMBEDKAR DEBATE (AROUND VARNA SYSTEM)

Ambedkar did not trust Gandhi's commitment towards untouchables, even he advised Dalits not to join the Harijan Sevan Sangh formed by Gandhi.

Gandhi	Ambedkar
He justified the concept of Varna System to build the mass movement or not to alienate upper caste Hindus and to show that Indian tradition was superior to that of British .	He believed that Varna system is the root cause for exploitation of Dalits and it has no scientific basis. Both of them uphold graded inequality and subscribe to the doctrine of birth rather than worth .
Varna system is division of labour (secular concept). But he did criticise the caste system as non-essential feature of Hinduism.	Ambedkar believed that there is no difference between varna system and caste . Varna means division of labourer (not division of labour).
Gandhi believed in no need of conversion of Dalits. For upliftment, he set up Harijan Sevak Sangh .	He believed that upliftment of Dalits is not possible within the fold of Hinduism as it is nothing but caste system.
Approach of Gandhi- Idealistic to Pragmatic .	Ambedkar's approach was more realistic .

4. AMBEDKAR'S CRITIQUE OF HINDUISM

- **Evolution of religion:** Ambedkar traced the religious evolution in early India i.e., **Vedic Society which got degenerated into Aryan society**. The **rise of Buddhism** and consequent social and moral transformation/ counterrevolution manifested into development of a specific ideological and political expression which he termed Brahmanism. Hinduism aims to establish the dominance of Brahmanism.
- **Madness, not religion:** Hinduism is not a religion, but madness because the religion compels the poor to remain poor/ ignorant to remain poor/ ignorant and it allows the people to touch cow dung but not fellow human being.
- **Justification of religious tenets:** The avatars of Hinduism, such as Ratna and Krishna, cannot be held up for adulation as exemplaries. He saw the **Bhagavadgita** as primarily putting forward a set of arguments to save Brahmanism in the wake of the rise of Buddhism.

- **Doctrine of purity and pollution:** Basis of Hinduism is rooted in criteria of purity and pollution which is neither logical nor scientific. It creates a **system of graded inequality and hierarchy**. Essentials practices that reinforce the criteria of purity and pollution: Vegetarianism and Endogamy.

Ambedkar against Endogamy: Through his anthropological and scientific study, he tried to explode the myth of purity and blood. He argued that even before emergence of Hinduism or Brahmanism, there has been intermingling of blood.

5.

AMBEDKAR ON ORIGIN OF SHUDRAS

He held that Shudras were Kshatriyas who rejected the domination of Brahmins and therefore Brahmins had stopped the practice of **Upanayan Sanskara (for upper castes)**. The term shudras came from the **King Shudarak**. The successors of Shudarak were called as shudras and considered as polluted because they develop enmity with Brahmins.

UNOUTCHABLES

- Ambedkar proposed a very imaginative thesis that untouchables were broken men living on the outskirts of village communities who, due to their **refusal to give up Buddhism and beef-eating**, came to be condemned as untouchables.
- Ambedkar objected for using the term HARIJANS (children of God) for members of SC Community. The word is misinterpretation and held that real word is **Dalits or depraved class**.

6.

AMBEDKAR ON SOCIAL JUSTICE

- **Ambedkar's State Theory:** Ambedkar was the first major theoretician in India who argued that consideration for the disadvantaged should be the constitutive basis of a state if the state is committed to the upholding of rights. Untouchability was only one of the great social disadvantages.

So, a set of positive measures are a better guarantee than merely the moral conscience of society although the latter is a prerequisite to sustain such measures in the longer run.

MEASURES	DESCRIPTION
Political Representation	➤ To ensure the political presence of disadvantaged groups. ➤ The concerned groups can undertake their pursuits of development, preservation, or reproduction, as the case may be, by themselves.
Constitutional Measures	➤ He envisaged definitive constitutional measures for the purpose rather than merely rely on public conscience. ➤ He also sought reservation in public employment to the extent they fulfil the requirement for such employment.
Developmental and welfare measures	➤ He sought extensive supportive policy measures towards these groups to extend to them the benefits of various developmental and welfare measures that a state undertakes.

Ambedkar saw preferential measures as resting on an inclusive conception of rights rather than merely the **goodwill** or **benevolence** of the majority. In fact, goodwill itself needs to be cultivated with an awareness of such rights.

In the absence of such cultivation, goodwill and benevolence often collapse into narrow pursuit of interests masquerading themselves in the language of altruism.

7.

AMBEDKAR'S STATE SOCIALISM

Ambedkar's state socialism emphasized pragmatic solutions tailored to India's socio-economic context, advocating for the nationalization of land and industries, rapid industrialization, and collectivization of

farms to address productivity and inequality, distinct from Marxist theory and the Soviet model.

Key features of Ambedkar's State Socialism are discussed below:

- **End of discrimination:** Discrimination is a culprit of the spirit of socialism. His main aim was to destroy all kinds of social discriminations. As a socialist, he advocated abolition of all kinds of social discriminations. The depressed classes would enjoy all the **fundamental rights**.
- **Classless and casteless society:** His State Socialism envisages a classless and casteless society. Individual welfare, morality and justice are the basic postulates of Ambedkar's State Socialism.
- **Ownership of state:** As an economist, he propagated that the **state is the owner of the land. To him, the basic industries should be state monopolies**. He thought that the state socialism can be achieved by state control over land, industries, religions, caste and through an elaborate scheme of constitutional method.
- **Larger role of state:** According to Ambedkar, caste consciousness hampers all economic systems. He suggested **nationalisation of life insurance and advocated state management and state ownership in industry** for the benefit of the poor and down-trodden classes.
- **Right to equal opportunity:** The concept of state socialism is based on the principles of justice, liberty, equality, and fraternity. To him, men are different from each other due to their birth, mental ability and faculty, hereditary and social atmosphere, but they should have right to equal opportunities through the constitutional method.
- **Public sector:** To promote rapid economic development through creation and expansion of infrastructure, promote redistribution of income and wealth, to create more employment opportunities, promote financial resources, to promote small-scale industries etc. are the objectives of the public sector or state-owned industries.
- **Land Reforms:** Being the owner of the land, it is the duty of the state to redistribute the land to those people who are poor farmers of the society. He wanted to abolish the Zamindars system.

8.

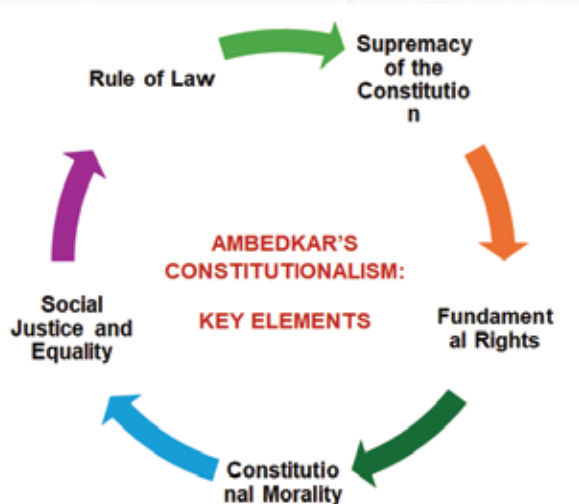
MARXIAN SOCIALISM AND AMBEDKARITE SOCIALISM

Both were very much concerned about the problems of the exploitation of humanity.

Marxian Socialism	Ambedkarite Socialism
1. The history of all hitherto existing society is the history of class struggle.	1. Indian history is obviously the history of caste and communal struggle.
2. The Scientific Socialism propounded by Marx based on class-struggle.	2. State Socialism of Ambedkar is based on peaceful and Constitutional method of law.
3. Marx was very much concerned about the problems of the proletariat class in European countries.	3. Ambedkar's main concern was about the problems of the down-trodden classes in India.
4. Marx's conception of socialism is based on stateless because he wanted to abolish the state as an instrument of exploitation. To him, the state will wither away.	4. Ambedkar's conception of socialism does not recognise the abolition of state.
5. Marx's opinion was that the problem of the proletariat is economic .	5. The problem of the Depressed Classes political, economical as well as social.
6. For Marx, the religion is opium. Marx believed in atheism.	6. Ambedkar did not believe in Hindu religion and denounced it. He embraced Buddhism because to him the Buddhism is basically rational based on liberty, equality, and fraternity.
7. The state is an instrument to exploit the oppressed classes.	7. Ambedkar believed in State as an instrument of social change and social welfare.
8. Marx wanted to establish communism through violent overthrow of state .	8. Ambedkar wanted to achieve socialism by peaceful constitutional methods .

9. CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE OF AMBEDKAR'S THOUGHTS

- Social Justice:** Ambedkar's foremost concern was social justice and the upliftment of marginalized sections of society, particularly the Dalits. His emphasis on equal rights, access to education, and the elimination of social barriers continues to inspire movements and policies aimed at achieving a more equitable society.
- Equality and Human Rights:** He emphasized the importance of individual **liberty, fundamental rights**, and the **protection** of minority communities. His vision of a just and inclusive society guides ongoing efforts to address discrimination, empower marginalized groups, and protect the rights of all citizens.
- Education and Empowerment:** His thoughts on education as a **means of empowerment and social progress** continue to guide initiatives aimed at improving access to quality education and skill development in India.
- Constitutional Framework:** His ideas on **constitutionalism, federalism, rule of law, constitutional morality, and the separation of powers** provided the framework for India's governance system and continue to shape India's legal and political discourse.
- Women's Rights:** His efforts to **secure equal rights and opportunities** for women, including the right to vote and access to education, paved the way for ongoing women's empowerment movements and the push for gender equity in India.



10. CRITICAL EVALUATION OF AMBEDKAR'S THOUGHTS

Ambedkar has often been portrayed as a leader who upheld the partisan cause of the untouchables. He was of course partisan, and he upheld the cause of the untouchables as the most disadvantaged and reviled segment of the Indian society. But such partisanship and advocacy were grounded on a body of thought and ideas built on defensible arguments which he very ably and effectively deployed.

Ambedkar is also treated as the leader of the community rather than a nation. This controversy goes to the extent that right wing intellectual in his book **"Worshipping False God"** held that Ambedkar was anti-national.

His basic framework of social justice is grounded in critique of Hinduism which can also be termed as **Ambedkarvad or counter-hegemony of Brahmanism**.

MANABENDRA NATH ROY (1887–1954): JOURNEY FROM MARXISM TO HUMANISM

"Freedom is the most important factor for the preservation of human dignity, the exercise of freedom leads to progress."

–MN Roy



KEY FACTS

- Methodology:** blend of Marxist analysis, empirical observation, rationalism, and critical thinking.
- Known for:** Founder of Communist Party in India and Mexico, Radical Humanism.

Key ideas: Radical Humanism and Radical Democracy.
- Impact:** As a communist, he laid strong foundation for leftist movement and politics in India. He also influenced debates on socialism and alternative economic systems.

QUESTIONS FOR DISCUSSION

- Comment on the Marxist and Radical Humanist phases of M.N. Roy's thought. (2012)
- Analyse M. N Roys ideational journey from Marxism to Radical Humanism. (2002)
- What are the major components of Modern Indian Political Thought? Examine then with reference to Gandhi and M N Roy. (2001)

1. INTRODUCTION: MN ROY

- Manabendra Nath Roy was an **Indian revolutionary, radical activist and political theorist**, as well as a **noted philosopher** in the 20th century. Roy was a founder of the Mexican Communist Party and the Communist Party of India. He was also a delegate to congresses of the Communist International and Russia's aide to China.
- He reformulated the **Marxian philosophy** in such a way that it appears as a philosophy of freedom. Roy was inspired by Marx's original humanism and by his social goal. He considered Marx as essentially a humanist and lover of human freedom.
- Sudipto Kaviraj** calls MN Roy as a **remarkable failure**.

2. IDEATIONAL JOURNEY OF MN ROY

- Ideational journey means evolution and transition in the ideas of MN Roy. He passed through three phases of development of his ideas – **Nationalism (Revolutionary)** (up to 1915), **Marxism** (1915–1946), and **Radical Humanism** (1946–1954).

PHASE	DESCRIPTION
Revolutionary/ Nationalist	- He was influenced by Jatin Das. - He thought of bringing independence through violent means.

Marxist/ Communist	- From 1920s – 1930s, we see transition in his ideas. - MN Roy turned Marxist. - MN Roy emerged as a critique of Gandhi.
Nationalist (Became member of INC)	- He became admirer of Gandhi. - He acknowledged Gandhi's program did help the masses in raising consciousness. - He emerged as critic of Marx.
Radical Humanist	He believed Radical Humanism as philosophy can only give true freedom to human beings.

A. MN ROY AS MARXIST (2nd PHASE OF IDEATIONAL JOURNEY)

- CONTEXT:** MN Roy was dissatisfied with the INC and its vision towards addressing the concerns of the poor. So, he got influenced by the ideas of Karl Marx.
- CONSCIOUSNESS:** Like Marx, Roy regarded the **physical being of man in constant relationship with nature**, wherein man plays an active role. He was also inspired by Marx's basic doctrine "existence determines consciousness".
- LEADERSHIP ROLE:** MN Roy also became the founding member of the Communist Party of Mexico and later the Communist Movement of India.
- CRITIC OF GANDHI:** During 1920s, MN Roy emerged as **critic of Gandhi (Mascot of Bourgeoisie class)** and called INC as party for Bourgeoisie (not masses). He also called Gandhi as a leader with medieval outlook (for **minimalist approach and promoting Khadi**). He was also against Gandhi's approach of mixing religion with politics.

CRITICISM BY SUDIPTO KAVIRAJ: Kaviraj criticises MN Roy for committing **guilt of heteronomy**.

"I have never been an orthodox Marxist. My attitude to Marxism was critical from the very beginning".

–MN Roy

MN ROY'S CRITICISM OF MARXISM

Context: Debate with Lenin at Communist Internationale.

It proved to be a turning point where he became the critic of Marx, and he shifted toward radical humanism.

Lenin's arguments	Roy's arguments
Lenin suggested that we should go for 2 stage revolution. ➤ 1st stage: We should support the national movement led by the bourgeoisie party (ex-INC in India). ➤ 2nd stage: After ousting of imperialist forces, we can go for the communist revolution. (Lenin believed that workers are not ready for the revolution).	➤ Against Lenin, Roy held that masses in India are sufficiently aware/ conscious. There is no need to support the bourgeoisie party and Marx was against the nationalism also. ➤ Roy also believed that INC would join imperialist forces and betray the masses. ➤ Thus, we can go for a single and straight revolution.

- **HISTORICAL MATERIALISM:** MN Roy argued that changes in history are not alone due to economic factors. Marx has ignored the role of ideas in shaping history.
- **CLASS STRUGGLE:** Marx says that history moves with the class struggle whereas MN Roy held that along with class struggle, class cooperation also shapes the history.
- **SURPLUS VALUE:** On contrary to Marxist argument that surplus value is result of exploitation of workers, Roy held that with equitable distribution of surplus value, exploitation can be minimised.
- **REVOLUTION:** In place of single revolution, Roy suggests for the mental revolution first.

Thus, it can be concluded that Roy suggests going for the Humanist Interpretation of Marxism i.e. giving centrality to human beings in shaping the history.

B. MN ROY AS NATIONALIST- MEMBER OF INC (3rd PHASE OF IDEATIONAL JOURNEY)

- After joining Indian National Congress, MN Roy became an admirer of Gandhi. He acknowledged Gandhi programme did play important role in raising consciousness among the masses.
- He thought that instead of challenging Congress from outside, he will try to radicalise INC from within. Consequently, he founded a league of Radical Congressmen.

C. MN ROY ON RADICAL HUMANISM/ NEW HUMANISM (4th PHASE OF IDEATIONAL JOURNEY)

Humanism is an attitude which attaches primary importance to Man and his faculties, affairs and aspirations. **The essence of Humanism is the importance placed on human being.** It is a philosophy of freedom, which aims at giving freedom to human.

The central purpose of Roy's Radical Humanism is to coordinate the philosophy of nature with social philosophy and ethics in a monistic system. "It is for this reason that Roy claims it as humanist as well as materialist, naturalist as well as nationalist, creativist as well as determinist".

THE MANIFESTO OF RADICAL HUMANISM

"The ideal of Radical Democracy will be attained through the collective efforts of spiritually free men and women united in a political party with the determination of creating a new order of freedom".

The members of the party will be guides, friends and philosophers of the people rather than as there would be rulers consistent with the goal of freedom; Political practice of the party will be rational and ethical.

α. PRINCIPLES/ FEATURES OF RADICAL/ NEW HUMANISM

- **FREEDOM AS PURPOSE:** Roy describes his philosophy as philosophy of freedom. Freedom of man is not just the political freedom, but freedom in actual sense means freedom from all sorts of fear including supernatural forces or superstitions. And this can be achieved only with development of science and scientific spirit.

- **INDIVIDUALISM:** As a radical humanist, his philosophical approach is individualistic. The individual could not be subordinated either to a nation or to a class.
- **BASIS OF SOCIAL ORDER:** Roy's aim of radical humanism is to establish a social order which is based on the scientific understanding of nature.
- **MEANING OF RADICAL:** Radical humanism treats human being in original or radical sense. He held that neither any philosophy nor parliamentary or liberal democracy gives scope for true liberation of man.
- **ROLE OF EDUCATION:** As a radical humanist, Roy came to believe that a revolution should be brought about not through class struggle or armed violence, but through education

"It is the man who creates society, state and other illustrations and values for his own welfare. Man has the power to change them for its greater welfare and convenience. His belief lies in 'Man as the measure of everything'".

-MN Roy

Freedom	Reason	Ethics
➤ Roy views freedom as existentialist i.e. man should be free in making his own choices. ➤ It also means liberation of man from necessities as well as superstitions.	➤ Man develops reason during his struggle for survival. ➤ Reason is the only sanction for morality, without moral men, there can be no moral society.	➤ Ethics are materialistic in origin and not spiritualistic in origin. ➤ His approach to ethics is utilitarian like Bentham.

Based on these principles of Radical Humanism, MN Roy proposed a social order which he calls as **Radical Democracy**.

b. WHAT IS RADICAL DEMOCRACY?

Radical democracy is a kind of **grassroot democracy**. Such an organisation of society can unfold ample opportunity for man, it will replace the executive power of the state under the control of free individuals. It gives opportunity to the people **for direct participation in governance and law making**.

The ideal of radical democracy will be attained through **the collective efforts of spiritually free men** united in the determination of creating a world of freedom.

3. CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE

- **HUMANISM AND RATIONALISM:** Roy argued for the primacy of **reason, critical thinking, and scientific inquiry** in guiding social and political transformations (**overcoming superstitions, caste/ religion-based politics and violence, etc.**). His commitment to rationality and humanistic values resonates with contemporary discussions on ethics, social progress, and the role of reason in public discourse.
- **CRITIQUE OF CAPITALISM:** The widening wealth gap, economic inequality, and issues such as corporate influence on politics continue to be major concerns in societies across the globe (**Oxfam Report**). Roy's ideas on the need for economic democracy and social ownership offer alternative perspectives for addressing these challenges.
- **GRASSROOT DEMOCRACY:** Despite adopting 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Acts, the substantive grassroot democracy remains a distant dream. Thus, **Radical Democracy remains** quite relevant which aims at taking the democracy at the doorstep of the people.

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4.

CONCLUDING REMARK

We live in an age where production is sumptuous, but distribution is partial; where science has conquered irrationality, but religion is propagating myths and superstitions where technology has brought humanity closer, but nationalism is instigating wars and terrorism.

In such a situation Roy's principle of ethical-politics and rational-social morality appears to be the only solution for the salvation of human strife.

"Spiritually free individuals at the helm of affairs will smash all chains of slavery and usher of freedom of all".

-MN Roy



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UNIT 10: WESTERN POLITICAL THOUGHT

SOCRATES (469-399 BCE)

THE ONLY TRUE WISDOM IS IN KNOWING YOU KNOW NOTHING." (SOCRATES)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ▶ "A system of morality which is based on relative emotional values is a mere illusion, a thoroughly vulgar conception which has nothing sound in it and nothing true." – Socrates
- ▶ "An unexamined life is not worth living." – Socrates

1. INTRODUCTION

Socrates was considered as **Wisest Man on Earth** because he accepted that "he knew nothing" or "he is ignorant". He is also called **THE FATHER OF ETHICS AND FATHER OF PHILOSOPHY**.

CONTRIBUTION OF SOCRATES

- ▶ He invented the methodology of **DIALECTICS**.
- ▶ The biggest contribution of him is **Theory of Knowledge**.

2. IMPORTANT QUOTES BY SOCRATES

- ▶ Knowledge is Virtue.
- ▶ Unexamined life is not worth living for a human being.
- ▶ In 399 BCE the Athenian democracy charged the philosopher Socrates with impiety and corrupting the youth of Athens. When he was asked to choose between escaping the state and drinking Hemlock (poison), he preferred to drink poison rather than escaping.

3. WHY DID SOCRATES CHOOSE HEMLOCK OVER ESCAPING THE STATE?

Because Socrates wanted to show that "life carries no meaning if we cannot live according to the ideas we subscribe to". He wanted to give the message that it is the duty of all citizens to obey the orders of the state even when it appears against our interests.

The state's action may appear against our interest because we may be ignorant.

4. BEGINNING OF PHILOSOPHY

Before Socrates, scholars were trying to understand the physical properties of the Universe. Some believed that everything in the Universe is made up of water or fire.

It was Socrates who believed that it is not enough to know what constitutes life, but it is more important to understand what constitutes "Good Life".

5. "KNOWLEDGE IS VIRTUE"

The above statement of Socrates forms the base of Socratic thought. According to him, the objective of life is to lead a Good Life. And to lead a good life, we should have the knowledge of a good life.

WHAT IS THE SOURCE OF KNOWLEDGE?

According to Socrates, the true source of ultimate knowledge is within us. Our soul is the ultimate guide. Our soul can guide us to avoid dilemma between what to do and what not to do.

HOW TO LISTEN TO THE VOICE OF SOUL?

Socrates proposed the methodology of **DIALECTICS** to listen to the voice of soul. Dialectics can be called a method of **logical reasoning**. It involves engaging people in the debates to understand the limitations of one's arguments and to correct oneself in a logical manner.

CATEGORIZATION OF KNOWLEDGE INTO TWO TYPES:

1. **Illusion of knowledge or Ignorance:** Socrates calls it opinions or beliefs, not knowledge. It is shakable.
2. **Conceptual knowledge:** It is unshakable as it is product of Dialectics. Through dialectics, our opinions or beliefs are transformed into true knowledge.

Hence, Socrates suggests- **An unexamined life is not worth living**. By this Socrates means that it is important to critically examine our beliefs, so that we are able to lead a good life in real sense. Thus, he equates true knowledge with virtue and believes that knowledge is a precondition for good life.

6. CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE

Inhuman practices: The idea is relevant in Indian context where many **outdated and inhuman customs and traditions** are still prevalent (for instance—superstitions, animal sacrifice, gender discrimination, etc.). When these customs are subjected to critical examination and reject them on a logical and rational basis, we can move on the path of social progress.

Relevance of Dialectics: The **foundation of Parliamentary Democracy** is based on debates and discussions. However, today the parliaments have become houses of disruption and legislations are passed without debates. Thus, Socratic methodology of Dialectics has great relevance for the democracies and governance.

7. IMPORTANCE OF SOCRATIC IDEAS

The Socratic theory of knowledge provided the foundation for Plato's political philosophy and justification for Rule of Philosopher King.

PLATO (427-347 BCE): JUSTICE AND REASON

"The Book (Republic) may be regarded as not only as a philosophical work, but as a treatise on social and political reform. It is written in the spirit of a man not merely reflecting on human life but intensely anxious to reform and revolutionise it." (Nettleship)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ◆ Explain Aristotle's critique of Plato's Idealism. (2019)
- ◆ Plato was an enemy of open society. Comment. (2015)
- ◆ Comment on: Western thought, one might say, has been either platonic or anti platonic but hardly ever non-platonic (Popper). (2009)
- ◆ Comment on: State is individual writ large. (2006)
- ◆ Comment on: Until philosophers are kings. Or kings and princes of this world have the spirit and power of philosophy, cities will never have rest from evil. (Plato) (2000)

ABOUT PLATO: KEY FACTS

- ◆ Plato (428/427 – 348/347 BCE), a Greek philosopher, is one of the most creative influential thinkers in political philosophy.
- ◆ He is known as the **Father of Political Philosophy and Founder of Philosophical Idealism**. He believed that there is a universal idea in the world of eternal reality beyond the world of the senses.
- ◆ In the entire history of political thought, no thinker evoked the admiration, reverence, and criticism that Plato did.
- ◆ **Major Works:** The Republic, The Statesman, The laws.

1. INTRODUCTION

- ◆ He was the first to formulate and define political ideas within a larger framework of a philosophical idea of Good. He was concerned about **human life and human soul or human nature**. He has been praised for his **denunciation of materialism and brutish selfishness**.
- ◆ Both **Voltaire and Nietzsche** characterized Platonism as the intellectual side of Christianity. John **Ruskin and William Morris** were attracted by Plato's concern for human perfection and excellence.

LIFE AND TIMES OF PLATO

- ◆ Plato, an aristocrat by both birth and temperament. Plato met Socrates in 407 BC at the age of 20 and since then was under his hypnotic spell.
- ◆ As a young man, Plato had political ambitions, but he became a disciple of Socrates, accepting his basic philosophy and dialectics i.e., the pursuit of truth through discussions and dialogues.
- ◆ The trial and execution of Socrates in 399 BC proved to be a turning point in Plato's life.

In 388 BC, Plato, after his return to Athens, founded the Academy, the institution often described as the first European University.

2. QUICK POINTS TO REMEMBER

MAJOR CONTRIBUTIONS OF PLATO

1. PLATO AS FATHER OF POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY



He was the first person to describe what constitutes an ideal **state and good political life, what is the idea behind the state and what are the ethics for the political class.**

2. THEORY OF PHILOSOPHER KING

According to him that state is ideal where philosophers are rulers. In words of Plato, ***“Until philosophers are the rulers or rulers learn the philosophy, there is no end to the predicament of huma life”.***

3. POLITICAL IDEALISM (CONTEXT- DEFEAT OF ATHENS FROM THE HANDS OF SPARTA)

- Ideal is real.
- Whole is prior to part (State is superior to individual).
- No concept of rights, only duties.
- No separation between ethics and politics.

4. INFLUENCE OF SOCRATES ON PLATO: METHODOLOGY

- “All that is Platonic is Socratic”.
- Plato’s methodology- Dialectics (all is written in the form of dialogues where Socrates is the main character).

5. INFLUENCES ON PLATO

- **Pythagoras:** The entire universe is based on mathematical principles.
- **Heraclitus:** Change is the characteristic of the world.
- **Parmenides:** Along with change, permanence is also the characteristic of the world.

3.

PLATO’S THEORY OF IDEA: REALITY IS SHADOW OF IDEAS

- **Theory of Idea:** The statement comes from Plato’s “theory of ideas” where he explains the nature of reality. He believes that idea is ultimate reality.
- **Context of the theory of idea:** poor state of Athens because of the ignorant ruling class.
- **Basis of theory of idea:** Socrates’ theory of knowledge (real knowledge is conceptual and can’t be challenges).
- **Matter vs Idea:** Plato believed that idea is real, and matter is rhetoric. And Plato proved it by using

methodology of Dialectics (matter is antithesis and idea is synthesis). Idea is perfect manifestation and belongs to the world of permanence (world of God).

- **Allegory of Cave:** Deep within the cave, the vision is restricted, and people could see only shadows which they believe them as reality. Once people escape from the cave, they come out of illusion and see the real world.

Thus, Plato wants to teach the ruling class true meaning of reality and true happiness.

Contemporary Relevance

Kautilya’s Arthashastra: “In the happiness of the subjects lies the happiness of the King” (good governance).

Role of Executives: The Executives must rule in the public interest and not self-interest. And the ruling class must adopt the qualities of Philosopher King.

4.

THEORY OF JUSTICE

The concept of justice is the most important principle of Plato’s political philosophy. The sub-title of the Republic, ‘Concerning Justice’ shows the extraordinary importance which Plato attached to justice.

The **sub-title of the Republic- “Concerning Justice”** shows the extraordinary importance which Plato attached to justice.

John Rawls: “Justice is the first virtue of the social system, just like truth is the first virtue of any system of thought”. Thus, justice is considered as a precondition for harmonious co-existence.

Four cardinal virtues of ideal state: Wisdom, Courage, Temperance, and Justice.

THREE PRINCIPLES AS FOUNDATION OF JUSTICE:

- **Functional specialisation-** as per capacity and merit (Departmental excellence).
- **Non-interference in other’s duties-** prerequisite for unity and welfare.
- **Harmony and interdependence-** between three classes representing **wisdom (Men of Gold), courage (Men of Silver), and appetite (Men of Copper).**

According to Plato, **justice does not consist in mere adherence to the laws,** for it is based on the inner

nature of human spirit, it is also to the triumph of the stronger over the weaker, for it protects the weaker against the stronger.

Similarity can be found between Concept of Justice and **Indian concept of Dharma**. It can also be related with Indian system of functional differentiation i.e. **Varna system**.

Prof. Ernest Barker– "Justice for Plato is at once a part of human virtue and the bond which joins men together in the states. It makes man good and make him social".

Prof. Sabine– "Justice is a bond which holds the society together".

STATE IS INDIVIDUAL WRIT LARGE

In literal sense, it means state is a bigger version of the individual. By this statement, Plato means that the nature of state depends on the character of individual. In nutshell, justice found at the level of the state and individual do not differ from each other.

- **Plato's purpose**– to create an ideal state on the foundations of perfect idea of justice or god's idea of justice.
- **Just soul**– is the one in which reason/ wisdom dominates over courage and appetite. And such souls are in perfect peace and harmony with each others.
- **Just state**– similar to the concept of just soul, just state is the one which is governed by the wisest man or philosopher ruler. And all other persons perform their duties according to the spiritual qualities of soul.

CRITICISM OF PLATO'S THEORY OF JUSTICE

- The concept grounded in morality but lacks legal sanction.
- Theory might be applicable in a city state but can't be enforced in modern state or society. The theory **restricts social mobility** (ex- a capable **slave** can't move up the ladder of social structure).
- He creates this notion of one quality being dominant, which is like **Varna System** in India.
- Plato's concept of justice gives **absolute power to one class**– the philosophers, which might lead to autocracy or tyranny of few.
- **Nietzsche**: he criticised Plato for founding a JUST and RIGHTLY ORDERED SOCIETY with the help of a LIE (myth of metals).

Popper: The abuses of the myth far outweighed its uses (Rigid class divisions, anti-humanitarianism and anti-individualism).

5. THEORY OF EDUCATION

Purpose: The theory of Education is linked to the theory of Justice. In just state, every individual has to perform the tasks as per his natural aptitude or spiritual qualities of soul. And in his system of education, there is process of filtration.

NETTLESHIP: "Education in REPUBLIC offered a formula for dividing work and achieving harmonious cooperation".

KLOSKO: "Platonic education is primarily a moulding of souls". Plato looked to education as an instrument of moral reform, for it would mould and transform human souls.

Plato observed the education system of Sparta and Athens, and he was inspired by the Spartan education system.

A. SCHEME OF EDUCATION

Athens	Sparta
➤ Privatised system of education and only rich could afford the education. ➤ Only men were allowed to get education and women were deprived. ➤ Neglect of military education. ➤ No control of state over education.	➤ Education was the responsibility of the state. Education was universal and state sponsored. ➤ There was no discrimination against women. ➤ Military education was mandatory for all. ➤ Education was strictly regulated by the state.

PLATO'S SCHEME OF EDUCATION: PHYSICAL, MENTAL AND SPIRITUAL TRAINING

➤ First stage: Primary education (0-6 years)	➤ Gymnastics for physical development ➤ Music for mental development ➤ Moral stories for character building
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Second stage: Secondary education (6-20 years)	All general subjects and military education
First Filtration Test (At 20 years of age): Whoever pass the test, will be promoted for further education. Rest will join the producer class.	
First stage: Higher Education (21-30 years)	Mathematics, Geometry, Literature
Second Filtration: Those who show aptitude for further learning will be promoted. Rest will join the soldier class.	
Second stage: Higher education (30-35 years)	Dialectics will be taught.
Third stage: Higher education (36-50 years)	15 years of practical training.
- At the age of 50, the person will become eligible for becoming the ruler. According to Plato, who has no lust for power and who is reluctant to govern, will become philosopher ruler/ king. "Those states are best governed where rulers are reluctant to govern".	

B. CRITICISM OF PLATO'S THEORY OF EDUCATION

- Plato's Scheme of education was undemocratically devised in so far as it ignored the producing class completely.
- The Platonic scheme of education will create an ideal philosopher more than an ideal man of action. Plato does not sufficiently realize that education should be relative to the character of the individual.
- Plato's diagnosis is correct, but prescription is wrong. He ignores the basic Human Psychology.
- It is true that those who have lust for power, may be also become corrupt. But at the same time, a person can't perform any task for longer period unless he has interest in the same.

So, we can think of some other legal or institutional accountability measures to deal with corruption of ruling class.

6. PLATO'S THEORY OF COMMUNISM

If Education is primary machinery to create an ideal state, communism is the supplementary machinery. Because the ruling class is the men of reason, and they know what constitutes Good Life.

Plato suggests communism as an additional safeguard, because sometimes in particular situation, appetite may dominate the reason. The purpose is to weed out corruption.

A. FEATURES OF PLATO'S COMMUNISM

- Meant only for Guardian Class (Ruling and Soldiers/ auxiliaries): chances for going corrupt exist.
- Communism of property: Guardian class won't be allowed to own property.
- Communism of family: family relations will result into corruption as well as nepotism. State will regulate the institution of marriage (Eugenic purpose- to create best race). And children will be in the custody of the state (to check nepotism and liberate women from domestic chores and allowing them to contribute to state).

B. CRITICISM OF PLATO'S COMMUNISM

CRITICISM OF COMMUNISM OF PROPERTY

- Motivation: Property acts as a source of motivation and gives sense of achievement. It also acts as a source of charity.
- Propertied class: Those who own property are men of reason and prefer stability.

Hence, Aristotle suggests that it would be inappropriate to deprive ourselves from the virtues of property.

CRITICISM OF COMMUNISM OF FAMILY

- Regressive: Aristotle strongly criticises Plato's prescription as it takes society back to barbaric ages.
- Emotional stability: It is evident that the institution of family is a source of emotional stability.
- Grube and Taylor: They call Plato's prescriptions as abhorrent Principles as they don't take into account the deepest human associations and emotions.

Plato's communism	Modern communism
Plato as idealist: Wants to create ideal state	Marx as materialist: Wants to end the state
Plato expects citizens to sacrifice their interests for the sake of state.	Marx calls for revolution against the state.
Plato's basis of communism is material temptation and its nature is individualist.	Marx' basis is the growth of social evils, which result from the accumulation of private property.
Plato divides the population into three classes.	Marx wants to abolish the classes.
Plato considers idea as ultimate reality.	For Marx, idea is false consciousness.
Plato does not support violence.	Marx supports violent overthrow of state.
Thus, similarities are superficial, and differences are fundamental.	

7. THEORY OF PHILOSOPHER KING

“For, no law or ordinance is mightier than knowledge”.
– Plato

“Until... political power and philosophy come into the same hands... there is no other road to real happiness”. – Sabine

The concept of the philosopher king was first proposed by Plato in his dialogue, the Republic. It refers to a theoretical ruler who combines philosophical knowledge and temperament with political skill and power.

- Linchpin of ideal state:** Philosopher king is a symbol of knowledge and sacrifice. The theory of philosopher king was the linchpin of Plato's ideal state. It was derived from the conviction that philosopher had the knowledge, intellect, and training to govern them.
- Absolute authority:** He will have absolute powers, with no limitations of public opinion or law. But he can't change the constitution of the Republic.

A. CRITICAL EVALUATION OF THEORY OF PHILOSOPHER KING

- Wolin:** “Plato denied participation of average person in politics and decision-making process”.
- Popper:** “Plato rejected popular participation on the grounds that ordinary person lacks capacity to comprehend absolute truth and idea of good. And what if claims of absolute truth are falsified.”
- Aristotle:** “Law is a reason without passion”. Aristotle justified the rule of law over the rule of person. Philosopher King is an utopia and in reality it will become rule of tyranny.

Later, in The Laws, Plato himself modified his views in wake of criticism by Aristotle and re-established the rule of law. Hence, it is said that Aristotle's ideal state (Rule of Law) is Plato's second-best state.

B. CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE

- We should acknowledge the wisdom of the makers of Indian Constitution who didn't approve rule of one person over the rule of law.
- Many countries in the world (like Iran, Russia, etc.) are suffering the consequences (dictatorship) of giving preference to the rule of one person over the rule of law.

8. ASSESSMENT OF PLATO

Plato as first Fascist or Totalitarianism

- Scholars like **Isaiah Berlin** and **Karl Popper** have called Plato as Father of Totalitarianism because he mainly talks about duties and neglected the liberty or individual freedom.
- Plato also advocated unquestionable obedience to the Philosopher Ruler.
- Karl Popper**– Plato attempted to end the dialectics and democratic traditions in Greece. If we don't regard Plato as first fascist, it is because of SPELL OF PLATO.
- However, **Levenson** defends Plato's writings and acknowledge the difference in times and writings of Plato.

Plato as enemy of Open Society (Popper)	▶ Popper's Book (<i>The Open Society and It's Enemies</i>): Calls Plato, Hegel and Marx as enemies of open society. ▶ Three arguments: Essentialism (supreme knowledge), Holism (sacrifices individualism for collectivity) and Historicism (ideological use of history). ▶ Thus, these thinkers rely on myths and present myths as ultimate reality.
Plato as Father of Political Philosophy	▶ Plato is the Father of Political Philosophy ▶ Plato is philosophy and philosophy is Plato. ▶ The entire western philosophy is nothing but the footnotes to Plato and Aristotle. ▶ "One might say, has been either platonic or anti platonic but hardly ever non-platonic". (Popper)
Plato as first feminist	▶ Despite coming from highly patriarchal society, Plato try to remove the disabilities faced by the women in Greece. He advocates for women's access to education and participation in governance. ▶ He makes no gender distinction as to who should be trained as rulers ("guardians") of the state. His scheme of communism takes custody of children which has liberating influence on women. ▶ Criticism- It is argued that the purpose of Plato was to use the talent of women for the service of state. ▶ Julia Annas argues that the Plato's argument in the Republic fails to make adequate case for gender equality.

	▶ According to liberal feminist theorist Susan M. Okin, Plato was in some sense a feminist, but an inadequate one.
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ARISTOTLE IS NOT ONLY THE GREATEST DISCIPLE OF PLATO, BUT GREATEST CRITIQUE OF PLATO

Plato	Aristotle
▶ Father of political Philosophy.	▶ Father of Political Science.
▶ Perfectionist- wants to create ideal state.	▶ Moderate/ Principle of golden mean- wants to establish best practicable state.
▶ Radical/ extreme solutions- abolition of family and property.	▶ Conservative approach- relies on collective wisdom of ages and wants to preserve traditions and customs.

9.

CONCLUSION

Plato is philosophy and philosophy is Plato for out of Plato comes all things that are still written and debated among the men of thought. **(Ralph Waldo Emerson)**

MACHIAVELLI

"It is better to be feared than loved, if you cannot be both." – Machiavelli (The Prince)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Explain how Machiavelli's application of empirical method to human affairs marks an important stage in the evolution of political science. (2014)
- Compare and contrast the views of Kautilya and Machiavelli on Statecraft. (2015)
- Critically examine Machiavelli's views on religion and politics 2020 Machiavelli's secularism. Comment (2018)

KEY FACTS ABOUT MACHIAVELLI

- **Methodology:** empiricist, historical, realist
- **Known for:** "The Prince," his influential treatise on politics and power
- **Key Ideas:** The importance of stability and order in a strong government, the use of deceit and force when necessary to maintain power, the separation of morality and politics
- **Impact:** Considered one of the founders of modern political science; his ideas have influenced political leaders and scholars for centuries. He is often associated with the idea of "Machiavellianism," which refers to the use of cunning and deception in politics.

1. INTRODUCTION

Niccolò Machiavelli, a key figure bridging medieval and modern political thought, was **pivotal in the Renaissance's cultural and intellectual revival**. Known as the **first modern political thinker**, he emphasized empiricism, realism, and the centrality of power. His advocacy for separating ethics from politics and his focus on historical analysis reshaped political theory, offering a new framework for understanding governance and political dynamics.

2. POLITICS AS MANAGEMENT OF POWER

Centrality of Power: Power was central to Machiavelli's political theory. He viewed politics fundamentally as the management of power, focusing on how rulers maintain and exercise authority.

Methodology: Machiavelli's methodology is characterized by empiricism, historical analysis, and realism. His approach to political science marked a significant evolution due to its reliance on empirical observation and real-world evidence.

The Prince: Machiavelli is best known for "The Prince," his seminal work on politics and power. This treatise is influential for its pragmatic advice on governance and power dynamics.

Key Ideas

- **Stability and Order:** Machiavelli emphasized the importance of stability and order for a strong government.
- **Use of Deceit and Force:** He argued that deceit and force may be necessary to maintain power.

Separation of Morality and Politics: Machiavelli advocated for the separation of morality from political strategy.

Views on Governance

- **Stable Authority and Order:** Machiavelli saw stable political authority as essential for social cohesion and moral regeneration.
- **Republican Liberty vs. Tyranny:** While he cherished republican liberty, he was also mindful of the threats posed by tyranny. His work "The Prince" focused on security and unity, while "The Discourses" emphasized liberty and republicanism.

Machiavelli is considered one of the founders of modern political science. His ideas, often associated with "Machiavellianism," have influenced political leaders and scholars for centuries, highlighting the use of cunning and deception in politics.

3. MACHIAVELLI'S VIEWS ON HUMAN NATURE

Machiavelli's views on human nature emphasize self-interest and conflict, shaping his pragmatic approach to effective governance and power management.

- **Inherent Characteristics:** Machiavelli believed individuals are inherently wicked, selfish, and driven by personal gain. He characterized human nature as



restless, ambitious, and prone to constant conflict, with goodness emerging only under compulsion or personal benefit.

- **Historical Perspective and Political Animal:** Machiavelli noted that humans tend to glorify the past, criticize the present, and hope for a better future. He echoed Aristotle's view of the individual as a political animal, driven by antisocial and anarchic tendencies.
- **Self-Interest and Behaviour:** Machiavelli argued that individuals are inherently antisocial, selfish, and greedy. For instance, people might easily forgive personal violence but resent the loss of property. He viewed self-interest as a natural, not sinful, aspect of behaviour.
- **Rulership Advice:** Based on his view of human nature, Machiavelli advised rulers to aim to be feared rather than loved to maintain order and stability. However, he emphasized that a ruler should avoid being hated by not harming property or women and using force only when necessary and justifiable.

CRITICISM OF MACHIAVELLI'S VIEW ON HUMAN NATURE

- **Contextual Limitations:** Sabine criticized Machiavelli for being narrowly dated and context-specific, arguing his ideas reflect only the Italian society of his time.
- **Focus on Selfishness:** Machiavelli's emphasis on selfishness and discord is seen as limited, not accounting for broader or universal social contexts.
- **Inconsistencies:** Machiavelli's belief that individuals prioritize life, family, and property yet might sacrifice family for personal goals reveals inherent inconsistencies.

4.

VIEWS ON CORRUPTION AND CIVIC VIRTUE

- **Causes of Corruption:** Machiavelli attributed corruption to wealth without merit, luxurious habits, and a lack of martial spirit, leading to public value disregard, inequality, and lawlessness.
- **Impact on Political Participation:** Corruption marginalized ordinary citizens from politics and required exceptional measures, such as strong rule by a prince with significant powers, to address it.

- **Role of Civic Virtue:** Machiavelli emphasized public virtue, including patriotism and public-spiritedness, as essential for ending corruption, fostering individual development, protecting freedom, and preventing tyranny.

5.

VIEWS ON RELIGION

- **Secularism and Church Critique:** Machiavelli, often termed the 'father of Western secularism,' criticized the church for failing to provide moral guidance and contributing to Italy's division.
- **Utilitarian Role of Religion:** He saw religion as essential for social and political life, providing divine sanction for rulers' decisions and maintaining discipline, but viewed it strictly as a tool for influence and control.
- **Critique of Christianity:** Machiavelli criticized Christianity for elevating humility over action, viewing it as contrary to his preference for men of action over contemplative figures.

Despite controversial views, Machiavelli's analysis laid the groundwork for modern Western secularism.

6.

MACHIAVELLI'S VIEWS ON STATE

Machiavelli's contributions fundamentally reshaped the concept of political authority and statecraft, laying the groundwork for modern theories of legal sovereignty.

- **Secularism and State Supremacy:** Machiavelli emancipated the state from medieval religious influences, advocating for its supremacy over individuals. He drew from Roman expansionist policies, stressing the importance of territorial growth for the state's survival.
- **Government Preferences:** In "The Discourses," Machiavelli championed republican government for virtuous societies, valuing collective wisdom and political equality. However, in corrupt societies, he endorsed a strong monarchy to preserve stability and the common good, opposing oligarchy.
- **Legacy:** Machiavelli's ideas on secularization, state expansion, and governance provided a foundation for understanding modern state authority. His vision of a united Italy and his advocacy for flexible governance based on societal conditions remain influential in political theory.

Machiavelli's emphasis on state authority, expansion, and adaptive governance underscores his enduring impact on the modern understanding of political stability and sovereignty.

7.

QUALITIES OF A PRINCE ACCORDING TO MACHIAVELLI

Machiavelli's counsel to rulers in "The Prince" offers a pragmatic approach to governance, emphasizing power consolidation and strategic decision-making.

- **Centralization of Power:** Machiavelli advises that the prince must prioritize retaining power solely in his hands, as shared power can be undermined. He cautions against trusting self-interested individuals and advocates for a ruler to be feared rather than loved, given that fear is more controllable and reliable.
- **Dual Qualities:** Echoing Plato, Machiavelli suggests that the prince should embody both the cunning of a fox and the strength of a lion. This combination allows the ruler to navigate complex political landscapes effectively.
- **Rational Decision-Making:** Machiavelli emphasizes the importance of empirical evidence and logical reasoning in political decisions. He advocates for calculated, strategic actions rather than impulsive behaviour, stressing the need to understand timing and context for optimal results.
- **Use of Power:** Machiavelli recommends a blend of hard and soft power. The prince should be prepared to either win over or eliminate opponents, with violence being a last resort. When necessary, violence should be decisive and thorough, ensuring that it prevents any possibility of retaliation.

Machiavelli's guide to rulership centres on effective power management, strategic foresight, and a balanced application of force. His pragmatic approach remains influential in the study of political strategy and leadership.

8. MACHIAVELLI AND POLITICAL REALISM

Machiavelli is celebrated as a pioneering figure in modern political science and a foundational realist in Western political thought.

- **Realist Perspective:** Machiavelli, through "The Prince," is recognized as a central figure in political

realism. His work offers pragmatic advice for rulers, detailing the mechanics of governance, strategies for state strengthening, power expansion, and avoiding decline.

- **Dual Morality:** Machiavelli introduces the concept of "Dual Morality," where the ruler operates beyond conventional law and morality. In his view, the end justifies the means, emphasizing the success of actions in enhancing state power over ethical considerations.
- **Power Politics:** Machiavelli prioritizes power politics, focusing on effective means to achieve political goals rather than adherence to ideals. His realpolitik approach centres on rational choices to expand and consolidate power.
- **Critique:** While influential, Machiavelli's focus on power acquisition often neglects the ethical implications and the relationship between means and ends. His theories, emphasizing practical success over moral constraints, have shaped the realist perspective in political science.

Machiavelli's contributions to political realism highlight a **pragmatic approach** to statecraft, prioritizing effective power management and strategic decisions, albeit with controversial ethical implications.

9.

COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS: MACHIAVELLI AND CHANAKYA ON MONARCHY AND POWER

Despite their different historical and cultural contexts, Machiavelli and Chanakya share notable similarities in their views on monarchy, conquest, and power.

- **Monarchy:** Machiavelli, in "Discourses," acknowledged the benefits of a well-established dictatorship under public law. Chanakya similarly advocated for a king's duty to uphold justice (dharma), promote prosperity (artha), provide enjoyment (kama), and facilitate spiritual growth (moksha).
- **Conquest and Responsibility:** Both thinkers emphasized the significance of conquest. Chanakya viewed war as a duty of the king (Raj dharma), while Machiavelli stressed that a ruler's primary focus should be on war and its strategic management. Both recognized the ruler's responsibility for the security and well-being of the people.
- **Stability and Legitimacy:** Both Chanakya and Machiavelli valued the long-term stability of the

state beyond any single ruler's reign. Chanakya justified monarchy through Hindu cosmology, while Machiavelli used divine authority to legitimize rulers. Their analyses underscore the central role of power in political legitimacy and governance.

Though separated by time and geography, Machiavelli and Chanakya offer strikingly similar insights into the role of power, monarchy, and statecraft, emphasizing the importance of effective governance and stability.

10.

IMPORTANCE OF MACHIAVELLI'S IDEAS IN THE CONTEMPORARY WORLD

- **Realism in Politics:** Machiavelli's focus on the realities of power and pragmatic political decision-making remains pertinent today. His recognition of self-interest and power dynamics provides a framework for understanding modern political behaviour and strategy.
- **Separation of Ethics and Politics:** Machiavelli's challenge to traditional moralistic views underscores that political decisions often transcend moral principles, driven by state interests. This perspective is crucial for navigating the complex ethical dilemmas faced by contemporary leaders.

- **Effective Leadership:** Machiavelli's emphasis on adaptability, rational decision-making, and the strategic use of force and diplomacy continues to inform discussions on leadership and governance. His ideas highlight the importance of these qualities in effective leadership.

- **Realpolitik and International Relations:** Machiavelli's concepts have significantly influenced the field of international relations, particularly through realpolitik. His insights into power dynamics, diplomacy, and the balance of power are central to understanding contemporary international relations.

- **Understanding Political Dynamics:** His analysis of political relationships, power, and stability offers valuable insights into modern political systems. Machiavelli's ideas contribute to a deeper understanding of political strategies and the challenges leaders face today.

Machiavelli's ideas, despite their controversial nature, provide essential perspectives for analysing and navigating the complexities of contemporary politics. They offer a realistic lens for examining power dynamics, leadership, and statecraft in today's world.

THOMAS HOBBS

"Life in the state of nature is solitary, poor, nasty, brutish, and short." (Thomas Hobbes, Leviathan)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- State of Nature as State of War (Hobbes) (2023)
- Individualism is inherent in Hobbes' absolutist ideology. Comment. (2022)
- Hobbesian notion of Political obligation. Comment (2017)
- "How would I and my fellow human beings behave if we were to find ourselves in a state of nature, and what does this behavior tell us about our innate predispositions?" (Hobbes) Comment (2016)
- Comment on the assertion of Laslett that Filmer and not Hobbes was the main antagonist of Locke. (2013)
- "Covenants without swords are but words and of no strength to secure a man at all." (Hobbes) Comment (2013)

1.

BACKGROUND

Background- English philosopher (1588-1679) known for his influential works in political philosophy and social contract theory.

Major Work- "Leviathan" (1651)

Social Contract- Hobbes proposed that individuals enter into a social contract, sacrificing some freedoms to establish a sovereign authority that ensures order and prevents the state of war.

State of Nature- Hobbes' concept of the state of nature depicts humans living in a state of constant conflict, driven by their self-interest and lacking a common authority to maintain peace.

Leviathan- Hobbes used the metaphor of the "Leviathan," a powerful sea creature, to represent the all-powerful sovereign authority necessary to keep society orderly and prevent chaos.

Absolute Sovereignty- Hobbes advocated for absolute sovereignty, arguing that a strong central authority with unlimited power is essential for maintaining social order and preventing societal breakdown.

In narrow sense, democracy is defined as a form of government and in broader sense it is defined as a way of life. The roots of democracy can be traced to the Ancient Greece.

In Ancient Greece, direct democracy was practiced in Athens. Though Aristotle favoured democracy, he considered Polity as the best practicable form of government. For him, democracy is a perverted form of polity.

Influence- Hobbes' ideas have had a significant impact on political theory, influencing concepts of government, authority, and the social contract, and sparking debates that continue to this day.

2.

INTRODUCTION

Hobbes was born prematurely in 1588 in England during a period of great turmoil as the country faced the imminent threat of the Spanish Armada. **He experienced turbulent phases of British history, including the Puritan revolution of 1641 and the Civil War, which plunged the nation into anarchy and a lack of security. As a result, Hobbes' philosophy focused on the importance of order and self-preservation.** He lived during a time of significant constitutional crisis in England, marked by intense debates between advocates of the Divine Right of Kings and proponents of constitutional rule based on popular consent.

His method was deductive and geometrical rather than empirical and experimental.

3.

VIEWs ON HOBBS

According to **Michael Oakeshott**: "The Leviathan is the greatest, perhaps the sole, masterpiece of political philosophy in the English language".

According to **William Ebenstein**, The Leviathan is not an apology for the Stuart monarchy nor a grammar of despotic government but the first general theory of politics in the English language'

According to **Macpherson**, Hobbes was a scholar of bourgeois class. Hobbes was **materialist, utilitarian and greatest of all individualists**. He was the one who gave the **theory of the right to life**.

4.

VIEWs ON HUMAN NATURE

Hobbes' view on human nature is discussed below:



- **Secular Foundations:** Unlike thinkers who relied on divine concepts like the "Idea of Good," Hobbes based his theories on what he saw as the core aspects of human behaviour.
- **Individualism and Self-Interest:** Hobbes disagreed with the prevailing view of humans as inherently social. In his view, individuals were isolated and driven by self-preservation. This self-interest manifested in a constant pursuit of pleasure and avoidance of pain.
- **Motivation by Pleasure and Pain:** Pleasure and pain were the fundamental motivators for Hobbes, pushing people to seek one and avoid the other. Even human will stem from these basic needs, not from any spiritual source.
- **Fear and Power as Driving Forces:** Hobbes believed fear, particularly the fear of death, played a crucial role. This fear, along with the constant drive for power, fuelled human actions.
- **Equality of Potential:** Hobbes saw people as essentially equal in their potential to achieve their goals, with cunning being just as valuable as physical strength.
- **Active and Goal-Oriented Beings:** Despite their self-interest, Hobbes acknowledged humans as active agents, constantly striving and willing.

Thus, Hobbes' view of human nature painted a picture of self-preservation machines, driven by pleasure, pain, and fear, all operating in a world where cunning and power were essential tools for survival.

5. STATE OF NATURE IN HOBBS

According to Hobbes, the state of nature was a condition where individuals were selfish and egoistic. It was a dreadful state characterized by complete liberty and a natural right to everything, including other people's bodies. In this state, there was no room for industry, agriculture, trade, or civilized living. Life was marked by constant fear, danger, and potential warfare among individuals competing for honor, wealth, and authority.

- The principal cause of conflict in the state of nature was rooted within human nature itself. **Three psychological factors—competition, diffidence, and glory—fed the atmosphere of perpetual fear and strife. Power was sought after because it ensured access to resources necessary for survival and provided pleasure and contentment.**

- Mutual suspicion and hostility prevailed, and the only rule individuals recognized was that one would take and retain as long as one had the power to do so.
- In the state of nature, there was no common authority, leading to the absence of distinctions between just and unjust. Without a common superior, there could be no law, and without law, there could be no justice. The state of nature lacked any conception of right and wrong because it lacked a standard of conduct.

HOW CAN AN INDIVIDUAL ESCAPE FROM THE CONDITIONS IN STATE OF NATURE?

Once the wretchedness of the state of nature is recognized, it becomes apparent that action must be taken to alter it. The initial step involves individuals choosing to pursue peace and establishing the necessary arrangements to achieve and maintain it. It becomes evident that the sole means of attaining peace is for each person to relinquish their inherent right to acquire and protect everything by any means they deem necessary.

- According to Hobbes, this endeavour must be a collective one, as it is reasonable for an individual to renounce their right to harm others only if everyone else agrees to do likewise.
- **He calls this collective renunciation of each individual's right to all things the "social contract."** The social contract inverts the state of nature while also building upon some key passions responsible for the state of nature: it amounts to a more intelligent way to preserve oneself and safely acquire goods.

6.

THE FEATURES OF SOCIAL CONTRACT IN HOBBS

The purpose of the contract signed by individuals in the state of nature is to escape the constant warfare between everyone. Hobbes introduces a new interpretation of the social contract, which is an agreement between the ruler and the ruled, in order to establish a commonwealth or state.

- To ensure their escape from the state of nature, people give up their natural rights to everything and, through mutual consent, establish a third party or group of individuals.
- This entity is granted the authority to enforce the contract, use force, and act on behalf of everyone.



Each person enters into an agreement with every other person in the following manner.

He argues "I authorise and give up my right of governing myself to this man or to this assembly of man on the condition that thou give up thy right to him, and authorise all his actions in like manner"

It is clear from the above statement that **no individual can surrender his right to self-preservation. The multitude of conflicting wills is replaced, not by a common will but a single representative will**

- By the transfer of the natural rights to each man, the **recipient becomes their representative and is invested with authority to deliberate**, will and act in place of the deliberation, will and action of each separate man.

According to William Ebenstein Hobbesian, social contract is made between subjects and subjects and not between subjects and sovereign. The sovereign is not a party to the contract, but its creation.

- Contract is irrevocable, men cannot annualize the contract.**
- They cannot repudiate their obligation.**
- Sovereign cannot commit any breach of covenant because he is not a party to it.**

They are also called as normative or philosophical theories, as they emphasize on democratic values such as liberty, equality, dignity, fraternity, etc.

Since they focus on democratic values, they can also be called as substantive model of democracy.

7. WHY ABSOLUTE SOVEREIGNTY IN HOBBS?

To ensure compliance with the social contract, Hobbes argues that there needs to be a visible power that can enforce it and compel individuals to keep their promises. This power serves as a reminder of the purpose of the social contract and in-stills fear of punishment, motivating people to uphold their obligations.

- Establishment of Sovereign Power:** Sovereign power is established when individuals cede their own strength to a single entity, which then holds the authority to enforce obedience and control public opinions.
- Alignment of Individual Will:** Hobbes argues that individual will should align with that of the sovereign,

- as desiring peace logically requires supporting all necessary measures to maintain it.
- Forms and Criteria of Sovereign Power:** The sovereign, or Leviathan, can take various forms such as monarchy, aristocracy, or democracy. The essential criterion is that it possesses absolute power to uphold the social contract and determine necessary actions for its defence.

8. THEORY OF ABSOLUTE SOVEREIGNTY

The core of Hobbes' political philosophy lies in his concept of sovereignty. According to Hobbes, the sovereign power is indivisible, unrestricted, and unable to be transferred or relinquished, and enduring.

- Establishment of State and Government:** The social contract simultaneously establishes both the state and government, granting the sovereign authority to enact legitimate laws.
- Absolute Sovereignty:** Sovereignty is absolute and unbounded, not subject to any conditions, rights of subjects, or customary laws.
- Lawful Authority:** The sovereign, appointed by consent, cannot harm subjects and acts lawfully in creating and interpreting laws.
- Authority and Obedience:** Individuals cannot object to the sovereign's actions as they have granted him complete authority on their behalf.
- Powers of the Sovereign:** The sovereign has full authority to initiate war, establish peace, impose taxes, and enforce punishments.
- Source of Authority:** The sovereign is the ultimate source of all administrative, legislative, and judicial authority, with law being the sovereign's command.
- Protection and Preservation:** The sovereign must protect the people both externally and internally, as peace and preservation are the basis for the sovereign's creation.

Thus, Hobbesian sovereign represents the ultimate, supreme and single authority in the state and there is no right of resistance against him except in case of self-defence.

According to Hobbes, any act of disobedience of a subject is unjust because it is against the covenant. **Covenants without swords are but mere words.** Division or limitation of sovereignty means destruction of sovereignty which means that men are returning to the old state of nature where life will be intolerably miserable.

9.

CRITICISMS OF HOBBSIAN THEORY OF SOVEREIGNTY

Critics have accused Hobbes of being the ideological precursor to totalitarian ideologies such as fascism and communism. However, William Ebenstein refutes these allegations based on the following arguments:

- **Government through Covenant:** Hobbes establishes government through a covenant that transfers all power, which is fundamentally different from the totalitarian regimes of the modern era.
- **State Objectives:** Hobbes' conception of the state aims at maintaining order and security for the well-being of citizens, whereas modern totalitarian states have anti-individualistic and anti-hedonistic objectives.
- **Equality Before Law:** Hobbes' authoritarian state lacks a characteristic feature of modern totalitarianism, namely, inequality before the law and the resulting personal insecurity.
- **Sovereign Form:** Hobbes allows for the sovereign to be either an individual or an assembly of individuals, whereas modern totalitarianism emphasizes the leadership principle and charismatic figures.
- **War and State Formation:** Hobbes acknowledges war as a driving force for the establishment of a state, but he does not glorify war in his work *Leviathan*. In contrast, totalitarian regimes often view war favourably and consider imperialist war as the pinnacle of national life.

As **Prof. Sabine** has rightly pointed out, in **Hobbesian political philosophy both individualism and absolutism go hand in hand**. Granting absolute and unlimited power to the state is, in essence, an attempt to provide a happy and tension free life to the individuals.

10. LAW AS THE COMMAND OF SOVEREIGN

Natural law or customs can only attain the status of Law only when willed and ordained by the sovereign. He brought to completion the process of subordinating the church to the state and swept aside the limitations of Divine Law, of Constitutional law and property rights that Bodin had imposed on his sovereign.

11. LIBERTY IS WHERE, LAW IS SILENT

A citizen is free to act as they please in matters not commanded or forbidden by the sovereign. However, the sovereign's command cannot override the individual's right to self-preservation. If the sovereign orders someone to take their own life, they are not obligated to comply because the purpose of establishing civil society is to preserve life.

CONDITIONS FOR OBEDIENCE TO THE SOVEREIGN

- **Permissible Disobedience:** Disobedience to the sovereign is allowed only if it does not undermine the sovereign's intended purpose. Otherwise, refusal to obey is not permitted, as it leads to a return to the state of nature where concepts of right and wrong dissolve.
- **Obligation and Sovereign Power:** Subjects are obliged to obey the sovereign as long as the sovereign can provide protection. The obligation lasts only while the sovereign effectively ensures security.
- **Right of Self-Protection:** Individuals retain the natural right to self-protection when no external protection is available. This right cannot be surrendered by any covenant. If the sovereign fails to suppress rebellion and the rebels establish a new regime that provides security, the legitimacy of the original sovereign is lost. The new regime, such as that led by Oliver Cromwell, becomes the true commonwealth.
- **Effective Power and Legitimacy:** A government must have effective power to be considered legitimate. Without it, the sovereign's authority is invalidated.

12.

HOBBS AS THE FATHER OF LIBERAL VIEW OF POLITICS

Hobbes's political thought, with its emphasis on the absolute power of the sovereign, may appear contradictory to liberal theory, which focuses on protecting individual rights. However, Hobbes's ideas laid the groundwork for the liberal perspective.

- **On Politics and Individual Rights:** Hobbes argues that politics is driven by individuals' desire for life preservation and possession protection, with government serving these ends. Happiness is the continuous success in obtaining desires. Individuals have no inherent duties to others; obligations arise only as means to personal ends. Even in a

commonwealth, they retain their natural right to self-preservation and are not obligated to submit to capital punishment or likely death in war.

- **Hobbes and Liberalism:** Hobbes's understanding of individual rights is narrower than that of liberal theorists, but he introduces the notion of inviolable natural rights and the idea that politics should support individual happiness. His concept of representative government suggests the government should ensure safety and protection, not rule over citizens.
- **Influence on John Locke:** Locke built upon Hobbes's ideas, developing modern political liberalism. Key elements include the state of nature, consent of the governed, and the political community serving basic needs, particularly property preservation. Locke's ideas influenced the founders of the United States, reflected in the Declaration of Independence and the Constitution.
- **Controversy and Criticism:** Hobbes's political ideas were and remain controversial. Critics argue his focus on self-interest conflicts with Aristotle's belief that politics should address both basic needs and higher ends. They also believe avoiding fundamental questions impedes the pursuit of wisdom, happiness, and excellence.
- **Legacy and Modern Impact:** Supporters argue Hobbes's focus on achievable goals contributes to modern Western security and prosperity, allowing for the pursuit of knowledge and excellence in private life. Studying Hobbes is crucial for understanding the political landscape and framework of the modern world.

13.

CONCLUSION

Hobbes's **view of individual rights is narrower than other liberal theorists**, focusing on natural rights and politics supporting **individual happiness**. His representative government ensures safety, not domination. John Locke expanded on Hobbes, shaping modern political liberalism with ideas like the state of nature and consent of the governed, influencing the **U.S. Declaration of Independence and Constitution**. Hobbes's ideas are controversial, with critics arguing they prioritize self-interest over broader political aims. Supporters contend that Hobbes's focus on achievable goals enhances modern security and prosperity, vital for understanding contemporary politics.

14.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE OF HOBBSIAN IDEAS

- **State of Nature and Social Contract:** Hobbes's concept of the state of nature and the social contract, defining a "war of all against all" and the need for a commonwealth, remains central to discussions on political authority, individual rights, and the balance between security and liberty.
- **Sovereignty and Absolute Power:** His theory of sovereignty, with the sovereign holding absolute power to maintain order, influences debates on executive authority, emergency powers, and government limits, highlighting ongoing concerns about the rule of law.
- **Individualism and Self-Interest:** Hobbes's focus on individual self-interest and personal security shapes discussions on human nature, moral philosophy, and economic theory, impacting contemporary debates on individual rights, ethical egoism, and economic decision-making.
- **Political Legitimacy and Consent:** The idea that political legitimacy derives from the consent of the governed has informed modern democratic theories, contributing to discussions on democracy, representation, and the relationship between citizens and the state.
- **Realism and International Relations:** Hobbes's realist perspective on international relations, emphasizing power, fear, and conflict, continues to influence global politics, diplomacy, and conflict resolution, reflecting the anarchic nature of the international system.

Hobbes's ideas, while critiqued and developed by later thinkers, remain foundational for understanding political philosophy, governance, and social dynamics in modern society.

JOHN LOCKE

"The state of nature has a law of nature to govern it, which obliges everyone: and reason, which is that law, teaches all mankind, who will but consult it, that being all equal and independent, no one ought to harm another in his life, health, liberty, or possessions..."

- John Locke (Two Treatises of Government)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Write on: Locke's Social Contract (2022)
- "Covenants without swords are but words and of no strength to secure a man at all." (Hobbes) Comment (2013)
- Comment on the assertion of Laslett that Filmer and not Hobbes was the main antagonist of Locke.
- Locke is an individualist out and out'. Substantiate this statement. (2012)
- Comment on: "The great and chief aim of men uniting into a Commonwealth and putting themselves under Government is the preservation of property." (Locke) (2008)
- Comment on: The end of law is not an abolition or restrain but to preserve and enlarge freedom (Locke). (2004)
- Comment on: The reason why men enter into civil society is the preservation of their property (Locke). (2003)

1.

INTRODUCTION

John Locke, born in 1632, played a pivotal role in the transformative Revolution of 1688 in England. He is widely recognized as the pioneer of Empiricism, a philosophical standpoint that asserts sense experience as the sole foundation of knowledge.

John Locke is celebrated as the originator of Liberalism and his political philosophy represents a significant milestone in the history of political literature. His contributions to the theory of Natural Rights, the concept of Separation of Powers, and the promotion of toleration are highly influential in the realm of liberalism. Locke's approach focused on specific details rather than abstract concepts.

2.

BACKGROUND

English philosopher and physician, born in 1632, considered as one of the most influential Enlightenment thinkers.

Key ideas: social contract, theory of natural rights, limited government, tabula-rasa, toleration and religious freedom

Major Works:

- "Two Treatises of Government" (1689): Presented his political theories, including natural rights, social contract, and limited government,
- "An Essay Concerning Human Understanding" (1689): Explored the nature of human knowledge, perception, and understanding

Influences:

- Influenced the development of liberal democratic ideals and the concept of individual rights
- His ideas on government and property rights heavily influenced the American Founding Fathers, particularly the drafting of the United States Constitution
- Played a significant role in shaping modern democratic theory and political philosophy

His emphasis on empiricism and the importance of experience influenced subsequent philosophers, psychologists, and educational theorists

3.

'STATE OF NATURE' IN LOCKE

State of Nature: In Locke's framework, the state of nature precedes political society but is not pre-social, as humans are inherently social. It is characterized by "peace, goodwill, mutual assistance, and self-preservation," rather than chaos or conflict.

Inherent Rights: Individuals in the state of nature hold inherent rights to life, liberty, and property, grounded in the Law of Nature, which reflects divine reason. These rights entail a moral obligation to preserve oneself and humanity, provided it does not compromise one's own survival.

Freedom and Equality: In this condition, people are free and equal without a governing authority. Each person acts as their own judge, where liberty is respected but not absolute. Individuals may not harm themselves or others unless it serves a higher purpose beyond self-preservation.

4. WHY DID SOCIAL CONTRACT EMERGE?

Inadequacies of the State of Nature: In the state of nature, individuals are their own judges and possess the power to enforce punishments for violations of natural law. This system, however, is flawed due to:

- **Lack of Established Law:** No universally recognized laws to determine right from wrong.
- **Absence of Impartial Judges:** No neutral authority to resolve disputes.
- **Deficiency in Law Enforcement:** Insufficient power to enforce laws effectively.

Need for a Superior System These shortcomings reveal the need for a more effective system. Although not a state of war, the state of nature is fraught with inconveniences and is not an ideal condition.

Threats of Conflict The self-interested nature of individuals can lead to conflicts and uncertainties, risking a state of war. This jeopardizes the prospect of peace in the state of nature.

Purpose of the Social Contract To address these issues, the social contract aims to establish organized laws and impartial governing institutions, replacing the unpredictability of the state of nature with stability and predictability.

Formation of Government While society is formed through a contractual agreement, government is established through the delegation of trust and fiduciary responsibility, ensuring effective governance and law enforcement.

The social contract addresses the limitations of the state of nature by replacing individual self-judgment with a structured system of laws and impartial governance. It ensures stability and fairness, enhancing societal order and security through delegated power and trust.

5. LOCKE'S IDEA OF CONSENT

- **Role of Consent in Locke's Philosophy:** Locke emphasizes consent as fundamental to forming political societies. In the state of nature, without established authority to create laws or resolve disputes, consent is key to joining and participating in political societies.
- **Membership through Explicit Consent:** Full membership in society is acquired through explicit

consent. While general obligations exist under the law of nature, specific obligations arise only from voluntary agreement.

- **Objection and Tacit Consent:** Scholars debate Locke's theory due to the perceived lack of actual consent to governments. Locke addresses this with the doctrine of tacit consent: residing within a country or traveling across its borders implies consent to its laws and authority.
- **Obligation for Resident Aliens:** Locke argues that resident aliens implicitly consent to obey local laws by living in a country. Property inheritance further strengthens this bond, as it signifies permanent jurisdiction under the commonwealth.

6. LOCKE'S SOCIAL CONTRACT THEORY

Unlike Hobbes, Locke's social contract theory involves two distinct contracts.

- **First Contract:** Locke's social contract theory involves two agreements. The first contract forms civil society through unanimous consent, transferring the right to punish lawbreakers to an impartial authority. Once civil society is established, majority rule governs decisions, reflecting the community's will. Individuals unite and agree to follow the majority opinion.
- **The second contract:** It establishes a government or legislative body tasked with enforcing natural law. This government, as the "supreme" authority, operates with fiduciary powers and can be removed or altered by the people if it fails to fulfil its trust.

Trust and Authority: The relationship between society and government is based on trust. The government, not part of the original contract, operates independently with authority granted by the people. This structure emphasizes the government's fiduciary role.

State of Nature and Government: Locke views the state of nature as a state where individuals are free and equal but bound by natural law to respect each other's rights. People create a commonwealth to resolve conflicts and protect rights. Obedience to government depends on its protection of natural rights, including private property. If the government fails to uphold these rights, it may be overthrown.

7.

CONCEPTION OF STATE IN LOCKE: KEY FEATURES

John Locke asserts that the state exists for the benefit of the individuals who form it. The state's primary purpose is to serve the welfare of the community, emphasizing that it is a human creation designed to meet the needs of its citizens. Locke rejects the idea of attributing a mystical or independent good to the state beyond the lives of its people.

Consent and Legitimacy: A legitimate state, according to Locke, must be founded on the consent of the governed. This requires a constitutional framework where individuals acknowledge and adhere to the rule of law. Political liberty depends on the establishment of standing laws that are known and accessible, as opposed to arbitrary decrees.

Limitations of State Authority: Locke argues that the authority of the state is limited and derived from the people. The state operates within a framework of trust, holding power on behalf of its citizens. It must exist for their well-being, rely on their consent, and be subject to constitutional limitations.

State's Role and Tolerance: Locke's conception of the state is one of tolerance and respect for individual differences. It is a negative state that does not aim to shape the character of its citizens or control their lives. Instead, the state aligns individual selfish interests with the public good, promoting overall societal welfare.

8.

THEORY OF NATURAL RIGHTS AND PROPERTY

According to Locke, individuals in the state of nature have natural rights, including the rights to life, liberty, and property.

- **Basis of Rights:** These rights are based on human reason and the need for self-preservation. The right to property extends to a person's own body and the goods acquired through their labour necessary for self-preservation.
- **Freedom in the State of Nature:** In the state of nature, individuals have the freedom to dispose of their possessions as they see fit, as long as they do not harm themselves or others.
- **Inherent Property Rights:** Property rights are inherent and pre-exist the establishment of government. No government can take away an individual's property without consent. The government's role is to protect people's lives, possessions, and the right to accumulate private property.

Property Acquisition: In the state of nature, property is held in common until individuals mix their labour with it, at which point it becomes their private property.

Macpherson Argued that Locke's views on property made him a bourgeois apologist, a defender of the privileges of the possessing classes.

9.

LOCKE AS AN INDIVIDUALIST

Locke in his writing displays himself as a radical individualist. He explained inalienable natural rights of the individual which can't be removed by the state. **According to Vaughan "Everything in Locke's system revolves around the individual."**

Locke gives utmost significance to the natural right of life, liberty and property. The State was created for the protection of natural rights and happiness of the individual.

10.

CONCEPT OF LIMITED GOVERNMENT IN LOCKE

Foundation of Government: John Locke advocates for a **state with limited sovereignty, opposing political absolutism**. He asserts that a legitimate state is created by the people, governed by a constitution and the rule of law, and its powers are derived from and held in trust by the people.

Limits on Government Power: Unlike Hobbes, Locke rejects absolute and indivisible sovereignty. He supports a government with divided powers and specific limitations:

- **Public Interest:** The government cannot command actions against the public interest.
- **Natural Rights:** It must not violate individuals' inherent natural rights.
- **Arbitrary Governance:** The government cannot rule arbitrarily or impose taxes without consent.
- **Alignment with Natural Law:** Laws must be consistent with natural law and divine principles.
- **Obedience:** A government exceeding these limits forfeits its legitimacy and does not deserve obedience.

Democratic Principles: Locke emphasizes the role of democracy in limiting government power:

➤ **Consent of the Governed:** The government must be based on the consent of the people, with representatives directly elected to ensure this consent.

➤ **Electoral Accountability:** Elected representatives must retain popular support to stay in office, encouraging adherence to legal boundaries.

Legislative Limitations: Locke advocates for restricting legislative power to prevent overreach:

➤ **Frequency of Sessions:** Limiting the duration and frequency of legislative sessions reduces the burden on people and prevents excessive and potentially harmful legislation.

Thus, Locke's theory promotes limited sovereignty, the rejection of legal absolutism in favour of popular sovereignty, and democratic principles as constraints on government power. His approach includes limiting legislative sessions to safeguard against overregulation.

11. SEPARATION OF POWER IN LOCKE

Legislative Power: Locke views legislative power as the supreme authority, responsible for determining how the commonwealth's resources are utilized.

Executive Power: The executive power enforces laws in specific cases.

Federative Power: Locke introduces the federative power, which deals with international actions and natural law violations, allowing countries to punish breaches to protect citizens' rights.

Powers vs. Institutions: Distinction Powers are functions like making or enforcing laws. Institutions may share the same power; for example, Locke's time saw legislative power shared among the House of Commons, the House of Lords, and the King. The executive and federative powers are often vested in the executive, indicating no direct one-to-one correspondence between powers and institutions.

Comparison with Montesquieu: Alignment Montesquieu's division into legislative, executive, and judicial powers aligns with Locke's concepts. Montesquieu also emphasizes the superiority of legislative power, associates executive power with international affairs (similar to Locke's federative power), and regards judicial power for domestic law execution (akin to Locke's executive power).

Locke's Views on Constitutional Design: Mixed Constitutions Locke supports legislative assemblies including elected representatives but allows for monarchical and aristocratic elements. He advocates for "mixed" constitutions incorporating various elements.

Locke's theory **does not prescribe a specific constitution type** or exclude unelected officials from legislative power. His primary concern is ensuring **adequate representation** to prevent liberty infringements and unjust taxation, with the community retaining ultimate authority to "remove or alter" the legislative power as needed.

12.

CONCLUSION

Locke advocates for a legitimate government based on the separation of powers. The legislative power holds ultimate authority, while the executive power enforces the law, and the federative power governs international actions. Powers can be shared among multiple institutions, and the people have the freedom to create mixed constitutions that combine different elements of governance. Montesquieu's later ideas align with Locke's formulation, emphasizing the legislative power's superiority and describing the executive and judicial powers in similar terms.

JOHN STUART MILL

"A person may cause evil to others not only by his actions but by his inaction, and in either case he is justly accountable to them for the injury."

- JS MILL (On Liberty)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Comment on: "All silencing of discussion is an assumption of infallibility." (J.S. Mill) (2014)
- Comment on: John Stuart Mill is a 'reluctant democrat'. - C. L. Wayper (2018)
- JS Mill's idea on Women suffrage (2021)

1.

INTRODUCTION

John Stuart Mill (1806-1873) was a highly influential political philosopher in the 19th century. His political theories marked a shift in liberalism, moving from a



hands-off approach by the state to a more active role, redefining liberty from a negative to a positive concept, and recognizing the importance of social interconnectedness in individuality.

While Mill was a liberal, he could also be regarded, at the same time, as a **reluctant democrat, a pluralist, a cooperative socialist, an elitist and a feminist.**

He also **replaced the quantitative approach of Bentham by a qualitative one.**

2. BACKGROUND

- **Key Ideas:** Utilitarianism, Harm Principle, Liberty, Representative Government.
- **Influences:** Jeremy Bentham, David Ricardo, William Wordsworth.
- **Notable Works:** "On Liberty," "Utilitarianism," "The Subjection of Women".
- **Contribution:** Advocated for individual liberty, free speech, and the principle of utility for societal decision-making. Criticized social and political oppression, championed women's rights, and called for representative government.

3. BENTHAM AS FATHER OF UTILITARIANISM

Utilitarianism, as defined by Jeremy Bentham, is a moral philosophy that evaluates the rightness or wrongness of actions based on their consequences. Bentham's definition can be summarized as follows:

"Utilitarianism is the doctrine that the best action is the one that maximizes overall happiness or pleasure and minimizes overall pain or suffering for the greatest number of people. This principle of utility suggests that the moral value of an action is determined by its ability to produce the greatest net benefit or the highest sum of pleasure over pain."

Hedonistic Calculus: Bentham introduced a hedonistic calculus to evaluate actions by measuring their intensity, duration, certainty, and extent of pleasure or pain. This method aims to quantify these factors to determine the moral value or utility of different actions.

Impartiality and Consequentialism: Utilitarianism emphasizes impartiality and the universal application of moral principles. It adopts a consequentialist approach, focusing on the outcomes of actions rather than the intentions behind them.

Objective: The goal of Bentham's Utilitarianism is to guide ethical decision-making towards the pursuit of happiness and the avoidance of suffering, ultimately striving for a more just and harmonious society.

Thus, Bentham's utilitarianism focuses on quantifying the effects of actions to determine their ethical value, with the ultimate goal of enhancing collective well-being.

4. MILL AS A CRITIC OF UTILITARIANISM

Mill retained the foundational principle of Utilitarianism but introduced significant modifications:

- **Higher and Lower Pleasures:** He distinguished between higher and lower pleasures, considering intellectual and moral pleasures as superior to physical ones.
- **Expansion of Utilitarianism:** Mill expanded the scope of Utilitarianism by incorporating factors such as moral motives, sociability, universal altruism, sympathy, and a redefined concept of justice that emphasized impartiality.
- **Happiness and Human Dignity:** Rather than focusing solely on pleasure, Mill made happiness and human dignity the ultimate goals of life. Happiness, for Mill, encompassed the development of moral virtues, the pursuit of lofty aspirations, self-control over desires, and recognition of individual and collective interests.
- **Quality of Pleasures:** While Bentham saw pleasure as equal in quality for all individuals, Mill emphasized that both pleasure and people differ in terms of quality. He famously stated that it is better to be a dissatisfied human being than a satisfied pig and better to be a dissatisfied Socrates than a satisfied fool.

According to **Bentham**, pleasure and people don't differ in quality. Hence, utilitarianism for Bentham was more of a **Quantitative term** —as he exclaimed "Pushpin as good as poetry". However, **Mill added the element of quality as for him, both pleasure and people differ in terms of quality.**

It is better to be a human being dissatisfied than a pig satisfied, it is better to be Socrates **dissatisfied than a fool satisfied.**

5. MILL'S IDEA ON LIBERTY



Mill classified liberty into 3 parts

- **The liberty of thought and expression,**
- **The liberty of action**
- **Liberty of association**

A. LIBERTY OF ACTION

Justification for Interference: John Stuart Mill's principle states that society can only interfere with an individual's freedom when necessary for self-protection. Such interference is only justified to prevent harm to others, not for the individual's own well-being.

Self-Regarding vs. Other-Regarding Actions: Mill differentiates between **self-regarding actions**, which concern only the individual, and **other-regarding actions**, which impact others. Individuals should be free to act in self-regarding matters without state interference. However, the state may intervene in other-regarding actions to prevent harm to others, a concept known as the "**Harm Principle**."

Challenges in Distinguishing Actions: Mill notes the difficulty in clearly separating self-regarding from other-regarding actions. For instance, destroying one's property might affect others or set a harmful example. Interference is only justified when there are direct obligations to others, not merely due to potential indirect effects.

Limits of State Intervention: Mill asserts that state intervention should focus on direct obligations rather than potential societal influence. The principle upholds individual liberty while addressing genuine harm to others.

B. LIBERTY OF ASSOCIATION

Mill defended the freedom of association based on several key reasons:

Effectiveness of Individual Action: Mill believed that tasks performed more effectively by individuals should be left to them rather than the government. Individuals with personal interest and investment in a matter are generally better suited to handle it.

Benefits of Collective Pursuit: Mill argued that allowing individuals to collectively pursue activities, even if less efficient than government execution, fosters mental development. The right to associate plays a crucial role in political education, promoting shared responsibilities and unity beyond personal and familial interests.

Avoiding Excessive Government Power: Mill cautioned against concentrating power excessively in the government. Encouraging individual participation in various activities helps prevent unnecessary expansion of governmental authority.

Mill viewed individual liberty as crucial for societal improvement. He believed that liberty fosters personal and moral advancement, enabling individuals to strive for growth. Empowering individuals to improve themselves leads to overall societal progress and flourishing.

C. LIBERTY OF THOUGHT AND EXPRESSION

Value of Liberty: Mill saw liberty as inherently valuable for fostering compassionate, civilized, and morally upright individuals. He emphasized that it benefits both society and individuals.

Threats to Liberty: The primary threat to individual liberty came from the tyranny and intolerance of the majority, especially through extreme egalitarianism and social conformity. Mill argued for limits on collective opinion's interference with individual independence.

Importance of Individuality: Mill championed individuality, seeing it as critical inquiry, responsible thought, self-development, and free will. He valued questioning norms and encouraging eccentricity against mass opinion.

Liberty of Expression: Mill argued that suppressing dissent deprived humanity of valuable knowledge and hindered the strengthening of correct views. He believed freedom of expression was essential for the clash between truth and error.

Role of Education and Happiness: Mill emphasized education, intellectual training, critical thinking, and character cultivation. He believed happiness resided in discovering and developing one's innate powers, exercising autonomous thought and action, equating happiness with liberty and individuality.

6.

LIMITS TO LIBERTY

Mill applied the principle of liberty mainly to mature individuals, excluding:

- **Children:** Due to their lack of maturity.
- **Invalids and the Mentally Handicapped:** Considered incapable of exercising liberty effectively.



- **"Non-Age" or Barbaric Societies:** Viewed as lacking the maturity for full liberty, with race seen as a hindrance to development.

Educational Deficiencies: Liberty could be restricted where individuals lacked proper education.

Liberty and Civilization

- **Advanced Civilizations:** Mill associated liberty with higher, more developed societies.
- **Lower Civilizations:** Suggested despotism or paternalism with strict limitations for societies deemed less advanced.

Liberty vs. State Strength

- **Warning Against Sacrifice:** Mill cautioned that infringing upon liberty to strengthen the state could be counterproductive.
- **Individual and State:** Recognized that states are composed of individuals and that excessive state control could be oppressive.
- **Society's Power:** Mill sought to protect the individual's private sphere from both government and societal oppression.

7.

"ALL SILENCING OF DISCUSSION IS ASSUMPTION OF INFALLIBILITY" – JS MILL

Advocacy of Free Speech: Mill views speech as a divine gift, essential for democracy and distinguishing humans from other species.

Purpose of Free Dialogue: Mill argues that the purpose of human life is to seek truth, with free dialogue being crucial for this pursuit. Emphasizes the importance of hearing dissenting voices, even those considered "mad," as truth can emerge from unexpected sources.

Rejection of Oppression

- **Tyranny of the Majority and Individual:** Mill rejects tyranny of both, asserting that silencing opinions deprives humanity of potential truths.
- **Clash of Ideas:** Believes that truth results from the confrontation of opposing ideas, not from suppression.

Importance in Democracy

- **Diverse Opinions:** In democracies, diverse opinions lead to discovering truth and reconciling differing perspectives.

- **Risk of Suppression:** Suppressing ideas, even those initially deemed false, risks losing valuable knowledge and implies an assumption of infallibility.

CRITICISM

Ambiguities in Mill's Theory: Mill was inconsistent in specifying the proper limits of legislation. While he supported compulsory education and regulations for public welfare, he opposed prohibition as an intrusion on liberty.

Critique by Sir Ernest Barker: Sir Ernest Barker criticized Mill for advocating an abstract form of individual liberty that may be impractical or insufficient in addressing real-world issues.

Evolution of Liberty Concept

- **Departure from Absolutism:** Mill's writings on liberty moved away from absolutist notions, recognizing the interdependence of individual actions.
- **Impact on Others:** Mill acknowledged that no behavior is purely self-regarding; every action affects others, challenging the clear distinction between self-regarding and other-regarding actions.
- **Bosanquet's View:** Bosanquet supported this perspective, emphasizing that individual actions inevitably have broader consequences.

8.

JS MILL AS FEMINIST

The Subjection of Women (1869) begins with the revolutionary statement, *"the principle which regulates the existing social relations between the two sexes—the legal subordination of one sex to the other is wrong in itself, and now one of the chief hindrances to human improvement; and it ought to be replaced by a principle of perfect equality"*.

Oppressive Marriage Laws: Mill highlights the discriminatory legal conditions in 19th-century England, including the denial of property rights to married women, exclusive guardianship of children by fathers, and the disregard of marital rape.

Paradoxes and Critiques

- **Inequality Despite Progress:** Mill finds it paradoxical that while liberty and equality are expanding in other areas, women remain oppressed. He seeks to challenge arguments for women's subordination and push for gender equality.

- **Historical Justifications:** He disputes the justification of women's inequality based on historical practices, noting that other oppressive systems, like slavery, have been rejected.

Advocacy for Equal Rights

- **Areas of Focus:** Mill advocates for women's suffrage, education, and employment opportunities, viewing these as essential for societal progress.
- **Equality as a Right:** He argues that women's status is worse than that of slaves due to chronic coercion and lacks legal equality.

Intellectual and Social Capabilities: Mill asserts that women have the same intellectual capabilities as men. He challenges the notion that women should be limited to domestic roles, advocating for autonomy in choosing their own paths.

Critique of Gender Roles and Family Power

- **Family Dynamics:** Mill criticizes the concentration of power in men within the family, leading to women's oppression. He questions the conventional separation of paternal and political power.
- **Economic Implications:** Mill attributes women's low wages to societal prejudices and barriers, arguing that removing these restrictions would benefit society by utilizing a broader pool of intellectual resources.

Mill believes that improving women's status is crucial not only for women but for the advancement of humanity. He advocates for equal opportunities to enhance both individual lives and societal progress.

9.

MILLS'S IDEAS ON REPRESENTATIVE GOVERNMENT

Mill viewed democracy as essential for achieving liberty in thought, expression, and action, which fosters personal development and enrichment.

Arguments Against Interfering with Freedom of Thought

- **Possibility of Truth Suppression:** Suppressing an opinion may prevent the emergence of a true opinion.
- **Partial Truth in Errors:** Even erroneous opinions may contain elements of truth that contribute to understanding.

- **Understanding True Opinions:** Suppressing false opinions hinders understanding the rationale behind true opinions and undermines the process of strengthening them.

- **Emergence of Truth:** The clash of opposing opinions allows remaining truths to emerge.

Limits to Individuality

- **Individuality vs. Harm:** Mill's concern for individuality is balanced by the need to avoid harm to others and maintain social harmony.
- **Negative Liberty:** Individuality should not disrupt social good; restraints are justified when actions affect the common good beyond personal interests.

Mill championed democracy and individual liberty as essential for personal and societal growth. While he valued individuality, he acknowledged that personal freedom must be balanced with the welfare of others and societal harmony, allowing for constraints only when individual actions impact the common good.

RELATING DEMOCRACY WITH REPRESENTATIVE GOVERNMENT

John Stuart Mill's vision of representative democracy is integral to his broader philosophy of liberty and individual development. He argued that democracy not only allows citizens to fully utilize their capabilities but also fosters virtue and intelligence, essential for both personal and societal advancement.

- **Representative Democracy and Progress:** Mill saw representative democracy as essential for progress, enabling citizens to develop their abilities, foster virtue, intelligence, and excellence, and make collective decisions effectively.
- **Reconciliation of Equality and Freedom:** Mill aimed to balance political equality with individual freedom. He believed that all citizens should be equal, with popular sovereignty giving legitimacy to the government.
- **Conditions for Effective Government:** Mill outlined conditions for a functioning representative government: active, self-reliant citizens; a commitment to democratic institutions; and safeguarding individual rights against majority tyranny.
- **Franchise and Voting Rights:** He supported equal voting rights but proposed adjusting the franchise to include literacy and basic skills as prerequisites. While advocating universal suffrage, Mill

emphasized the importance of ensuring that voters have the character and ability to contribute to the public good.

- **Importance of Political Participation:** Mill argued that political participation was crucial for developing reason, judgment, and moral maturity. He believed that involvement in governance and decision-making fosters community and belonging.

Mill's approach to representative democracy emphasizes the critical balance between political equality and individual freedom. By advocating for thoughtful enfranchisement and active participation, Mill aimed to enhance governance and nurture a community where individuals and society can thrive together.

10.

MILL AS RELUCTANT DEMOCRAT (CL WAYPER)

J.S. Mill is recognized as a transitional thinker who supported both direct democracy as an ideal and representative democracy as a practical form of government.

Conditions for Democracy: Mill expressed reservations about spreading democracy universally. He believed that democracy should be adopted only in societies that meet certain conditions, including the presence of a civic culture and a commitment to democratic principles.

Advocacy for Benevolent Despotism: Mill advocated benevolent despotism for colonies like India and China. He was concerned that expanding voting rights without the necessary conditions could lead to mobocracy and pave the way for authoritarian rule. This caution aligns with historical patterns where democracy, without constitutionalism, led to dictatorship or military rule.

Despite his concerns, Mill's scepticism was rooted in his strong belief in democratic governance. His reluctance reflected a profound commitment to both the theory and practice of democracy. While he emphasized the need for qualification in introducing democracy, Mill remains a prominent advocate of democracy and its fundamental values.

11.

RELEVANCE OF JS MILL'S IDEAS

John Stuart Mill's ideas continue to resonate deeply in contemporary debates across various domains.

- **Individual Liberty:** Mill's advocacy for individual liberty and freedom of expression remains highly relevant. His argument that individuals should be free to pursue their own interests as long as they do not harm others aligns with current discussions on freedom of speech, privacy rights, and personal autonomy.

- **Utilitarianism:** Mill's utilitarian philosophy, which focuses on maximizing overall happiness and well-being, influences modern ethical discussions. His framework helps navigate the balance between individual rights and the greater good in policy decisions and societal debates.

- **Women's Rights and Gender Equality:** Mill's pioneering support for women's rights and gender equality was groundbreaking. His arguments for equal rights, education, and political participation continue to inspire and support ongoing feminist movements and efforts toward gender equality.

- **Democratic Governance:** Mill's insights into representative democracy and political participation are pertinent today. His emphasis on informed and active citizenship underscores the importance of public engagement, free elections, and accountable governance in sustaining a healthy democracy.

- **Harm Principle:** Mill's harm principle, which permits interference with individual liberty only to prevent harm to others, remains influential. It is a key framework in debates on issues like hate speech, drug legalization, and government surveillance, guiding when societal intervention is justified.

Mill's philosophical contributions offer valuable perspectives on liberty, ethics, and governance, continuing to shape and inform contemporary discussions on these critical issues.

12.

CONCLUSION

Mill's liberal philosophy was pivotal in advancing modern democratic equality, particularly through his advocacy for women's suffrage. As a Member of Parliament, he campaigned for women's rights and critiqued their oppression, despite limited progress. Mill was among the first male philosophers to address gender subjugation and emphasized the need to protect individuality and privacy from collective intrusion.

NOTE: KARL MARX HAS BEEN DISCUSSED IN POLITICAL IDEOLOGIES (UNIT 8).

ANTONIO GRAMSCI

"The old world is dying, and the new world struggles to be born: now is the time of monsters."

- Antonio Gramsci (Prison Notebooks)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- ❖ Critically examine Gramsci's concept of Hegemony. (2008)
- ❖ Explain, as per Gramsci, the distinction between hegemony and domination. (2013)
- ❖ Discuss Gramsci's notion of 'organic intellectuals'. (2015)
- ❖ Comment on: Gramsci's concept of Hegemony. (2016)
- ❖ According to Gramsci, hegemony is primarily based on the organization of consent.' Comment. (2019)

1.

INTRODUCTION

- ❖ **Prominent Figure:** Antonio Francesco Gramsci, an influential Italian Marxist and social philosopher, was a key figure in 20th-century Marxist thought.
- ❖ **Imprisonment:** Imprisoned by Mussolini's fascist regime in 1926 due to his leadership in the Communist Party.
- ❖ **Prison Writings:** During his imprisonment, produced over 30 notebooks and approximately 3,000 pages of historical analysis and political commentary.
- ❖ **Prison Notebooks:** Highly regarded as a significant contribution to 20th-century political theory.
- ❖ **Inspirations:** Drew inspiration from fellow Marxist theorists and thinkers such as Machiavelli, Pareto, Sorel, and Croce.
- ❖ **Cultural Hegemony:** Developed a theoretical framework explaining how ruling powers use cultural institutions to maintain dominance in capitalist societies.
- ❖ **Superstructure and Class Relationships:** Argued the superstructure (cultural and ideological institutions) upholds class relationships. State and civil society employ mechanisms of hegemony to reinforce dominance.

- ❖ **Counter-Hegemony:** Advocated for developing counter hegemony to challenge ruling powers.

2.

GRAMSCI'S SIMILARITIES AND DIFFERENCES WITH MARX

According to Marxist theory, the mode of production shapes society, with all aspects derived from the economic base. Gramsci emphasized the significance of the superstructure, including cultural and ideological elements, in driving social change.

- ❖ **Ideas and Ideology as Class Consciousness:** Unlike Marx, Gramsci recognized the importance of ideas and ideology, considering them forms of class consciousness and integrating Hegelian idealism into his interpretation of Marxism.
- ❖ **Rejection of Economic Determinism:** Gramsci rejected economic determinism, emphasizing the role of cultural factors in historical analysis, influenced by Benedetto Croce.
- ❖ **Interplay of Economic Base and Superstructure:** He acknowledged the independent role of consciousness and offered a theory of history that highlighted the interplay between the economic base and the superstructure components.
- ❖ **Reciprocal Relationship:** Gramsci argued for a reciprocal relationship between the economic base and the superstructure, suggesting that cultural elements like law, culture, language, religion, and tradition could impact and transform the economic base.
- ❖ **Unity of Economic Base and Superstructure:** In contrast to classical Marxian tradition, Gramsci advocated for the unity of the economic base and the superstructure, recognizing the influence of culture, ideologies, and moral principles in shaping society.
- ❖ **Bourgeois Hegemony:** Gramsci emphasized the role of bourgeois hegemony in controlling society, extending beyond materialistic considerations to encompass cultural aspects.

Marx	Gramsci
❖ Marxist theory focuses on the coercive practices employed by the ruling class to exploit the proletariat through force.	❖ Gramsci places significant emphasis on the role of ideology and the superstructure in his analysis.

- ▶ **Marxist** theory focuses on the coercive practices employed by the ruling class to exploit the proletariat through force.
- ▶ **Society** is divided by Marx into two main components: the base, which encompasses the economic structure, and the superstructure, comprising socializing mechanisms such as language, religion, education, law, ideology, mass media, and the military.
- ▶ **According** to Marx, the economic base of society determines its social, political, and cultural environment.
- ▶ **He asserts that the economic relations within society form the foundation on which a legal and political superstructure is built, shaping specific forms of social consciousness.**
- ▶ Marx argues that since the ruling class owns and **controls** the means of production, they also dominate intellectual and cultural production. **Consequently, the ideas propagated by the ruling class become the prevailing ideas in society. Thus, for the working-class revolution to succeed, there must be a fundamental**
- ▶ Gramsci **places significant emphasis on the role of ideology and the superstructure in his analysis.**
- ▶ According to him, the ruling class strives for hegemony, seeking to establish its rule as acceptable to all classes before resorting to direct force and coercion.
- ▶ **Gramsci challenges the Marxist notion that the power of the ruling class is confined to the economic base alone.** Instead, he argues that a class becomes hegemonic not only through controlling the means of production and exerting coercion, but also by gaining consent from other classes.
- ▶ Unlike Marx's preoccupation with the economic base, **Gramsci highlights the importance of ideology and ideas. He argues that as long as the ideas of the subordinate classes are dominated, the ruling class can maintain its rule without resorting to force and oppression.**
- ▶ Gramsci further expands on Marx's division of the state into the base and superstructure by introducing the concepts of political society and civil society.

- ▶ **transformation of the economic base.**
- ▶ Marx contends that the economic base determines the social status of individuals, **implying that if the working class aims to become the dominant class in society, it must seize control of the economic base. In essence, revolution becomes possible only when there is a profound change in the economic foundation.**

- ▶ **Political society encompasses coercive institutions such as the government, armed forces, and legal system, while civil society includes non-coercive institutions involved in shaping public opinion, including libraries, schools, associations, and even architectural and urban elements.**
- ▶ Gramsci suggests that the failure of socialist revolution in capitalist societies, contrary to Marx's predictions, can be attributed to the hegemony of the capitalist class. As a result, he proposes a two-stage approach to class struggle and revolution: the war of position and the war of manoeuvre.

3.

BOURGEOISIE INSTRUMENTS OF DOMINATION

Marx's theory of historical materialism asserts that the dominant class's power is solely rooted in economic control. He views the state as essentially an instrument of the bourgeoisie. In his "Force theory of class struggle," the ruling class maintains its dominance through coercion, instilling fear and employing punishment.

In contrast, Gramsci presents a more nuanced perspective on how the ruling class maintains its power. He acknowledges that they employ various means such as force, economic influence, the formation of a historical bloc, and the consent of the governed. Gramsci specifically highlights two non-coercive methods:

- ▶ **Hegemony:** This concept refers to the ruling class's ability to establish its rule by gaining the consent and acceptance of other social classes. It involves

shaping the dominant ideology and cultural norms to align with the interests of the ruling class.

- **Historical bloc:** Gramsci emphasizes the importance of forging alliances and forming a cohesive bloc between different social groups. This strategic coalition enables the ruling class to maintain its dominance by unifying diverse interests under its ideological and political leadership.

Overall, **Gramsci's analysis offers a more comprehensive understanding of power dynamics, highlighting the significance of consent, ideology, and coalition-building alongside coercion and economic control.**

4.

THEORY OF HEGEMONY AND THE ROLE OF INTELLECTUALS

Gramsci's key contribution to Marxism lies in his concept of cultural hegemony, which explains how the ruling class maintains its domination over other classes.

- **Ideology's Role in Power:** Gramsci argued that ideology, not just force, is crucial for the ruling class to maintain control.
- **Hegemony Explained:** Hegemony describes the ruling class's intellectual and moral leadership, achieved through consent rather than just force.
- **More Than Domination:** Hegemony goes beyond simple domination. It involves both subjugating opposing groups and gaining the support of allied groups through cultural influence.

Through hegemony, the ruling classes establish their worldview as common sense, ensuring compliance and suppressing revolutionary movements. It not only involves the imposition of a monolithic ideology but is also produced by various institutions such as schools and prisons. Workers internalize these ideologies, making the struggle against capitalism challenging as they may identify with and subscribe to the ideas of their exploiters.

Gramsci's shift in focus from political economy to the analysis of culture marks the beginning of "Cultural Marxism." Hegemony, according to Gramsci, goes beyond binary domination and represents a comprehensive understanding of power and attraction. It involves on-going negotiations, compromises, and transactions between the ruling and subaltern classes, resulting in a constant process of consensus-building and adaptation.

Gramsci **distinguishes between two types of hegemony.**

1. **In limited hegemony**, the dominant class fails to accommodate the interests of the subaltern class, making revolution more feasible and allowing workers to develop true consciousness.
2. **In expansive hegemony**, the dominant class accommodates the interests of the subaltern class, making revolution highly challenging and hindering the development of true consciousness among workers.

Overall, Gramsci's concept of hegemony highlights the complex interplay of power, consent, and ideology in maintaining class domination, expanding the understanding of Marxist theory beyond economic determinism

5.

GRAMSCI'S ANALYSIS OF SUPERSTRUCTURE

Gramsci is recognized **as a theoretician of the superstructure** because he places significant emphasis on the role of the superstructure in the development of history and the distribution of power within society. **In contrast to Marx's economic determinism, Gramsci attributes an autonomous role to the superstructure.**

Gramsci identifies two levels of the superstructure:

- **Civil Society:** This level is closely connected to the economic base and serves as a source of legitimization. It encompasses various social institutions and practices that shape public opinion and values.
- **Political Society:** This level exercises overall control and represents the institutions responsible for coercion and governance. It includes the government, armed forces, legal systems, and other institutions that enforce laws and maintain social order.

In essence, Gramsci's analysis recognizes the interplay between these two levels of the superstructure and their influence on social dynamics and power relations.

6.

HOW CIVIL SOCIETY OPERATES IN SUPER-STRUCTURE?

Civil society occupies a position between the state and the economic structure. It functions as a private network that permeates all social organizations and plays a crucial role in disseminating and maintaining hegemony. Despite its outward appearance of neutrality, civil society is closely aligned with the economic base and serves as a significant arena for the operation of hegemonic power.

- **The primary objective of civil society is to generate consent and support for the capitalist class. Gramsci argues that both civil society and the state form the structures of domination in society.**
- **For capitalism to maintain its stability, it relies on the effectiveness of civil society institutions. These institutions act as a buffer, absorbing shocks and functioning as the first line of defense against revolutionary movements.** Consequently, Gramsci proposes engaging in a "war of position" to contest and transform civil society.

In summary, civil society occupies a crucial position in maintaining capitalist hegemony, and challenging its influence within civil society is a strategic approach in pursuing social change.

7. GRAMSCI'S IDEA OF REVOLUTION

Gramsci identifies the failure of the socialist revolution in capitalist societies, which contradicted Marx's predictions, as resulting from the dominant class's hegemonic control. In response, Gramsci proposes a two-stage strategy for revolutionary class struggle.

- **The first stage is the "war of position," which involves challenging the hegemony of the capitalist class within civil society.** This covert and gradual struggle aims to gain influence and power within key social institutions. It seeks to create an alternative social base for a new state by nurturing organic intellectuals and establishing supportive institutions.
- The second stage is the **"war of manoeuvre," which entails a direct confrontation with the political state.** Gramsci argues that once the working class has developed revolutionary consciousness through the war of position, they can effectively overthrow the capitalist state and establish a communist system.

It is crucial to recognize the interconnectedness of these two stages. In modern times, a direct confrontation with the state alone is insufficient to threaten the dominant class's position unless they

continue to maintain their hegemonic control over civil society.

In summary, Gramsci's proposed two-stage strategy for revolution acknowledges the significance of countering hegemony within civil society before engaging in a direct struggle against the political state.

8. GRAMSCI'S IDEA OF INTELLECTUALS

Gramsci perceives intellectuals as individuals who perform organizational roles in various spheres of society, including the economy, politics, and culture.

- **He argues that all individuals engage in intellectual pursuits outside of their professional activities, although they may not be intellectuals in terms of their social function.**
- **According to Gramsci, intellectuals play a crucial role in creating, sustaining, and expanding the hegemony of the class they represent.** They go beyond merely expressing economic interests and are instrumental in articulating and disseminating the perspectives of their respective classes.

Gramsci's concept of intellectuals encompasses a wide range of social agents, including scholars, artists, and those in technical or leadership positions in society, such as administrators, bureaucrats, industrial managers, and politicians.

He classifies intellectuals into two categories: organic intellectuals and traditional intellectuals.

ORGANIC INTELLECTUALS

- **Gramsci identifies intellectuals as individuals who possess specific sociological characteristics and represent the interests of a particular class.** They are actively involved in both the production of ideas and the articulation of their class's aspirations, often developing counter-hegemonic narratives. For instance, Ambedkar is viewed as an organic intellectual for the Dalit community.
- **Organic intellectuals are seen as entrepreneurs and organizers within the masses. They play a crucial role in shaping new cultures and social classes, acting as spokespersons for the working class.** Gramsci considers organic intellectuals as a distinct "new class" that emerges alongside the rise of a new social class. These intellectuals are unique in that they give voice to those who lack representation and can inspire collective action for meaningful causes.

Due to their opposition to and displacement of established classes and their intellectuals, **organic intellectuals can be viewed as revolutionary.** Their significance lies in their ability to elaborate and disseminate organic ideology, making them essential agents in the struggle for social change.

TRADITIONAL INTELLECTUALS

- **Gramsci identifies another class of intellectuals who do not belong to any specific social class but maintain historical continuity through customs and traditions.** Church fathers serve as an example of this type. These intellectuals, known as traditional intellectuals, are often closely associated with the petite bourgeoisie class, particularly in rural areas.
- **Traditional intellectuals fulfil a socio-political role by establishing an organic connection between the peasant classes and the state apparatus.** They may include priests, lawyers, teachers, doctors, and others who enjoy a different standard of living than the average peasants. Their presence serves as a source of inspiration for the peasant class to strive for improved standards of living.
- **Unlike organic intellectuals, traditional intellectuals are detached from the process of production and labour.** Instead, they focus on private spheres such as religion, ethics, and education. They may have an acknowledged or unacknowledged association with the ruling class of their time.

The role of traditional intellectuals is significant in understanding how hegemony operates. In order for an emerging class to successfully overthrow the ruling class, it becomes necessary for the traditional intellectuals to align themselves with the ideology of the emerging class. Their ideological shift plays a crucial part in the transformation of hegemonic power dynamics

9. CONCEPT OF IDEOLOGY AND STATE

Ideological Epiphenomenalism: Epiphenomenalism argued that the economic infrastructure determined the ideological superstructure, suggesting ideology had no impact on economic life or revolutionary change. Gramsci revised this notion and argued that ideology is a structure in itself.

Source of Revolutionary Change: Gramsci argued that revolutionary change arose from tensions within the economic infrastructure, particularly the relations and forces of production and antagonistic classes.

Critique of Inevitability: Gramsci rejected the idea that capitalism would collapse solely due to economic laws, emphasizing the mutually exclusive class character of ideologies between the capitalist and working classes.

Redefining Ideology: He redefined ideology as practices, politico-ideological discourses, and elements, moving away from epiphenomenalism and class reductionism.

Organic Ideology: Gramsci introduced "organic ideology," a system of class rule or hegemony integrating various ideological elements into a unified system.

Hegemonic System: In a hegemonic system, the ruling class holds power through economic supremacy and articulates ideological discourses within civil society.

Diffusion Through Institutions: Organic ideology spreads through social institutions like the family, churches, media, schools, legal systems, trade unions, and economic associations, integrating diverse class interests into a cohesive structure.

Role of Organic Intellectuals: "Organic intellectuals" unify ideological elements from subordinate groups into a coherent system, establishing hegemony.

Gramsci's theory influenced critical theorists analysing **consumerism and materialism's** role in creating a **homogenized society**, which leads to a loss of revolutionary consciousness among workers and sustains capitalism.

10.

CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE OF GRAMSCI

Antonio Gramsci's ideas continue to be highly relevant in contemporary times, offering valuable insights into the dynamics of power, hegemony, and social change. Here are some aspects of Gramsci's theories that remain pertinent today:

- **Cultural Hegemony:** Dominant groups use cultural institutions (media, schools) to spread their ideas and control public discourse. (e.g., Hollywood promoting a specific type of family structure as the norm).
- **Intersectionality:** Different social identities (race, class, gender) shape how people experience oppression. (e.g., A Black woman might face both racism and sexism that a white man wouldn't).
- **Counter-Hegemony:** Social movements challenge dominant ideas and build solidarity for change. (e.g.,



The Black Lives Matter movement challenging police brutality narratives).

- **Organic Intellectuals:** Intellectuals play a role in shaping public opinion and advocating for social justice. (e.g., Artists using their work to critique social inequalities).
- **Global Capitalism:** Gramsci's critique of capitalism highlights the exploitation and inequality within the system. (e.g., The concentration of wealth in the hands of a few while many struggle to afford basic necessities).

11.

CONCLUSION

Antonio Gramsci's ideas revolutionized political theory by looking **beyond economics**. He argued that **culture** and **ideology** play a crucial role in shaping societies. Gramsci's concept of **hegemony** explains how dominant groups maintain power not just through force, but by shaping ideas and public discourse. He also identified the importance of "organic intellectuals," leaders within social movements who challenge these dominant ideas. Overall, Gramsci's work provides a powerful lens for understanding **power, resistance, and the forces that drive social change**.

HANNAH ARENDT (1906–1975): AN INCONSISTENT YET ORIGINAL THINKER

"Unthinkable respect for authority is the greatest enemy of truth." (Albert Einstein)

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

- Critically examine Hannah Arendt's conceptual triad of labour, work, and action. (2019)
- Discuss Hannah Arendt's analysis of the role of Ideology in modern totalitarian regimes. (2016)
- Comment on: "Power is never the property of an individual; it belongs to a group and remains in existence only so long as the group keeps together." (2014)
- Hannah Arendt's conception of the 'political'. (2012)
- Discuss the political philosophy of Hannah Arendt. (2003)

1.

INTRODUCTION: HANNAH ARENDT AS A THINKER

- Hannah Arendt was one of the seminal political thinkers of the twentieth century. The power and originality of her thinking was evident in works such as *The Origins of Totalitarianism* (1951), *The Human Condition* (1958), *On Revolution* (1961), *Eichmann in Jerusalem: A Report on the Banality of Evil* (1963) and *On Violence* (1969).
- She has delved on multiple ideas through her own prism of experience and contemplation. Arendt's work undertakes a reconstruction of the nature of political existence.
- Hannah is particularly known for her analysis of the problems of human freedom and the various forms of power revealing in the contemporary society. Her thinking is so original that it cannot be clubbed with any of the prevalent ideologies.
- Hannah Arendt proceeds with, beginning from a phenomenological prioritization of the "factual" and experiential character of human life, endeavouring to uncover the fundamental structures of political experience.

2.

HANNAH ARENDT ON TOTALITARIANISM (REIGN OF TERROR)

CONTEXT: Arendt's first major work, *The Origins of Totalitarianism* published in 1951, is a response to the devastating events of her own time – the rise of Nazi Germany and the catastrophic fate of European Jewry at its hands, the rise of Soviet Stalinism and its annihilation of millions of peasants, free-thinking intellectuals, scientists and political activists.

RULE OF VIOLENCE: Arendt emphasised that these political evil forms could not be interpreted as merely larger or more extensive versions of earlier precursors, but rather as a wholly "novel form of government" based on **terror and ideological fabrication**.

TERROR AS END: Modern totalitarian governments have employed fear less strategically than past tyrannies, which had used it as a tool for gaining or maintaining power. Instead, terror had become a political aim and end in itself.

POPULARITY OF IDEA: Totalitarian ideologies were popular due to the devastation of order and the spread of revolutionary unrest due to WW-1 and Great Depression, creating a clear path to secure future.

EROSION OF FREEDOM AND LIBERTY: European populations were vulnerable due to the **erosion space for freedom and liberty and thus the public life** with

- **EROSION OF FREEDOM AND LIBERTY:** European populations were vulnerable due to the **erosion space for freedom and liberty and thus the public life** with the expansion of imperialist capital and the capture of the state by bourgeoisie.

HANNAH ARENDT ON IDEOLOGY

Arendt is a critique of ideology as ideologies are unscientific and misused by the totalitarian leaders (for instance, **Fascism and Communism**).

Marx claimed his theory as science and **Hitler** based his theory of Racial Superiority of Aryan Race on Darwin's theory of **"Struggle for existence and natural selection"**.

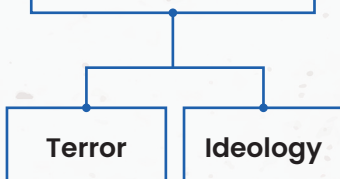
Totalitarians rooted their ideas in nature's superhuman laws. And they call for observing these laws and play active role in the History.

They appealed masses to kill **Targeted Enemies** in the name of Historical Laws. And when people become part of conspiracy, it is easy to justify VIOLENCE.

A. WHAT CONDITIONS GIVE RISE TO TOTALITARIANISM AND WHY PEOPLE GET INFLUENCED BY TOTALITARIANISM?

- **LACK OF SOCIETAL ORDER:** The most conducive environment for growth of totalitarianism is socio economic crisis and instability of life.

Two Instruments of Totalitarian State



- **MODERNITY:** Arendt blames modernity for rise of totalitarianism. In symbolic sense she says that modernity begins with the explosion of nuclear bomb in Hiroshima. In her work The Human Condition, she believes that the most important human action is participation in public affairs. Modernity has ended the public sphere and given rise to centralised bureaucratic administration with the belief that bureaucrats would work in public interest. Since modernity made economic sphere the most important one, we neglected political sphere and it resulted into the state becoming totalitarian.
- **DEPOLITICISED MASSES:** According to her, when depoliticised masses are enfranchised, it gives rise

- to totalitarianism. Depoliticised masses get right to vote which gives rise to **demagogic leaders and mobocracy**.

Only when the people act in a responsible manner and participate in politics, they can prevent the emergence of totalitarianism.

3.

THE HUMAN CONDITION: HANNAH ARENDT ON POLITICS

- **Exploration of Political Experience:** The work of establishing the conditions of possibility for political experience, as opposed to other spheres of human activity, was undertaken by Arendt in her next major work, The Human Condition (1958).

- Arendt's Critique of Traditional Political Philosophy: She conducts a historical-philosophical inquiry into the origins of democracy and political philosophy in Ancient Greece. Arendt proposes

Freedom is **"an accessory of doing and acting;"** "Men are free... as long as they act, neither before nor after; for to be free and to act are the same."

a **phenomenological reconstruction** to improve political life and critiques traditional philosophy for devaluing human action (**vita activa**) in favour of contemplation (**vita contemplativa**).

- The Human Condition is fundamentally concerned with the **problem of reasserting politics** as a valuable realm of human action i.e. **praxis**, and the world of appearances.

The prime culprit is **Plato**, whose metaphysics subordinate action and appearances to the eternal realm of the Ideas. In the Allegory of cave (The Republic), Plato describes the world of human affairs in terms of shadows and darkness.

4.

THE VITA ACTIVA: LABOUR, WORK AND ACTION (Conceptual Triad)

In The Human Condition Arendt argues for a tripartite division between the human activities of labour, work, and action. Moreover, she arranges these activities in an **ascending hierarchy of importance** and identifies the **overturning of this hierarchy** as central to the eclipse of political freedom and responsibility which, for her, has come to characterize the modern age.

LABOR: HUMANITY AS ANIMAL LABORANS

- Labour is that activity which corresponds to the biological processes and necessities of human existence (for maintenance of life).
- Arendt is highly **critical of Marx's elevation of animal laborans** to a position of primacy in his vision of the highest ends of human existence.
- Drawing on the Aristotelian distinction of the oikos (the private realm of the household) from the polis (the public realm of the political community), Arendt argues that matters of labour, economy and the like properly belong to the former, not the latter.
- The prioritization of the economy (capitalism) has eclipsed the possibilities of meaningful political agency and the pursuit of higher ends which should be the proper concern of public life.

WORK: HUMANITY AS HOMO FABER

If labour relates to basic necessities of life, **work is "the activity"** which corresponds to the unnaturalness of human existence i.e. fabrication of an artificial world of things.

Humanity in this mode of its activity is called as **homo faber**. A person is the builder of walls (both physical and cultural) which divide the human realm from that of nature and provide a stable context of spaces and institutions within which human life can unfold.

Homo Faber's typical representatives are the builder, the architect, the craftsperson, the artist and the legislator, as they create the public world both physically and institutionally by constructing buildings and making laws.

DISTINCTION BETWEEN LABOUR (ANIMAL LABORANS) AND WORK (HOMO FABER)

1. Whereas labour is bound to the demands of animality, biology and nature, work violates the realm of nature by shaping and transforming it according to the plans and needs of humans; this makes work a distinctly human (i.e. non-animal) activity.
2. Since work is governed by human ends and intentions, it exhibits a certain quality of freedom.
3. Whereas labour is concerned with satisfying the individual's life-needs and so remains essentially a private affair, work is inherently public.

ACTION: HUMANITY AS ZOOM POLITIKON

- **Homo Faber vs. Human Freedom:** Arendt argues that the activity of homo faber does not equate with human freedom and cannot occupy the apex of the human condition.
- **Freedom in the Vita Activa:** The quality of freedom, essential to politics, is found in the activity of action proper within the vita activa.
- **Action as Freedom:** The defining quality of action is its ineliminable freedom, its status as an end in itself. Arendt, drawing from Augustine, equates human action with freedom.
- **Public Nature of Action:** Action is a public category, experienced through interaction with others, corresponding to the human condition of plurality.
- **Importance of Publicity and Plurality:** Action gains meaning through the presence of others who witness it.
- **Action as Political:** For Arendt, action is synonymous with the political; politics involves citizens exercising their agency through free speech and persuasion.

COMPONENTS OF ACTION

Freedom = Natality	Plurality
➤ She defines freedom as natality. Natality means capacity to do something new. ➤ She puts emphasis on people's participation in politics and freedom to express oneself recognising worth of each person.	➤ Equality: Sameness i.e. all of us are humans and equal. ➤ Diversity: Though all of us are same, yet different. It means, everyone is unique and has capacity to do something new.

"...freedom...is actually the reason that men live together in political organisations at all. Without it, political life as such would be meaningless. The raison d'être of politics is freedom, and its field of experience is action."

"Power is actualised only where word and deed haven't parted company, where words are not empty and deeds not brutal, where words are not used to veil intentions but to disclose realities and deeds are not used to violate and destroy but to establish relations and create new realities."

-Hannah Arendt

5. HANNAH ARENDT ON REVOLUTION

Hannah Arendt in her work, **On Revolution (1961)** takes her rethinking of political concepts and applies them to the modern era. Arendt **criticizes both liberal and Marxist interpretations** of modern political revolutions (such as the French and American).

Criticism of Liberals: She disagrees with the view that revolutions were primarily concerned with the establishment of a limited government with space for individual liberty.

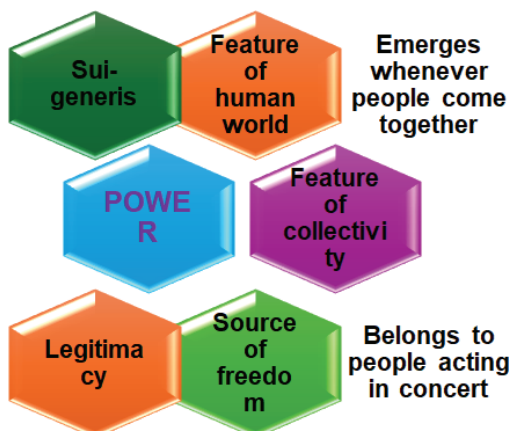
Criticism of Marxists: She disputes the claim that French Revolution was a popular attempt to **overcome poverty and exclusion** by the many against the few who monopolized wealth.

Arendt's View: The revolutions exhibit the exercise of fundamental political capacities – that of individuals acting together on the basis of their mutually agreed common purposes, in order to establish a tangible public space of freedom. Yet Arendt sees both the French and American revolutions as ultimately failing to establish a perduring political space in which the on-going activities of shared deliberation, decision and coordinated action could be exercised.

The average citizen, while protected from arbitrary exercise of authority by constitutional checks and balances, was no longer a participant “in judgement and authority,” and so became denied the possibility of exercising his/her political capacities.

6. HANNAH ARENDT ON POWER

Basis of theory: Based on the theory of Human Action and understanding of totalitarianism.



She tries to give real meaning of power rather than what is generally understood. In order to understand power, we need to distinguish between some words which appear similar:

Force and Power: Force is characteristic of nature whereas power is a characteristic of society and social world.

Strength and Power: Strength is characteristic of individual, and a person may be strong and weak, whereas power is characteristic of social world and **people acting together**.

Violence and Power: Violence is used by state or authority whereas power belongs to the people.

7. EICHMANN OF JERUSALEM: THE BANALITY OF EVIL

The concept emerged in her book ***Eichmann in Jerusalem: A Report on the Banality of Evil (1963)***.

Shift in Focus: This work of Arendt marks a shift in her concerns from the nature of political action to a concern deeper– the interrelated activities of thinking and judging. She wanted to know present times evil does not appear evil, it has become banal or normal part of day-to-day life.

The Bureaucratic Machine: During the trial of Eichmann (an official responsible for extermination of Jews), she realised that he was not the real culprit. He did not even have hatred towards the Jews. Rather the **Bureaucratic Culture i.e., culture of blind obedience**.

“Persons who commit crimes are neither monsters, psychopaths, sociopaths or brilliant. They are just bureaucrats.”

–Hannah Arendt

➤ **Fault of Eichmann:** He had lost imaginative capacity. He was not aware of moral consequences of his actions. He was an innocuous man who operated without thinking.

➤ **Faceless Nature:** So, evil becomes banal when it acquires **unthinking systematic character** and when ordinary people participate in it, build distance from it, **justify it in countless ways**. **There are no moral conundrums and revulsions**. In such situation, evil does not look like evil, it becomes faceless.

Presently in our society the issues involving like **mob violence, discrimination and oppression** are key evils, it becomes banal when people become **spectators and at times un-thinking participants**.

8. CONTEMPORARY RELEVANCE

- **Civic actions:** Her reflections on the distinctiveness of modern democratic revolutions have been important in the development of republican thought, and for the recent **revival of interest in civic mobilizations and social movements**.
- **Influence on scholars:** Arendt has decisively influenced critical and emancipatory scholars. Jürgen Habermas admits the formative influence of Arendt upon his own theory of **communicative action/ reason and discourse ethics**.
- **Technology:** Jean-Luc Nancy have likewise been influenced by her critique of the **modern technological "levelling" of human distinctiveness**, often reading Arendt's account in tandem with Heidegger's critique of technology.
- **Deliberation and Participation:** In today's context, participation and consultations with civic society are crucial for functioning of substantive democracy. Thus, Arendt's theories of power and political are of great relevance.

Social audit, Mohalla Sabhas, etc. are the contemporary democratic models.

9. CRITICISM OF HANNAH ARENDT

- **Feminist Critique:** Arendt's strict division between the "private" and "public" spheres results in exclusion of women from the legitimate politics as the outside or "public" realm is subject to domination by men.
- **Marxist Critique:** Marxists criticize her for separating economic matters (social justice, poverty and exploitation) from political discussion and neglecting issues of social justice.
- **Arendt's endorsement of Athenian state** and ignoring the modern political institutions is criticized by the scholars as direct participation of all the people seems unworkable. Further, her notion of superiority of political action and subordination of other modes of human action has also been challenged.

10. CONCLUDING REMARK

Despite these and other criticisms, Arendt continues to be one of the most innovative, thought-provoking, and important political thinkers of the 20th century. Her work will undoubtedly continue to inspire political philosophy as we moved into the 21st century.

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